Finding Halfmoon

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39014010.

Rating:
Mature

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra), Swift Wind (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Emily (She-Ra), Wrong Hordak (She-Ra), Razz (She-Ra), Princess Alliance (She-Ra) - Character, Original Characters, George (She-Ra), Lance (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
catradora, Finding Halfmoon Series, Catra's POV, POV First Person, Slow Burn, Fluff, Fluff and Smut, Healing, reflections of the past, Dreams and Nightmares, Visions, Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Adora (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Implied Sexual Content, Original Character(s), Other Additional Tags to Be Added, Descriptions of war, Childhood Trauma, Panic Attacks, Halfmoon (She-Ra), Catra and Adora are in love, Family, Marriage Proposal, Weddings

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by Midnight_Owl2

Summary

Catra and Adora have been together for over a year now. They're engaged and are living their best life in Brightmoon. Everything seems perfect… almost perfect. After Entrapta discovers some mysterious ruins and presents her findings to her friends, Catra begins to experience strange visions, visions that appear all too familiar to her. She makes it her secret mission to find out what they mean. Whilst searching for answers, Catra discovers some more information about her past before the Horde and comes across those she never imagined existed.

Who Am I

Chapter Summary

Adora's and Catra's starts like any other, that is until Glimmer asks to see them.

Entrapta presents some new findings from a recent mission.

Catra starts to question why she feels like a part of her is missing.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“Catra? Are you awake?”

I hear a voice softly whisper in my ear. I’m at peace in my sleepy state. Five more minutes is all I ask for. Cuddling up to the strong, soft form next to me, I wrap my arms around them tightly and bury my head against their chest.

“Is that a yes or a no?” The person asks again and they begin to gently scratch behind my ears. I learn into their touch, slowly beginning to purr.

“Curse you Adora. You know how much I love being scratched behind my ears.”

I hear my girlfriend, *no wait… fiancé*, giggle below me. Her chest rises and falls with her laughter. I open my eyes to find her gorgeous smile and beautiful blue eyes looking back at me.

“Well it worked didn’t it? You’re awake aren’t you?”

“Yes but I thought we agreed that we’d have a lie in this morning and do nothing.”

"I know but I've been awake for a while now and… *well*… I was getting lonely."

Sitting up slightly, I move to hold the covers against the front of my chest to keep myself covered and warm. I look down at Adora is disbelief.

"You were lonely? I've been sleeping right beside you all night!"

"I know but it gets lonely after a while when your still asleep and I have no one to talk to. You are pretty to watch when you sleep though so I'm not complaining."

Stars I love this dummy. How on Etheria did I end up falling in love with her?

My laughter echoes through our room as I lie back down, resting my head on Adora's chest before placing a gentle kiss over the Heart of Etheria scar under her low cut shirt. The scar has now started to fade but it's still visible to those who know where to look for it. Adora starts to trace slow circular patterns through the thin fur on my back, before gently placing a kiss to the top of my head. Our free hands find each other under the blankets and we interlace them together. Our bodies perfectly fit together as if they were made for each other.

Life with Adora is wonderful. I never dreamed that one day I'd get to spend the rest of my life with her like this yet here we are, lying together in bed, holding each other close and planning the rest of our lives together as future wives. The war ended just over a year ago and Adora and I have been engaged just under two months now. It was one of the best days of my life. I had not expected it at all. Despite her having me worry about her all day with her *'unusual behaviour'*, she had planned the perfect proposal.

She took me back to the beginning, the place where our story began, the place where we shared so many memories that only me and her will ever get to share: our secret spot, the watch

tower. I remember it clearly. The sun was beginning to set over the newly greenfield Fright Zone, Adora took my hand in hers, looked me in the eyes and spoke from the heart. She presented me with her wing pin, saying that it resembled new beginnings and the next chapter of our story, before getting down on one knee and asking me to marry her. Of course I said yes, there was no questioning it. Adora is my world, the love of my life… *I just can't believe that she beat me to it.* I was going to be the one to propose to her. The only reason I haven't yet is because… *well, I'm kind of embarrassed about it…* I haven't found anything significant to propose with yet. I want to propose to her with something meaningful, something that comes from the heart, something that represents both of us. Sadly, anything other than my mask, *which we all know what happened to that,* I haven't really owned anything personal.

Adora is aware that it bothers me that I haven't been able to give her something as an engagement gift yet, but she has reassured me many times that it doesn't bother her and that I don't need to give her anything in return. I know that it makes sense but still it feels… *wrong.* This wing pin shows that Adora loves me and that I am her forever love, but it upsets me that I have nothing for Adora that tells others that I love her and that she is my forever love. I promise myself that I will get Adora something before we get married, but I don't want that something to be plain and simple. Whatever I get her I want to represent us, to be unique, to represent that love that I have for her, the love that I have always had for her.

The feeling of Adora's hand brushing through my hair brings me out of my thoughts. My hair is slightly longer now than what it was when the war ended but still not a long as I'd like it to be. I will be growing it out, getting it as long as possible, back so that I have a mane. A Magicats mane has a significance that's difficult to describe, but as much as I like my short hair it only feels right to grow it out. If I had made the choice to cut my hair short then maybe I'd feel different about it… *but Prime took that choice away from me, took my right to choose and to be free away from me.* Therefore, by growing my mane back, it'll hopefully allow me to

feel more in control than I did back then. The flashbacks that came with my hair getting to that slick length were scary. They kept me up most nights. Thankfully Adora helped me through them all, reminding me that I was no longer in that living nightmare and that I was now, and forever will be, safe in her arms. My hair is at a point now where I can get it into a low pony tail, a length that finishes just slightly above my shoulder blades but is enough to cover the chip scar. It's not much but it's a start. We had to cut it back a bit so it'll look right when it fully grow back. It's taken it a while to get to this point.

"What you thinking about?" Adora asks curiously.

Adora can always tell when something is on my mind. However, at this moment in time, nothing is really bothering me, I'm just away with my thoughts. Although, something has just occurred to me…

"I'm thinking why hasn't my beautiful fiancé given me my morning kisses yet?"

Adora sarcastically looks in shock… "Oh no I'm a terrible fiancé. I'm not fit to be your wife, *never alone mind fiancé*, if I forgot to give you morning kisses."

Adora goes to get up out of bed. Using all my might, I grab Adora's night shirt and drag her back down to the bed...

"Where do you think you're going? Get back here!"

She lands on top of me in a fit of laughter. *Stars I love this dummy.* Adora kisses me passionately and I return her kiss with the same amount of enthusiasm. Adora giggles between each kiss, telling me how much she loves me and how beautiful I am. She knows I get flustered easy and struggle to take compliments like this, but I am getting better. Learning to love myself was a big leap forward but its helped to make taking these compliments easier. Our kisses get a bit more heated and our hands start to roam over each other's body. Adora repositions herself on top of

me properly and starts to kiss my pulse point. I swear she's deliberately trying to turn me on.

"You're so clingy." I tease as my claws slightly dig into the back of her nightshirt.

"I am not. I just love showing my beautiful fiancé how much I love her. I love you Catra."

"I love you too dummy. Now who said you could stop."

Adora smiles and kisses me softly before things start to pick up in pace. Adora's hands are soft and gentle. They map out my body perfectly, although I'm not surprised now considered how many times we've been together like this. It took us a while to get this confident and comfortable with each other, learning what works for each other, learning what each other likes and dislikes. We quickly worked it out although to me it didn't really matter. With Adora it always felt right, felt perfect, felt like we were meant to be. We haven't really had time to be with each other like *this* in a while. We've only had time for heavy, heated make-out sessions here and there with quick stolen moments when possible but never anything more *physical* where we can give into our desires. It's becoming increasingly frustrating. Hopefully now we have some time alone to make up for lost time.

Unfortunately for us, before things can start to lead anywhere more than kissing and soft touches, a knock is heard at our door followed by some light scratching…

Knock, Knock, Knock

"Sorry to bother you two love birds but I think Melog wants to come inside. I think they've been sat here for a while judging from the scratch marks on your door." Glimmer's voice calls from the other side of the door, followed by a loud *"mreow".*

At least Sprakles remembered to knock this time. Last time she *poofed* in her after hearing Adora say *"For the Honour of Grayskull."* It was an awkward moment for all three of us. Let's

just say that if it wasn't for the covers covering me and the fact that when Adora transforms she still has her clothes on, well then there would have been a story to tell. Naked Adora is for my eyes only. She has Arrow Boy to fond over.

Adora looks slightly disappointed and I can't help but laugh.

"Thanks Sparkles. Melog I'll let you in in a moment."

"Okay cool. I'll see you in a bit then… oh wait, before I go, can you both meet myself, Bow and my dad in the briefing room later today? Entrapta's found something that she wants us all to take a look at."

Adora and I look at each other slightly concerned. I'm not quite sure if we should be intrigued or worried. There have been plenty of weird and wonderful new sightings all over Etheria since the magic was realised from the planet's heart. Whatever Entrapta has discovered will obviously be an interesting discovery, that I'm certain of.

This time Adora is the one to answer… "Sure thing Glimmer. Give us about an hour or two to get ready and have something to eat and we'll see you there."

"Thank you. See you later. See you in a bit Melog… oh you want a belly rub? Do we want a belly rub? Oh you do. Who's a cute little Krytis alien? You are. Yes you are. Okay I got to go now. I'll see you later with Catra and Adora. Bow might give you some belly rubs too if you ask him."

Adora shakes her head in disbelief and giggle-snorts before looking back at me…

"Come on Adora. You know Melog is adorable. They know how to get attention when they want it. Even you have fallen for their charming ways before now."

"It's a good job they're cute, otherwise I'd be telling them off for interrupting our little private moment."

"At least Melog is polite and doesn't come barging in uninvited like your talking horse or sparkly friend."

With that Adora bursts out in laughter and rolls off the top of me, holding her sides…

"What's funny is I can't even argue with you on that one. Talk about embarrassing. Thank stars that both have now taken a leaf out of Melog's book and knock before entering, or in Swift Winds case not long flies through the window and then awkwardly tries to get back out the same way."

Both of those incidents were a mood killer. Thankfully for Swift Wind, nothing was going on between Adora and I at that moment. All he saw was my towel go flying, followed by a loud splashing sound as I fell into the water feature in our room right after I finished having a shower. Thankfully for me, therapy has helped me to get over my fear of pools of water after what happened on Primes ship. It could have been much worse. Adora dove in after me and gave Swift Wind a proper mouthful about it, which he felt incredibly sorry for afterwards.

Adora and I both get out of bed and get dressed ready for the day to begin. We both choose to wear our standard attire. We do have other clothes but we feel more comfortable in what we're used to wearing. So much so we had Brightmoon's designers make the same outfits but it different colours for us. However, I did make Adora a brand new jacket for her birthday. It's the same style as her red one but it's a beautiful blue colour instead so that it matches her eyes. The rips in the sleeves were my idea. She does wear it from time to time but she has stated that she likes to keep if for special occasions such as date nights and adventuring. Can't really argue with that one. I opt to wear my standard attire for two reasons: one, just like Adora I feel more comfortable in clothes I feel familiar with and two, because I know what effect the boob window has on Adora.

Once fully dressed, Adora opens to door for Melog, who greets her by brushing up against her leg in a way of saying thanks. She

shuts the door behind them and bends down to Melog, giving them a good scratch on their head in greeting. Melog leans into her touch before licking her cheek. Adora's laughs exactly like the first time Melog gave her a greeting kiss. They then bounce over to me and join me on the bed, gently brushing their head against mine as they start to purr up a storm.

"Awww. I've miss you too buddy. How was your morning at Entrapta's?"

Melog often visits all of our friends around Etheria, but they tend to visit Scorpia, Entrapta and Madam Razz the most. It's good that they get to spend time with our friends when they choose to. Everyone enjoys their visits.

"I enjoyed it. I like how she is active from sunrise. It means I can go visit her before anyone else wakes up. She and Wrong Hordak made me many different mini foods to try, all of which I really enjoyed, even though I don't really need to eat. The mini meats were my favourite. I also got to play with Emily. That was fun. I'm not quite sure how I feel about real Hordak yet, but he did give me pets when he came to give Entrapta her mini morning coffee. I think it'll take a while for me to warm up to him. Also, your friend Entrapta found something really interesting that I think you and your mate will be interested in. Overall, I really missed you and was getting lonely outside. Sorry if I interrupted your mating ritual."

"What did they say?" Adora asks curiously. Sometimes I forget that they she can't communicate with them like I do.

"Why not have a guess? Put your *'Melog translation'* skills to the test."

Adora has been working with Melog and I to try and recognise what certain *mews, mreows and meows* mean. She has stated its so she can communicate with Melog in an emergency or at least understand some aspects of what they're trying to tell her if needed. Sometimes I think she's a little jealous of our connection,

but then I remember she has a sacred bond with that magical, annoying flying horse of hers. At least he can tell me what's wrong in words if needed. I don't think I'd have the patience to try and understand him if all he did was neigh and whinny.

"Alright then. I recon Melog said something about missing you even though they went to visit Entrapta in the early hours of this morning after spending the night with us. I noticed them lick their lips so I'm going to say some tiny food was involved. I think I noticed their tail sway towards me and then back to you on their last meow so I'm going to say they're excited to show us something Entrapta found. Finally, I'm not sure on what their last *mreow* meant but it was a bit quieter than the others and they mane turned a little pink, so I'm going to guess that they're embarrassed about something."

Melog meows happily and smiles at Adora… "They said well done. You're getting quite good at communicating with them Adora."

"Awww thanks Melog. So are you going to tell me what their last, slightly embarrassed *mreow* was about?"

I look to Melog to make sure that they're okay with me telling her. They nudge my arm and hide their head against my shoulder, letting me know I can tell her…

"They said that they're sorry if they interrupted our mating ritual earlier but they were getting lonely outside the door."

Melog's mane starts to blush and they try to hide their head against me even further. I could have sworn for a minute that they looked smaller in size. Adora moves to sit on the bedside and starts to stroke their mane.

"It's okay Melog. You didn't interrupt anything. I understand. It can get quite lonely out there when you're on your own. Thank you for knocking though before coming in."

Melog's face reappears and they smile back at Adora before pouncing on her, rubbing their cheeks against her head. It's a sign

of love and affection, something that they picked up from me when we bonded.

"Sometimes I wonder who's actually in this relationship with you: me or Melog? Now come on. We've got to go meet your friends."

"They're your friends too Catra." Adora argues, I can hear her eyes rolling in her voice.

Difficult is the only way I can describe how it's been getting used to adjusting to this new form of life. It took a while for some of the princesses to accept me and I can't really blame them for being wary of me, not after everything I did during my time with the Horde. However, I have done and am still working towards earning their trust. I'm making amends to prove to myself, to prove to them all that I'm not the person who I once was. That person was the old me, someone who I don't even recognise anymore, someone who was fighting out of fear and anger caused by others and themselves. It took a lot of therapy, self-reflection and healing, both as an individual and as a partner to get to where I am today. Sure some people may never forgive me for the things I have done, stars even I wouldn't forgive myself for some of the stuff I have done, but the actions I am taking towards becoming a better person for myself and others are making this journey worthwhile. Adora, Sparkles, Arrow Boy, Swift Wind, Melog, Micah, Entrapta, Scorpia and the others, they're my family. I love them all, yet I can't help but feel like something is missing.

Shifting the thought from my mind, I pick up my wing pin, *what was once Adora's wing pin,* and attach it to my shirt just above where my heart rests. I look at myself in the mirror, making sure it's positioned correctly. Adora comes up behind me and wraps her arms around my waist. She kisses my cheek before resting her head on my right shoulder.

"It suits you."

"It does doesn't it? I still feel bad that I haven't got you anything."

“I told you that you don’t need to worry about that. Your love for me is more than enough. I don’t except anything from you.”

“I know but I’m still going to get you something. I’m just waiting till I find something meaningful.”

Adora squeezes me softly and doesn’t press the matter further. I lean into her embrace, letting her scent and presence ground me. It’s weird seeing Adora without her wing pin on her belt. It almost looks bare, like her attire has a missing piece. After a few moments Adora releases her hold on me and moves away slightly. At first I miss the contact, but then she takes my hand and leads us to towards the door.

“Come on. We better get going if we want to get something to eat before we meet Glimmer and Bow.”

“I hope they have fish sticks ready.”

“Really Catra? Fish sticks, for breakfast?”

“What? They’re my favourite. It’s only like Melog liking Entrapta’s tiny food that she makes them.”

Adora simply laughs as we make our way down the corridor to Brightmoon’s kitchens.

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Breakfast was quick and easy this morning. They had fish sticks so that was a good start to my morning. Adora had some toast and Melog has some toast crusts as they were already full from eating Entrapta’s specially made mini foods. They said that I need to ask Brightmoon’s chefs if they’ll start doing mini foods for them.

It’s a short walk to the main briefing room from there. The last time I was in here it was full of princesses, all of whom were discussing their rebuild plans for Etheria. I’m not going to lie, it was an uncomfortable situation to be in but I felt like I had a responsibility to be there considering I was partially responsible for all the damage, especially the damaged caused to Salineas. I still feel guilty for all the chaos I caused but in Perfuma’s words *“there’s no point in dwelling on the past. We have to learn to move forward and accept what has been done.”*

The briefing room seems pretty empty with only a few of us here. Micah appears to be the only one we are waiting on now. Entrapta is working away on her tech pad with Emily, her robot from the Horde, by her side. Melog makes their way over to Arrow Boy, who greets them with open arms. Melog meows at him and immediately rolls over. Bow wastes no time in giving our Krytis friend the attention they desire. At the head of the table Sparkles snickers to herself.

As if she wasn’t giving Melog the exact same attention with that stupid kitty talk earlier this morning.

Adora and I walk over to them, officially greeting them all,or at least everyone who is here.

“Morning everyone. Where’s Micah?” Adora asks as she takes her seat at the table.

I’m very tempted to jump right into Adora’s lap just to see the look on her face, but I don’t want to embarrass myself so I take a seat beside her. Adora looks at me a little disappointed as if she was expecting me to jump into her lap.

“Dad’s running a little bit late. Something about Swift Wind trying to set all the horses free again.”

“Oh no. I’ll go help your dad catch the horses and I’ll talk to Swifty again?”

"It's alright Adora, the horse are okay. They're all in their stables. It's actually Swift Wind who my dad is talking to. He seems a little upset that none of the other horse want to leave their stables like he did. My dad's trying to calm Swift Wind down and get some of the horses to follow him just to make him feel better."

Adora's jaw drops in disbelief. I on the other hand start to laugh under my breath. Whilst we wait for Micah, I might as well tease some people.

"Oh by the way Sparkles, I forgot to thank you not *sparkling* into our room unannounced this morning."

Adora's cheeks turn red and Sparkles places her hand over her eyes, failing terribly to hide her embarrassment… "Believe me Horde Scum, I learnt my lesson after last time."

"What happened last time?" Bow asks innocently looking up from giving Melog cuddles.

Glimmer's face turns bright red and Adora tries to hide her face under her jacket lapels. What I didn't expect was Entrapta to answer him…

"Judging from Glimmer's blushing levels, Catra's snicker and Adora's failing attempt to hide herself under her jacket, my prediction is that Glimmer teleported into Catra and Adora's room when they were…"

"Okay Entrapta! Thank you for clearing that up for us but Bow doesn't need to know all the details about what happened." Adora jumps in rambling over her words. She's bright red like she can't believe what she's hearing.

I on the other hand can't stop myself from laughing, I have tears in my eyes. Bow has gone bright red and is trying his best to hide his giggles whilst looking at how embarrassed Sparkles is. Our laughter dies down just as Micah enters the room.

“Good Morning all. I’d ask what you are all laughing about but I’m going to pass on that considering how bright red my daughters’ cheeks are.”

“Wise choice.” Bow says before pecking Sparkles on the cheek.

“I apologies for the delay. As I’m sure you are all aware by now, there was a slight mishap with the horses earlier. Adora you might want to check on that talking horse of yours later. He seems quite upset that his freedom movement didn’t go as planned.” Adora simply nods, giving way for Micah to continue… “But I am here now. Entrapta, what is it that you have recently discovered that you want to discuss with us?”

Entrapta taps away on her tech pad, acting as if she hasn’t heard anything.

Maybes she’s just finishing up some data touches. Maybe she’s secretly planning world domination. Who knows?

Adora nudges me, “Do you think she heard him?”

I don’t even get the chance to respond before Entrapta abruptly speaks out of nowhere…

“Sorry! I was waiting for the last few programming data points to download before responding. You know how awkward it gets when things haven’t loaded properly. So here’s the gist. I sent Emily on a surveillance search a few days ago following on from Queen Glimmer’s request to ensure that all of Horde Prime’s bots and clones had been disabled, especially after the last encounter a few weeks ago.”

“You know Entrapta that you don’t have to refer to me as *queen* right? We’re all friends here and queen sounds too formal for me.”

“I know but your dad’s here and I want to make a good impression.” Entrapta says, slightly blushes as she tries to hide her smile. Micah smiles back at her.

Entrapta has only met Micah a handful of times and he mainly knows her for being Hordak's lab partner, as well as being the princess that joined the Horde for *'science purposes'*. Really, it's no wonder that she wants to make a good impression. Sensing that all is okay Entrapta continues…

"As I was saying, Emily completed a surveillance search in this new location hidden behind what I am calling mount Etheria as no one knows it's geographical name. We wanted to make sure no bots or clones where seeking refuge there. The plan was for any bots found to be deactivate but clones like Wrong Hordak to be rescued and provided with the help they need to start a new life amongst Etheria's people."

"Did you find any?" Adora asks, concern written all over her face.

"Thankfully no… but we found something far more fascinating."

A series of images scatter across the briefing rooms' holographic displays. They're not as clear as they possibly could be but that's due to Emily's limited camera functions. There are old red flags, ripped and tattered hanging in the still pictures. Large mounds of debris, battle weapons, old Horde machinery and strange looking claw marks can be seen along the stone walls and posts.

"Are those ruins?" Bow asks as he carefully examines the images in front of us.

"They're ruins alright, but not just any old ruins. The soil sample that Emily collected has allowed me to analyse the site in more depth. The sediment predicts that whatever happened here occurred about two decades ago. It's clear from the flags and the machinery that the Horde landed an attack here, but on what species and for what reason I can't be certain."

"Hang on a second. Entrapta, what do you mean when you say species? Surely the Horde attacked Etherians?"

Why did I say that? I know I want answers to some things but I shouldn't let my curiosity get the better of me, especially not when I haven't spoken to anyone about it yet. We all know the saying 'curiosity killed the cat'.

"Etherians yes, but Etheria is made up of all kind of species such as Scorpioni, Lizard Folk, and the First-One sitting right next to you. However, looking at the data, the readings show something more incredible. My hypothesis is supported by the unusual weaponry found and the markings left on the ruins. I'd need more data to be certain but if my calculations are correct, I believe that we have stumbled upon a Magicat ruin."

Magicat ruins? H-how is this possible? I mean it's not impossible but surely if there are ruins here on Etheria that are roughly the same age as me, then surely that'd mean that there are other Magicats out there? But that can't be possible. I was told throughout my childhood in the Horde that I am the last of my kind. I was left on the Horde's doorstep as a kid not long before my species became extinct. If these exist and what Entrapta says is true then… then everything I was told about my childhood, about my past, about how I really ended up in the Horde, might be all a lie. Everything I know about myself, about who I am… it might not be true?

Micah is the next to speak… "It is a possibility. For as long as I can remember there were Magicats around when Angella and I were young. However, we don't know what happened to them. They simply disappeared. We can't be sure if this is an ancient Magicat ruin or not until we investigate further."

Call it suspicion or instinct but I sense that Micah might be withholding some information. The way he is talking and the way his body is positioned tells me that he knows something. He knows more than he is letting on. I'll have to investigate this further later.

Taking a closer look at the pictures in front of me, I notice that they look oddly familiar. The claw marks, they follow a certain

pattern. The abandoned weaponry has a colour that looks recognizable to me. The stone carvings in the wall, they're not really clear but why do I feel like I've seen them before.

"Ah!"

A flash of bright light hits me. I'm not sure how but an image appears in my mind. This place, these images, I can't help but feel like I've been there before.

"Hey, you okay?" Adora asks as she places a hand on my shoulder steadying me.

This… this is all too much to take in right now. I need to get some air. I need to clear my thoughts.

"Yeah I-I'm fine. I just… I need to get some air."

Getting up from my seat, I don't look back as I make my way towards to exit. Adora goes to follow me but I get Melog to stops her. I need a moment alone. Adora watches me go but understands what Melog is trying to tell her.

As I leave I can hear the discussion continue from down the hall thanks to my Magicat hearing abilities…

"Glimmer and I will head to my dad's library. We'll see if we can find anything useful. Entrapta in the meantime can you get Darla ready for an away mission. We need to investigate this further."

"I'll go speak to my sister and see if she knows any ancient spells that will help reveal any hidden passages within that area. Ruins or not, there may be a secret entrance somewhere. I want you all to be safe. Glimmer, I'll teach you the spell if there is one when I get back."

"I'll go check on Swift Wind and make sure that he is okay."

"What about Catra? Do you want me and Bow to check on him so you can go and be with her?"

"Catra needs her space right now. I think this is a lot for her to hear. For a long time she has believed that she was only Magicat left on Etheria. I think Melog is going to go and find her in a few minutes and I'll catch up with her later."

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What does all of this mean? Is there something I'm not seeing? Why do I feel like some part of me is missing?

It takes me a while to cool off. Somethings that I saw and heard in that meeting don't quite add up. I've tried taking a walk to cool off but that didn't really work, I even tried meditating. When that didn't work I decided to come back here to mine and Adora's room, where I've been sat for a while doing the breathing exercises Perfume taught me.

Breathe in… hold… breathe out… repeat.

I don't know why I chose this moment in time to look at what I have held in my hands. It's been in a hidden box for ages but I've never had the want to look at it since we found it…

My Crimson Red Mask.

Adora and I found it when we had to search Primes' vessel to make sure that nothing was still active that could pose as a threat to Etheria. It's split in two, a clean break across the middle. I remember it happening, the single swipe of his metal clawed hand as he striped me of my dignity. I screamed for help, to be free but my cries were only heard by those in my head for I was silenced by his light…

Breathe Catra. Remember to breathe… In… out… in… out… you're safe now. He's gone for good. He can never hurt you again. Adora promised she'll never let anything bad happen to you ever again.

Despite all that has happened this mask is still a part of me, a part of my past. It's like She-Ra's old sword. It's a reminder of what was and what must never be forgotten no matter how painful the memories are. *"It's the struggles of the past that allow us to become stronger to move forward",* is what Perfuma once told me. But my mask, there's more to it than that, there's more to it than being a part of my past. I remember it being given to me by someone, someone important. The only problem is I can't remember who gave it to me, or why.

My ear twitches as I hear the door slowly creek open. A medium weight sits on the bed next to me and a heavy head rests on my lap. I stroke through Melog's mane, allowing their presence to calm me further. The start to quietly purr.

"Hey Melog. Can I ask you something?"

Melog mewls and looks up to me… "Do you remember your anything about your family."

Melog looks deep in thought, as if they're trying to plan what to say… *"I remember little bits about my family. I had a few older siblings and parents just like all life from from Krytis did but I don't remember much. When Horde Prime came, I was alone. My family was gone, my happiness taken from me. However, I never lost sight of hope. Hope that one day I'd be found and I'd find a new family and someone to share my love with. Life on Krytis was very different to life on Etheria. Sometimes it's easy to forget what I once had. However, I love my new family just as much as I loved my first family. Do you remember your family?"*

Do I remember my family? - I think I do but sometimes I wonder if it's all just a dream or some wicked visions some bitch planted in my memories to mess with my mind. I may never know the truth.

I sigh slightly and continue to stroke through Melog's mane at a steady pace, letting their presence calm me…

"I'm not sure if I remember them or not. I remember little things like someone singing to me, someone holding me close promising me that everything would be okay. But I also remember fires, sights of blood and hearing screams of fear before all went calm and someone was then saying goodbye. I don't know Melog, everything is so confusing. I'm not even sure if I dreamt certain things or if it was real. If it was real, I'm not even sure if I can recall where and when it happened. If I did have a family what happened to them? Did they love me? If so then why did they abandon me at the Horde's doorstep? I sometimes have nightmares about it, almost something like flashbacks that I can't explain. It's like I'm reliving something that has already happened, but I don't know how true it really is."

"Have you told your mate about these nightmares?"

"No… no I haven't. It's something that I don't want to worry her about."

Melog looks at me, slightly annoyed by this, but they accept that now is not the time to argue about it and they settle back in my lap.

"The only thing I know for certain Melog is that I feel like something is missing. I feel like there is something I need to know, something I need to discover. Something that will explain why these dreams keep happening and tell me what they mean."

Melog cuddles up to me and I hug them tightly. It's only then that I realize that I have been faintly crying whilst talking. I don't hold back anymore. I let my tears fall. Melog stays close to me through it all.

A few minutes pass before my tears subside. My eyes feel raw and I have no doubt that they're blood shot too. *Great how am I going to explain this to Adora?*

Knock, Knock

"Catra? It's me, Adora. Can I come in?"

I place my mask back in the box I retrieved it from. It also holds She-Ra's broken sword. I close it shut and place it at the back of our wardrobe where it can be hidden. I wipe away my remaining tears.

"What you asking for? It's your room too."

Adora slowly enters, closing the door softly behind her…

"I know it is but I thought you could use some privacy. I didn't want to startle you by just walking in."

Adora sits beside me on our bed and the first thing she notices is my tear stained cheeks. She brushes her hands over my cheeks and places a gentle kiss to my forehead. I rest my head against her shoulder as she wraps her arms around me. Adora's kisses and cuddles make everything better.

"How you feeling?"

"I'm okay. Just feel a bit shit."

"Well it was a lot to take in. Do you want to talk about it?"

"Not yet, but thank you for asking. Can you hold me for a bit, please."

I can tell Adora's worried about me, I can sense it. I can feel it in the way her body has tensed, yet she doesn't persists. It's one of the many things I love about her. She lets me be and she'll be ready to listen to me when I'm ready to open up to her. Adora's there for me when I need her most… *"You look out for me, and I look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other."*

"So when's the away mission to investigate what Entrapta found?"

There's no point hiding from it. The sooner we get on with things the better.

"Well Glimmer and Bow have gone Bow's dad's library to do some research to see if they can find anything useful. Micah's gone to see if Castaspella knows any detection spells that might be handy for the mission and Entrapta predicts the necessary upgrades to Darla should take a few days, hopefully no longer than a week once she's assessed the internal damage from… *you know*. She said most of the damage is prepared but she wants to triple check everything. We've predicted that we'll be ready to leave by the end of the week. Micah and Emily will be staying behind so it'll be like the old times, but you don't have to come with us if you don't want to. I understand if you choose not to. I don't want you to feel…"

"I want to go Adora. I need to go… well I don't need to go but if there is something there that can tell me about my species or give me any indication about what happened to them, I need to be there."

Adora smiles softly and hugs me tighter.

That's the last we speak of the upcoming journey for that night. Adora tells me about Swift Winds new plan to encourage the *'horse freedom movement'* by bribing them with apples and I help her to translate some more of Melog's communication sounds. Night soon falls and we fall asleep like we always do: Melog resting at our feet, Adora tightly holding me close whilst my tail wraps around her leg. We fall asleep to the sound of me purring. Come morning you would have thought it was a peaceful night, but it wasn't. That night, the nightmares that I told Melog about kept me awake.

I still haven't told Adora the truth about them.

Chapter End Notes

> Well there you have it. Finding Halfmoon has officially begun. I hope you enjoy reading it. Please let me know what you thought. The first prequel story (The Proposal) is now up in the Finding Halfmoon Series (link below). There are plenty

more prequel stories and extra content chapters yet to come so keep an eye out for them. Today's chapter was a special release to celebrate the two year anniversary of the Dreamworks SheRa finale. Chapter two will be released tomorrow. See you all then. :)

Prequel Story: The Proposal - https://archiveofourown.org/works/39010038

P.S - I apologies if there are any spelling or grammar mistakes. I'm not the best at spelling but I try 😂

The Adventure Begins

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora take a trip to visit an old friend.

Adora summons She-Ra.

The Best Friends Squad's latest Adventure Begins.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Remind me again why you want to go and visit the crazy old lady again?"

"Razz isn't crazy. She's just easily confused."

"Adora it took her nearly a whole year to remember that you are Adora, not Mara. Not to mention she talks to her broom like it's an actual living thing."

"I think it was more of a case of the trapped magic affecting her timeline abilities. Not to mention that she is… *ancient.* I'm not exactly sure how old Razz is but that won't help with her memory either. As for the talking to her broom thing, I can't fight you with that one. It is a bit strange. Like why does she have to keep bonking me on the head with it?"

"I'm surprised the broom bonks haven't knocked some common sense into that head of yours yet or destroyed that ridiculous hair poof"

"Oh piss off. You know I can un-propose to you."

"I know, but you won't because you *love* me."

Adora and I end up in a state of laughter. I love teasing her. She's so easy to get flustered. Adora knows I'm joking when I call Razz

crazy, although she did scare me quite a bit the first time I met her. She kept asking me all sorts of random questions and telling me off for making tears in her robes… *I had never even met this woman before, or at least I don't think I have?* Adora later explained to me that Madam Razz sometimes gets confused with the past, present and future, as well as who is who and what events have actually occurred. It's almost like she jumps between alternate realities. It would have been very helpful and less nerve wrecking if she had told me that sooner.

Overtime, I have become quite friendly with Razz. It just took a while for me to get used to her random antics. Growing up in the Horde has made it a little difficult for me to warm up to people, it sometimes takes even longer for me to trust someone. The only time I felt an instant connection to someone and felt like I could trust them from the beginning was when I met Adora. Many believe that it was a sign, a clear indication that we are soulmates, individuals who were meant to be together from the very beginning... I can't argue with that.

"Okay but seriously Adora, why did you want to come and see Madam Razz today, right before a mission? Why not yesterday or the day before that? Despite that fact that I like Razz and I like visiting her, you know how I feel about her conspiracy theories, especially right before a mission."

Technically that isn't the whole truth. The nightmares that I have only told Melog about have been keeping me awake these past few nights. They've never been as bad as what they have been. They only usually appear around certain nights of the year. It's weird I know but it happens. They've been worse since Entrapta showed us those images of the suspected Magicat ruins a few days ago. I'm worried Razz might say something or pick up on something that might be connected with what Entrapta found. I'd rather not get myself worked up thinking about it. I still haven't told Adora the truth about my nightmares yet. I can sense that she's getting increasingly concerned. I'm going to have to tell her the truth eventually. I know she won't judge me but I'm worried about what she might say.

"I know and I'm sorry, but I have a feeling that we need to speak to Razz today. I don't know how to describe it other than I feel the exact same way I did when I first found Razz. I felt lost and then I stumbled upon her. I would have gone yesterday if I had time but with all the preparations going on I've been too tired to do anything. You know you didn't have to come if you didn't want to."

"I know I didn't have to Adora, but I didn't want you going on your own. Besides, we haven't really had any alone time, any me and you time recently. I know a walk to visit Razz isn't much but if it means I get to spend some alone time with you then I'll take it. Who knows, hopefully Razz has made some of her incredibly delicious blueberry pie."

"She is good at baking pies." Adora happily says, before wrapping her left arm over my shoulders and leaning in to kiss my cheek.

We're not too far away from our current home in Brightmoon and Razz's place in the Whispering Woods, but it does take a while to get there by walking. Adora and I have discussed potentially moving out of Brightmoon before we get married, perhaps building our own place like Spinnerella and Netossa did. It would be nice to have our own home but know that we'd still be welcome back at Brightmoon should we choose to stay there for a while. It also means that we'd be located in between the two, making it easier to get to get to Razz's and Brightmoon if needed.

"How come Melog didn't join us this morning? They love visiting Razz."

"*Urm…* Melog asked if I'd mind if they stayed behind today to help Entrapta and Wrong Hordak finish the final touches on Darla. Really I think they wanted to stay behind as I know she promised to bring them some of the mini foods that they love so much. It's true when they say the way to Melog's heart is through their stomach."

Okay so that again is not entirely true.

Melog stayed awake with me most of last night. I didn't want to wake Adora as she was exhausted when she got to our room but I was too anxious to go back to sleep. I knew that if I was to fall back asleep my nightmares would be waiting for me. Melog sensed this and stayed up with me. We went for a walk and sat on the rooftop gardens of Brightmoon for a bit. The sky was clear last night and the stars were mesmerizing. They often remind me of Adora with how bright they shine and how breath-taking they are. Adora and I love watching the stars. I even named one after her, it's the one that shines the brightest. She also named one after me, it's the slightly smaller yet just as bright star beside hers on the right.

I took my drawing pad with me last night, it's something Perfuma suggested trying as drawing can help you to relax. I have drawn Adora quite a lot and some features such as flowers and animals around the Whispering Woods and Brightmoon. Adora, Arrow Boy and Sparkles all bought me art supplies for my birthday, saying that I had a special talent and every skillful artist needs a proper artist kit. Last night I decided to draw Melog chasing a firefly with the night sky scenery behind them.

After an hour or two, my drawing was complete and we went back to mine and Adora's room. Thankfully, Adora was still as stiff as a log and hadn't noticed that I had left. Well, she had turned over and was now hugging my pillow so I guess she must have been missing me even in her sleep. Carefully, I moved the pillow out of Adora's arms and settled down in its place. Melog lay on the other side of me, their head resting on my shoulder. They offered to come with us this morning but I told them to rest. I asked Entrapta if she could make them some of her mini foods for them as a thank you from me for last night.

Adora doesn't suspect a thing and accepts that what I have said is the truth. A sigh of relief escapes me and we continue to talk as we continue towards Madam Razz's hut.

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"Well the chimney is smoking so she must be in."

"Not only that but it smells like something delicious is cooking. I hope it's pie."

Adora laughs. I haven't had one of Razz's pies in weeks. Her blueberry pies are the best. I have asked Razz many times before if she could one day show me how to make her famous blueberry pie. She says she'd love to but then says that someone else wants to show me how to make it first. Who this person is I don't know. Sometimes I think she gets confused that that someone might be her but in the near future. Anyway, I'm going to have to try and ask again soon. I know she'll give me the recipe if I ask nicely. Razz often says that *'I'm like a granddaughter that she never had.'* I do enjoy baking with Razz. Sure some of her cooking methods are unusual, especially pastry making in an old Horde helmet, but it's been fun to learn how to bake.

We move the blanket door drape to the side and sure enough Razz is by the stove baking something delicious.

"Hello dearies. What a pleasant surprise. It's so nice to see you again. You're just in time too. Madam Razz just put a freshly made pie in the oven…"

Please be blueberry, please be blueberry, please be blueberry.

"Catra will be happy. I'm making blueberry pie."

"Yes Razz! You're a legend!"

Madam Razz comes over and gives both Adora and I a tight squeeze. We have to crouch down to her height so she doesn't hug our legs. I never thought I'd find someone shorter than me… *in saying that Sparkles is a few inches shorter than me so I have that win over her.*

“Hey Razz. It's nice to see you. I hope you don't mind but there is something Catra and I want to ask you?”

Just when it seems like we might have Razz’s concentrated attention… “BROOM! BROOM WHERE ARE YOU?! You need to come and say hi to Adora and Catra.”

Adora looks slightly frustrated but she’s used to this by now. I on the other hand am trying to hold back my laughter. I saw this coming the second Adora said she wanted to ask her something.

“There you are broom. I thought I’d lost you then. Don’t scare me like that. Sorry Adora you were saying. Oh and remember to speak up this time. You know I can’t hear you without my glasses.”

Adora accepts defeat and slightly giggles… “There is something we needed to ask you?”

Razz launches forwards with a finger on her lips, shushing Adora harshly...

“Quite Adora! You can’t discuss with me how you plan to propose to Catra with her standing right next to you. Have you lost your mind?”

"Yeah Adora. Have you lost your mind?" I tease. Adora gives me the side eyes look but I just smirk back. She loves me really.

“Razz I proposed to Catra two months ago remember. I proposed at the top of…”

BONK

“Ouch.” Adora rubs the top of her head after Razz bonks her on the head with her broom.

“Adora! Catra is right there! Seriously girly I think you need to get your eyes checked.”

"At least your stupid hair poof softens the blow."

Adora looks at me unimpressed. I can't hold it in anymore, I let out my laughter, tears threaten to fall from my eyes. Got to love Razz's and Adora's relationship. Adora smiles at me and tilts her head towards Razz, asking if I'd give talking to her a go.

Stand aside Adora. I've got this.

"Hey Razz. Think you could take a look at some pictures for us and tell us what you think they might be."

"Of course Catra dear. Hand them here and Madam Razz will take a look and see."

Adora looks at me gobsmacked. She quietly asks *"how did you do that?"* I simply shrug my shoulders as even I don't know how I did that.

Adora gives the pictures to Razz who looks at them curiously. Whilst we wait, I have a look at the baking pie. There are two cooking. They're not quite ready yet but they smell delicious.

Adora looks towards me and then back towards Razz… "Do you recognise anything?"

Madam Razz shakes her head and passes the photos back to me... "Sorry dearies, I don't recognise them. Halfmoon is still standing so it can't be that."

"Wait did you say Halfmoon?" Adora asks curiously.

"What's Halfmoon?" I ask.

"Halfmoon is said to be a lost kingdom. Angella once spoke of it but she never told me what it was or where it is located. I long thought it to be a myth, a place a bit like Beast Island before we found out that it *actually* exists."

"Don't be silly Adora. Halfmoon is where Catra is from?"

"WHAT!?" Both Adora and I shout in unison.

"Hold on a second Razz. Surely I'd know where I came from if it existed, especially if it I was there to begin with."

"Maybe not Catra, especially not with you joining the Horde so young." Adora states not realising the panic that it causing to set in.

"I can't see that being a possibility Adora. I'm a Magicat. Magicats have very good memories."

Well that's dependent on if a certain witch erased some of my memories or not… "Besides we both know I ended up in the Horde because I was dumped in a box on the Horde's doorstep. If it wasn't for you finding me who knows what might have happened."

Panic slowly starts to set in. My heart starts to pick up in speed. My breathing starts to become ridged. My fur starts to stand on end. Adora senses that I'm entering a state of panic and worry. She sits me down beside her and places her hands on my shoulders. She gets me to look into her eyes and focus on her voice. I follow her breathing pace, following through with my exercises. Stars I wish Melog was here, they could turn me invisible and they'd understand my reason for panicking. It takes a few minutes to settle, but Adora's presence calms me quicker than usual.

"You okay? Do you want to go home? We can leave if you want and call it a day?"

"I'm okay Adora. I promise. I think we need to find out more about this place, *about Halfmoon*, before we leave."

"Are you sure?" Adora asks one final time. One of her hands slides to brush the side of my cheek, with the other sliding down to hold my hand. I lean into her embrace, thankful that she's here beside me.

“I’m sure. But do you mind asking, please?”

Adora smiles, nods in agreement and places a gentle kiss on my forehead. She keeps a tight hold on my hand and turns to face Madam Razz once more.

“Is there anything you can tell us about Halfmoon?”

Razz sits herself down on a stool across from us. She looks deep in thought and she repositions her glasses before speaking…

“Halfmoon is home to the Etherian species called Magicats. They’ve been around for as long as the First-Ones but I haven’t seen them, other than Catra, for a few years now. I believe the Horde were making advancements around Halfmoon a while ago but I’m not sure what happened. Besides Halfmoon still exists and I believe one is still searching.”

“Searching for what?” Adora asks curiously.

Ding

“Oh. Pies done.”

Razz jumps off her stool and goes to take the pies out of the oven. Adora doesn’t get her answer. She goes to ask again but I ask her not to. It’s clear we’ve lost Razz’s focus and I’m ready to go home. We have all the information we'll get from Razz today.

The pies smell good. Razz wraps one up for us in a towel and hands it to me…

“Here you go dears. Enjoy it.”

“I’m sure we will Razz. Thanks for the pie. It was nice seeing you.” Adora says as she walks towards the cloth draped door and waits for me outside. I go to follow suit when Razz calls me back.

“Oh Catra dearie, remember to save a slice for that someone special.”

I look back to Razz confused and slightly concerned by what she means. The only special person in my life is Adora and I always share Razz's pies with her. Not wanting to worry Razz or Adora, I smile back and say… "Will do Razz. Thanks for the pie."

"Goodbye dearies. Come back anytime you'd like. Madam Razz enjoys visitors."

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The walk back to Brightmoon from Razz's is fairly quiet. We usually hear all sorts of wildlife and the wind whistling but this time, nothing. It's a bit eery. Something feels off.

"Hey, you okay?" Adora asks as she gently nudges me in the side.

"Yeah I'm fine. Why'd you ask?"

"Because you haven't said much since we left Razz's and you haven't touch the pie yet."

"I'm not that hungry."

"That's not like you. You never miss an opportunity to devour one of Razz's pies, especially the blueberry ones. You sure there's nothing you want to talk about?"

"Seriously Adora I'm fine. Besides, Razz told me to save a piece for someone special. I thought maybe you and I could tuck into it later tonight, after we've given our friends a slice obviously. Have you seen how big this pie is? It's bigger than the ones she usually makes. Even I don't think I could eat it all myself."

I try to laugh it off but I can tell from the way Adora's shoulders hunch and her slacked grip on my hand that she's worried. Maybe

even feeling a little bit guilty. My suspicions are confirmed when she starts to ramble…

"I'm sorry if anything Razz said made you feel uncomfortable. I didn't know she was going to bring up Magicats or Halfmoon. I didn't even realise that Halfmoon was an actual place or some place that once existed. I thought it was all a myth, maybe legend. I'm sorry it caused you to panic. For all we know, what she said might not be true and she might be getting confused again and…"

My hand forms a tight grip on Adora's hand. I stand in front of her to stop her in her tracks…

"Adora stop! You've got nothing to apologies for. You hear me. Nothing at all."

Adora now looks me in the eye. There are signs of tears appearing… "But it was me who wanted to go there, all because of some stupid feeling that we'd find something out."

"And we did find something out. Something useful. Alright I know it caused me to panic a little bit… I'm guessing that's what your feeling guilty about?"

Adora nods and a small tear runs down her cheek. I reach up with my free hand to brush it away…

"Hey. I don't want you to feel guilty about that okay. It just scared me a little bit that's all. If you weren't there though it could have been a lot worse for me. You kept me calm and grounded. You made me feel safe. *'You look out for me and I look out for you.'* We made that promise to each other remember? You made hearing all that stuff easier because you were besides me and you didn't pressure me to sit through it. I chose to stay so we could find out more. That was my choice. Don't ever feel guilty about something that happened through my choice okay. Promise?"

Adora smiles at me and rests her forehead against mine. I start to purr, both out of love and the fact that I know it helps her to

relax.

"Promise. I love you Catra."

"I love you too dummy."

SCREECH

"Did you hear that?" Adora asks, searching the area but keeping a tight hold on my free hand.

"No I didn't… Of course I did you idiot! Never mind the whole incredible Magicat hearing senses I have, I think the whole of the Whispering Woods might have heard it."

Snap* *Flush* *Flutter

"FOR THE HONOUR OF GREYSKULL!"

Adora transforms into She-Ra and we stand back to back in our old battle stances. Hopefully, if it's an animal, Adora can calm it through She-Ra's powers. If not, hopefully we can fight our way out of trouble and have some victory pie at the end.

A slight fluttering sound comes from ahead. I have my claws ready to attack. Whatever it be: clones, bots, animal stampede, we can take it.

Suddenly out of the bushes a creature flies towards me. I pounce forward ready to attack but stop when I realise what it is. I retract my claws and tap Adora's shoulder, getting her to turn around and face the creature with me. Adora sighs a breath of relief and She-Ra fades away. Adora looks at the creature in amazement…

"Is that… is that what I think it is?"

"I think it might be."

The creature in front of us is an Etherian Moon Owl. It's a female from what I can tell with the spots located on her chest. Her

feathers are a beautiful mix of dusty white and sandy brown, her eyes are a dark shade of amber. One of her tail feathers however appears to have a slight kink in its tip. It might have been sustained from an old injury, hence why we heard her when she flew. Etherian Moon Owls are usually silent flyers but if her tail feather kink knocked as few branches and leaves on the way down then it's no wonder we heard her. The owl tilts her head sideways, as if trying to figure out what Adora and I are. The owl screeches once again in greeting. *Yep it was definitely her who scared us.*

"So you're the one who scared us. Wait till I tell our friends Sparkles and Arrow Boy how you managed to summon this one to turn into *the mighty She-Ra*."

I try my best not to speak too loud as I don't want to scare the owl away. I've never seen an owl this close before. Adora doesn't seem to be paying any attention to me. She's too interested in the owl, looking as if she's in some sort of trance.

"Catra… th-that's an Etherian Moon Owl?" She says quietly, trying not to scare her off.

"Yes Adora. That's an Etherian Moon Owl."

"Do you realise how rare they are? I'm sure they're endangered."

"I know they're rare Adora. Do you not remember the one that used to fly over the Fright Zone every now and then."

"I remember but I've never seen one this close. They're even more stunning than I imagined. I have to get a picture."

"Adora you didn't even bring your…" As I speak Adora pulls out her camera from her pocket... "Of course you brought it with you. Remember to turn the flash off. The bright light can hurt animals eyes."

I introduced Adora to photography not long after I started drawing. I preferred to draw so Adora decided to try another form

of art. She bought me artist supplies for my birthday and I bought her camera supplies. She specializes in taking pictures of me, pictures of me with her, and pictures of our friends.

"Alright stay still. Don't move." Adora says as she tries to get the perfect angle.

"You know the owl probably can't understand you."

"Probably not but it can read my body language. But I'm about to prove you wrong as I'm going to ask it to *'Strike a pose'*."

I'm about to call Adora a dummy when the owl does actually strike a pose. It turns to the left and shows off its wing colouration whist titling its head, looking directly at the camera. I swear Adora's a secret animal whisperer.

"Perfect. What do you think?" Adora asks showing me the image she captured.

"Looks good. You're getting quite talented with the camera."

"Thanks. Maybe you could try drawing it one day."

It's more of a question rather than a suggestion. Adora's always encouraging me to try and draw pictures of things she captures in photos but I have drawn the line at trying to draw people other than her.

"Maybe I will, considering they are one of your favourite animals." I respond in a flirtatious tone. Adora blushes. *Works everytime…* "Now come on. I want to get home so we can have some pie."

Adora puts her camera away and retakes my hand in hers. We walk past the owl who doesn't move. She simply turns around to watch us walk past. I turn back one last time to find her looking at me curiously with that ridiculously cute head tilt that owls do. The owl then flies way, high above the trees and out of sight.

--

We arrive back at Brightmoon shortly after. It appears Entrapta has finished making the necessary upgrades to Darla and has stationed the ship outside ready to go. Melog spots me and comes running over. I quickly pass the pie over to Adora, ready to catch Melog in my arms when they jump. They're not as heavy as some would expect but their size means that they're very likely to knock me over if I don't prepare to catch them. Melog immediately starts to purr up a storm and I join them too.

"If we didn't know that that is Melog, from a distance it would like you're carrying a giant teddy bear." Adora laughs as she gives Melog a scratch behind their ears.

Gently, I place Melog on the ground and we go over to Entrapta and the others. All seems to be prepared for the mission.

"Hey guys. Where have you been? Bow and I have been looking for you everywhere. We were worried something had happened to you when we found Melog on their own."

"We went to speak to Madam Razz. Adora wanted to see her before the mission. Melog asked if they could stay behind so they could help Entrapta and enjoy some of her mini foods they love so much."

Melog *mreows* besides me. The others thinks that they are agreeing with what I said when really they just said, *"you still haven't spoken to Adora about the nightmares have you?"* I know they're right but I don't want to worry her, especially not after today.

Bow is the next to speak… "Well that's understandable. We were just speaking to Entrapta about the plan. We plan to set off in the morning then we can be back before nightfall. We found some stuff out at my dads' library but not a lot. They're going to have a

look in the archives and get back to us if they find anything. Did you have any luck?”

My ears instantly flatten against my head at Bow question, remembering what was said at Razz's. Adora senses my unease and steps in to answer...

“We did but I think we might be better telling you that stuff tomorrow. Catra and I have had a long few days and we’d rather just spend the rest of the day relaxing. Also Razz made us a pie and we’d really like to tuck into that.”

Leaning over, I whisper my words of thanks to Adora and she smiles back. I then ask the others… “Would you like a slice?”

Arrow Boy and Sparkles accept the offer. We offer some pie to Entrapta too but says she prefers *‘smaller samples’* but would love the recipe if I ever get hold of it. Nightfall soon arrives and tomorrows journey will soon begin. I know I usually curse Bow for saying this but let the Best Friends Squad Adventure begin.

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you enjoyed reading chapter two. What do you think they'll find when they arrive at their destination? Do you think Catra will tell Adora the truth about her nightmares before they arrive? Find out when chapter three is released on Friday. I hope to see you there 😊

Mysteries

Chapter Summary

The Best Friends Squad (plus Entrapta) travel to the mysterious new ruins.

Adora's concerns for Catra begin to grow.

Catra starts to wonder why this place looks familiar.

Chapter/Content Warning: Brief Descriptions of War Aftermath.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"For the last time Melog, I don't want to talk about it."

Mrew

"No. I'm not going to do that."

Mreow?

"You know why! Adora's already got enough to stress about with the expectations of She-Ra again, which might I add that she's already not happy about but there's nothing either me or her can do about it."

Meow, mrow, Mreow

"I'm not pushing her away okay. I'm just… trying to save her the pressure of feeling like she has to fix everything. I know I should tell her about the nightmares Melog but the truth is it's not that simple. I know Adora. She'll try everything she can to help, to stop them from happening, to fix it, but in reality… **sigh*…* I feel

like this is something that can't be fixed so easily. I feel like this is something only I can fix or at least resolve. Only I can find out what these nightmares mean. Do you get what I mean?"

Meow, Purr

Melog rests their head on my lap and drops the conversation. We're currently on our way to this new location that Entrapta found. I'm watching the scenes pass by at Darla's main viewing window. Adora is sat in the pilot's seat… *I think*. She was pacing around a few minutes ago but now her footsteps have stopped. I can sense that she's still in the room. Sparkles and Arrow Boy are somewhere else that I don't care to know and I imagine that the science *genius* is with them.

This new location is not too far away from Brightmoon, well not if we take Darla that is. If we were to walk there it'd probably take a little longer than an hour or two dependent on your walking speed. Maybe even three hours if you're not sure where you're going. The trip using Darla should take about thirty minutes. Despite that being a relatively short time compared to walking, I can't help but get lost with my thoughts.

My fingers brush through Melog's rough blue mane as I try to calm my racing thoughts. Their mane has been like this since last night when I got frustrated with the continuous nightmares again. My dreams were adamant on keeping me awake. Everytime I tried to close my eyes and fall asleep, flashes of random scenes and images came flooding back. It quickly became increasingly difficult to sleep. It go to a point where I was to scared to fall back asleep.

The facts Bow gave us from when he and Sparkles visited his dads library are probably to blame for the increase in nightmares. Apparently Halfmoon used to be an ancient kingdom once ruled by Magicats. They had a rich culture, practicing in the art of magic, healing, nature and combat. Around two decades ago, the Horde learned of their community and saw them as a threat. As a result the Horde wanted to destroy their kind, permanently erasing them from Etheria. No one knows for sure what

happened, expect mass destruction followed. It was a lot to take in, especially considering that I myself, *a Magicat,* might be the last remaining individual of my species. I know Razz can get confused sometimes with what she says, I might not even be from Halfmoon, but that then still leaves the question open as to where I came from. All I know is that I was abandoned on the Horde's doorstep as a kid, but then again I don't even know if that's true anymore. It's all so frustrating and upsetting.

Is it so hard to want a simple answer about my past, to know where I came from, to know who I am?

Adora, bless her soul, has been amazing and supportive through it all. She's held me close every night, wiped my tears away with the gentle brush of her hand, and reminded me of our sacred promise that shall never be broken: *'you look out for me, and I look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other.'*

I don't know what I did to ever end up this lucky to have Adora in my life, to be her life partner, but I'll thank the stars every night that I get to call her mine.

Despite all this I do feel slightly guilty. I don't want Adora to feel like I'm shutting her out by not telling her what my nightmares are really about but I also know she won't push me for answers.

Adora's building frustration is clear to see. She wants to help but I don't see how she can. I also don't think it's the sole fact I haven't told her the truth. Adora and I… *well…* we haven't had a moment to ourselves in weeks. A moment to *be alone* together. Everytime it seems like we're free to finally relieve some of the tension and give into our desires, we end up being called to some *'important'* diplomatic mission or event that we have no choice but to attend. Believe me we've tried to get out of them many times. It's been a case of stolen moments here and there: passionate kisses that are never enough, soft touches that don't quite satisfy our desires, the occasional rough housing and pinning of each other against the walls that we can't take any further. The closest we've been to

some much needed me and Adora time was when we had a walk to see Razz yesterday. These nightmares are a pain in the rear too because when we probably do have time to be more intimate with each other, which at the moment is rare, we're both too exhausted from staying up into the early hours of the morning because of them.

Thanks dreams.

I'm going to have to do something about them sooner or later. I'm going to have to tell Adora the truth about them as I feel at this point talking about them might be the only way to get them to ease off a bit… *or at least ease off enough for us to have some serious, much needed, quality time together.*

My ear twitches at the sound of faint footsteps coming up behind me. Melog murps, before getting up out of my lap, stretching, and then wandering over to the person standing behind me. I feel them brush up against someone's leg before they continue to pad along the floor towards the doors. Darla's doors open and close leaving me and the other person alone together. Melog sure knows how and when to make a hasty exit.

Next thing I feel is a pair of strong, gentle arms hugging my shoulders from behind. A gentle kiss is placed on top of my forehead. A quite *murp* escapes me at the sudden yet gentle gesture.

"Hey Adora."

Adora softly hum-giggles at my catchphrase that I have always used to greet her. She moves to sit beside me on Darla's window ledge and threads our fingers together. Adora keeps a strong grip of my hand. Her grip is not overly strong but tight enough for me to sense that she's not completely relaxed. Not only that but I can see it in her body language. Her shoulders are slightly slumped, her smile isn't as radiant as usual and I can sense a bit of sadness in her eyes. It probably doesn't help that she has dark circles

under her eyes from the lack of sleep from being awake with me most of the night.

"Sorry I kept you up most of last night, and the night before that, *and the night before that*. You know you didn't have to stay awake with me all night…"

"I know I didn't have to, but I wanted to." Adora smiles slightly and gives my hand a reassuring squeeze.

"I really am sorry though. You shouldn't have to suffer because of me. I-I'll make it up to you I promise."

My voice starts to stutter. I feel like I'm on the verge of tears. The exhaustion and the endless nights are catching up with me. Adora moves closer to me and starts to rub soothing circles on my back with one of her free hands.

"You don't have anything to be sorry for Catra and you certainly don't have to make it up to me. We look out for each other, like we always promised..."

Adora's thumb starts to rub slow, soothing circles on the back of my hand. She sighs slightly and I look up to find faint tears brimming in her eyes.

Why do I sense that we're about to have a serious conversation that I really don't want to have right now but know is need.

"But I think we need to talk about this… about the nightmares. I'm not going to push you to tell me what's really going on but I can't help but feel like there is something you aren't telling me. If there is something bothering you I want you to know you can tell me anything okay. We're a team Catra. When your happy I'm happy, when your sad I'm sad. I worry about you. If I can help fix something that will make whatever it is that's bothering you better or even go away, I will do everything I can to do just that… even if that something means that all I can do is be there for you to help you through it. Just please don't shut me out. Please don't leave me in the dark. There is nothing you can say or do that'll

make me stop loving you. I hope that is not what's worrying you or stopping you from telling me what's *really* going on because believe me, you're stuck with me for life whether you like it or not."

That earns a slight, teary giggle from me, shortly followed by a faint smile. My smile is reflected by Adora's own…

"I love you Catra. I always have and I always will."

Adora places a gentle kiss to my forehead before resting our heads together. We have always done this from a young age, especially when one of us needed the others comfort. Although, in this case, it feels like we both need to comfort each another.

Usually a forehead touch would be enough, but this time it isn't. Carefully, I climb into Adora's lap and wrap my arms around her so I can hold her close to me. My claws slightly dig into her jacket, I'll be surprised if she can't feel them. My ear rests against her chest, listening to her strong, steady heartbeat. Adora's head rests on top of mine and she whispers sweet words over and over again… *"I'm here"… "I've got you"… "I'm not going anywhere."*

We hadn't realised it but we have both been faintly crying. *Stupid emotions. Although it does feel good to have a little cry every now and then.* After a minute or two our tears subside. My low purr can be heard throughout the room.

"I love you Adora."

Those are the first words I'm able to say once I've regained control of my breathing. I know Adora already knows this but I felt like it needed to be said…

"I'll never stop telling you how much you mean to me or how much I love you."

Adora places a gentle kiss to my forehead and I reposition myself so I'm now facing her. Her thumbs brush against my cheek, wiping my tears away. She smiles…

"Is that a promise?"

I slightly giggle, feeling better after that slight breakdown. *Stars I love this idiot.*

"Yeah. It's a promise."

I wipe Adora's tears away and lean in, passionately kissing her like so many times before. It's slow and soft. Her presence is calming. Maybe Melog is right. It might do some good telling Adora what's been going on and maybe then things will start to improve. I lean back slightly to look at Adora once more. I take a deep breath and hold her hands tightly in my own. She's made it clear that she's ready to listen and I am ready to talk…

"First of all, I'm sorry if I ever made you feel at any point like I've been keeping you in the dark or shutting you out. It wasn't my intention and I'm sorry."

Adora goes to tell me the usual but I stop her by giving her *the look*. She smiles understandingly and waits for me to continue…

"Secondly, I apologies for the occasional mood swings and outburst but I'm getting increasingly pissed off that we haven't been able to spend some much needed *quality time* together. I know you have been feeling the exact same as me recently, you made that clear a few times. I promise that I'm going to try and make some much needed time for us soon if you try to do the same. I think we are both in need of some alone time to give into our desires and be together how we want, for as long as we want."

Adora lightly giggle-snorts knowing exactly what I mean by that and nods in agreement. It's something we're both to blame for but both in desperate need of…

"I know my nightmares haven't been the biggest of help with all that and I have to be honest with you Adora, they're starting to scaring me. I want them to stop, to leave me in peace but they won't. I don't know how to make them stop. I want to ask for

help but I don’t know how to and I don’t even know where to start.”

My eyes slowly start to water again and Adora pulls me close to her, holding me tight. I take a few deep breathes and continue…

“Melog suggested that I tell you what they’re about, why I think they’re happening and what’s bothering me. They think it’ll help stop them. If not stop them then at least ease them.”

I take a few more steady breathes keeping my thoughts calm and collective. This is harder than I thought it was going to be but here goes nothing…

“Adora, my nightmares… they’re not about him, *about Prime*. They’re about…”

ZOOM

“Oh good. You’re already here. Glimmer! Bow! They’re in here.”

Entrapta enters the room as if nothing has happened. She’s clearly unaware of what was going on. The others soon arrive, followed by Melog who comes in chasing after them. They look to Adora and I and then back at Entrapta. They give her a scolding look that she doesn’t even pick up on. They sigh in defeat, a true representation of how I’m feeling right now.

Unlike the others, Adora notices this and immediately seeks to comfort me. I’ve sort of curled in on myself, feeling embarrassed and slightly ashamed. Adora quietly whispers a word of apology to me and I promise to tell her everything later, *that’s if I ever get the chance to tell her later*. She kisses me on the cheek before heading over to Mara's chair.

When Glimmer and Bow ask Adora what’s wrong she gives them a blank look. Seeming confused they look at me, then back to Adora, then back to me one more time and then back to her. It’s only then that they get the message that they've interrupted something important and I see them whisper a word of apology

themselves. Adora shakes her head, sighs, tells them it's okay and that it's not their fault.

Melog comes over to me and immediately asks for cuddles. I'm not sure if that's to make them feel better or to distract me from my thoughts but who cares, I'm not going to refuse them the offer of cuddles. Melog cuddles make a lot of things better. They also say that they're sorry they couldn't stop the others from entering the room when they did but I reassure them that it's not their fault. Adora looks over to us and smiles.

"Everyone ready?" Adora asks. Her view has changed to the path ahead. Everyone nods in agreement… "Okay then. Darla, take us down."

~ Initiating landing procedures. Coverage of landing sight appears to be stable. However, travelers might want to hold onto something. My analysis shows slight turbulence for the landing sequence process. This might be a bumpy decent. ~

I take that as a good excuse to jump into Adora's lap. I pounce and she catches me, laughing as I get comfy. It's not long before my arms wrap around her shoulders and her arms hold my waist. Melog's mane turns slightly red in colour and spiky in shape, their claws dig into the ground. Sparkles and Arrow Bow almost face plant the floor but quickly find something to hold on to. Entrapta on the other hand is waving her hands in the air, laughing her head off like this is some sort of amusement ride. It certainly was rocky decent.

--

"Entrapta are you sure you know where we're going? All I can see is trees, rocks and bushes. It looks nothing like the pictures you showed us." Sparkles asks quite concerned.

Entrapta seems to be doodling on her tech pad as if trying to find some answers…

"Well I can't say I know exactly where we're going for sure. As we know the Whispering Woods is forever changing and shifting as a result of Etheria's magic. Darla got us as close to the coordinates on Emily's database as possible. We knew the rest of the journey would be on foot. For all we know, the woods might not want us to find the exact location of the ruins, but then again how was it that Emily came to find them."

"Entrapta! Maybe speak, I don't know… in your *non-science words* for once, please. Just tell us do you know where we are or what direction we're meant to be heading."

"I did… Did that not make sense?"

Entrapta looks to Sparkles confused, who is clearly getting more and more frustrated by the minute. Bow is trying to keep her calm whilst Adora and I try to contain our laughter…

"Basically, I have an idea of where we are heading but I can't get an exact location reading as my data pad is playing up. The magic is interfering with it. We're basically traveling on instinct."

sigh - "Fucking hell. We're doomed."

"Ha! That's not very queen like of you Sparkles. Besides where's your sense of adventure gone? I hear from Adora that you were the one who used to get into trouble the most."

"That is not true… *okay maybe part of that is true* but Adora was no different. Has she not told you about the time we were in the Crimson Waste and she awoke a giant three headed sand snake? We ran from miles in the scorching heat to escape its jaws, only to then be surrounded by a large area filled with quicksand, which *I* fell into."

"She what!?"

"I think Glimmer is exaggerating a *little* bit. Besides, she missing out the part where I heroically drove into the quicksand after her to save her."

"Only Adora forgot that I could teleport out. I ended up saving her in the end. Bow back me up here."

"It's true. Adora also tried tasting sand not long after that to try and find out which direction to go."

Okay that's something else. Laughter from us all fills the air. We all have to hold our sides to stop the aching. It feels good to have a laugh over something stupid Adora did. I needed this. It's lightened my mood already. I've felt a bit uneasy since Darla landed. Of course I want to find these ruins, maybe they'll give me some answers, but some part of me makes me not want to find those answers. I worry that I'll find something out that I might regret and then things from here on out might get worse. I need things to get better not worse.

Melog's mane starts to shiver and they let out a quiet mewl. They cling to my side, showing that they feel on edge and nervous, a true reflection of my current state. I bend down and stroke through their mane in an attempt to reassure them, *and myself*, that we'll be okay.

"Everything will be fine Melog. We'll find this place and this mission will be over with before you know it. I promise."

Comfortingly, they press their head against mine and begin to purr. It's soothing for both of us. Adora notices our little talk and when I rise again, she takes my hand into her own and gently smiles. She places a soft kiss to my cheek.

We continue further into the heart of the Whispering Woods. That is until we hear a familiar but eery sounds.

SCREECH

The whole gang freaks out and we get into our battle stances, forming an attack circle. Bow grabs his arrows, Sparkles summons her staff, Melog's mane flares a fiery red, Adora wields her sword, I unsheathe my claws and Entrapta, *for some reason*, chooses her tech pad as an appropriate weapon to throw. You'd think by now with all her technology inventions that she would have made a portable weapon. I'm not sure why she hasn't added an emergency weapon to her hair… *I'm not even sure if her hair is real or made from one of her science experiments.*

Hoot

A small owl lands on a rock in front of me. A sigh a breath of relief and tap Adora's shoulder. She turns around and relaxes, her sword fading out of sight when she see the owl. The others follow suit when they realise that there is no present danger.

"At least you didn't summon She-Ra this time."

"Wait a minute? You mean to tell me that Adora summoned the all mighty She-Ra because of some owl screeching?"

"I didn't know it was an owl at the time Glimmer. I thought we were in serious danger and my first instinct was to protect Catra."

"Oh aren't you a romantic." I tease, batting my eyes at Adora. She giggles softly, tells me to *"piss off"* and lightly pushes my shoulder.

Arrow Boy and Entrapta do not seem to be paying attention to the conversation at all. They're mesmerized by the owl in front of them. Honestly, these people act like they've never seen an owl before.

"Is that… is that a…"

"Yes Bow it's an Etherian Moon Owl. Well observed."

"Fascinating. I wonder if I can take it back to the lab to study it."

Entrapta goes to move forward but Adora stops her in her tracks...

“Entrapta no! They’re highly endangered and a rare sight. This is only the second time Catra and I have ever seen one.”

“Well technically it’s the second time we’ve seen this practically one. You see the kink in their tail feather? It’s the same one that spooked us yesterday.”

“All the more reason why it should be studied.”

Sternly, I give Entrapta a disapproving look. She eventually drops the situation and goes back to observing the owl. Despite the others being fascinated by the sight before them, the owl does not seem overly bothered by the attention they’re receiving. Instead, it keeps looking at me, every so often turning its head slightly as if trying to get a better view. It’s like to trying to figure out what I am, maybe even who I am.

My thoughts are interrupted when I hear Melog’s thoughts…
“Prey?”

Their tail starts swishing in the air, their pupils open as wide as possible and their claws lightly dig into the ground. They’re getting ready to pounce.

“Melog?”

Too late. They jump at the owl but thankfully it jumps over them. The owl lands back on the rock and screeches at Melog. Unfortunately, Melog is still in chase mode. I can not only see it in their body language but I can also feel it. The owl then flies over them, brushing its talons through their mane, and continues to fly into the distance at a low level. Melog follows.

“MELOG NO!” I call after them, following them hot on their heels.

“CATRA WAIT UP!” Adora calls. She’s not too far behind me.

“WHERE ARE YOU GOING!” Sparkles and Arrow Boy shout in unison, before following after us.

“Oh so were going that way now?” I hear Entrapta say faintly.

--

It’s like running through an obstacle course, clambering over and under fallen trees. Sights of damaged rock faces are to my side. It’s becoming increasingly difficult to see. Although my sight of Melog isn’t clear, I can sense that they’re still following the owl. I can feel them. They’re in chase mode and there is no stopping them... *or at least that’s what I thought.*

A dark passage initially hidden by a fallen tree and overgrown foliage eventually opens up. Melog has stopped dead in their tracks and I join them. I stand by their side, placing my hand on their mane as I try to catch my breath. Hopefully they won't run off again.

They really can run when they want to. I’m not sure who’s faster: me or them.

“Melog, I’m begging you, *never* do that again. You could have gotten lost. Anything could have happened to you.”

They don’t answer. *That’s unusual.*

I look to them properly and find them completely frozen in place. Its then that I notice that their mane it’s also stiff. It’s not flowing like it usually does…

“Melog? Are you okay? What’s gotten into you?”

Following their line of sight, I clearly see what has caused them to stop in their tracks. My fur stands on end, my tail puffs up and my ears lie flat against my head. My heart rate starts to pick up in speed.

Adora soon catches up and appears from the overgrowth "There you are. I thought I'd lost…"

Adora's words fall silent as Sparkles, Arrow Boy and Entrapta appear behind us. It takes a few moments for it to become clear where we are.

Entrapta speaks for us all… "Oh good you found the ruins. What are we waiting for? Let's go see if we can find anything interesting."

Melog shakes themselves out of their trance and mews at me, offering their apologies for running off. However, I'm not able to fully take in what their saying. This sight, it's somehow all looks too real to me. It feel like I've somehow been here before. It's only when I feel Adora's hand rest on my shoulder that I jump back to my senses. She looks to me concerned.

"You okay?"

My hands race to push my stiffened fur back down, flattening my puffed up tail. I don't want the others to sense how on edge I am. Only Adora can read my body language perfectly and the last thing I want is for the others to know when I'm worried. Pushing my fears and nerves to the back of my mind I respond to her…

"I'm fine. Let's just get this over with."

We walk deeper into the ruins, hopefully to uncover some of the answers to the mysteries this place holds.

--

As we walk further into the ruins, it becomes all too clear of the sheer mass of destruction the Horde left in their tracks. Some of the old Horde flags have now began to rot off their posts and are

beginning to decay under to mud and hardened ash. Some other sights are far more disturbing. There are small toys and materials left visible under the rubble. It's an upsetting sight to see. It's even more disturbing to think what level of evil the Horde went to, attacking innocent lives and possibly tearing families a part, all for what prize?

Bow helps Entrapta carefully collect some soil samples and easy to carry weapons that have been left lying around, all of which can be taken back to Brightmoon and her lab for further analysis.

We walk further into the ruins. Hopefully if we head deeper we might be able to get some more thorough answers as to what the concluding result of the attack was… *although I think we can all assume the worst.*

Walking past a series of fallen rocks I come across a small passage way. It appears to lead to another part of the Whispering Woods, a part I didn't notice before. It somehow seems familiar.

A sudden wave of dizziness hits me and I lose my balance. I steady myself on a nearby rock, claw marks deeply engraved into the stone. I can feel them under the palm of my hand…

"I won't leave you."… "I'm afraid you don't have much choice."

Melog comes up beside me. Their cowering. *Can they feel what I'm feeling?* My mind hurts for some stranger reason. I squeeze my eyes shut and something enters my mind. It's almost as if it's a clear vision…

"I'm not going to let them get to you or our daughter."

"Catra?"

Adora's voice brings me back to my senses. I hadn't even noticed her standing in front of me. She looks at me worryingly. I try to tell her I'm okay but my throat feels dry like I'm lost for words.

What was all that about? Those voices sounded familiar.

I try to stand but my knees slightly give way. Adora catches me and helps me regain my balance. She holds me until I'm certain that I can feel my legs fully once more.

She goes to ask if I'm okay when Bow shouts us from around the corner… "Adora! Catra! You might want to come and take a look at this."

We head around the corner and come across what appears to be some sort of memorial. There are various inscriptions on the wall that look like First-Ones writing but they don't exactly follow the same pattern.

"It looks like First-Ones writing but I'm not sure. Adora can you read this?" Bow asks.

Adora moves forward, her hand tracing over the writing. Ivy has started to grow over parts of it. At least some form of life is able to grow here. I hear Adora sigh in frustration...

"I can't. It's not First-Ones writing despite it looking the same. But look here…" Adora pulls away some of the ivy with great force, which reveals something even more interesting… "there's also picture diagrams."

"Maybe whoever was here before all this happened left diagrams along with the inscriptions in case anyone who couldn't read their language came across it. Smart when you think of it." Sparkles says. She forms a magical ball of light which illuminates our surroundings, giving us better visibility.

Something feels oddly memorable about this place, about this memorial. I can't help but feel like I've seen this before and I'm not talking about the picture. But that's impossible… *right?*

Melog meows besides me trying to capturing my attention. I think I hear Adora ask me something, but I can't hear her clearly. I feel like I'm entering a trance. *These carvings… these inscriptions… where have I seen them before?*

I brush my claws over the carved drawings, following their story. A powerful creature, something that looks like a large tiger, transforms when entering battle to protect its citizens. When the battle is done, the creature later fades and returns to its true form… "Magicats?"

"What?" I hear them all faintly say behind me.

"Magicats! This is a Magicat ruin. I-I think I've seen these before."

"How can you have seen them before Catra? This is the first time we've ever been here. Sparkles asks curiously.

I can feel Adora somewhere behind me looking at me with concern. I'd look back to her for reassurance, to tell her it's okay by my mind tells me to keep going, to continue searching for answers.

The drawings continue, followed by a bold inscription at the top. Below lies a series of hand prints, all of which are the same shape and style as my own. There are three together in the shape of a heart, two large and one slightly smaller. My hand brushes over them before resting on the smallest one.

I've seen these before.

Entrapta speaks, breaking me from my trace… "Can you read what the inscription says?"

Taking a few steps back from the wall, the inscription becomes more clear… "Halfmoon."

Suddenly a bright green light flashes before my eyes. I start to panic, fearing that it's another trap set by Horde Prime… but no… *something else happens.*

"Luna you need to get out of here. Take our daughter somewhere safe and don't look back."

"I won't leave you Dawn!"

Visions start to flood my mind. Visions of what I can only assume to be something that occurred many years ago.

"I'm afraid you don't much choice. I'm not going to let them get to you or our daughter. I promise you that. Please, take her and stay safe. I'll find you when this is all over."

My claws start to dig into my scalp. I can't control it. I can't get these visions to stop. It's exactly like my nightmares only this time I'm awake.

Visions of fires, sounds of gun fire, loud scream and pleads for help. The feeling of someone holding me close against them as they run for their life. *No! No! This can't be happening. It's not real. It's not real!*

"We'll find each other. Don't ever lose sight of hope."

I can hear and feel the others around me but I'm not able to respond to them. I can't get these visions to stop. *PLEASE MAKE IT STOP!*

"I love you very much. Never forget that!"

That voice. Why do I recognise that voice!

"I'm sorry my kitten."

No! Come Back! Please! Don't Leave Me! STAY!

"Catra?"

The visions stop, the voices disappear. When my mind is clear I look up. My friends surround me with worried eyes. Adora has a firm grip on my shoulders. She looks at me with great concern and maybe a slight hint of fear.

"Adora…"

My body goes limp and my legs give way. I fall to the to the ground at an alarming rate. The last thing I feel is Adora catching me before everything goes dark.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading chapter three. As many of my readers from my first fic TATEOTW know, I love using cliffhangers 😅. Please don't hate me to much. I promise it'll be worth it.

So what do you think will happen next? Who are the people Catra heard in her visions? Do you think Catra will be able to tell Adora about her nightmares now? You'll have to wait and find out in the next few chapters.

Please let me know what you thought and spread the word of the story to your friends. Thank you for your kind words on the previous chapters. I love reading your comments.

Chapter four will be released on Monday along with not one, but two extra context chapters (one will be realised Monday, the other on Tuesday or Wednesday (I graduate next week so extra content updates exact dates ware a bit off 😅).

I hope to see you on Monday. 😊

Visions

Chapter Summary

Catra's nightmares continue.

Adora screams.

Catra and Adora make the most of their time alone.

**Chapter/Content Warning: Brief Descriptions of War & Childhood Trauma. **

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

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My eyes struggle to open and my arms feel heavy. I feel a soft blanket below my body. It almost feels like it's grass. Finding my strength, I lift my body up off the ground. Strangely my body is aching but I feel incredibly light. It doesn't quite make sense.

"What? Wh-where am I? What's going on?"

BOOM

Fuck what was that?!

I look around trying to detect where the sound came from and what caused it. The only thing surrounding me are ruins, although they're not quite ruins… at least not yet anyway. This, this looks like the Magicat ruins that I visited with Adora and the others earlier but everything seems full of life, full of colour, exactly how it should be.

Hang on a second… Where's Adora?

"Adora?"

I call, but there's no answer.

"Adora!"

I try again but my words become nothing more than a whisper despite my shout of desperation.

"ADORA!.. MELOG!.. SPARKLES!.. "BOW!.. ANYONE!"

BLAST

Another thunderous roar comes from up ahead. Screams and cries for help flood my way. I run towards to sound, curious but terrified at the same time. The sight that greets me is nothing short of a living nightmare. Fires burn ablaze, eating up the village as the unforgiving flames spread. Innocent lives charge into battle, many falling short of their target. Families flee from the demons grasp. It's not long before I realise who is responsible for the destruction and chaos. Horde flags fly high as soldiers who I fear I might have once called comrades destroy my own kind… Magicats.

No. This is not real. It can't be real!

Pinching myself to wake up doesn't work. Despite all the aches and pains in my bones and muscles I feel numb when I pinch my skin. I'm unable to tell if I'm dreaming or living in a real life nightmare. The only thing that I can be certain of is that this moment in time, this level of destruction, occurred at the hands of pure evil.

Why am I here? Why am I having to live this reality? WHAT DO YOU WANT FROM ME!

My eyes shut closed and my ears pin down against my head. Panic starts to set in, building in my chest. My fur stands on end, my body crouches in on itself. *"It's not real. It's not real."* I keep telling myself over and over like a mantra but it's no use. No matter how hard I try to wake myself my efforts prove useless.

Suddenly, to my surprise, the screams stop, the bright fires disappear and the ground stops shaking. It feels like there is a sense of calm but surely that's too good to be true, especially not after everything I have seen. I open my eye to find that I have been transported to a different part of the Whispering Woods. Where exactly I'm not quite sure but just like the time I first went to the ruins, this place somehow also feels… *familiar*.

A faint mewling sound alters me. I recognise the sound as a cry of worry. Whoever it came from sounds confused and quite possibly scared. I turn slightly to see a young Magicat kitten in a box, and a tall slender figure standing over them. She looks hurt, wounded, a large cut on her leg making it difficult for her to stand. Being careful not to startle them, I take a few tentative steps forward. Heck I'm not even sure if they can see me. After all, I'm not sure if this is simply all a dream or reality…

"Hello? Are you okay?"

The figure does not respond. I reach out to touch her shoulder but my hand fades through them.

Okay so I now know this is definitely a dream but that still doesn't make any sense as to why this feels strangely familiar. It's like I've been here before.

The slender figure seems to be saying something to the young Magicat in the box but her words are silent. I can't see the young kitten inside the box properly but I can see that they have hold of something in their tiny hands. It's a bit too big for them to hold properly but they grip onto it tightly, holding it close to them. It's a crimson read colour and follows the same style of a Magicat head.

It's a Magicat mask… my mask!

Before I can get a closer look, the older Magicat, who I now assume is the kittens' mother, closes the lid, protecting her kitten

from the outside dangers of Etheria. This time when she speaks I hear her.

“I’m sorry my kitten.”

That voice. I know that voice.

The figure slowly walks away but then looks back one final time. She has a silverish grey colour to her fur with three dark coloured forearm stripes on each arm. Her eyes are a deep shade of blue, one that someone doesn’t forget. Her mane is a dark bronze colour that has been dusted with the falling ash from the fires. The purple robe that covers her chest and waist, along with her black leggings are showing signs of wear and tear, her injuries becoming more clear. It’s evident that she’s reluctant to leave her kitten behind but her injuries put them both at risk.

A sense of familiarity washes over me. For some reason I don’t feel like the figure is looking at her kitten, it’s like she's looking at me. I think… I think I’ve seen her before, even though I’m not sure when or how. As if guided by instinct my hand reaches out to her but as I do she turns and runs. The vision starts to fade.

“Wait! Please! Come Back! Help me to understand!”

The vision is darkening, disappearing fast. The scene around me starts crumbing inwards. Darkness closes in.

No please. I need answers! Who are you?

“STAY!”

***

--

GASP

I awake startled. My heart rate and breathing pace is elevated.

W-Where am I?

I try to get up but my body struggles to move. It feels as if there is a heavy weight on top of me. My vision is slightly blurry but it's starting to come back to me.

Breathe Catra. Remember to breathe. Try and stay calm.

I take a few deeps breathes to steady my breathing. It's then I feel a familiar presence nudging the palm of my hand before starting to softly purr.

"Melog? Is that you?"

My throat feels dry. I'll be surprised if they heard me.

"I am here friend. Do not fear. I am right beside you."

Melog moves further up my side and I finally see them. Their mane has returned to their normal light blue colour. It's smoother too compared to the last time I saw them. They nudge their head against mine, reassuring me that they are real, which helps me to calm down further. I lift my arm as high as possible, despite the heavy and sore ache, and stroke through their mane.

I don't remember injuring my arms at any point so why do they hurt?

Once my vision is clear, I take in my surroundings to the best of my ability. The soft bed underneath me, the sound of running water somewhere, the bright sparkly wallpaper that I keep telling Adora we need to tear down and replace tells me all I need to know. I'm back at Brightmoon, where its safe, in mine and Adora's bedroom.

Speaking of which where is Adora?

Melog quietly mewls beside me, sensing my growing anxiety. They tilt their head down to the other side of my body. Following the direction of their head, I find the true reason as to why I can't get up. Adora lovingly lays over me. Her head rests against my chest, her arms keeping a tight hold of my waist. The lovable idiot has fallen asleep in her day clothes and has left her ponytail in. If she keeps sleeping with it tied up she'll be bald before she's thirty.

"How long has she been there?" I quietly ask Melog.

"She's been by your side since the moment we got back to Brightmoon. She's refused to leave your side. She made me promise that I'd get you to wake her if you awoke."

Guilt washes over me, knowing full well that I put Adora through all this: the stressing, the sleepless nights and now the worrying about what happened to me back at the Magicat ruins. *Stars I love her but I too worry about her.*

I slowly untangle my arm from underneath her body, before gently removing the elastic from her hair. My claws gentle brush though her long blonde locks.

Adora slowly starts to stir and her arms tighten around me. Her head presses against my chest slightly harder as she groans. I can tell that she's trying to fight sleep but she manages to open her beautiful blue eyes.

"How many times do I have to tell you to sleep with your hair down dummy?"

It's at that moment Adora fully awakes and sits up with a start.

"Catra? You're awake!"

Tears start to fall from Adora's eyes. She kisses my forehead, my cheeks and my nose before finally finding my lips. She then lays back down across my body, her arms wrapping completely around me. She buries her face in the crook of my neck. Her words are slightly muffled through her tears…

"I was worried sick. I was so scared that you weren't going to wake up."

I hold onto Adora's body like it's my life line. My claws dig into her jacket just like the time she saved me from him. She's here… she's really here and I'm safe in her arms.

"Nine lives Adora. I blacked-out that was all. I'm sorry I scared you. I didn't mean to worry you. How long was I out for?"

Adora sits up, enabling me to get a better view of her. She looks exhausted, but I can sense that she's relieved that I am now awake. Adjusting my position, I sit up slightly, resting my back against our headboard and get more comfortable now that Adora's not squashing me. My hand instinctively finds hers and I give it a reassuring squeeze.

"You were out for quite a while." Adora says. Her eyes deliberately avoid my gaze.

"Adora? How long is quite a while?"

Adora sighs deeply… "You were out of it for at nearly a whole day. A few more hours and it would have been a whole day. Glimmer teleported us back here once we managed to get Darla to an area we recognised. I had Castaspella check you over. She said exhaustion combined with what ever happened at *that* place might have caused you to enter 'burn-out'. Melog and I never left your side."

Melog meows beside me and moves to a seating position. Adora reaches across me and strokes their mane. They smile and lean into her touch. It can't have been easy for any of them. I know that I was only out of it for a day but Adora can't communicate with Melog like I can and I don't know if Melog is able to communicate with me like they usual would when I blacked out.

"I'm sorry I worried you. I don't know what happened. All I remember is reading what that inscription said and then a flash of light hit me. I started hearing voices, seeing strange yet familiar

sights. I begged for them to stop but they wouldn't end. It terrified me. The last thing I remember was hearing your voice, looking into your eye and feeling you catch me as my body gave way right before I blacked out. Adora, I'm so sorry…"

Unshed tears start to fall down my cheeks, preventing me from saying anymore. Adora is quick to react, moving to sit next to me, wrapping her arms around my body, allowing me to rest against her shoulder. Melog lies across my legs, purring softly in attempt to get me to settle. I'm not even certain as to why I'm getting upset over something as stupid as this. I've been through all sorts, suffered things far worse than this. Maybe it's just me being silly or the fact that the sleepless nights and the hidden emotions are finally getting to me.

Adora places a gentle kiss to the top of my head…

"You have nothing to be sorry for Catra. You're awake now and you're okay. That's the most important thing."

Adora's thumb brushes across my cheekbone, wiping away any remaining tears. I feel her move slightly, reaching behind her towards the bedside cabinet for something. She hands me a glass of water…

"Here. Drink this."

Gratefully accepting the glass from Adora I take a few steady sips. I don't want to choke like the last time I gulped down a glass of water. That was when I was back on Darla after what happened with… That was one of the worst mistakes I ever made. I cough a few times. I hadn't realised how dry my throat was until now. It's refreshing. It's not long before the glass is completely empty.

"Thanks."

"You're welcome."

Adora smiles. She continues to trace smooth circular patterns through the fur on my back underneath my pyjama shirt. It's very

relaxing.I purr under her touch.

Hang on a second. She got me undressed and into my pajamas but forgot to do the same for herself… what an idiot. Stars I love her.

"I know this might be a stupid question to ask right now considering you've only just woken up, but how you feeling?"

"A bit shit. My body aches for some strange reason. A part from that I feel okay otherwise. Feelings wise… I feel confused, slightly lost if anything. So much was troubling me before all this happened and now to make matters *even more exciting* I started to see things when I blacked out. Things that seems strange yet familiar at the same time. I'm not sure what to do, what to think, or what to feel anymore."

My face falls into my hands and I groan from the stress this is all causing me. I'm extremely frustrated by the whole situation. Adora's hand stills on my back for a moment or two and I hear her speak…

"You were saying some strange things in your previous state. Even Melog seemed concerned. I want to help Catra, we all do."

"I know Adora and I really appreciate it. I just… I don't know how you can help, or if you can help at all. I don't even know where to begin. I don't want to worry you even more."

Melog *mreows* and nudges my head with theirs, forcing me to look at them… *"maybe telling your mate about these nightmares, these visions that you keep having, will be a good place to start."*

Maybe Melog has a point. I was going to tell Adora about them, about the nightmares, back on Darla before we were rudely interrupted by the others. Even if telling Adora doesn't stop the nightmares and visions it might help having someone other than Melog to talk to them about.

“You know I’m always here for you Catra, no matter what. I’ll be ready to listen when you’re ready to talk.”

I take a few deep, evening breathes before sitting back up. Surprisingly, Adora is smiling at me despite everything that has been going on. Her smile gives me the courage I need to tell her anything and everything. I trust her with my whole heart. I lean forwards and place a soft kiss to her lips, before resting my forehead against hers. My hands form a comforting hold on Adora’s hands. Her presence helps to keep me grounded.

“Back on Darla, I was going to tell you what my nightmares where about and why they had been causing me to act more elusive. At first I thought they were only dreams, figments of my imagination trying to piece a puzzle together. I used to get the same nightmare at least once a year, around a certain date but I never thought anything of it. That was until Entrapta showed us those images of the suspected Magicat ruins. For some reason, the same dream became more frequent, only this time more events were added to them. They started to scare me so I thought if I stayed awake they couldn't scare me or hurt me. I didn’t want to worry you which was why I started to avoid you and avoided talking about them. I can see now that that was not the best idea.”

Adora amusingly hums in agreement. However, she does not speak and allows me to continue.

“I know I’m an idiot for doing that and I’m sorry. I won’t do that again I promise.” I take another deep sigh to steady my thoughts… “When we went to investigate the ruins, I couldn’t help but feel like I’ve been there before. I know that might sound crazy to some and others might call me stupid…”

“Catra it doesn’t sound crazy or stupid at all.”

“I know it doesn’t seem that way to you Adora but to some it might seem strange. Besides you heard what Sparkles said when we saw those inscriptions.”

Adora looks upset by that. I know Sparkles probably didn't mean it the way it came across but it still hurt me a bit…

"Anyway, I could hear someone talking. Telling someone to *'leave'* that they *'wouldn't allow someone to get to them'* and that they'd *'find each other when it was all over'.* When I blacked out, I started to see more of my nightmares unfold before me, only this time it was as if I was living them. I was back at the ruins, only this time they were full of life. Fires raged, people like me where either running into battle or fleeing for their lives. I couldn't tell if it was all real or if it was all a dream. I was scared Adora, terrified… and then all of a sudden it stopped. Everything seemed to disappear, a sense of calm surrounded me. I found myself in a new part of the Whispering Woods… and then she appeared."

Adora's hands instinctively tightens around mine, her breathing hitches slightly in hidden anger. To my surprise Melog's mane stays a calm blue. I thought it would have become rough in shape and changed colour a few times by now.

"Shadow Weaver?" Adora asks, her voice stern and sharp.

"No. No it wasn't her. I'm not sure who she was but I could have sworn I have seen her before. I don't know when or where but she looked familiar. She had blue eyes, a silverish grey look to her fur with dark coloured forearm stripes just like mine. Her hair was a clear deep shade of bronze despite the ash from the fires that had mixed with it. She was injured, a deep cut on her leg. I wanted to help but I couldn't. I don't think she could hear or see me. But that's when I noticed the box. There was a kitten inside, a Magicat kitten. I couldn't get a clear look before the tall figure closed the box. I recognised her voice as she spoke one final time. I recognised her voice Adora."

Adora's hand reaches forward, her thumb brushing over my cheek. It's only then that I realised that some of my tears had started to fall again. *Stupid emotions.*

Adora pulls me into another warm embrace. I rest my ear against her chest letting her steady heart beat soothe me. I don't know who the figure in my dreams was or if she still exists, but I'm certain that I have seen her before. I recognised her voice.

Melog whispers that they're proud of me for overcoming my fears and telling Adora the truth. Strangely, in a way, Melog was right. Even if these nightmares don't stop I feel like a huge weight has been lifted of my shoulders, simply by being able to share my worries with the person I love… but there is something more that's bothering me. Something that I feel I should also tell Adora about.

There's a stiffness in Adora's posture, as if she's just realised something.

"Catra? You don't think…"

"I don't know Adora. I don't know, but there's more I feel I should tell you about."

Adora places a gentle kiss to the top of my head and moves back so we're once again fully facing each other. She has an encouraging smile on her face, which encourages me to continue. In the corner of my sight, I see Melog's ear prick up and their attention turns towards our bedroom door. I would follow their lead but right now I need to tell Adora the whole truth. The whole truth about what's been bothering me.

"Adora…"

BANG

Our bedroom doors swing open, startling both myself and Adora. Sparkles, Arrow Boy, Micah, Entrapta, Swift Wind and even Scorpia come barging through the door. Melog faintly growls at them but a quick touch from my hand to their mane calms them down. There is no intention behind their growl but I can tell they're pissed off with them for interrupting us for a second time. Adora looks even more unimpressed.

All of them run over surrounding me and Adora. It makes me feel incredibly uncomfortable and a little bit claustrophobic. If I was more alert and not freaked out by these visions then maybe I'd feel okay. Although, knowing me it probably wouldn't make a difference.

"CATRA! You're awake!" Bow practically squeals.

"We'll of course she's awake. It was only a short 'burn-out' episode. Nothing too serious to worry about." Entrapta states whilst looking over her data pad. I wonder if she's found out any useful information.

"WILDCAT! YOU'RE OKAY! I was worried sick. I came over as fast as I could."

I swear Scorpia would have pulled me in a bone crushing hug right now if it wasn't for Melog and Adora blocking me from either side. They're my two protective body guards.

"Got to admit Horde Scum you had us really worried there. Adora hasn't left your side since you blacked-out."

Adora turns a shade of pink. It's *adorable*… "I believe so." I say as I reach out to take Adora's hand in mine.

"So Catra. I can sense through mine and Adora's sacred bond that she has been a worried mess since they arrived back in Brightmoon. Even I was starting to worry about you. I was going to bring you so of my comfiest hay to make a pillow for you if you hadn't woken up by the end of today. Are you doing okay?"

Adora looks to Swift Wind and back to me asking if it's okay if she leaves my side for a moment to go and reassure him. I can sense that she doesn't really want to leave my side right now, but I can tell she needs to give Swift Wind a quick hug just like I sometimes need to give Melog a quick hug. Difference between those two is that Melog is small enough to sit beside me, Swift Wind doesn't have that advantage.

"Thanks Swift Wind. I'm fine now I promise. I'm sorry for worrying you all. It's just been a lot to take in and to deal with at the moment."

"What do you mean a lot to take in? Did something happen to you? Did you see something when you blacked out." Scorpia asks curiously.

"Well I…"

"Nothing overly drastic happened to her Scorpia. We were all there when she blacked out. If it wasn't for Adora catching her she probably would have hit her head pretty hard. Not to mention I noticed Melog's mane turning many shades of red and blue when we were on our way back home and they didn't stop after I teleported us back here. Catra what was all that with Melog about? They're even changing colour now."

Their mane is changing from a bright blue to a faded red, and they're starting to cower beside me. Thankfully the other's don't know what this means but Adora does and she acts on instinct. She tries to get to me but her path is now blocked by the others. I try to calm down and respond in a reasonable manner…

"Well Melog reflects my emotions and before you lot came in I was…"

"Maybe it has something to do with Halfmoon. The data and samples collected do show that it was once a Magicat settlement. That we now know for certain. There's a lot of mysteries still to be uncovered there. Catra how do you feel about going back there, preferably sooner rather than later? We may need your translation skills again." Entrapta asks as she taps away on her tech pad.

How do I feel about going back there?

"Maybe this is a discussion for later Entrapta. We're not even sure if it's safe to go back there yet. Besides, you know I saw something in the bushes as we were leaving." Bow says as he tries to pull Entrapta back.

Bow saw something? W-what did he see?

Another memory tries to flash its way into my mind but I stop it before it can even begin. I can feel Melog getting smaller beside me. I want to hide and disappear.

"Maybe we should all give Catra a moment and let her relax for a while." Micah suggests. Finally someone has some common sense.

"Good suggestion Micah. Besides I don't really want to talk about it right…"

Sadly my words fall short as I'm bombarded with more and more questions. I don't take them in, my mind blocks them out. My claws dig into the blanket below me and my fur starts to slowly rise. I don't like this, I don't like this one bit. I appreciate their concern and curiosity but right now I want to be left alone. I feel as if they're closing in on me. I can't make them stop. If they don't back off I think Melog might explode with fear and rage…

"SHUT IT!"

The room falls silent and everyone turns to face the enraged voice behind them. Adora's face is bright red and her hands have formed fists at her side. Her breathing is heavy. I've never seen her look this mad before.

"All of you out… NOW!"

One of them, I'm not sure who, goes to protest.

"But…"

"No buts! You all heard me the first time. Catra needs to rest and if you haven't noticed we were in the middle of a private conversation before you all came barging in here. We appreciate your concern but can you not see how you all bombarding her with questions is making her feel? She just woke up of Etheria's sake! Give her a break! You're supposed to be her friends not detectives."

Damn Adora really went there.

The others look at Adora stunned and turn back to me, each whispering words of apology. Adora appears to have started to cool down.

"Now please can you all give Catra some alone time and allow her to recover. If you need anything come and ask me. Although I too would very much like a break. Now that I mention it, scrap that, forget what I just said. Don't come to me unless it's an emergency. I'm having three days off doing nothing but relaxing with the woman I love."

"Adora..."

My voice whispers slightly. I look to Adora and smile. I'm not quite sure what I want to say. *'I'm proud of you'*, *'that was hot.'* It's taken a long time to get to a point where Adora will say what she truly feels, what she wants, what she deserves.

Adora smiles back to me and moves to my side now that there is a clear path. The others take that as their cue to leave. They whisper words of apology again to me and now to Adora. Micah tells us to let him know if there is anything we need before making his exit. Melog is now back to their full size. They go to get off the bed and leave but I stop them.

"You know you don't have to go right? You're more than welcome to stay here."

"I know, but I feel like you and your mate are in need of some alone time. I shall stand guard and make sure nobody disturbs you. I won't be too far. Make sure you call should you need me."

They lick my cheek and jump of the bed. They brush themselves up against Adora's leg before making their smooth exit outside the door. Adora lets out a deep sigh that she hadn't known she was holding in. She looks at me slightly embarrassed...

"I'm sorry you had to see that. I'll give you some space."

As she turns to leave, my hand reaches out and grabs a tight hold of her hand… "Adora wait."

Adora looks back to me with those beautiful blue eyes of hers… "Please, stay."

"You sure you want me to stay after you saw me have a go at our friends?"

"They deserved it. Besides, it was kind of hot."

Adora starts to laugh as I pull her down to sit beside me on the bed. I rest my head against her shoulder and she rests her head on top of mine. It's calm and peaceful, exactly what we are both in need of.

"Thank you for setting our friends straight."

"Anytime. I love you Catra."

"I love you too."

Adora places a gentle kiss to my lips which I lovingly return.

"So, do you want to continue telling me what's been bothering you before we were rudely interrupted?"

I giggle slightly… "Sure. Why not."

Grrr

A loud grumble comes from Adora's stomach.

"When did you last have something proper to eat?"

"Urm… *yesterday.*"

"Adora!"

"Hey, you can't blame me. You haven't eaten either."

“That’s different. I was in dream land.”

GRRR

As if on cue my stomach rumbles too, which caused both Adora and I to begin laughing. I’m not sure who’s more hungry, me or Adora.

“How about we go and get something to eat or even better, we politely ask Melog if they will bring us some cake so we don’t have to see anyone.”

“I’ll only agree to it if Melog doesn’t mind.”

Almost instantly, Melog’s head pokes in around the corner of our door. I swear that alien friend of ours has super hearing. The *mreow* and smile… “Thanks Melog. Make sure to get yourself something too.”

Adora looks at me slightly confused… “I thought Melog didn’t consume food. Or at least not like we do.”

I smirk and lightly laugh under my breath… “They don’t need to consume food like we do. It’s not like they rely on it for survival, but that doesn’t mean that they shouldn’t enjoy the delicious foods Brightmoon has to offer. *Remind me again how long you have known them for?”*

Adora gives me a slight shove on my shoulder. Although *slight* is an understatement. She literally shoved me so hard that she then had to catch me by the arm so I didn’t fall off the bed. We both start laughing until our sides hurt.

“Do you mind if I go have a shower? I wouldn’t go and have one before because I was worried you’d wake up and worry if I wasn’t beside you. It’s just I’d rather have one before I get into my pajamas.”

“What are you asking me for dummy? Go and have one… *if you’re lucky I might join you*.”

"I thought cats hated water?"

Adora teases and this time I shove her off the bed quite literally. She lands on the floor with a loud thud. The laughter starts again. It's nice to have a laugh. I feel comfortable when I'm with Adora. I can be myself.

I contemplate waiting for Adora to be done with her shower, but the more I think about it I'd quite like to have a shower myself. Not to mention that I don't really want to be left alone with nothing but my thoughts.

Getting up from our bed, I make my way to the bathroom. Who knows, maybe this could lead somewhere. We haven't had much alone time recently.

--

Fresh steam makes contact with my fur. Adora is folding her towel by the sink side. She jumps a little bit when I wrap my arms around her, she was probably distracted by the sound of running water. I will admit, it is quite calming.

"Did you miss me or something?" Adora asks teasingly. I can picture the smug smirk on her face.

"Maybe. I decided to join you. You know, to keep you company."

Adora turns in my light hold so we're now face to face. She places a soft kiss to my forehead… "I'll go get your towel and then I'll join you."

"Promise?"

"I promise."

Adora lightly kisses my lips before leaving me to strip out of my pajamas in private.

I never really liked water but I always tolerated it. Back in the Horde, I found showers bearable as Adora and I, especially when we were little, used to share a shower. The only reason we did that was because I used to get matted fur all the time as the Horde didn't have Magicat brushes. Adora would get in the shower with me in her standard Horde uniform during our younger years and help brush out all the mats in my mane. Despite how difficult and knotty they were, she was always extremely gentle. When she finished she'd leave the shower and I'd throw her my soaking uniform over the stall doors which she'd put at the side. I'd shower first and then I'd wait in the changing rooms just outside of the showers for her to be finished too. We'd then both sneak off to the boiler room together to dry off and dry our clothes. We didn't think anything of it back then. We were kids.

As we got older, I found a more *convincing* reason to tolerate having a shower. Stolen sneak peeks over the shower stalls were moments I savored the most. Adora's body was perfect, gorgeous, the definition of beautiful and perfect. I on the other hand had a lack of confidence in my body. I always made myself believe that Adora would never go for someone like me. Someone who's muscles weren't as defined, someone who felt ashamed of their wild, animalistic features. It wasn't till Adora and I became a thing that she admitted to also sneaking a few glances at me in the showers during our cadet years. Turns out Adora thought the exact same as what I thought about her. In her eyes, I was perfect, stunning and in Adora's word, the definition of beautiful. Our teenage years were confusing to say the least.

Unfortunately my toleration of water was soon to become a fear… *thanks to him.* I remember suffocating, drowning as his pool of green torment corrupted my mind. I screamed for help, begging for this nightmare to be over. I saw everything behind my green eyes, struggling to escape his clutches. I though the only way to escape from him, the only way to protect the woman I love, was

to sacrifice myself. Thankfully for me Adora wasn't prepared to give up on me so easily. Her love saved me, gave me a reason to live, a reason to keep fighting.

It took a lot of work to overcome my fear of water. Prime damaged me in ways I thought unimaginable. I would only allow Adora near me, to help me with any form of way to overcome my fear. First was a wet flannel slowly washing over my fur. Next was to have my whole body covered in small water droplets. The third stage was to have my whole body surrounded by water. Adora held onto me through it all, until I was ready to let go. At first I wouldn't open my eyes, afraid of seeing green again, but when I opened my eyes I saw nothing but clear droplets and the beautiful sight holding onto me, promising me that I'd be okay. I felt like I could finally see.

We're still working on larger pools of water. Sometimes I get flashbacks to that brainwashing pool of his but I'm getting better. I'm no longer clinging to Adora when we enter our room fountain pool anymore. We decided to start overcoming my fear there as I felt safe and comfortable in our room, but even now I still prefer Adora to be with me when I shower.

Once fully undressed, I take a deep breath and enter the shower. The water droplets run smoothly down my fur, before landing on the shower floor, dancing to a silent beat. I let the feeling of the water calm me, clear my mind from my thoughts. Two strong arms make their way around my waist and I feel a gentle kiss being placed on my shoulder. My immediate response is to purr and lean against Adora's warm embrace. We're practically skin to skin, only small droplets of water come between us.

"Do you mind if I bathe you?" Adora asks suggestively, as she reaches for the shower gel.

The one I use is different to the one Adora usually uses. Adora uses of Brightmoon's standard issued soaps. It's got a nice, clean smell to it and thankfully this one doesn't make her *sparkle*. The last one she used had glitter in it. She was itching for a whole

week till I made her change it to one that doesn't irritate her skin. Mine is more natural, one that was suggested by Perfuma. My fur and skin is extremely sensitive to certain substances so I have to use one that uses herbal remedies. It soft on sensitive skin and it helps to keep my fur smooth and smelling fresh.

Adora squeezes some of my soap onto her hands and gentle massages it into my fur and onto my skin. Her hands perfectly map over my body, smoothly gliding over and under my chest, giving small squeezes to certain areas as she goes. She attempts to tickle me at one point by squeezing my hips, but my tail bats the side of her hip, telling her to not even try it.

"Is this okay?" Adora asks before washing my tail and ears.

Adora knows how sensitive they are, both in terms of touch and for *other reasons*. Her touches are suggestive, teasing, but she doesn't persist in her chase. If I'm being honest I'm slightly disappointed about it. I can tell she wants more and secretively so do I. I turn in Adora's hold, prepared to protest as to why she's stopped but the smirk on her face tells me all I need to know. She's doing this deliberately.

"You're enjoying this a little too much aren't you?"

"Maybe. I can tell how hard it is for you to hold back your moaning." Adora responds. A devilish smirk appearing on your face… "I would have continued, taken this further but I don't want to scar Melog. Not to mention, with what I plan to do to you, they'd be back before our little make-out session would have ended anyway."

Well now I'm interested. What plans does she have? Shame she's right though.

"I hate it when your right. Now pass me your shower gel. I'd like to get my share of touching your body before Melog comes back with food."

Adora giggles and hands me her shower gel. Just like she did to me a few moments before, I map out her body perfectly, gliding smoothly across her body contours and curves. I tease her slightly more than she did with me. It's entertaining to watch her trying hold back her gasps and slight moans…

"Catra."

"What? I'm not doing anything."

"You know *exactly* what you're doing."

The rest of our shower time is filled with passionate, heated kisses. Our hands wander across each other's body but they don't make contact where they're need most. It's agonising to hold back from what we both want, what we both desire, but we know Melog will be back soon so there is no point in starting what we can't finish.

Adora turns the shower speed down, before completely turning it off. She reaches for our towels and wraps me up in mine before covering herself in her own. She then proceeds to scoop me up and carry me back to our bed.

"Practising for the day when you carry me down the aisle?"

Adora laughs and she places me gently down on our bed. She gently brushes through my fur to prevent knots from forming before *'fluffing'* me up with my towel.

"You're so cute and fluffy."

"I'm not cute or fluffy."

"You definitely are. There's no denying it. My fiancé is the cutest and *fluffiest* Magicat in the whole of Etheria."

Adora places a kiss to the top of my head, before handing me a fresh set of pajamas. She then proceeds to dry herself. I manage to persuade her to keep her hair down and loose. It's suites her.

I sense that Melog is on their way back with food after having their fill. I wonder what they'll bring us?

--

"I have to agree with you Catra. Chocolate cake is the best cake there is."

"I know right. I don't even know why it was a debate between Sparkles and Arrow Boy."

Melog returned with some fish sticks, *my favourite,* pancakes, *Adora's favourite,* and two slices chocolate cake. Apparently Wrong Hordak was in the kitchens and wanted to *"provide his joyous brothers with nourishment after their long trip"*. He's been visiting Brightmoon a lot recently. He's taken up a passion for cooking so Sparkles offered to have Brightmoon's chefs show him some of their recipes. According to Melog, he remembered all our favourite meals so decided that that would be best to give us. Melog, *surprise to surprise*, asked for mini meats. I'm not sure how Melog managed to carry all of our food back to us but they somehow manged it. They are some form of shape shifter after all.

Later on, Melog asked if Adora and I would mind if they went and spent the night catching up with Swift Wind, which of course neither of us mind. They have a weekly *'companion chat'* night where they… *you know now I think of it I'm not sure what their weekly catch ups consist of. I'll have to ask them one day.*

Now there is only Adora and I in our room, eating our way through the last few pieces of chocolate cake.

"Well, after knowing Glimmer and Bow for a few years, you come to learn that they tend to start a debate over little things like that.

Like this one time, they debated over weather Glimmer's mini figure should sparkle or not."

"Let me guess. Having mini Sparkles sparkling won."

"Oh one hundred percent sparkly Glimmer won. Glimmer hated it for weeks but eventually grew to love it."

Got to admit Bow is very creative when it comes to crafting mini figurines. I didn't expect him to make one for myself and Melog. No one but Melog knows this, but I got quite emotional when I got back to mine and Adora's room. It felt like I was finally part of their family, a real family, which sadly now brings me onto the next thing that has been playing on my mind and why I feel so guilty for having these thoughts.

Adora takes my now empty plate and places it on the dresser table with hers. She then goes to lock our door and comes back to sit besides me on our bed. We both get comfy in what we refer to as our *'talking positions'.* Adora positions herself against the headboard and I settle between her legs. My head rests against her chest so that I can listen to her strong steady heartbeat. My arms wrap around one of her biceps and my tail wraps around her leg. Adora's arms wrap around my arms, holding me in a warm, comforting embrace. One of her free hands alternates between brushing through my hair and stroking patterns through the fur on my back. No words are said just yet. The atmosphere is calming. We don't push each other to say anything, we'll speak when we're ready.

Here goes nothing…

"Do you ever wonder where you came from? Do you ever wonder how you ended up in the Horde? Question how things might have been different if you grew up with your family?"

Adora's body slightly stiffens. I know that this was a risky question to ask but I need to know, I need answers. Adora is the only one like me, *to an extent*, who has lived a similar life to me. She takes

a deep sigh and then hums, as if she's trying to think of a suitable way to answer…

"I guess so. I mean I know how I ended up in the Horde. I was brought through a portal as an infant to fulfill a destiny that I didn't know about until I defected from the Horde. I sometimes wonder what my family was like and if they ever fought to find me or did they simply give up. I sometimes think what life would have been like if none of that happened. What life would have I led? But then I look at all that and I realise that if I hadn't been brought through the portal, if I hadn't ended up in the Horde, then I never would have met you. Not only that but I wouldn't have met Glimmer and Bow. I wouldn't have become the strong warrior that I am today and I wouldn't have been able to be with the most beautiful, amazing, wonderful Magicat who makes my life complete. Sure I sometimes wonder what my life would have been like if I knew my birth family, but I have learned to accepted that my destiny was to be here, with you and all the others. Maybe knowing how I ended up in the Horde has made the acceptance process about my past easier as I know it was out of my control, but none the less I love all of you. You are my family, my found family."

A slight shiver makes its way down my spine at Adora words… *'found family'*. That word alone plays on a loop in my mind. My ears adjust slightly to lie against my head. Adora notices this change and proceeds to hold me closer. She places a gentle kiss to the tip of my ears.

"Is this part of what has been bothering you? Not knowing the truth about where you came from and how you ended up in the Horde?"

Classic Adora. She can read my like an open book.

I nod slightly, unable to form any words just yet. Adora's hold on my body grows stronger and she gently rubs soothing patterns across my back. She knows I'll answer her properly when I can. After a few moments, I take a deep sigh and answer...

"I remember little bits about my past, or what I think is my past. I remember little things like someone singing to me, someone holding me close promising me that everything would be okay. But then I remember fires, sights of blood and hearing screams of fear and then someone saying goodbye. I see those scenes in my dreams Adora. They scare me sometimes. The only thing I'm certain of, that I remember, is that you found me in a small box in the Fright Zone corridors. You found me, took care of me and gave me my name. That I am forever grateful for and everything you did for me. I felt safe when I was with you."

I have to stop and take a few steady breathes before continuing…

"As I got older I started to question why I was the only one of my species in the Horde. Sure it wouldn't have bothered me if folks like Rogelio and Octavia where the only ones of their kind too, but that never seemed to be the case. When I tried to find out some answers I was punished and told that my species was an abomination to Etheria and that we were wiped out of the face of Etheria. Why I was the only one left? I never knew the answer. I had hoped that our files, the ones Scorpia found and gave to us after she reclaimed the Fright Zone, would give me some indication as to what happened and how I ended up in that dump. All it said was my species and *'abandoned in the Fright Zone corridors'*. That's the only information in my files about my past. No name given, just an ID number. That's all I was to the Horde, a number. It's why I value my name so much. The name that you gave me Adora. It gave me a purpose, a way to say *'I did that. Me, Catra. I achieved that.'"*

Almost there Catra. You're doing fine. Just a bit more and you would have told her everything…

"Since Entrapta showed us those photos, plus the combination of the nightmares and now the visions when I blacked-out, it's all been getting to me again. I love my family: you, Melog, Arrow Boy, Sparkles, even that annoying talking horse of yours and the others. I'm grateful that I have them all in my life. You're all my family, *my found family*. However, I can't help but feel like a part

of me is missing. A piece of me that I need to know more about. How did I end up in the Horde? Was I really abandoned? Did I have parents? Did they love me? If so then why did they leave me to suffer at the hands of evil? These are all the questions that I'll probably never have the answers too, but I have to try and find something out. I have to try. If I don't… **sigh** … it's like not knowing who I am?"

Overcome with emotion, I let me tears fall as Adora comforts me. She whispers sweet nothings and promises to me… *"I'm here"… "It's okay"… "I've got you"… "Let it all out"… "I love you".* She kisses the top of my head in between every phrase. She uses her free hand to wipe away my tears. They're slowly start to die down and my breathing evens out.

"I'm sorry."

Those are the first words I speak after all is said and done. Adora moves me forward slightly so she can get a better look at me.

"What are you sorry for?" She asks, sounding confused. *Is it not obvious?*

"Isn't it obvious? Adora, I'm sorry for making you worry about all this. I hate feeling and seeming like I'm ungrateful and selfish for wanting to know about my past and my real family. I-I'm sorry for getting like this. I-I'm sorry f-for having you worry about me over s-something so stupid. I-I'm sorry I'm not enough."

"Catra stop!"

Adora's voice is firm and her nails dig into my shoulders where her hands are resting. My eyes lower to avoid her gaze.

"You have nothing to be sorry for okay. Nothing. You are not being selfish or ungrateful or stupid for wanting to know more about your past and where you came from. After everything we went through growing up, no one deserves to know the truth about their past more than you do. If that is what you want, to know more about your past and your family before your found

family, then I will help you in any way I can and I'm certain the others will too. As far as everything else goes…"

Adora's hand rests against my cheek, forcing me to look at her once more. I expected her to be angry, upset, yet her eyes show nothing but love and compassion…

"I'm always going to worry about you Catra. There is no changing that. You're my soulmate, the love of my life, my person. I'm going to worry about you when I can sense something is bothering you. You can't deny that you don't do the same with me."

That remark earns a small smile on my behalf. Adora continues to speak...

"I can't promise you that we'll find all the answers you seek, but I can promise you that I will be with you every step of the way if that's what you want."

Adora places a soft kiss to my forehead and brushes away my remaining tears with the gentle wipe of her thumb. I lean further into the touch of her palm, keeping her there for a few more moments.

"You sure you're not mad at me?"

"I promise I'm not mad at you. There is nothing to be mad about. Although, I do want you to remember something."

"Oh yeah. What's that?" I ask curiously.

"No matter what anyone tells you, no matter how upset or alone you sometimes may feel, remember that *you are Catra*. You are the strongest, most caring, amazing and beautiful person in the whole of Etheria. You are worth more to me than anything in the universe. You are my soulmate, the love of my life, my home. I thank the stars everyday that our fates crossed paths. I love you Catra, more than words can say and more than actions show. You are Catra and I love you so much."

Signs of tears start to form in Adora's eyes. My hands reach forwards to brush them away as they threaten to fall. I move myself slightly out of Adora's hold, so I'm not practically sat in her lap. My eyes find hers and our hearts start to beat as one. A low purr starts to emit from my chest as I say the words that have never spoke more truth…

"I love you Adora."

Moving in slowly, I passionately kiss her. At first its slow and soft. Adora hands steady themselves on my back, holding me close to her. My arms rest around her neck. It's tranquil, peaceful and steady. However, it's not long before all of that pent up frustration from not having time to be intimate with each other becomes too much to bear. The steamy shower probably hasn't helped either.

We seize our opportunity alone to give into our desires. Our kisses become my hungry, more demanding. Our once smooth body touches become more eager, tugging at the others clothing, which has now become nothing more than an inconvenient barrier between us. Moving with grace, I gently turn and lower myself on our bed, pulling Adora on top of me. We part only to catch our breath. Adora's pupils are blown wide and I wouldn't be surprised if mine are too.

"Catra… do you want to do this?" Adora asks. I can hear her heart beating at an increased pace. I can sense she wants this, just as much as I do

"I want this Adora, but only if you want this too. I love you."

That gives Adora all the confirmation she needs… "I love you too."

There's a sudden change in the atmosphere. What was once calm and peaceful, is now eager and longing. Adora meets my lips eagerly with more hungry kisses. The rest of our night is filled with passionate love making. Each of us taking it in turns to try and make the other scream their lovers names with pleasure as we give in to our desires. Hands roam wildly across the others

body, marks are left in visible and no visible areas. When all is finished and our bodies tell us that we can no longer continue despite the want to go one, we fall asleep, holding each other tight in our arms, tangled between the sheets.

I'll have to remember to ask Sparkles if we can have some new bed sheets tomorrow. I don't think I'll be able to repair the scratch marks in these ones.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading chapter four. Where any of your questions answered or do you now have more questions? Let me know in the comments. I love reading your thoughts on where you think the story is heading 😊

We also have two extra content chapters that are now up in the Finding Halfmoon Series. One is about what was going through Adora's head after Catra blacked-out (posted today. Link Here: https://archiveofourown.org/works/39176232). The other is the explicit version of this chapter (will be posted tomorrow). Hope you enjoy reading them.

Chapter five will be released on Friday. The question is will more answers being uncovered? See you soon 😊

Unanswered Questions

Chapter Summary

Bow's Dads find something of interest that they present to the Best Friend Squad.

Catra is still suspicious that Micah knows more than he'll admit.

Catra decides to take matters into her own hands.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"How much longer do you think they'll be? Not to be rude or anything but I'm getting kind of bored and would really love any excuse to go back to cuddling Adora."

"Your practically cuddling her right now. You're curled up on her lap. You're the literal definition of a *'lap cat'*. Besides, didn't you two spend three days doing exactly that?"

"We did but that doesn't mean we can't go back to doing that some more of that if we have some spare time Sparkles."

A yawn escapes me. Who knew relaxing could be tiring. It's probably a sign of how desperate Adora and I were for some much needed relaxation time.

We have spent the last three days simply relaxing and enjoying each other's company. Adora and I slept way into the day, ate whatever we wanted, cuddled until we became too warm from holding each other only to refuse to let go of one another, spent a nice evening at Mystacor's pools and beaches and even had the occasional sparring match that led to… *well you know.*

The nightmares and visions have also calmed down since I told Adora about them. I still get little flashes but nothing too serious that I end up awake in tears or the shivers. I've actually been able to get a few decent nights sleep. It's been nice to have some much needed time to ourselves, to have some Adora and I only time. We definitely need to do it more often, we both needed some time to ourselves. Personally, I feel refreshed and ready to take on anything, which leads us to where we are now.

"I'm sure they won't be too long now. If I know my dad's they're probably planning how to make a dramatic entrance with whatever they've brought with them."

"I take it they found something then?" Adora asks, looking slightly concerned but also eager to know more.

"I think so. What information they have exactly I don't know but I guess we'll find out soon. If it's one thing I know it's when you set my dad's off on a mission, they commit to it one hundred and one percent."

All of us, or at least everyone who is aware of what happened since our arrival back from Halfmoon, has been summoned to attend an urgent meeting in what was Brightmoon's old war briefing room. Sparkles asked beforehand if I was okay for her to invite Scorpia. Apparently she has been very concerned since she heard what happened. She sent Adora and I some of her famous tea whilst we were resting. It was surprisingly very nice, better than I initially expected. She's a good friend. It took me a long time to forgive myself over the way I treated her back in the Horde. I'm not proud of what I did and my behaviour was no excuse for how I made her feel. All she did was be nice to me and I took her for granted, pushing her away in the process. I couldn't understand how or why Scorpia forgave me so easily, but now I understand and I can't imagine my life without her.

Scorpia is sitting on the opposite side of the table to us giving Melog some belly rubs. They're quite fond of Scorpia and I can

see why. She has a good, honest heart that she wears on the sleeve of her exoskeleton. Her and Perfuma make a good team.

"You know what, I think I'm going to give them a call. See where they're at. Maybe it'd be easier if Glimmer could…"

BANG

The sound the doors make when they hit the walls make my ears hurt and everyone else jump. I've lost count of how many times I've suggested they put door stoppers against the walls due to the fact people like to barge in through them. The amount of handle marks on the walls is ridiculous.

Adora notices the flinch of my ears from the sound. If I move them too quickly my ear muscles can sometimes spasm and it becomes difficult to lift them again. It's one of the unfortunate side effects from many years of Shadow Weavers punishments as result of her powers. I used to get call *'flat-ears'* back in the Horde when that happened, but only Adora knew the true reason as to why my ears sometimes stayed in that position. Adora rubs them gently for a few seconds, allowing my ears to return to their normal position more easily and comfortably. Sometimes I think people forget I have sensitive hearing.

"Sorry we're late everyone. Lance thought he saw an Etherian Moon Owl on the way here and made us stop for ten minutes to see if he could find it."

"I'm telling you I saw one… *or at least I think I did.* It's not very easy to see when you're carrying a load of research articles but I'm telling you I saw something that looked exactly like one."

An Etherian Moon Owl? Surely it can't be the same one that we saw at the ruins. That would be weird. Try not to think too much about it Catra. For all you know they might have mistaken it for a common owl or other bird. Besides, Lance needs glasses to see and George is convinced that it wasn't an owl at all from the

sounds of it. Beside, you've got bigger things to worry about now so get your head in the game.

George and Lance drop a series of books, scrolls and artifacts across the holographic table before giving Arrow Boy a massive hug. I swear he's turning blue with how tight his dad's are hugging him.

"Bow it's so nice to see you again, and everyone else of course."

"It's good to see you too. Do you…**squeeze*… do you mind loosening your grip a bit please*. *I can't breath."*

Bow's dad's laugh before loosening their grip. Bow starts gasping for air as he holds his stomach. A tad over dramatic if you ask me but he did turn blue for a moment… *And here I am thinking Scorpia's hugs are bone crushing.*

"Wow. You weren't kidding when you said you found something. Why didn't you ask Bow to ask me if I could teleport you here? I would have been more than happy to."

"It's okay Glimmer. We decided a walk through the woods would be nice. Get some fresh air in our lungs. Besides, it gives Lance and I some time to see what new life Etheria has to offer since Adora and Catra stopped the Heart of Etheria from activating and released it's magic instead."

A slight blush appears across my face knowing that my part in ending the war has been acknowledged. In the corner of my eye, I see Adora smile, appreciating what George has said. Only our close friends know what really happened down at the Heart of Etheria but Adora is adamant on making my contribution known, reminding me that if it wasn't for me being there to pull her back when she felt like giving up none of us would probably be here. Our first kiss however, that memory is only for me and Adora to share.

"Speaking of which, Catra how are you feeling? We were quite concerned when we heard what had happened to you when you

got back from… *that place*."

"It's okay George, you can say Halfmoon. We've got to accept that that's what the place is called sooner or later. I'm fine thanks for asking. I'm feeling a lot better now after some much needed rest. I think I'm as eager as everyone else to find out what you've discovered."

"Glad to hear it. Alright everyone gather round. Lance if you'd please do the honours."

On that note everyone gets up from their seats and gathers around the holographic table. Well, everyone except Micah that is. He keeps his distance for a little while and has been unusually quite all morning. Something seems off.

Melog appears besides me, nudging my leg, asking me if I'm okay. I telepathically ask them to keep an eye on Micah. Call it instinct or whatever you want to call it, but I sense he's hiding something from us. He doesn't seem himself. Let's see if he says anything during this meeting.

Lance and George arrange the files in a set order: pictures, inscriptions, artifacts, all sorts, each and everything laid out on the table before us. Some of the inscriptions are written in modern day Etherian language, First-Ones writing and then wording that only I was able to read when at the ruins. Adora recognizes them and silently asks me if I want to read them out or not should the group ask. The slight shake of my head is all it takes for Adora to understand: if any of the team ask me to read them she'll quickly, but politely, shut them down.

The artifacts seem rare, possibly more ancient than what Entrapta retrieved from the wreckage. There's a small dagger and some form of cloth material. It's purple in colour and soft to the touch. From the way it's ripped it looks as if it was caught on something when the person wearing the clothing it belonged to got caught or entangled. It's in good condition for something that might be over two decades old.

The pictures presented to us are slightly grainy, probably due to their age. Some are in colour, some are in black and white, but one thing above all stands through… the people in these images, *they're Magicats.*

"Fascinating." Entrapta says as she seems to be in a clear trance.

Entrapta goes to touch some of the stuff with her purple, scientifically modified hair, but Sparkles bats it away. Sparkles is sometimes the one who keeps us out of trouble, wether that be by batting us away from something or literally teleporting us away. However, now that I think of it, she's usually the one who gets us into trouble. It's always worth it though.

Adora looks to me, she's as amazed and confused as I am. There really were Magicats before me… *so what happened to them?*

"How did you managed to get hold of this stuff?" Adora asks.

"That's a good question. George would you like to answer that one."

"After Halfmoon collapsed and Magicats disappeared, the Rebellion felt that it was best that as much of Magicat culture and history was preserved in any way possible. Myself and a few members of the original Rebellion went to salvage many of the artifacts and resources that hold valuable information for history purposes."

"Hang on a minute. If the Rebellion existed at the time of Halfmoon's demise why didn't they help them. Surely, all Etherian kingdoms vowed to help and protect each other when another was in danger." Sparkles's voice rises with anger as she speaks. It's like she's reading my thoughts.

Why was help not offered? Surely this could have been prevented!

For the first time today, Micah moves forward and places a hand on his daughters shoulder. He takes a deep sigh before speaking…

"At the time of Halfmoon's demise the Rebellion was crumbling. Many kingdoms had already turned against each other and were backing out against their oaths to protect their own. The Horde was making vast advancements. No one knew what their next move would be. By the time Brightmoon received word of what was happening, the Horde had successfully seized Halfmoon. We were too late. Nothing could be done to stop the attack. The damage had already been done."

The room falls silent. Not a single word is spoken. I have to steady myself at the edge of the table, my claws digging into the holographic screen. Anger and frustration fills my body. Not only is the Horde to blame for this but the original Rebellion is too. They could have helped, but they didn't!

Adora rubs soothing circles across my back whilst Melog softly purrs besides me. I take a few deep, steady breathes, trying my best to keep my anger contained. When I've cooled down, I reposition myself so I look calm and collected once more, although deep inside I'm a burning fire of rage. Frustration and angry is clearly written on Adora's and Glimmer's face. The others show confusion and upset. Sensing that no one has to balls to ask more about Halfmoon, I decide to speak…

"What else can you tell us about Halfmoon? Did you find anything else of interest a part from the fact they were left to defend themselves from evil and suffered because of it."

It wasn't my intention to have some bite behind my words but I can't help the way it came out. Got to let out some anger. After all, some of the Rebellion's original members are here.

"Actually yes. Even George and I are fascinated by what we discovered. George I think you'd be best to discuss this stuff considering you follow royal historical backgrounds."

George repositions some of the pictures and turns to a set page in one of the very old looking books. Clearing his throat, he speaks…

"Like many Etherian kingdoms, most places are ruled or overlooked by a royal family or leaders of some sort. Magicats were no different. They had a long line of leaders dating back to the time of the First Ones. If our calculations are correct, Magicats might have once been the oldest royal family in Etherians history. It's long believed that some members of the royal family had the ability to transform into a powerful creature when they were threatened or attacked. If this is true, the claw marks you found at those ruins might have once belonged to that creature in question. Most interesting fact about the Magicat royals is that the last known royals have more or less been erased from history. There are still mentions of them but why they have been subjected to a removal from history is unknown. It's something some of us may never know."

Or something only one of us may know.

There's a sudden shift in Micah's body language. He whispers words of absence to Glimmer, saying that he has something *'important'* to deal with. Making his goodbyes and thanks quick, Micah makes a hasty exit. Melog gets the same feeling that I do of unease and suspicion. We both agree that it's best if we follow him.

I slightly nudge Adora's arm to get her attention. She leans in close to me, making it possible to whisper… "Find out whatever can about Halfmoon and Magicats. Melog and I are going to follow Micah. I have a feeling he knows more about this place than he's letting on."

Adora nods in understanding a finds a way to create a diversion.

"Say what's this? What are the chances of it being some part of a weapon, something like She-Ra's sword? I'll get mine out to compare… FOR THE HONOUR OF GREYSKULL!"

Blinded by the sudden flash of light, Adora gets She-Ra's sword to appear out of thin air. The distraction is enough for Melog to cloak us and make our exit unnoticed. As we leave I can hear the others

ask various questions about the remaining artifacts, but not before having a grumble at Adora first. It's not long before we find Micah walking alone down the corridors towards Brightmoon's gardens. Melog and I follow him in complete silence.

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Where on Etheria is he going? It feels like we've been following him forever.

Melog and I have been tracking Micah invisibly since he left the war room. So far he has made no immediate contact with anyone around Brightmoon, a part from stopping to say hello to the passing guards here and there. He's simply made his way through the vast majority of Brightmoon gardens. He's looked back a few times, causing Melog and I to hold our breathes, but he hasn't appeared to see us or noticed our presence yet.

It's starting to feel like we're getting nowhere. This is getting pointless. Maybe we should go back to mine and Adora's room and call it a day.

Mreow.

Melog alerts me to the fact that Micah has stopped in his tracks. He's taken us to a peaceful area of the garden. An area covered in blossoming flowers, beautifully arranged vines, a calm flowing fountain and a proud standing statue. He's taken us to Angella's memorial garden.

I remember helping Sparkles create this place not long after the war ended. A place where people can remember a person who gave their life to fix my mistake. I remember the day it was completed. Many were crying, especially Sparkles, but I also has a few tears in my eyes. This guilt of the grief I have caused still sits with me. It pains me to know that I took someone important,

someone so loved away from one of my closets friends. However, after many talks here with Sparkles, I have been able to process my guilt and learn to live in peace with it. Sparkles told me that initially she was mad at me for what had happened, angered that I had taken her mother away from her. It was only after she nearly lost everything, lost her friends and her family, that she realised that it was Angella's choice that meant they were a part. Angella gave her life so that her daughter and her friends had a chance to live.

Talking about Angella and who she was as a person has allowed me to see that that no matter how bad I feel about what's happened, Sparkles's mom made a choice to protect her, to protect everyone, to give everyone a fighting chance. Angella wouldn't want me to dwell on the past. Angella would want me to live my life to the fullest and enjoy it, to live the life her sacrifice has given me the opportunity to enjoy. I wish I could have known Angella. She seems like a proper role model. A mother to those who needed someone to look up to. I promise myself everyday that if I ever find a way to correct my mistake I will make things right again.

Micah stands in front of Angella's memorial whilst Melog and I stay well hidden behind one of the walls posts, still invisible thanks to their cloaking device. Micah looks deep in thought, like something is tormenting his mind.

"I wish you were here Angie. You'd know exactly what to say and how to approach this situation."

What on Etheria is he talking about?

"I'm not sure what to do anymore or what to say. We should have been there to help them. We should have been able to stop the Horde when it happened, to stop them from getting as far as they did. I wish we had known what would happen so we could have stopped it. We failed them… *I failed them…* and now I fear that I may not have the answers I need to give, the answers that one is looking for. How do I approach something like this?"

Okay now I'm very confused but also interested at the same time.

I look to Melog asking if they know what Micah is talking about but they look back at me with a blank expression.

"Angie I miss you so much and I wish you were here beside me now. I need your guidance. I long for the feeling of your hand in mine, making it easier for me to speak the truth. I know that's not possible but if you can hear me, please give me the strength I need to open up to her, to tell her all I know, to guide her on her journey… to tell Catra the truth and all I know about our friends the Magicats."

Magicats? He knew the Magicats!

Shocks strikes Melog and I hard, making it difficult for Melog to sustain the cloaking device. Running sounds like a good option but curiosity to find out more information drives me to stay. Micah turns his head a smiles…

"You can drop the cloaking technique now if you want. There's no one but you and I here."

Shit. When did he notice us?

Melog allows the invisibility trance to fade, making both of us visible once more.

"How did you know we were here?"

"I had a feeling that you'd follow me after I left the briefing room abruptly. It was only when I saw one of the guards trip over nothing but air that I suspected Melog had cloaked you. Not to mention I did hear a tiny yelp from one of you shortly after that so I guess they accidentally stepped on someone's tail?"

Melog hunches over embarrassed. I was ready to give the guard a piece of my mind for not watching where they were going but Melog quickly reminded me that we were invisible and it was their fault for not giving a large enough bypass. I checked Melog over

after the incident and they seemed okay. They only suffered embarrassment from the situation.

“I know you have questions Catra. You’re a smart, curious individual. Feel free to ask me anything you wish. I’ll do my best to answer.”

Micah sits on the bench across from the memorial statue, watching to fountain flow at a steady pace. He moves over, inviting me to join him. At first I’m not sure whether to sit besides him or not, but with a gentle bit of encouragement from Melog I move to sit next to Micah. There's a few minutes of silence between us. It’s mainly the result of me gathering my thoughts, thinking what I want to ask and then questioning do I really want to know the answer. Micah doesn’t pressure me to speak. He waits patiently with a smile on his face. Petting Melog’s head which they rest on my lap, I decide that there is no harm in wanting to know more.

“If you knew Halfmoon existed why didn’t you say anything until now?”

Micah’s eyes avoid my gaze, telling me that he is carefully thinking about how to answer my question. I don’t think he’s ever had to deal with something like this before. He looks to Angella’s statue, smiles, and turns back to me…

“The kingdom of Halfmoon was a very secretive community. They liked to remain hidden and only made themselves known when needed. From what I was told, they lost their trust in other kingdoms because of the damage left by the First-One’s. They wanted to keep themselves as secret as possible and only deal with the other kingdoms when needed."

“Well that makes sense. Magicats can be very secretive and do sometimes prefer to keep themselves to themselves. Believe me I know, I am one.”

That earns a smile and light hearted chuckle from Micah. I don't think I've ever heard him laugh. He continues...

"However, after many years something changed and the new heir decided it was time for change too, to come out of hiding and to lead a new life. They joined the Rebellion and made great alliances with its members. Brightmoon was close with Halfmoon. We were known for being the most powerful. When I learned about how Halfmoon used to live I finally understood why they chose to remain hidden for so long. So even after Halfmoon's demise, I wanted to honour their secrecy by only revealing it's true name should it be necessary. Not to mention I also wasn't certain if the ruins were part of Halfmoon. The Whispering Woods has a tendency of shifting the villages in that area a lot."

I suppose that is a fair reason to not have said anything about Halfmoon until now.

"What do you know about Halfmoon? Did you know any Magicats?"

"What I know with regards to Halfmoon is pretty much the same as what you have already learnt and discovered. Halfmoon was the longest reining kingdom on Etheria. They fought the First-Ones after they discovered why they were mining the planets magic. Most importantly, the kingdom was a safe place for Magicats. As for your question of did I know any Magicats… yes I did. Angie and I were very good friends with the most recent queens, especially in our younger years. It was the most recent queen that suggested that Halfmoon forge an alliance with the Rebellion, especially when considering the advancements the Horde were making. It was her first official royal decree. Both leaders were courageous in battle, they never gave up on their friends… it's a shame that some of their friends gave up on them."

Micah's tone saddens and Melog's mane goes a deeper shame of blue. I know they connect with my emotions but they can also change their appearance based on the feelings within the

atmosphere. They're the own being and they can show their own emotions as well as mine.

“If Halfmoon was part of the Rebellion, why didn’t any of the rebels help fight against the Horde? You said the leaders were courageous in battle, maybe even the strongest members of the Rebellion. If that is true, then why did Halfmoon fall?”

Micah takes a deep sigh and looks to Angela's memorial for guidance once more. However, instead of looking back to me this time, his eyes remain fixated on her…

“Many of the Rebellion members had turned against each other by the point of Halfmoon’s demise. Many had already broke their deal within the alliance, claiming that they were better off protecting their own. Angela and I offered our support in any way we could but both queens stated that as much as they appreciated our help they didn’t want to get us involved in further danger, especially not with Angie being heavily pregnant with Glimmer at the time. However, we eventually came to an agreement that if anything drastic was to happen, we would be providing them with support regardless of what they said. We’d send troops, weaponry and aid. We were going to get through this together."

That must not have been an easy decision for either side to make. It now makes more sense as to why Micah is conflicted with the situation. Brightmoon wanted to help their friends but their friends didn't want to risk the future heir of Brightmoon growing up without a father, even though that unfortunately happened for some time.

Micah takes a deep sigh and continues...

"Sadly, the Horde attacked unexpectedly one autumns night. No one, not even Halfmoon, saw it come. By the time news had travel to the kingdoms and alerted us of the ongoing situation, it was too late. Villages had been destroyed. Lives had been lost. The kingdom of Halfmoon had fallen at the hands of evil. We lost a great friend that day, a true leader.”

Okay so that explains what happened to the Kingdom of Halfmoon, but what about the Magicats? Surely some survived?

Melog nudges my leg, sensing my unease. I have to ask, even if I fear the answer…

"What happened to the Magicats? Do you know if there are any still alive? Are they still out there?"

Micah turns to face me once more. Despite the worry I see within his eyes, he does his best to provide a reassuring smile…

"Unfortunately Catra that is the one question that I don't have the answer to. After Halfmoon collapsed I never saw another Magicat again. I knew from extensive battle plans that I saw after my capture that the Horde was determined to destroy all Magicats as they saw them as a strong threat. Sadly, after the attack, I had to assume the worst. I thought the Horde had succeeded in their mission and Magicats had become extinct. A long part of Etherian history and culture lost to the Horde's devastation and destruction..."

Micah softly places a gentle hand on my shoulder...

"That was until I met you. Catra you are special in more ways than you may ever know. I'm sorry I don't have all the answers to your questions but I hope what I have told you provides you with some form of comfort. I have told you all I know. Now it's your turn to follow the path this journey is taking you on."

No… no that can't be all he knows. He's got to know more. I still have so many questions left unanswered.

Melog's mews brings me out of my trance. It's clear that this is all I'm going to learn today. Smiling at Micah, I give him my words of thanks. Micah makes his leave shortly after. All that remains is Angela's memorial, Melog's calming purr and myself, struggling to piece together what I have learnt.

--

'Follow the path this journey is taking you on.' We just finished a three year mission, a mission to end a war! Why do I have to be sent on another one? Surely I can't be the only Magicat left on Etheria… I can't be?

Melog and I decided that it was best if we headed back to mine and Adora's room shortly after Micah left. Despite Micah answering some of my question, I still feel greatly frustrated by the whole situation. I've been pacing up and down our window balcony for at least half an hour now, trying to piece parts of a missing puzzle together.

"I can't be the only Magicat left. I mean, the Horde clearly had it in for my species but I have to hold onto hope that some of us got away. Look at me, I'm living evidence that that is a possibility. I somehow got away and survived. I managed to survive within the Horde."

Melog's head follows my movements from their position on the bed as I pace back and forth talking to myself out load. I'm surprised they haven't gotten dizzy from following me or gotten bored of listening to me yet.

Sensing that the pacing isn't helping to eases my racing thoughts, I decide I'm better off trying to relax by joining Melog on the bed. Dramatically, I flop down onto the bed on my back. I swear for a moment or two it looked like Melog went flying as they didn't expect me to land with such force. My suspicious are confirmed to be correct by the disapproving look they give me. I probably would have laughed if I wasn't so stressed right now.

"Melog, why do things have to be so complicated about me when it comes to working stuff out?"

"It's because you are complicated."

Surprised by the cheekiness in that remark, I sit up and give Melog a fake-shocked look… *"Melog?"*

"What? It's true. I'm only going off the evidence. Look at how long it took you to work out that you were in love with Adora. I knew before you did."

"Well technically you can sense my emotions. The Horde didn't exactly teach us about love or what being in love was. Besides I knew I liked Adora, but didn't know I liked her more than a friend. It just took me a while to act on it."

"Even Perfuma noticed before you did…"

"Alright I get it. When it comes to love I'm not the smartest at recognizing my feelings but Adora was no different. If anything she was just as oblivious as me."

I giggle slightly and begin to stroke through Melog's mane. I can see a little smirk appearing on their face. It's like I'm having a proud parent moment, I never would have guessed Melog could be so mischievous or cheeky with their remarks. *They've learnt from the best.*

After few minutes pass there's a knock at the door, followed by a soft voice calling from the other side…

"Catra? Melog? Are you in there?"

Adora's voice is as clear as day.

"Yeah we're in here. The doors open."

Adora comes through with a beaming smile on her face. Seeing that Melog and I are not going to move from our comfy positions on the bed, Adora decides to belly flop face down and joins us. The force sends both of us flying, even causing Melog to yelp in the process. They look to me unimpressed, which only results in me giggling.

After Adora realises that her current position isn't as comfortable as she initially thought, Adora turns over and props herself up on one arm so she can get a better view of me. She starts to make lazy patterns across my arms, following the direction of my forearm stripes. She used to do this all the time when we were kids. It's relaxing for both of us. I could let her do this for hours.

"Did you find out anything of interest from George and Lance."

"A little bit but you didn't miss anything important. I mean they speak about some of the materials and weaponry they found but not much about Magicats themselves. If you want to have a proper look later I did take some notes."

"Of course you did. Classic Adora. Always been a note taker."

"I only took notes because *you* never showed up to class. Beside, I know you secretly read them an hour before a test. They must have been detailed enough for you not to fail so who's laughing now."

Adora and I start to laugh. She's always been like that, ever since her early days in the Horde. She used to have me testing her on her notes for hours. I'm certain she memorized what she wrote. Either that or she has an eidetic memory. Her notes did come in handy though for when I needed to quickly learn something before a test.

"What about you? Did you find out anything from Micah?"

My breath hitches slightly and my eyes remain fixated on their location on the wall. I don't know why I was shocked a little by the question. I knew Adora would ask that at some point. Melog slightly moves so that I have to place my hand on their head, which automatically starts moving to stroke them. They do this when they sense that I'm worried. It helps to keep my thoughts at bay. With my free hand, I reach for Adora's and lace our fingers together.

"Yeah, we did."

The next hour is filled by me telling Adora everything I learnt from Micah. Adora has some questions of her own, some which I am able to answer, others I'm not. By the end of it Adora appears to be just as confused and frustrated as me.

"Well at least you found something out."

"Yeah. I guess my instinct was right. Micah was holding back more information than what he was letting on, but now I know it was within reason. However, despite now having some answers I still feel like a something's missing."

"What do you mean?" Adora asks curiously as she moves her hand to brush through my hair.

I turn my head slightly so I can get a better view of Adora before I speak again…

"Micah said something about *'following the path that this journey is taking me on.'* I can't quite describe it but I feel that there is more to this story, more to my story, more pieces of the puzzle that have yet to be discovered. I know that might sound crazy but I still have so many unanswered questions. Questions about Magicats, questions about my past… *questions about me.*"

Adora lovingly rests her forehead against mine. My tail moves to wrap around her leg as if it's second nature. The purr that emits from my chest is soothing and creates a sense of calm in our room.

"First of all, that doesn't sound crazy at all. I want you to forget whatever makes you think that. Secondly, it's natural to want answers to questions that have no answers. I know it's quite frustrating when it seems like you my never find what you're looking for but I meant what I said the other night. I will help you in anyway I can. I'm just sorry that there's not much I can be doing that will help right now."

"Oh Adora, you are helping me in more ways than you know. Being here with me right now, listening to me, holding me close,

that’s helping me in more ways than one. Sometimes I worry that you don’t give yourself enough credit. You are amazing Adora and I love you for simply being you.”

Moving in I gently kiss Adora. It’s small, soft and sweet. There's no rushing and neediness to it. It’s simply a passionate kiss. A kiss that says I love you. We spend the rest of the night talking nonsense and cuddling each other close. All seems perfect, but the next few nights that follow are filled with the visions that once again haunt my dreams. Annoyed and frustrated by the recurring and never ending series of eventful dreams, I decide that it’s time to take matters into my own hands.

When I wake up on the third night in a row, I decide that enough is enough. Quietly, I creep out of bed, get dressed and put my red and black jacket on that Adora made me not long after we started dating. She made it for me so I’d stop stealing hers. She loves me wearing her jacket really. I make sure to attach Adora's wing pin that she gave to me as an engagement gift above where my heart is located. Once dressed, I write a short note for Adora, place it on her bedside table and gently wake Melog...

“Melog? *Psst,* Melog?”

Murp?

“I’m going out for a bit. Look after Adora for me will you?”

Melog immediately protests and stretches as they wake up…
“Hang on. I’m coming with you and before you protest, Adora would kill me if I let you go out this late on your own. She can take care of herself.”

Stars I hate it when they’re right.

Before, leaving, I place a gentle kiss to the top of Adora’s forehead and promise her that I’ll be back soon. Melog and I quietly exit of our room, head out of Brightmoon castle and enter the Whispering Woods.

"So, where are we going?"

"To get some answers. We're going back to the beginning."

Chapter End Notes

There you have it. Chapter five of Finding Halfmoon is now completed. Have some of your questions been answered after Catra spoke to Micah? Let me know in the comments. I love reading your thoughts on where you think the story is heading. 😊

Also, did anyone pick up on some key mentions/facts/occurrences in these first few chapters?

We're are heading towards a major turning point in the story. Things are about to get interesting 👀. Find out what I'm on about on Monday when Chapter six is released. Bonus points if you can guess the chapter title. Hope to see you there. 😊

P.S - For anyone who is interested, Catra's jacket is like the one in the fic I wrote for Adora's birthday this year (you can read it here: https://archiveofourown.org/works/36530122). Only difference is it's a dark red and black rather than blue and gold.

P.S 2 - I also hope you enjoyed reading the recent extra content chapters for Finding Halfmoon. There are plenty more to come so stay tuned.

Back to the Beginning

Chapter Summary

The adventure back to the beginning begins as Catra goes in search of answers.

Catra and Melog encounter a friendly face on their late night journey.

All the while, Catra can't help but feel like her every move is being watched.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Any idea which way to try and go next?"

Mreow

"Urgh… I hate the Whispering Woods when it does this."

Melog and I have been searching for the ruins of Halfmoon for almost two hours now. Melog is convinced we're lost and I'm starting to worry that they might be right. We've followed our instincts for as long as we can, letting the woods guide us, following the stars that map out our position. I was hopeful at one point. I thought we were getting close when the trees started to cover the night sky, almost like they were closing in on us. However, our luck ran short when the passage reopened and we discovered that we had been going in circles. Not really sure how that's possible when we walked in a straight line, or what felt like a straight line, but as we all know the Whispering Woods likes to shift and change.

Stupid Woods. Why can't it help me for once?

Accepting defeat I turn to face Melog. They do their best to give me an encouraging smile but I can sense that they're secretly as disappointed as I am. I think we were both hoping to have found something by now. Maybe I'm not meant to find anything tonight. Maybe I'm not meant to find anything at all. We're probably best going home and calling it for the night. I know the way back thanks to the stars. Adora showed me last year how to read them should I ever find myself lost and unsure how to get back to her. It comes in handy for midnight strolls like this.

"What do you say Melog? Should we accept defeat and head home?"

"I'd give it another hour or two. We've got a few more hours before daylight. Also, I'm not sure if you can feel it, but I can sense something. Nothing bad but I feel like we're heading in the right direction. It's like magic is pulling me forwards."

Melog has a special connection with Etheria's magic. They can sense things long before they happen, almost as if they're looking into the future. It's worrying sometimes because despite their amazing capabilities they're never able to project images of the future or predict it course of events. They're only able to feel magic and project memories of the past, which is cool in its own way. Sometimes it frightens me slightly, but I'll never admit that to them. However, I trust Melog and I know for a fact that they would never put me in danger. They'd protect me at all costs and I'd protect them. If they sense that we're heading the right way then I suggest we keep going.

Melog starts sniffing the air, their tail swishing around in curiosity. They're either trying to track something or trying to figure out which way to go next. Apparently they can see magic particles, something us Etherians can't do. Honestly, I really think they're *'pulling my tail'* with that one. I saw the way they snickered when they first told me that.

Murp

Melog's head tilts in curiosity and they walk at a steady pace into the bushes ahead of us. It's like they've completely forgotten that I'm standing right beside them.

"I guess we're going that way then." I sarcastically say to myself, following Melog into the bush.

After a few minutes of walking, I too pick up on the scent Melog's been following. It's recognizable, familiar. What I want to know is why this person would be out so late at night? If I'm not mistaken, I certain that we are nowhere near that part of the Whispering Woods.

Splitting the tall grass apart, it becomes clear who this specific pie smelling scent belongs to. Melog *mreows* and the figure turns, smiling at us…

"Catra dearie. How nice to see you again. You brought Melog too."

Melog happily trots over to Madam Razz, pressing up against the side of her hip. She's so small that Melog stands at half her size. Razz gives Melog pets to the top of their head before continuing her journey through the woods. Melog and I catch up to her, deciding to join her on her walk.

It's dangerous to be in this part of the woods, especially so late at night, and alone. Why is she out this late anyway?

"Hey, Razz… what are you doing out here so late at night?"

"Collecting berries for the pie."

"You're collecting berries?.. For a pie?.. This late at night?"

"Yes that's what I just said. Were you not listening?"

"Couldn't have it waited till morning?"

"Probably, but life is full of adventure so why not start looking now?"

“And you’re alone?”

“Don’t be silly Catra. I’m with you and Melog. Now help Madam Razz find some berries for the pie.”

Melog and I stop for a moment, looking at each other very confused and bewildered.

Is she seriously looking for berries this late at night? I know Adora said she has a tendency to wander but at this time of night… seriously?

We only realise a short time later that Razz has gone even further into the woods, humming a tune as she goes. Melog and I have to start running to keep up with her.

“Razz wait up!”

“Come on Catra. We haven’t got all night.” Razz’s voice echoes through the woods.

--

Madam Razz is faster than I remember. Melog and I are starting to lose sight of her. The only thing that lets us know that we’re on the right track is the fact we can still hear her. The deeper we go the darker the woods become. Fallen trees start to appear once more and the ground beneath us turns to dust.

How on Etheria did Razz get over this stuff? Even I’m struggling to climb over it.

“Razz! Razz where are you?”

“Over here dearie.”

Razz's voice calls through some thick overgrowth of fallen trees. Melog and I follow the sound. When the overgrowth clears we find Razz. She doesn't appear to be hurt but she doesn't appear to be relaxed either. I try to get Razz's attention but when Melog mews besides me and I look up it makes sense why Razz is frozen in place. I know where she has lead us…

"We found it. We found the ruins. But how?"

I look to Razz, hoping for answers but she does not speak. Instead, Razz starts to move through the ruins, focusing on the path ahead. Overwhelmed with a mix of emotion, I become too scared to follow her, afraid that something bad might happen again like before. I've been through much worse so this should be easy.

If an old lady can walk through this place without fear then so can I.

Melog gently pushes me on the back of my leg, telling me that it's okay to follow and that they'll be right behind me. Knowing that I can trust them, I take a steadying breath and follow Razz.

Everything is the same as before. Horde flags rotting off their posts, deep claw marks etched into the stone walls, ash and rubble paving the way. Nothing has change… *or at least so I thought.*

"Eek."

My foot stumbles slightly, almost causing me to fall. Thankfully, I'm able to keep my balance and instead my foot lowers slightly into the ground. You'd imagine that the path would be solid due to ash turning to stone from being mixed with the rain and mud, but that's apparently not the case. Nervously, I look down to find that my footprint has stepped into one belonging to another. At first I thought it might be one made by Adora or Arrow Boy when we were last here judging by the size *(they have slightly bigger feet than me but not by much)*, but when I remove my foot and

inspect it more closely it becomes all too clear that it does not belong to either. This footprint, this shape, looks very similar to my own, but it's not one made by myself.

"Hey Melog? Do you know if this was here before?"

Cautiously, Melog comes over to inspect it, but they cannot recall if it was here before or not. It looks and appears to be fresh.

Something doesn't feel right.

A cold shiver makes its way down my spine, causing my fur to stand on end. Maybe it's the wind. Maybe it's the frost surrounding this place. Maybe it's something else altogether. Trying to shake the fear aside, Melog and I re-join Madam Razz. Her hand slowly brushes across the stone edge that has claw marks deeply engraved into it. She gasps slight, feeling every break into the rock.

"Razz, are you okay?" I ask, slightly concerned. Razz however does not answer and she continues on her path.

Melog and I continue to follow her, letting Razz guide us. Sometimes, letting her lead the way may lead us to the answers of some unanswered or unspoken questions. It's best to let her come to terms with this place before asking questions.

Rustle

My ears twitch at the sound and my tail halts its movement. Turning quickly, I get a glimpse of something running across the passageway that leads to another part of the Whispering Woods. Maybe it was a rabbit, it might have been a boar, but it looked too big to be either. Unsure of what it was, I decide it's best to avoid that area and to continue to follow Razz and Melog to a wall covered in Ivy. It appears to be a dead end.

"Maybe we should be heading home. I don't think we will find any berries here. What do you say?"

Madam Razz still doesn't responds. I'm becoming increasingly worried. I bend down to Melog, quietly whispering to them… *"I don't have a good feeling about this place."*

Melog agrees with me. We're better off getting out of here sooner rather than later. Reaching out, I go to tap Razz's shoulder, but as I do she pulls the overgrown ivy to the side, revealing a secret entrance. My movements stop instantly.

How did Sparkles not detect this before?

My tail bristles and my ears immediately move to lie flat against my head. My pupils become nothing more than a pin prick, trying to focus on whatever lies ahead. My claws slightly unsheathe, ready to defend us if needed. Nothing comes and Razz start to enter the passage…

"What is she doing? Razz get back here!"

My voice is nothing more than a harsh whisper. The last thing we need right now is to alter our presence to anything that might be watching.

"Come on Catra. There's something Madam Razz needs to show you."

Wait has Razz been here before?

I look to Melog, wondering what to do next. They look as worried as me but we both know we have to keep moving if we're to find any answers. Even if we don't find anything we can't leave Razz behind.

Stars I wish Adora was here. She'd know what to do.

I remain on high alter throughout the walk through the dark passage.

--

It’s a long dark tunnel. Melog’s mane and my heterochromic eyes are the only things that light the way. As a kid, Adora used to be scared of the dark, worrying that some mysterious shadows would harm me or her in the night. At the time we didn’t know what the shadows were. Unfortunately for me, I found out the truth about them a few years later.

Anyway, the Horde didn’t believe in nightlights, saying that they were for the weak. I’m sure if Adora asked for one Shadow Weaver would have provided one, but she’d never ask. Adora loved that my eyes glowed in the dark, saying that they helped her to relax and feel at ease. I never used to like the fact that my eyes glowed in dark conditions, but I did love making Adora feel safe and happy so at least I did find something to like about my eyes.

Heterochromia is rare, along with all my other *‘cat-like’* features. I hated them for a long time, feeling inferior and worthless for being different. It was never easy to like the way I looked, especially when I was bullied for it. Adora used to say that my features make me unique and wonderful, some might say beautiful. I never believed her back then but now I do. Adora loving me for who I am has made it clearer to see. Overtime I’ve learned to embrace my Magicat features and like me for me. I am unique, powerful and in my own way wonderful, no one can take that way from me.

A bit of moonlight eventually shines through a crack in the wall, illumining the area surrounding us. There’s two thrones at one end of the hall, large hanging drapes attached to the walls, a large diplomatic table in one corner that leans due to a broken leg and some form of large memorial near where the moonlight shines. It’s looks like Horror Hall, *recently renamed Honour Hall by Scorpia,* back at the Fright Zone. Despite how good my eyesight usually is, the dust and darkness makes it increasingly difficult to

get a clear picture of the memorial, or where we are exactly. However, if I'm going off Brightmoon's layout, I think this might be a throne room.

Melog mewls at my side and I find Madam Razz looking at the thrones. She places some sort of purple scarf on one of them, maybe even a part of a robe of some sort. Melog and I move towards Razz, wanting to make sure that she is okay. The moonlight shows that Razz has tears brimming in her eyes. She speaks softly…

"They were brave warriors. I had never met someone more fierce or determined as they were. Loyal to their people and their family. They were my friends."

Razz slowly walks away and stands in front of the memorial. Melog and I follow her, trying to work out who, if not what, is pictured on the wall. If I can't see it clearly I'm not sure how Razz can? Maybe she's remembering what she saw, rather than seeing it now.

"A part of Etheria died that day, along with so many innocent lives. I wish I could have warned them of what was to come, of what evil would tear their family apart. But Halfmoon is still standing and one is still searching."

One is still searching? Is Razz talking about me?

Curiously I look over to the thrones, wondering who once sat there and why they had to abandon this place. Surely their demise was not without a great battle, not with Razz saying that they were fierce warriors…

"Hey Razz? Who were your… Razz?

Razz is out of sight, nowhere to be seen. Panicking frantically, I starts scanning the room for any sign of her.

Where has she gone? What if something has happened to her?

“Razz?.. RAZZ!”

No answer. Only my voice echos back towards the entrance.

“Melog did you see which way she went?”

Before Melog can answers I hear Razz’s cheery hum. She’s singing something about berries this time. I can’t lose her yet, not when I have more questions I need to ask. If Razz has been here before, even if it was a long time ago, she may have the answers I’m looking for. Melog and I start to sprint in her direction, hoping to keep up with her.

--

“I see a light.”

“Are you sure we should head towards it?”

“It’s not that kind of light Melog. It’s the exit. The way we came in.”

Sprinting as fast as we can, Melog and I burst out of the tunnels exit. Melog goes in search one way and I go the other. I call for Razz with all my might…

“Razz! RAZZ WHERE ARE YOU?.. RAZZ!”

Mreow!

Melog voice roars from around the corner. Fearing the worst I run to their side, worrying that something bad has happened. Thankfully there is no danger but they haven’t found Razz. Melog points to a bush, a berry bush to be exact, before altering me to a set of Razz’s footsteps. They lead back into the Whispering Woods.

"Well at least she's found her berries. Do you think she'll be okay on her own?"

Melog is quick to reassure me… *"Madam Razz will be okay. She can communicate with the Whispering Woods in ways that we can't understand. It's probably how she was able to guide us here. The woods will keep her safe and guide her home. I'm sure of it."*

I know Melog is probably right but I still worry about her. I still have some questions I need to ask about this place and now I feel like I have been left with even more that what I started with.

"Come on Melog. I guess we best go look for some answers whilst we're here."

Melog and I spend the next hour or so looking around some of the ruins for more answers. We agree that it's probably best that we don't go back down the passage until we return with the others. There's no telling what else is in there and it's too dark to see properly. For now, we'll stick to searching through the ruins under Etheria's moonlight… *and the watchful eyes of an unknown presence.*

--

After a few more hours of searching, Melog and I unfortunately come across nothing new that could provide us with answers to what I'm yearning to know. It's getting increasingly frustrating. One little bit of information about my past is all I need, all I ask for. Why is it so hard to want to know about my life before the Horde?

During our time here, I have memorised the inscriptions on the stone cliffs, discovered that the flash of light that caused the visions was thanks to a green rune-stone type thing stuck within

the wall, and yet again I was drawn to the three hands below the word that says Halfmoon.

To make matters worse, I'm not sure which way to go to get out of here. I feel like I should head down the passage way that leads to another part of the Whispering Woods but I don't know where it will lead us to. The hazy night sky mist is covering the stars, making it impossible to read them. We're pretty much stuck here until the dawn. The only good thing from tonight is that I haven't had any visions.

Melog can feel the rise in frustration and they're trying to calm me down, but nothing they do seems to be working. It's not their fault. It's a me problem. I've tried my breathing exercises, *even that stupid meditating technique Perfuma suggested*, but at this point I feel like I need to scream and shout, maybe even punch something… *BUT THERE'S NOTHING TO PUNCH!*

"AHHHHHH!"

My scream of frustration shakes the trees, causing some birds to fly from their cozy nests. I fall to the ground, holding my knees close to my chest as I rest my back against a boulder. Frustration results in tears falling from my eyes. The last time I felt like this was not long after the Horde conquered Salineas under my control and Scorpia left to fight with the Rebellion. Melog tries their best to comfort me, telling me to let all my frustration out but also reminding me to steady my breathing. Sometimes you need to have a good scream and shout, maybe even a little cry, to feel better.

My ear twitches slightly when I hear something land on a stone rock not too far in front of us. I look up and find that it's an Etherian Moon Owl, the exact same on that's been following me for weeks.

Why does it keep following me? What does it want from me?

Despite the dull ache in my legs, I stand and confront the owl. They looks to me with a neutral expression. Awkwardly, I start to talk to them like they can understand me…

"What do you want? Haven't you got anything better to do besides following me around?"

Unsurprisingly, the owl doesn't respond. They simply tilt their head, scanning me in full form.

"What? Have you never seen a Magicat before? Well take a good luck as I'm probably the only one left!"

The owl tilts their head the other way before righting their head back up. Their eyes stare into mine as if they're trying to communicate with me. Now is not the best time for this. I'm going to be taking my frustrations out on an owl… *an owl that started it all by bringing me here in the first place!*

"Why did you bring me here?! This place has left me with nothing but nightmares and a series of unanswered questions. If you're supposed to guide me, then where are the answers I need?!"

Mreow?

Melog starts to make a series of strange noises besides me but I pay little attention to them because I'm in full rant mode and there is no stopping me. They're probably trying to calm me down or something.

"I have tried everything to make these nightmares stop, to make the visions stop, but nothing I do is ever good enough is it. It'll never be good enough! You might as well say I'm not good enough!"

Mreow!

"Is it so hard to want some answers to my past? To know the truth about my family? To know what happened to them and

whether they truly loved me or if I was abandoned at the Horde's doorstep? Why is it so difficult to want answers to who I am!"

GRRRRRR!

Shit. I recognise that growl. This can't be good.

"Melog what's wrong?"

Melog's mane glows a fiery red and their hackles raise. I follow their line of vision and notice two blue eyes watching us. They're not Adora's eye. I can recognise Adora's eyes anywhere. Besides, these ones follow a familiar pattern. They kind of resemble my own.

Noticing that they have been spotted the creature makes a dash for it.

"Hey! Stop!"

Melog and I follow them hot on their trail. They lead us down the passage way that takes us to what I suspect is another area of the Whispering Woods. The owl stays behind, watching the chase from a safe distance.

--

The creature alternates between running on two and four paws. They skillfully climb over rocks and slide under fallen trees. At this distance I can't quite make out what they are, all I can see is that they have two pointy ears and a long tail. One thing that I am certain of is that they are fast, *very* fast.

Melog and I start to struggle to keep up but I'm not giving up yet. I'm going to catch this creature if it's the last thing I do. The creature darts past a stream of smooth flowing water, which leads

into a cave opening. Hopefully they're not leading us into a trap. However, if this does happen to be a trap then I'm prepared for battle. Adora and I have been training for moments like this since our childhood days so I hope they're ready for a fight like never before.

The further into the cave we go, the lighter it gets. This is really unusual as for a cave, without any visible cracks, it should in theory be dark.

How is it so light in here?

I'm closing in on the creature. I've almost got them. Suddenly, I trip on a rock, face planting the floor with a loud thud. The creature manages to get away but that's the least of my worries. More rocks start to fall. I scramble forwards, scrapping my claws against the floor as I desperately try to get up and out of the way.

"Ahhh!"

I scream in pain as one sharp rock manages to hit the side of my knee, causing me to tumble to the ground once again. I use my arms to shield my head as the rest of the rocks fall, hoping that it'll all be over soon.

It's not long after that the rocks stop falling and the dust clears. Coughing deeply, I clear my throat and rub my eyes so that I can see better.

"Fuck."

The walls have blocked the path that I initially came from. There is no way around them. Struggling to stand, I notice a deep cut through my leggings. The rocks that knocked me down has cut my knee and its bleeding quite bad. Thankfully, the stream of water is still running through the rocks so I can wash it clean when I find Melog.

Hang on a second… where's Melog?

Clambering onto the rocks, I use my claws to try and make small opening between the fallen mess...

“Melog? Melog can you hear me?”

A small beam of light shines through from the other side. Melog’s face appears.

“Melog! Are you okay?”

“I’m okay. Are you okay? Are you hurt?”

“I’m okay Melog. I promise.” *I really hope that lie is convincing…* “Although I think I’m trapped over here. I’m not sure how to get out and I don’t think it’s a good idea to move these rocks. We risk another landslide if we do.”

“Okay. Try and find another way out if you can. Maybe try following the flow of water. Flowing water has to lead somewhere. I’m going to go and get help. I’ll be as quick as I can. I promise.”

Sensing Melog’s worry, I try my best to reassure them.

“Don’t worry about me Melog. I’ll be fine. I’ve survived way worse than this. Water is still running through this way so I’ll find a way to keep myself entertained until you get back with Adora. I’ll be okay. Now go.”

Melog looks back to me one more time before starting to run back the way we came, going for help.

You’ll be okay Catra. It’ll be okay. Melog will be back with Adora in no time. Until then, better make yourself comfortable.

Gently lowering myself off the rocks, trying not to hurt my leg further, I try my best to turn back around and get comfortable. In my state of worry I hadn’t noticed the tall slender figure standing behind me. Immediately forgetting the pain in my leg, my instinct drives me into defensive mode.

“Hey easy there. I just wanted to make sure that you’re okay. I heard the rocks fall so I came back and then… you’re hurt?”

The tall figure moves towards me but my deep growl, sharp claws and shining teeth tell her to back off.

“Don’t come any closer! Who are you?”

The figure looks at me in amazement, but also slight concern that I am behaving defensively. I don’t know who this person is so if they think I’m going to be friendly for one minute they’ve got another thing coming.

“You’re a… you’re a Magicat?”

“Yeah no shit! Now answer the question! Who are you?!”

The tall figures moves slightly closer to me, but not close enough to become an increased threat. They stop when their figure becomes clearer in the light.

“I am Luna: Queen of Halfmoon and protector of Magicats. Now answer me this... who are you?”

Chapter End Notes

> Ohhh another cliffhanger, and this time at a major turning point to the plot of the Finding Halfmoon story. I promise the wait will be worth it.
>
> What do you think will happen next? Who is this mysterious Luna? Will she be able to provide Catra with the answers she seeks or will Catra make a run for it at the first possibly opportunity? - Let us know in the comments. I love reading your thoughts.
>
> Chapter seven will be released on Friday. See you soon. 😊

Answers

Chapter Summary

> Catra feels like she's seen Luna before and seeks to learn more about her.
>
> Luna tells Catra more about Halfmoon, hoping to give her some answers to her questions.
>
> All the while, Catra starts having new visions as Luna speaks, leading to them both finding something they believed to be lost long ago.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“Who are you?”

The tall slender figure becomes more clear as she steps forward, entering a break of moonlight seeping between the caves cracks. Shock overcomes me and my defensive side completely vanishes when her full appearance comes into view… *she’s a Magicat.*

How is that possible? I thought I was the only one left?

Luna, *if that’s who she really says she is*, has a silverish grey colour to her fur, which contrasts smoothly with her dark forearm stripes and long, thick hair braid that has started to show a few grey strands, most likely due to her age or stress in her youth. Her most noticeable feature is her blue eyes. They make her appear warm and welcoming, trustworthy in a sense. This person… *this Magicat*… she looks familiar.

Is she the Magicat I’ve been seeing in my visions?

“Why would I tell you! For all I know your trying to distract me, waiting for me to show a moment of weakness and then you’re

going to attack, hurt me, finish me off. Well I'm not falling for that trick!"

My voice is stern and my growl echoes through the cave tunnel. She may be a Magicat but I don't trust her… *or at least I don't feel like I should*. Strangely for once my instincts tells me to trust her, *a complete stranger*, but if I've learnt anything from my youth it's that instinct can sometimes lead you blind. In this situation I'm reminded of my Horde training: never let your guard down. Never let them see how scared you really are.

"Let me reassure you that I am *not* trying to distract you. I can tell you know that I am not in anyway, shape or form going to hurt you. I'm not that kind of person. I'm concerned that you'd even think that."

"Oh yeah? Well why were you spying on Melog and I. You're a Magicat, I'm a Magicat. I know what stalking looks like!"

Luna starts moving slightly closer to me as she speaks…

"I was observing what you and your unusual looking friend were up to in old Halfmoon. Forgive me for being curious as to what they were and what you were up to. I haven't exactly seen any other Magicats, *other than those in my kingdom*, or any other creatures outside of Halfmoon in nearly two decades."

At one point Luna comes a bit too close for comfort and I decide to make a stand…

"Don't come any-ah!"

I try retake my defensive stance but as I do my injured leg gives way, causing me to fall to the ground in pain. Luna slowly crouches down to my level and reaches forwards concerned. It's my low growl that warns her to stay back. She tries a different approach to get me to trust her.

"I know this must be scary for you. Being so close to someone you've probably never met before is nerve wrecking. I didn't mean

to startle you. I was curious that's all. You know what they say about Magicats and curiosity. I ran because I've been hurt once before by unknown dangers and I didn't know what your friend was capable of. I promise I'm not going to hurt you and I can see that you're in pain."

My mind starts planning what to do as my next move. I can fight but my tactics won't be as effective as usually, especially not when I'm injured. However, when I look up I notice that Luna is smiling brightly, smiling brightly at me. She speaks once more...

"Please, let me help you. Trust me."

Am I really going to put my trust into someone I've just met? I know I did when I first met Adora but that was different… wasn't it?

Luna shows no sign of being a threat or of any danger. Her fur is smooth, her tail tip gently bats side to side, showing she is calm and content, her ears are alert but more relaxed than what they'd be if they were alert to danger. Moreover, the features that says that trusting her wouldn't be a terrible idea is her eyes. They're calm, welcoming, caring. For some reason I feel relaxed when she looks at me.

Sensing that trusting Luna might not be such a bad idea, I reluctantly lower my guard and remove my hands from my injured leg. Stretching my leg out the best I can, a small hiss escapes through the grit of my teeth. It hurts more than it should. The cut is probably deeper than it looks.

Slowly, Luna moves closer to my side, gently using one of her claws to peel away the ripped fabric of my leggings, allowing her to better access to my injury.

Now that she's closer I notice some more of her features. Her choice of clothing matches well with her fur colour. She has a cobalt blue rob-type dress that covers her chest and lower waist, leaving her mid-section exposed. The top half also hangs off her

right shoulder, a few deep cuts that have scarred over are visible. Around her neck she's wearing wear a sun shaped necklace that has a blue coloured gem at its centre. She's wearing black leggings that come up to her knees and wrap around her feet, pretty much like my old Horde uniform. I imagine the leggings are padded at the base of her feet to aid with support for walking a running. It's a feature I really wish was considered when my old Horde uniform was created.

Luna has a few visible but noticeably faded scars on her arms and tail, along with a tiny nick on the outer edge of her right ear. I'm going to guess from the extensiveness of her scars that she also has a few hiding under the clothing on her legs. If I didn't know better I would have said that she has had a run in with the Horde many years ago, maybe even more than once. It wouldn't surprise me to be honest.

"It's quite deep."

"I've suffered worse. *That…* that's nothing."

Luna looks up at me slightly upset, trying to understand what I mean. She has that stupid worried parent look that I've seen George and Lance give Bow when they discover that he did something they were unaware of, or when Micah lectures Sparkles about why trying to tame the beast under Brightmoon is a bad idea but lets her try anyway. She doesn't know me so there's no need to look at me that way. I can take care of myself, I always have.

Luna appears to push her concern aside and goes back to assessing my wound. She gently places her hands around my cut, holding my leg steady. A slight hiss of pain escapes me when contact is made.

"This might sting a little but it'll only be temporary. You ready?"

Despite Luna's calming tone and reassuring words, panic starts to set in as my memories reminds me of all the times I put my trust

in people before, only to have my trust betrayed. I'm starting to think this was a bad idea.

Maybe I should wait until Melog comes back with the others and then Adora can heal me. I know what her healing feels like and I'd feel much safer.

Desperately looking for a way out, my claws start to scratch along the rocks as I try to pull myself away from Luna. My attempts fail despite Luna having no grip on my leg. The walls start closing in around me and my breathing picks up in speed.

Stars I wish Adora was here, she'd know what to do. Breathe Catra Breathe. Try and calm down.

Unexpectedly, a soft feeling brushing against the tip of my tail calms me almost instantly. There's also the sound of someone softly purring at a steady, soothing pace… *but it's not me who's purring*.

My eyes open, panic disappearing almost as quick as it appeared. The tip of Luna's tail is gently brushing up and down mine. Her purr is calming, following a set beat that can probably be heard vibrating throughout the caves tunnels.

"It's going to be okay. Trust me."

Luna reassures me with a bright smile on her face.

I'm going to be okay. I can trust her.

Slowly nodding my head, Luna put a bit of pressure on my leg and proceeds whatever it is she is doing. A dull blue light appears under the palms of her hands as she closes her eyes and focuses. Judging by the grit of her teeth she appears to be struggling, but none the less its mesmerizing to watch. My leg stings a little but only for a few second, shortly being followed by a dull ache and then no pain at all. When the light fades Luna removes her hands and smiles.

The wound… it's completely gone. Not even a scar in its place.

"H-how did you do that?"

Luna smiles. As she stands as she answers…

"Magicats can do many impressive things. I am a self-taught healer, but it takes a lot of time, patience and practice to get to that level. That is the first time I've been able to heal someone in many years."

I wonder if that's why she looked like she was struggling when healing me?

There's a hint sadness in Luna's voice. She reaches out her hand to help me up. At first I'm not sure whether to take it, but I do eventually, only because she I notice that she has retracted her claws. Standing upright my leg feels like it had never been injured.

"Now do you trust me?"

Back to the trust situation are we?

"It's going to take a lot more than a magic trick for me to trust you. For all I know, you may still be plotting something."

It's not my fault I have a hard time trusting people. You can thank the Horde for that.

At this point I'd expect Luna to look pissed off with me. Surprisingly, Luna doesn't look annoyed at all, she actually looks calm and relaxed, maybe even a little curious.

"I can sense that you have some serious trust issues, which is fine. I am in theory still a complete stranger and I don't know the root cause of those feelings. However, try looking at it this way. I could say the exact same thing about you. How do I know you're not secretly planning an attack against me?"

Okay she does have a point but I know for a fact, *as a Magicat myself*, is that she would have been able to detect others if there was an attack coming by now. Magicats can sense creatures and people through scent alone at least a mile away thanks to our super senses... *which means I would have sensed an attack on her behalf by now if there was one.*

Damn it!

Luna hums to herself when she realises what she has achieved.

"What I'm trying to say is that I'm a Magicat, you're a Magicat, we're practically the same despite being unique in our own way. Neither of us are showing any sign of being a threat or a danger to the other. The only signs your showing me is that you are scared and have trouble opening up to people, yet you are wanting to trust me."

"I'm not scared! You don't even know me!"

"Maybe not, but maybe I know you better than you think."

Luna looks to me with a smile, knowing full well that she's got me thinking about what she means by that. There's a strange sense of familiarity when I'm near her, but that's still not enough for me to trust her completely. She'll have to earn it.

"I imagine that you have questions, questions you want to ask about this place but fear the answers too. That's why your here isn't it? Maybe I can help. That's if you let me."

"How about you show me the way out of this place first, then I'll consider your offer."

"Very well, but on one condition."

"Oh yeah? What's that?"

"I would very much like to know your name. Otherwise I'll be referring to you as the '*sassy Magicat'* from here on in."

I don’t let Luna see it, but I can’t help but slightly smile at the proposed nickname. It’s quite humorous, not to mention possibly fitting. It’s better than somethings I have been called in the past. At least this one isn’t insulting.

“It’s Catra.”

“Catra? It’s a nice name.”

“Yeah well, someone important gave it to me. Now are you going to show me the way out of here or not?”

Luna turns around and slowly walks down the path, deeper into the cave tunnels. I look back to the blocked path, the way I initially came in before being trapped. A part of me says that I should wait for Melog and the others to find me, but my survival training tells me to find my own way out. I want to trust Luna, she’s showing no signs of being a threat and my instincts tell me to follow her… *but I’m scared, scared of the unknown.*

“You coming?”

Luna’s voice calls from a few paces ahead. Her eyes are starting to glow in the distance as she tuns back to face me. Sensing that my greatest chance of escape is to follow her, I push my fear aside and catch up to her. If I have to fight my way out I’m more than prepared, but for the first time in a long time, I feel like I can trust someone without the complete overwhelming fear of getting to know them first.

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Luna guides me to a secret exit that opens up near another cave not too far from the outer memorial wall, the one that started all the visions to be exact. Luna then guides me back to the ruins.

The moonlight is brighter now, the dawn will soon be approaching. The ruins have become more clear, but a shadowy haze casts over them. There is a tense feeling in the air. It's uncomfortable to say the least. A cold shiver makes its way down my spine. Luna's tail has stilled and her ears have re-positioned to lay almost flat against her head. I recon she too can feel the unease in the atmosphere.

Taking a deep sigh, Luna speaks once again. Her tone of voice sounds more sad than when she spoke to me back in the cave…

"Home, where ever that may be for you, is that way. Be careful out there. Many Etherian creatures lurk around these parts at night. Hopefully the Whispering Woods will protect you."

Luna takes a few paces forward walking deeper into the ruins. My mind contemplates running or staying. Really I should be heading home, it'll soon be sunrise and I don't want Adora worrying about me. I know I left a note but we all know what Adora's like. I forgot my travel tech-pad too so I can't even send her a good morning message to let her know I'm okay like I usually do.

On the other hand, I want to know more about this place, want to know what really happened here, I want to know more about Luna and who she is. I don't know how to describe it but I feel, in some way, connected to her. I know that sounds strange but I get this calm feeling when she's near, a calm feeling that I only usually feel when I'm with Adora. Maybe that's why it was easier for me to let my guard down when near her after she healed my leg. Maybe that's why I calmed down so quickly when she touched my tail, something I only ever let Adora do. I feel like there's more to her story, she just needs someone to listen, someone to talk to, someone to trust.

Don't regret what you're about to do Catra.

My attention turns away from my exit and I go in search of Luna. She hasn't gone far. I find her by the large rockface that has Magicat claws cut deep into it, not far from the pathway where I

first spotted her. Her hands run along them smoothly, her claws feeling each and every grove. Her eyes appear to be glassy and her sigh is deep but she hasn't quite yet noticed that I'm beside her.

Trying me best not to startle her, I clear my throat with an almost silent cough. Her ears prick up exactly the same way mine do when I hear something or someone. She looks to me, her face showing no clear emotion.

"Look, I'm sorry about what happened back in the cave. I'm not usually that sharp, *at least not anymore anyway*. I just… **sigh** … I find it difficult to trust people, especially people I have never met before. Having a rough childhood does that to you. But thank you, for helping me that is, for healing my leg. It'll certainly make my journey home easier."

Luna smiles slightly and rises tall and proud. I have her full attention.

"Okay, this is a bit embarrassing to admit but you're the first Magicat I have met for as long as I can remember."

Luna looks confused, maybe even slightly shocked by that, but she doesn't interrupt and allows me to continue…

"I thought I was the only one left, or at least that's what I was led to believe. When my friends found this place, I started to wonder what happened to my kind, to Magicats. I don't know much about my past or people like me. I want to know what happened here so I can try and piece together parts of my past. Please, I know it's a lot to ask but I want to help. I want to understand."

Luna's once humble smile returns…

"There's a lot to tell about this place, many stories to uncover. It all depends on what you want to know?"

"Okay well maybe you could start by telling me what happened here and then maybe tell me, if you feel like you can trust me, a

bit about yourself. I… I'd like to get to know you."

Well that doesn't sound awkward at all Catra. Well done. You played that real smooth.

Why did I have to say that last part? Sure I want to know more about her because I'm almost certain that Luna is the Magicat I keep hearing and seeing in my visions and dreams but I could have worded that a lot better.

Luna hums and smiles, which instantly puts my nerves at ease.

"Many years ago, Halfmoon lived in peace with Etheria's magic and the other Kingdoms that call this planet home. We Magicats specialized in battle strategies, art, healing but more specifically magic, hence why were called 'Magicats'. Some say that we are, *or were*, the most powerful individuals in Etheria. I'd argue that we simply learned to understand the magic and beauties that Etheria has to offer. We never took it for granted. Unfortunately, we spent many years in hiding after the war started by the First-Ones, who you may or may not have heard of."

Heard of the First Ones? Better not tell her I'm engaged to one.

"Anyway, I spent a lot of my youth sneaking out to explore what Etheria had to offer, to learn about this planet we call home. The war ended many, many years ago and there seemed to be no threat. When my time came to lead the Magicats, I decided that it was time for change. With the help of my best friend, who later became my wife, we brought Halfmoon out of hiding and forged an alliance with the Rebellion. We made many great friends. Learned many new things. All seemed well and we could finally move forward, away from our troubled past."

Luna starts to move towards the passage that leads to what I assume to be an old throne room. I have a feeling that this is going to be a walking, talking story. However, I'm intrigued to see where she is leading me.

We stop when she comes across a Horde flag that still hangs. Luna's look becomes stern and angered, a low growl emitting in her throat as she speaks…

"But then evil arrived. At first I had never heard of them or knew of the unspeakable acts they were committing. Alongside our most treasured friends, we did everything within our power to stop them. My wife and I knew that if we wanted to live a better life, a better life for all Magicats and our future daughter, we'd have to be prepared for anything. "

Luna had a daughter? What happened to her?

In the blink of an eye, Luna pounces upwards, snatching the flag between her claws and shredding it to pieces. She went from being a calm, collected individual to a burning ball of rage in seconds. It was impressive to witness. She makes sure to leave the shredded material in the soil, where it can rot and decay.

Afterwards, Luna takes a deep calming breath and continues on her path into the passage that leads to the throne room. As I go to follow, my mind stops me in my tracks. A simple vision appears before me: fires, Horde flags, Magicats screaming as they run. Two Magicats hold their kitten close as the chaos unfolds. One of them looks like Luna, the other I'm not too sure of.

Come on Catra focus. Now's not the time to start having visions.

When I catch up to Luna she's standing at the front of the throne rooms entrance, before slowly walking over to what I can only assume to be a once holographic war room table…

"The war raged on for many years, despite our best efforts to bring evil to their knees. It didn't help when they conquered the Scorpion Kingdom. The battle that day was a difficult one. Both sides suffered greatly, but our best efforts weren't enough to stop them. My wife and I lost two close friends, their daughter was orphaned and the Magicats officially became the Horde's next target..."

The Scorpion Kindgom? Isn't that the Fright Zone? The orphan… could that be Scorpia?

"If I had kept the creature a bay then what happened next may never had occurred. The Horde might not have seen us as a huge threat. We might have had more time to prepare. To make matters worse, the Horde now had an official base, somewhere secure that they could prepare for battle. They forced orphans to becomes soldiers, brainwashing them to think what they were doing was right and had access to a runestone which some *bitch* took power over! I though her long to be dead. She betrayed us. I lost everything that mattered most to me because of her. If I ever see her again I will kill her myself for what she did!"

Shadow Weaver? Luna knew Shadow Weaver. Well, at least she won't have to worry about that last part.

Luna's breathing becomes a bit jittery. Faint tears can be seen in the corner of her eyes but she quickly wipes them away, retaking her previous posture.

How long has she kept this all to herself? Does she have no one to look out for her? Is she all alone? Her wife, her daughter… is Shadow Weaver responsible for what happened to them?

Luna's eyes trail towards the thrones. I can hear a faint growl with her throat as she gives them a mean glare…

"My parents, they always thought that I was not fit to be a leader. They shoved me aside all because I loved someone they didn't approve of. They wouldn't have helped their friends. They would have watched from the side lines like the cowards they were. I will never forgive them for how they treated my wife or my people, simply because they weren't as privileged as them. The only thing they were right about was that I failed to protect those who meant the most to me."

Luna's anger starts to fade. It's like she's fed up with arguing with herself over this. Her shoulders slump and her ears lie flat against

her head once more. Her arms move to hug herself, something that I used to do often in the Horde when I was in need of comfort. Luna turns and makes her way towards the exit.

It's starting to become clear to me that even talking about her past is just as painful as reliving it. A part of me feels guilty for wanting to know more, but then again she wouldn't tell me unless she trusted me and wanted to speak of it. I reckon she's telling me all this for a reason, whether it be to help her or to help me.

I go to follow her when another vision stops me… this time I have to steady myself against the wall. A young Magicat appears from behind the throne chairs. They look like they're trying to capture the tail of another Magicat, possibly one of their parents. When the kitten succeeds, the older Magicat over dramatically plays dead. The young kitten giggles before being picked up by another Magicat from behind… it's Luna, only she looks younger.

This vision… is this Luna's wife and daughter?

"Catra?"

Luna's voice brings me out of my trance. She has one hand placed gently on my shoulder. Her eyes look at me concerned… "Are you okay?"

I steady my breathing before I answer… "Yeah, yeah I'm fine. I just keep getting these weird visions."

"Visions?"

"I-it doesn't matter. It's not important. What were you saying?"

Luna scans me with her eyes, her body language shows that she is worried for me. However, there is also something else there, a sense of suspicion, maybe even curiosity. Thankfully, Luna doesn't question it and continues to lead me out of the passage way. I look back to the thrones one last time before following her.

When we exit the cave Luna guides me to the stone memorial wall. She stops when she see the three hand prints in the shape of a heart. Luna's hand moves to rest over the slightly larger one of the two bigger prints and she finishes her story…

"The Horde attacked in the middle of the night. None of us saw it coming. No one, not even our allies at Brightmoon, could prepare for the death and destruction that would follow. My wife ordered me to run, to protect our daughter and to stay safe, above all to stay alive, even if it was just for our daughters' sake. She promised we'd find each other when it was all over… but that would never happen. My wife stayed behind to fight, to give my daughter and I a fighting chance. Sadly, she was one of the many innocent lives lost that night."

Luna's tears silently start to fall and she holds her sun necklace in her hand. I wonder if it's something her wife gave her, like when Adora gave me her wing pin badge. Instinctively, my hand reaches for Adora's pin, my thumb brushing over it gently, making sure that it's still there. I want to try and comfort Luna somehow but I'm not sure what to do. I've never been great with emotions. I've only recently learned how to channel my own so understanding how to comfort others, unless its Adora obviously, doesn't come easy.

Think Catra. Come on think… Okay this might seem crazy but if it worked for you then it might work with her.

Taking a deep sigh I move closer to Luna. The tip of my tail gently starts to brush up and down the end of her Luna's tail. My hand rests on her covered shoulder, rubbing small circles over it. Surprisingly, this doesn't feel strange at all. It feels natural, almost as if this is something Magicats do when another Magicat is upset. When you think of it, I guess it's more or less the same as when I brush the tip of my tail across the top of Adora's hand.

Luna seems to calm down almost instantly. Her breathing starts to steady out and her tears start to disappear. When she looks up

she smiles and me her eyes show sympathy and a silent word of thanks…

"Sorry you had to see that. It's been a very long time since I've spoken about what happened that night and about my wife. I miss her and my daughter very much. Many people have moved on from what happened that night but it's not as simple for me. I've learned to accept what happened but the pain I feel over losing them hurts everyday. Thank you for listening and letting me get it all out. I only tell people I trust the whole truth about me past."

I'm unable to hide the tiny smile that creeps across my face. My cheeks start to blush too but hopefully that can't be seen due to the darkness, although the mist haze is now starting to fade and the night sky is starting fall.

"Well it's nice to know you trust me. Thank you for sharing that with me. I know it's not easy to open up about your past, especially when it feels like you're alone. But if it's one thing I've come to learn it's that there is always someone there to talk to, someone who will listen to you, someone you can trust."

Luna smiles as we both walk back towards the passageway where I first spotted her. It's a nice, content walk. I can tell Luna is feeling better having got all that off her chest. Coming here must not have been easy for her.

We come to a halt when the passage opens up. The fading moonlight lighting up the path between the trees. All looks clear ahead, but unfortunately for me another vision appears in my mind: a Magicat, most likely Luna, is running down the passageway, carrying something, or rather someone, close in her grasp. Four Horde soldiers are hot on her tail.

What happened to her daughter?

The vision causes me to stumble slightly. If Luna hadn't been beside me to hold me up, I probably would have hit my head on a

rock or something…

"Easy there. We don't want you getting injured again. Healing isn't easy."

Luna jokes but her voice soon goes quite. Her eyes follow the path ahead. She helps me to stand once more. Sadness visible in her eyes…

"There is one part of the story that I haven't told you. A part of my past that I haven't had the courage to tell anyone."

Almost as if in a complete trance, Luna guides me down the pathway where Melog and I were chasing her some hours ago. We don't go past the cave, so I know for a fact that we have taken a different path at some turn. The walk is silent, partially more eery than before, but something draws me to follow her, something that might give me the answers to the questions I have yet to ask.

Luna stops when she comes to a series of old, tattered crates. They're stacked up against a walls edge, hidden well by overgrown bushes and shaded by a series of trees. Moss and vines have started to grow over them. The remaining moonlight illuminates the area, showing off all the life that has learnt to thrive here. This place, this exact location, looks strangely recognizable.

My ears drive my attention to the sound of Luna's voice hitching slightly. I can sense that she's upset, silently debating whether it was good idea to bring me here or not. But then again, she might have brought me here for a reason.

I feel like I'm here for a reason. I found that place for a reason.

"What happened to your daughter?"

Luna's eyes look slightly glassy. Her attention turns away from me and down a path that I didn't notice until now was in front of us. The path in question shows signs of having lived better days.

Fallen tree trunks have snapped and fallen to the side. Deep tank tire tracks have been buried into the now dried mud. Only partial parts of moonlight seep in through the remaining trees, showing the path that leads into darkness.

"I failed my daughter. I failed to protect her, to keep her safe. I ran for miles, away from the chaos and destruction, keeping my daughter held close to my chest as evil made their mark. I could feel her claws digging into my clothes, scratching against the skin under my fur, trying to hold onto me the best she could. I didn't care in that moment what was happening, not if it meant I could keep her safe."

Unable to no longer look at the path, Luna's head falls to the ground. She desperately tries to keep the majority of her tears at bay. It's at that moment a bit of the fading moonlight shines on her leg. I notice a long scar running from the top of her thigh and under the lower part of her leggings…

"Unfortunately for us I hadn't noticed that we were being followed by some Horde soldiers until it was too late. All it took was a deep cut my leg, caused by one of their traps, to slow me down. I had to fight all four of them, all whilst protecting our daughter. They knew the risks of the job and they met their fate, but it was no longer safe for me to keep our kitten with me. My injury was slowing me down and I knew someone would soon find us."

Luna just about manages to keep her tears at bay when she looks up again. There is no harm in letting them fall. Sometimes a good cry helps us all. However, I recon she is holding them back so she can finish her story. Luna's look turns to the crates as she continues her story…

"I already feared the worst for my wife and I wasn't about to lose our daughter too, especially not after all we had been through to have her. She was our little miracle, our everything. Her only hope was for me to leave her here and find her when it was all over. I placed her into one of these boxes, told her to stay quiet and not to come out until I returned to take her somewhere safer. I didn't

want to leave her but it was her best chance of survival. I knew if they found us we'd be killed. I gave her my mask, my crimson red mask that my wife made for me. A simple something to remember me by should the worst happen. I told her that I loved her and silently promised that we'd somehow find each other again and that I was sorry. I thought she would be safe. I couldn't have been more wrong."

Luna now turns to face me, sadness and guilt present in her eyes. A few tears also escape my eyes as she finishes her tale…

"They took her. The Horde took her! I chased them for miles but to no avail. I don't even know what they did to her. I failed her. I failed to protect her. I still search for her everyday, hoping that she somehow made it out alive, to tell her that I'm sorry, but I feel like my efforts are useless. I'm holding onto nothing more than a thin thread of hope. Because of my failure, I may never see her again."

That it's… that can't be the end. It can't be… I know it's not the end of the story.

Unexpectedly, my heart rate starts to pick up in speed. My breathing becomes ragging and my knees start to feel weak…

"W-what did your daughter look like?"

Should have I asked that? Do I really want to know the answer to that question? Am I just hoping for an answer that might not even turn out to be what I fear or hope it might be?

Luna looks to me confused with heavy tears threatening to fall from her eyes, but then shock washes over her as if she has just realised something. She takes out a photo from her pocket. She look at it and smiles the best she can…

"This is the last photo I have of us all together as a family. It was taken about a day or two before the attack. I keep it with me to remind me that they're still with me, even if we are apart."

Luna hands it over to me, my shaking hands taking it the best I can. I take a deep breath before looking at the photo. What I see shocks me to the very core.

The picture is of Luna, her wife and her daughter. From the picture alone I can confirm that Luna and her wife are in fact the two Magicats I keep seeing in my visions and dreams, but that's not all. The piece of material that Bow's dads showed me recently matches the same colour of the clothing that Luna is wearing in the picture. But that's not the thing that shocks me even more. The mask Luna is wearing… *it's my mask!* The exact same one that I had when I was in the Horde! The kitten held in her arms, her daughter that went missing… *it's me!*

I'm Luna's daughter! Luna is my mother!

A flash of light in my mind startles me, causing me to fall to the ground. Luna quickly comes to my side. I can hear her voice but I can't communicate with her. The visions taking place… *I can't stop them…*

"Luna you need to get out of here. Take our daughter somewhere safe and don't look back."

"I won't leave you Dawn!"

"I'm afraid you don't have a choice. I'm not going to let them get to you or our daughter. I promised you that I'd always protect you both. Please, take her and stay safe. I'll find you when this is all over. We'll find each other. Don't ever lose sight of hope. I love you both so much."

"Catra? Catra it's okay. Focus on my voice. You're okay, you're safe. I'm not going anywhere. I'm right here beside you."

Luna tries everything she can to get through to me. Her voice is calm and I can feel her presence. Maybe she's dealt with something like this before and knows to let the visions ride out. It's a shame I can't tell her what happening, what I'm seeing. Hopefully it'll all be over soon…

"I need you to look after this for me. Can you do that?"

In my vision, Luna hands the younger version of myself her mask, tears in her eyes. It's all becoming clear now…

"How about we play a game of hide and seek? You hide and I'll seek. I need you to hide in here and stay very quiet okay. I'm going to go and tell mama that we're doing this okay. Then when she goes and hides I'll come and seek you both."

Vision Luna leans forward and places a gentle kiss to my forehead, before resting our heads together… *"I love you very much. Never forget that!"*

The vision version of Luna then proceeds to close the box, protecting my younger self from the outside dangers of Etheria. I clutch onto her mask, *my mask*, tightly…

"I'm sorry my kitten."

The vision start to fade as I see the past version of Luna disappear into the distance. Only this time it ends differently. When I open my eyes, when the vision completely fades, Luna, *my mom*, is here besides me.

"Are you okay?" Luna asks concerned.

Her hand reaches forward to comfort me, but I jump back slightly, unsure of how to react to this new information. Luna immediately retracts her touch, noticing my sudden change in behaviour…

"Catra it's okay? It's just me, Luna."

I pounce upwards and start pacing backwards and forward trying to piece things together.

"No no no, it can't be true. It *can't* be true!"

My tail aggressively sways side to side and my claws scratch through my scalp. My heart rate and breathing rate is edgy,

picking up in speed with every beat. I'm not sure how I should feel about this.

Luna slowly starts to rise and tries to approach me calmly…

"Catra try and calm down."

"CALM DOWN? CALM DOWN! How do you expect me to calm down when I've just discovered that I'm your daughter!"

Luna's once calm face falls and looks at me in complete shock. Her eyes start darting side to side, trying to figure out what's going on. Her tail sways side to side anxiously.

"H-how do you know? How can you be certain?"

"I-it's hard to explain. I've been having dreams about my past ever since I ended up the Horde. I was told that my species was extinct and that I was abandoned at the Horde's doorstep. If it wasn't for Adora I probably would have been killed. The only thing that I had with me was a crimson red mask, which in the picture clearly shows that it was your mask. I know because I still have it. I kept it with me after all this time. It was a part of me that I couldn't let go."

Luna examine the picture as I hand it back to her, pointing out of her mask. My words match the description. Luna carefully listens to every word I say...

"The nightmares kept getting worse since I first saw the ruins and then I started having visions. When I first mentioned them to you it was after a vision where I saw a young Magicat kitten chasing after another Magicats tail in the throne room, and when you brought me here the visions of that night, exactly how you described it, appeared in my mind. I remember you asking me to look after your mask, telling me that we were going to play hide and seek a-and that you'd come find me when it was safe."

Tears are now slowly starting to pool in the corner of my eyes as I begin to stutter over my words…

"Y-you told me that you loved me and that you were sorry. The last thing I remember seeing was you running off into the distance with tears in your eyes. I-I wanted to call for you to come back but I promised to stay quite. I-I didn't understand then… but I do now."

Panic rant over, I finally find the strength to stop pacing. Realization hits me…

I'm Luna's daughter. I was never abandoned. I was taken. I was loved and I was wanted. I had a family that fought for me. A family that tried everything they could to protect me. A family that was taken away from me by the Horde… the people I fought for. The people I believed cared about me. Everything I was told, everything I was led to believe about my past… it was all a fucking lie!

Hang on a minute… I fought for the Horde. I was a part of the Horde's chaos and destruction. I have done unforgivable things. The daughter of someone how lost everything because of them, was a member of the Horde! Never alone mind a member, but Second-in-Command!

Fear starts to take over my body. My fur stands on end and I start to shake uncontrollably. My fight or flight response is about to take over. When I look to Luna she has tears in her eyes, but I can also sense a hint of worry. She slowly moves forwards, her hand reaches out for me to take should I choose to…

"Catra?"

Overcome with fear, anger and a hint of confusion, I dart into the distance, running as far away as I can.

"Catra wait!"

I hear Luna call behind me in the distance. My heart tells me to stop, to finally console with someone I lost so many years ago but the fear of her finding out who I was and what I did before I became the real me forces me to run as far away as I can.

--

Tears cause my vision to blur as I desperately clamber over fallen rock and trees. Everything looks so different here, I can't even tell where I am. The burning feeling in my legs begs me to stop, but I have to keep going. Stars I wish Melog was here, they could turn me invisible and all would be okay.

Eventually I'm forced to come to a stop, but not because I want to. If it was and option I would have kept on running.

"Shit!"

It's a dead end. A large cliff face surrounds me. The only way to escape is the way I came but I fear that I may have already run out of time before Luna catches up to me.

The Whispering… it's like it's fighting against me.

"Catra?"

Luna? She's getting closer.

I look up the rock face… *I can climb that. I've climbed taller than that.*

Unsheathing my claws, I start my climb up the cliff-face using my strength to pull me up. Unfortunately for me, moss has started to grow and when I do manage to get my grip I then end up losing my footing due to a slippery patch. The rising sun doesn't help either. It makes it difficult to see.

"Catra please. I just want to talk!"

Luna's voice is slightly louder this time. She's getting close. I need to get out of here. Reaching up, I grab onto a sharp rock. My

arms burn, my legs ache, but I have to keep going.

Here we go. Three, two, one…

"Ah!"

The rock that I had a grip of falls away from the cliff-face, causing me to fall back to the ground, landing face first. Contrary to what people think, Magicats don't always land on their feet. That rule only applies to Magicats when they're not falling from a height greater than six feet above the ground.

"Ouch."

Slowly lifting myself off the ground, I check to see if I have any cuts or broken bones. Lucky for me there are none. I should only have a few bruises showing tomorrow. I then proceed to dust myself off and reassess the cliff-face once more… *is it worth trying again?*

"Catra?"

Shit. I thought I'd lost her.

Sensing that Luna is standing somewhere behind me, my body starts to tense up. I refuse to look at her. I won't let her see my visible pain. I won't let her see my tears that are starting to fall. Instead I keep my back turned to her, my ears remain flat against my head, my tail extremely stiff and my shoulders hunched. I try my best to shut her voice out as she speaks, the voice that I hear in my visions, the voice I recognise from my childhood, the voice that belongs to my mom.

"Catra please. I know this is a lot to take in but I just want to talk. Everything will be okay."

"NO IT WON'T!"

My voice echoes through the woods. Birds fly from their nests, the wind stills and the ground felt like it was shaking for a moment.

Luna didn't deserve that, she didn't deserve any of what happened to her… *and neither did I.*

Slowly, I turn to face Luna. She is a few feet away from me, tears threatening to fall from her eyes. I can sense from her body language that she wants to come closer to me, to comfort me, to hold me close, but she won't just yet. She doesn't want to startle me again, to risk losing me a second time.

I go to speak but my voice stutters through the heavy falling tears. My arms and tail move to hug my body, providing me with some sort of comfort…

"You don't understand. I-I can't be your daughter. I believed my whole life that you never wanted me, that you abandoned, that I was never loved. That's what I was taught to believe. It's what I believed for a very long time."

Luna goes to move forward but stops when she see me take a step back. Luna understands and let me say what needs to be said…

"I let it control me. I let that anger drive me into doing terrible things. The things I have done, the unforgivable actions that I ordered… I was part of the Horde! I was a part of this. They created a monster. When you find out the truth… you'll wish you never found me."

Hearing Luna's voice crack and her breath hitch forces me to look up. She is no longer holding her tears back, she's letting them fall. She looks defeated, exhausted.

"Catra I know this is a lot right now and your probably scared and confused, but I need you to listen to me okay… I have always loved you. I never stopped loving you. I never stopped searching for you and I never would have stop even if I hadn't met you today. I don't care about what you did in the past, that won't change anything. You're still my daughter."

The grip that my tail and arms have my body slowly starts to relax as I carefully listen to Luna words…

"The Horde took you, manipulated you, forced you to do their evil deeds. I can see clearly how much pain they have caused you. I'm so sorry that I wasn't there to stop it from happening, to take this burden away from you before it became part of your roots. I'm your mother. I swore from the moment you were born and I first held you in my arms that I would protect you no matter what and I failed you. I will never forgive myself for that."

But she did nothing wrong. She kept her promise to find me and she did exactly that. I wasn't her fault that I was taken. The Horde is the one to blame for all this. She did everything she could to protect me. If it wasn't for her… I might not even be here.

Tears now start to fall heavily from both mine and Luna's eyes. We couldn't even hide them if we tried…

"I am so sorry that I wasn't there when you need me most but I'm here now. I don't care how painful the stories are to tell, I will listen to everything you want to tell me when you're ready to, both the good and the bad. I will listen to every word you have to say and I will not judge you for it because I know in my heart you were only doing what you had to do to survive. All that matters is who you are now.

Luna does her best to give me a reassuring smile as she speaks…

"I missed out on so much of you growing up because the Horde took that away from me. They took you away from me. I understand it will be a long, difficult road for us to get to know each other once more but I can't risk losing you again. I understand if you choose never to see me again after this and as painful as that will be for me I'll respect that. But right now, above anything… I would love nothing more than to get to know my daughter, my kitten."

Tears stream down Luna's cheeks as she reaches her hand out longingly, hoping that I will step forward and take it. At first I am hesitant, unsure of whether I should or shouldn't do. I have gone nearly twenty years not knowing the truth about my past, about my family and now everything seems too much to comprehend. However, all it takes is a look into Luna's eyes for all my hesitance to disappear. There is something so familiar in Luna's eyes, something that I see in Adora's everyday… *love.*

Surging forward, I push Luna's hand aside and do something I have been yearning deep down to do since the moment I found out that she was my mom. I tightly hug her, holding her close. My claws dig into Luna's shoulder blades and my head presses firmly against her chest.

At first Luna is slightly shocked, I don't think she was expecting me to hug her. However, a few seconds later, Luna comes to her senses and wastes no time in returning my hug. Her arms wrap around me tightly, holding me close and never letting go. Even after all these years a part, hugging her feels so familiar, loving and safe.

Long forgotten memories start to come back to me as Luna holds me close. Her fur feels as soft as I remember and her scent is as calming as it always has been. Her tail wraps around my own, providing me with a feeling of belonging.

No words are said, but tears are shared as the dawn begins to break. The purr that emits from us is so loud that it can probably be heard all across Etheria. Neither of us want to let go as we share our first, warm embrace in many, many years.

What was once lost has been found… I have been found.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading chapter seven. Be honest, who needed the tissues?

Well done to those who guessed that Luna is Catra's mom. We'll get to learn more about her and Catra's other mother Dawn in the next few chapters. However, if you would like to read how I think Catra ended up in the Horde and learn more about what happened that night then you're in luck. The second prequel chapter is now uploded in the Finding Halfmoon series (link here: https://archiveofourown.org/works/39320709). Hope you enjoy.

Please let me know your thoughts. I love reading your thoughts on where you think the story is heading. We have now hit the first major point of the plot but there is so much more to come as hopes and anxieties run high. I think the next main question is: will Adora find Catra in a place only Magicats know exist? 😊

Halfmoon

Chapter Summary

As the sun rises, Luna takes Catra back to Halfmoon where they can rest.

Catra meets someone important to Luna.

Catra and Luna prepare to fight as an intruder enters Halfmoon's territory.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Dawn soon approaches and it has to be one of the warmest sunsets I have ever felt. It's probably a beautiful one too but I can't really tell from the easing tears that now pool in the corner of my eyes. I don't know how long has passed. Luna and I have been here for a while now, simply holding each other, neither wanting to be the first to let go. After all these years being separated can you really blame us.

"I'm so sorry Catra. I never meant for any of this to happen to you. I tried everything to get you back. I'm sorry I failed you."

Luna tries her best to speak through her slowing tears, yet her guilt shows through. My grip on her only tightens when I speak…

"You didn't fail me. You found me, like you promised you would. You're here now and that's all that matters."

"I promise I'll never leave you again. I will never let anything like that happen to you ever again. You are my everything."

Luna places a gentle kiss to the top of my head, promising me that she means every word she speaks. Her purr is incredibly loud, much louder than my own, but still incredibly soft and

comforting. I could stay here forever held tight in her arms, but that isn't a complete possibility...

"So what happens now?"

I am slightly worried about the answer to my question. I really should be heading back home to Adora and the others. They're probably worried sick, but I also don't want to leave.

Luna partially moves out of our embrace, but she still remains close. She looks to me with her beaming smile and places the palm of her hand over my cheek. Without second thought I lean into her warm, comforting touch. She looks to me as if she can see herself in me...

"Well that's up to you. You're more than welcome to come back to Halfmoon with me and rest up before heading back home. Alternatively, you could head back to wherever you call home…"

"No! I-I don't want to lose you again. I'm not ready to leave you yet!"

Fear sets in and I desperately pull Luna back into a tight hug. After everything I've been though, after everything I have lost or has been taken from me… *I can't lose her again.* If I leave now I fear I'll not be able to find my way back to her. Some might say that I'm over-reacting a bit but after everything I have been through I am prone to fearing the worst.

Tears threaten to fall from my eyes once more but Luna is quick to stop them from falling. She speaks words of comfort whilst slowly tracing soothing circular patterns across my back...

"Shhhhh it's okay. I've got you. I'm not going anywhere I promise. How about we both head back to Halfmoon, get a few hours of much needed sleep after our eventful night, have something to eat and then, if you want, I'll walk you home that way you know where to go to find me. How does that sounds?"

That does seem like a better idea. Not to mention I am pretty tired. Besides, who knows, maybe Melog is already on their way back with Adora and the others.

Unable to form words, I nod my head against Luna's chest. We stay hugging each other for a little while longer, until I feel relaxed enough to let go. Luna has reassured me that she won't leave me and I trust her. After all, she is my mom.

Luna guides us to the cave opening that we exited earlier this morning when it was still dark. The cave tunnel itself still looks dark but my excellent eye sight makes everything a bit more clear. The river of water still flows down this way and the rocks that block my original path still stand.

Take it Melog isn't back with Adora yet? Hopefully they'll find me soon.

Luna looks to the rocks and then takes a right turn, down towards a longer tunnel that is partially lit. I'm not sure how that's entirely possible, especially considering there doesn't appear to be any cracks within the walls for light to slip through.

"The north entrance to Halfmoon, or should I say new Halfmoon, is a slight walk from here but we'll be there soon."

"How is it so light in here? There aren't any cracks in the tunnel walls. I always thought you shouldn't go towards the light."

Luna laughs slightly as she turns to face me. I wonder how many times she's heard that one before…

"You'll see."

A few more paces forward and the source of light becomes clear. Hanging up on the walls are a series of torches, the flames burning a bright amberish-red colour. They light up our path, guiding us deeper into the tunnel. It's like we're heading underground, or even within a mountain.

The end of the tunnel soon opens up revealing a sight that I had only even dreamed of seeing. Tall structures stand proud from the ground and on the higher platforms within the mountains heart. Trees grow both from the floor and off the cliff side, climbing higher the further up you look, twisting and turning to face all directions, threatening to fall should the walls crack. Colour bursts to life, but there is one thing that stands out to me above all.

Magicats! There are Magicats everywhere.

"Wow."

To the side of me, Luna smiles brightly when she sees how memorized I am by the sight in front us...

"Impressive right? I knew when I found this place that we'd be safe. It's well hidden, water flows in through the stream outside and when the sun is at the right height, we get a good few hours of warmth. We remain well hidden from above thanks to the blind coverage from the trees at the top and across the walls. I knew that if so much life could thrive here within this mountain then so could we."

Overcome with emotion and shock, it becomes a struggle to hold back my tears but I manage it. It feels strange to see so many Magicats together in one area, especially when you've gone so many years thinking that you are the only one left.

Luna starts to walk down the slope, guiding me through the villages. There are so many Magicats here, all of different shapes, sizes, fur colours and ages. It's amazing to see. The foods that are baked in the morning smell delicious.

I wonder what's been baked? Bread? Toasties? Pie?

Many of those we pass say morning to Luna whilst others look on in amazement and curiosity. My sensitive hearing manages to pick up on a few of their silent whispers, many asking: *'who is that'*… or *'could it be?'*… and *'is she an outsider*?'

Feeling slightly intimidated by the situation I am allowing myself to be put in, my body starts to try and make myself appear as small as possible, almost trying to turn invisible. My ears lie flat against my head, my tail curls around my leg and my arms move to hug myself. Luna instantly recognizes this and moves closer to me, blocking me from some of the other Magicats' glaring eyes.

Luna then leans over to whisper in my ear…

"I'm sorry if this has made you feel a little uncomfortable but this is unfortunately the only way through to where I live. I hadn't realised so many would be awake at this time. There's a hidden passage up ahead behind the thick overgrowth. We can hide in there."

Luna's words make me feel slightly better and she remains close to my side the rest of the way. When possible, we hide in the overgrowth and make our way to a small castle. Strangely, it almost looks as if it has been built into the mountains walls purposefully for camouflage.

Luna stops when she notices two guards at the entrance. They're Magicats, most likely her protectors, *so why has she stopped?*

Luna quickly scans the area before revealing a smirk.

I know that look. I used to give Adora that look all the time when we planned on doing something we shouldn't back in the Horde. What is she up to?

"How good are you at climbing?"

"Me? I'm an excellent climber. Why do you ask?"

Luna turns to me and starts to chuckle under her breath.

"What's so funny? You asked and I answered?"

"It's just you sound so confident for someone who landed flat on their face a few hours ago."

"Yeah… well… shut up!"

Luna starts to giggle even harder, trying her best to contain her laughter as to not alert the guards… *great now my cheeks are burning.*

"Come on. We're going to go in the back way."

Following Luna, we come across a window that's at least a fair few feet above the ground. My breath catches slightly, feeling a little nervous about why we are choosing to enter this way. Luna choose at that moment to speak...

"We could go in the front way but I know the guards will ask who you are, maybe even interrogate you. Standard protocol, you can't be too careful. I don't want them to make you feel uncomfortable."

Okay can she read my mind?

Smiling at Luna, I whisper a silent word of thanks. I might be her daughter but I'm still not ready for everyone to know that just yet. Besides, I need to get to know her as my mom first.

Is it okay for me to call her that? Is it too soon? Why does it feel weird to say that?

"Do you need a boost?" Luna asks as she points up to the window.

"Nah. I've got this. Besides, I've climbed way higher than this."

"Really?"

"Oh yeah. All the time. Adora and I used to climb up to the top of the watch tower back in our Horde days. We used to watch the sunset and… *stuff."*

The thought of Adora alone is enough to make me blush. My eyes catch Luna smiling brightly at me.

Shit, better get climbing Catra.

After a few minutes, Luna and I make it through the window and sneak into the castle. We cautiously make our way down the corridors, avoiding contact with any of the guards. We might have knocked a few things over accidentally and had to hide behind a few plants every now and then but we made it work.

We eventually enter a calmly light room, one about the same size as mine and Adora's room back at Brightmoon. There's a bed, a sofa, wardrobe, bathroom and even a small balcony that is well blended into the mountains cliff-face, overlooking the Whispering Woods from a well-hidden viewpoint. You wouldn't even spot it from the ground. You'd have to find a way to get up this high to even know it was here.

"I haven't done that in years."

Luna says through a fit of giggles giggling. She quietly closes the door behind her. Curiosity get hold of me so I end up asking…

"Done what?"

Luna walks over to her wardrobe to retrieve a blanket and pillow as she speaks…

"Snuck around Halfmoon castle. Your mama and I used to do that all the time back when we were younger. We used to sneak around old Halfmoon's castle at night, raiding the kitchens and sneaking out when possible to chase the fireflies and explore Etheria. As we go older we had other reasons to sneak around… but you don't need to know about that."

Luna's cheeks blush slightly. I can't tell whether she means that in a way of '*you don't need to know why we used to sneak around'* or *'you don't need to know what we got up to in our youth'*. Either way it is nice to see Luna smile. It's reminds me of the time Adora and I used to do stuff like that...

"Sounds like Adora and I. We used to sneak around the Fright Zone all the time: climbing up to our secret spot in the evenings, searching off to the Horde's pantry to get the other an extra ration bar when the other wasn't well or we were hungry, even having sleepovers where we'd stay up all night whispering about… *whatever.* We still do that sort of stuff now only this time it doesn't matter if we get caught. Life is no longer like it was back when we were in the Horde."

My hand moves to fiddle with my wing pin badge. I really miss Adora, I wish she was here.

Luna smiles and places the spare blanket and pillow down on the rather large, comfy looking sofa. It's big enough to fit two people on it.

"I know it's not much but I think you'll be better off staying in here with me for a while. You can either take my bed or the sofa. The choice is yours. I'll answer any other questions you might have after you get some rest."

"Thanks. I'll take the sofa. It surprisingly looks comfy."

There's a few moments of awkward silence between us, both of us unsure of what to say to each or what to do next. Luna is the first to break the silence…

"Well, I'll be over there should you need anything. Although I should probably let the guards know that I'm back first but then I'll be back here. Make sure you get some rest."

Luna turns to leave but my hand reaches out taking hers in my own…

"Luna wait..."

Luna stops in her tracks and looks back at me. I feel slightly embarrassed to ask this but I don't want to be alone, at least not yet anyway.

"Can you maybe… *stay*… just until I fall asleep. I sometimes struggle to fall asleep in unfamiliar places on my own."

Technically that isn't a lie, but it also isn't the complete trust. Ever since Adora rescued me from Prime's ship I have struggled to fall asleep without her by my side. The fear of being alone in an unfamiliar place after what *he* did to me has that effect on you.

Luna smiles, unphased by what I have asked…

"Sure."

She sits down beside me as I get comfortable. She then reaches for the blanket…

"Do you want me to tuck you in?"

"What? Seriously? No… I'm not a kid anymore."

A faint laugh of embarrassment comes out through my words. I guess it would be nice to be tucked in again like I used to be. I know I like Adora tucking me in when I'm not feeling well. She sometimes rolls me up into a *'purr-rito'* as she calls it when cuddling. Maybe being tucked in will help me feel more at ease.

Luna seems to pick up on the slight embarrassment in my voice and finds a way to put my mind at rest…

"You sure? You used to love it when you were little. Your mama used to tuck you in whilst I sang you to sleep. It might have been a few years ago now but I still remember how to look after my kitten."

Part of that memory starts coming back to me resulting in a smile. I remember someone tucking my tail in under my blanket before kissing me goodnight. Not only that but I remember someone singing me a soft tune when I couldn't sleep or when I was unwell.

Caving into the feeling of wanting to relive that memory, I let Luna tuck the blanket around my body as she begins to hum a gentle tune. I quickly recognise it. It's the same song that I used to sing to Adora when she was sick or exhausted from her day training. I always wondered where I heard if from and why it brought Adora and I such comfort. It's calming, peaceful.

Feeling exhaustion take over my body, I fall asleep within a matter of minutes with Luna right by my side.

--

It's a while before I awake. I'd probably still be sleeping if it wasn't for the smell of some delicious food and the hunger building within my stomach. Stretching, I clear the sleep from my eyes and look around the room.

Luna is exactly where she said she would be but she's wide awake. She seems to be reading a book of some sort, maybe even looking through some old photos. Her hand holds her sun necklace around her neck as she flicks through the pages. When she notices that I am awake, she smiles, closes her book and walks over to me, gently sitting beside me.

"How long was I asleep?"

"A few hours. You looked like you needed it too. I thought it'd be better to let you sleep, especially after you said you've been having nightmares."

I smile slightly, which is reciprocated by Luna's own. I look over to the balcony trying to work out what time it is. It's looks like it's almost midday, maybe even slightly after that. I have no concept of time here. It's weird.

A loud rumble interrupts my thoughts as my stomach growls. With everything going on I had forgotten to eat.

"*Hehe.* Sorry. I haven't eaten since yesterday."

Luna hums in amusement…

"Nothing to be sorry for. I had a feeling that you might be hungry when you awoke. Whilst you were sleeping, I went to get something for myself and also made you a little something. I only got back about ten minutes ago so it's still nice and hot."

Luna walks over to her desk side that has a plate covered with a silver tray. She brings it over to me and smiles. She then removes the lid revealing some delicious looking food...

"I hope you still like blueberry pie. I remembered it was one of your favourite things to eat when you were little. Well that and fish sticks. I know that that was a long time ago so if you're not so keen on it now we can go and find something else."

My jaw practically drops when Luna hands me the plate.

Even after all these years she still remembers what I like to eat.

"You don't need to worry. Blueberry pie is still one of my favourite things to eat. I always wondered where my sweet tooth came from, even if I only recently discovered that I have one.

Luna looks curious by that. I don't think she has yet worked out that Horde life diet was practically crumbs and whatever excuse a ration bar was. That will be difficult story to tell her.

The pie however, strangely tastes exactly like Razz's. *I wonder why that is?*

As if being able to read my mind Luna answers...

"An old friend of mine used to look after you when your mama and I had *'diplomatic'* business to attend. She used to make it for

you all the time. You loved it so much that I had her show me how to bake her special recipe. It's all we could get you to eat when you were unwell. She made me promise that I would show you how to bake it one day if you ever took up baking. She loved having you visit, always saying that you were like the grandchild she never had. She was a treasured friend. She saved my life a long time ago."

"What do you mean?"

"Well you see this…"

Luna gestures a single claw to the nick in her right ear…

"I tracked the Horde for days, weeks, months after they took you. I chased them for miles, fought off many of their own. That was until their bastard leader, *Hordak,* found out of my doing and decided to take matters into his own hands. He hunted me down and tried to kill me with his own hands. Fortunately for me he didn't know that my bloodline hold a great gift, one that allows us to turn into a powerful creature when threatened. Some of his soldiers knew of the creature but he hadn't seen me in action. One look was all it took for him to retreat like a coward, but I wasn't prepared to let him escape so easily. I chased him for miles despite the injuries that had already been inflicted upon me."

Luna's once strong voice starts to turn saddened and cold…

"Sadly, grief and anger started to take over and the creature started to fade. I was losing me connection to the creature within. Hordak saw this as an opportunity and took one shot. Thankfully he missed a fatal shot but he did catch my ear. It caused me to lose my balance and I stumbled, knocking myself out on a nearby rock. The last thing I remember seeing was his skiff driving away on the dusty land before I blacked-out."

Luna seems to phase out for a moment or two. It's like as she speaks she is reliving the events that once occurred. I know that

feeling. It sometimes happens to me sometimes when I have had to discuss certain events in therapy.

After a moment or two, Luna seems to snap out of her reflective state and takes a deep breathe. She continues to speak…

"My friend later found me and somehow managed to take me back to her little hut within the Whispering Woods whilst I was still unconscious. I think she cut off and used part of my robe to drag me there. I'm not sure. Anyway, she helped to sort my injuries and get me back on my feet. She told me to not give up looking for you as you would one day return and that you were closer than I could ever know. She got confused quite a lot of the time so that ultimately confused me too, but nevertheless her words gave me hope. Sadly, after that I never saw her again. The Whispering Woods shifts a lot. I often wonder what happened to her."

Realisation hits me as I finish eating the last piece of pie. I know who Luna is talking about.

"Does this friend of yours happen to be short, slightly *ancient* looking, has wild hair, wears huge glasses that make her eyes stand out like a bugs and whacked people on the head with a broom?"

Luna looks to me slightly baffled…

"Maybe. Why do you ask?"

Oh stars. How's Luna going to react to this?

"Because if you're on about someone called Madam Razz… she's still alive. I visit her regularly and she makes me Blueberry pie when I visit."

Luna, clearly surprised by this new piece of information, looks overwhelmed with shock and disbelief. Her head falls into her hands as she desperately tries to hold back tears. Instantly my arm moves to rub small circles across her back, which I'm very

surprised about as I'm only this quick to move towards someone who needs comforting when it's Adora.

Luna openly speaks her thoughts...

"How on Etheria is she still going? I feared the worst when I couldn't find her after that."

"Believe me I have no idea either. I only met her about a year ago when Adora took me to meet her. Adora met her a few years before I did and they've been good friends ever since. Razz seemed to already know who I was, which was a bit scary a first but I guess it makes sense now."

"I swear she's going to outlive all of us. She was around when I was a young Magicat."

Luna seems surprised, shocked, but above all, happy by the news that Razz is still alive. However, now I wonder how old Razz is exactly? When Luna comes back out of her shocked phase, she looks up to me and smirks. She has the teasing look that I sometimes gives Adora. *Why is she looking at me like that?*

"What?"

"You've mentioned this Adora person a lot since I found you. Don't think I haven't noticed you blushing and smiling when you say their name. Who are they? Are they someone important to you?"

I can feel my cheeks blushing even harder at the mention of Adora's name. Is now the right time to tell Luna who Adora is, that she is my fiancé, soon to be wife? I giggle nervously, trying my best to avoid Luna's questioning eyes…

"Oh Adora. She's just a *really* good friend of mine. She's the one who found me when I arrived at the Horde. We've been best friends since our childhood. We've looked out for each other from the very first moment we met. She's the reason I'm still here, alive and well that is. She actually gave me my name… *well my*

name that I have gone by ever since I can remember. I couldn't remember what my name was before that time and I was too afraid to speak back when I first met her. The name Catra just kind of stuck."

My hand strokes over Adora's wing pin when I speak about her. She's the reason I'm alive. The reason I'm alive and well. The reason why I have now been given the opportunity to reconnect with Luna.

Luna smiles and leans back…

"Well she picked a nice name for you I'll give her that."

A bright smile appears across my face and I laugh slightly when I remember who Adora actually chose my name...

"Adora did however suggest a few other names before we got to that one, but yeah, I think she chose a good name too. I recon you'll really like her. She's headstrong, sometimes stubborn, a bit of a *'lost in the moment'* kind of person at times but she is by far the most courageous, loyal and loving person I have ever met. She's my everything."

Great now I'm blushing even harder. Time to change the subject *Catra.*

"Hey Luna, do you mind if I ask you something? It's been bothering me a bit since I got here."

"Of course. Feel free to ask me anything."

Okay here it goes. Take a deep breath and ask…

"You don't mind that I haven't called you *'mom'* yet do you? It's not that I don't want to, it's just I've never really had a mother figure in my life before who I could look up to. I think it might feel a bit weird to call you *that* just yet until I get to know you a little

better. I don’t know, it’s hard to explain, but do you get what I mean?”

Alright, Micah, Lance and George are likeable parent figures in my life but I don’t feel as connected to them like they do with Arrow Bow or Sparkles, maybe even Adora. It’s hard to describe. The only person who might know what I mean by this is Scorpia. After her moms were lost to the war all she had was her grandad, but after his passing she was on her own. The only *'mother figure'* I may have had in my life was... *she wasn't even that. She doesn't even deserve to be considered as that! I'm glad she's gone. She can never hurt me ever again.*

Honestly, I more worried that Luna will be ashamed of me when she finds out who I really am, about the things I did when I was part of the Horde. I don’t want to call her mom yet in case she doesn’t want to know me after she finds out the truth. It’d be easier to go our separate ways if I don’t call her mom just yet; if I don’t feel a complete emotional connection to her.

Ashamed of myself I turn to face away from Luna. However, the warm touch of her hand over mine forces me to look back at her. I expected Luna to look upset, maybe even slightly anger, but she looks back to me full of love…

“I won’t lie to you Catra, it bothers me slightly. However, I don’t except you to call me mom. It would be wrong of me to expect that from you. We have been separated for so long that it will be difficult to go back to our old ways. You can call me Luna forever if that’s what you prefer, I don’t mind. I won’t force you to call me anything else, but if you one day choose to start addressing me as your mom again, then I’d love that… but you only do so when you feel ready. Promise?”

A small tear escapes from my eyes which Luna is quick to brush away. I let her guide me into a warm hug, one that feels calm and safe.

“I promise. Thank you”

Know that's sorted and the air is cleared there is more I want to ask. Wanting to know more about Luna and my mama, I pluck the courage to ask her my questions once my tears calm. However, my thoughts are interrupted when a screeching sound comes from the arm rest behind me.

SCREECH

My fur bristles and I quickly turn in Luna's hold. The sound startled the living daylights out of me, whereas Luna is laughing her head off...

"HAHA! Dusk, that is no way to say hello to our guest. You gave the poor soul quite the fright."

Hearing Luna's laughter calms me down and I allow myself to relax. There is no danger, nothing to be afraid of. Looking more closely I realize who's caused me to freak out...

"*You little…* you've been following me around for the past few weeks. How did you find me here?"

Luna moves from besides me and reaches her arm out. The Etherian Moon owl chirps at her and climbs up her arm, moving to sit on her shoulder. The small owl brushes up against Luna's cheek. She smiles and gives the owl a few head scratches.

"Catra meet Dusk. Dusk meet Catra."

Dusk chirps and flaps her wings, almost as if she is saying hello. It's rather cute but still doesn't explain what's going on...

"You have a pet owl?"

"Yep. Quite ironic isn't it considering that I'm a Magicat and Magicats chase birds."

Luna laughs and she moves to sit beside me once more. Dusk balances perfectly as Luna moves.

“H-how? W-what?..”

Luna clearly see the confusion on my face as I try to figure out what's going on. She smiles in amusement before deciding to fill me in on the story...

“After I lost your mama, and the worry that I had lost you too, I entered a really dark phase of grief. Grief alone is enough to kill a Magicat as we create incredibly deep connections with our partners. I was on my way back to new Halfmoon, which was still being constructed at the time, after I got *that* injury to my ear. It’s only when I stumbled over a log because I wasn’t looking where I was going that I notice Dusk. She was a small owlet, probably only a few weeks old, who had been knocked out of her nest. From the looks of it, the Horde had destroyed most of her habitat when they passed through the area. Part of her tail was broken and she was left defenceless, unable to fly. I tried to locate her parents, possible siblings, but to no luck. In that moment I made the decision to take her with me, to nurse her back to health.”

Dusk starts to nuzzle under Luna’s chin the best she can. Dusk is acting very much like Melog when they want attention. Luna chuckles and *'beak-boops'* Dusk. The result is hilarious as Dusk completely blanks out, staring into space. Both Luna and I giggle slightly and Luna continues to speak…

“So I brought her back to Halfmoon with me. I fed her up, taught her how to hunt and when she was old enough I taught her how to fly. That was difficult as I can’t fly but we worked it out. The kink in her tail feather is the result of her broken, now thankfully healed, tail bone from when I first found her. I healed it the best I could and had to let nature do the rest. It makes her a bit louder when flying but it doesn’t affect her survival. When the time came that Dusk was ready to fend for herself she refused to leave. She chose to stay with me, become my friend. She does tend to go on regular adventures on her own every now and then but she always returns home to me. We helped each other through a lot of difficult times. I rescued her and in return she rescued me. We

saved each other, was there for one another when we need them the most."

Luna gentle strokes Dusk on the top of her head, resulting in the owl leaning into her touch. Reminds me of the time I met Melog.

"Sounds like very much like Melog and I."

"Is Melog your unusual looking friend?"

"Yeah. Melog is my friend who you saw with me back at the ruins of old Halfmoon. I found them when my friends and I went in search of something. They had been alone for many years and they chose to bond with me. Neither of us has had it easy. We have both been through a lot, but we've pulled through it all stronger than ever. At first I didn't quite know why they chose me but I soon came to learn that they needed me just as much as I needed them. I'd be lost without them."

Luna is clearly curious but also slightly concerned about what I mean. I'm going to have to tell her about my past eventually but now is not the time.

"You know you can tell me anything, right? I meant what I said back when I found you."

"I know I can and I will eventually. *It's just...* right now I have so many questions I want to ask. I want to learn more about you and my mama and…"

BANG

The room doors come swinging open and a young, rather broad looking Magicat guard comes barging through. Luna looks over to them, initially unimpressed by their intrusion. However, that soon fades when she sees how concerned they look.

"Queen Luna. I'm incredibly sorry to disturb you and your guest but Halfmoon's boundaries have been breached. There's an intruder within the Kingdom's territory."

“Impossible! Halfmoon’s protection barrier is impenetrable to any technique and form of magic.”

But maybe not She-Ra’s magic?

“I’m as concerned as you are my queen. The issue is we don’t know who it is or how they have discovered us. I fear it may be them.”

“The Horde?”

Luna’s deep growl can be heard vibrating through the room. Her fists clench as her side. I’m quick to settle the matter concerning that greater evil...

“No it can’t be! Adora and I defeated the Horde for good over a year ago. The war is over. It’s why you’ve seen some many new creatures around Etheria. When Adora and I released the magic the First-Ones trapped underground, it encouraged all these creatures return to Etheria, ensuring them it was safe to return.”

Adora? I forgot Melog went to get help. It could be Adora and our friends, here to rescue me. I have to get to them before something terrible happens.

Despite my words, Luna still seems greatly concerned. Her tone of voice is powerful and determined when she give the general their orders...

“Gather your strongest Magicats general. We’re going to investigate. We’ll start with stealth and observe procedures before we decide what to do next. We need to determine if this new presence is a threat. Only attack if absolutely necessary. We won’t go down without a fight.”

The young general salutes and makes a hasty exit. Dusk the owl follows them. Luna looks back to me as I try to spring into action...

“I’ll come with you.”

There is a sense of urgency in my voice and for more than one reason. I got to push past Luna but her hands are firmly placed shoulders, stopping me in my tracks.

"No Catra. I need you to stay here where it's safe."

"But…"

"No buts! I won't lose you again. I promise that I will return to you and when I do... I'll make sure you get home safe to Adora. I can tell she means a lot to you so right now if you won't stay here for me, then please stay here where it's safe for her."

But it might be Adora. Adora might be the intruder.

Sensing that Luna won't take no for an answer I give into her pleas. I will wait here for as long as I have to. She places a gentle kiss to my forehead…

"I'll be back. I promise."

With that Luna takes her leave and I am once again left alone with my thoughts.

--

I'm not sure how long it's been. It could have been minutes, maybe even hours. My racing thoughts and growing anxiety is the only thing keeping my company. I want to go help but how can I help? I don't know my way around Halfmoon. I'd be pretty much useless when navigating my way around this place and I don't know who's a threat and who's not.

"Ahhhhh!"

A cry of frustration escapes me.

Why is it everytime something good enters my life, the fear of losing them soon takes over. Why is it always me who suffers this way?

SCREECH

My sensitive hearing alert me to the sound of Dusk's call down the corridor, followed by the sound of heavy footsteps at a fast pace. They suddenly stop outside the door, which I locked not long after Luna left. Something struggles to opened it, giving in a few good thuds and shakes. It sounds like something is scratching at the door, trying to find a way to open it. Whatever is on the other side is determined to get in here.

Sensing danger, I unsheathe my claws ready to attack. I'm ready for whatever dangers are on the other side of that door. I'm not going to go down without a fight.

Three… two… one…

BANG

The doors swing open. I prepare to charge forward, ready to attack. However, no attack comes and no defensive strategy is necessary. Two figures stand before me: one small and one tall. One *mreows* in greeting whilst the other beautiful sight smiles…

"Hey Adora."

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you all enjoyed chapter eight of Finding Halfmoon. Did anyone guess that Dusk (the Etherian Moon Owl that has been following Adora and Catra) would be Luna's companion? We will definitely be seeing more of Dusk and Luna in future chapters.
>
> We're now officially at the halfway point of Finding Halfmoon and there is still much more to come. Thank you all for your continued support throughout the fic updates. It means a lot

to me: more than words can say. I love reading you comments and where you think the story is heading so please keep them coming. There is also a new extra content chapter released in the Finding Halfmoon series on what was happening back in Brightmoon whilst Catra was with Luna in Halfmoon. Go check it out (link here: https://archiveofourown.org/works/39473535). 🥰

The big question now is what do you think will happen next? Although Adora has now found Catra, what's going to happen if Luna finds them? What is Adora's plan and how will Catra react? Find out on Friday when the next chapter is released. Hope to see you there. 😊

P.S - TATEOTW readers may notice that the tune Luna hummed/sang to Catra in the early part of this chapter is a reference to the last chapter of the You & Me fic (TATEOTW prequel story). If you haven't checked it out yet, why not give it a read.

Family

Chapter Summary

Catra tries to explain to her friends what is going on but things don't quite work out how she hope they would.

The group of friends get quite the shock when a secret is revealed.

Catra follows Luna to ask some more questions. A story unfolds: tears, laughter and smiles are shared.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Catra!"

Adora practically screams as she rushes froward, taking me into her arms and lifting me off the ground. Without even thinking about it, my arms and legs wrap around Adora allowing her to spin me round. My head buries against her neck as I take in all of her…

She's here. She's really here. She found me.

Adora gently lowers me back to the floor but her tight grip remains. My hands move to hold her cheeks, my thumbs brushing away her tears as they start to fall. Adora leans in, kissing me passionately, one which I eagerly return. I almost forgot what it feels like to kiss her. The love of my life, my soulmate: I've missed her so much.

"Are you okay? Are you hurt? Melog told me what happen and I was worried when I couldn't find you. I thought I'd lost you."

"I'm fine Adora. I promise. Much better now you're here. I really missed you."

Mreow

Melog circles around my legs, brushing themselves against the back of my knees. I reach down, stroking the top of their head.

"I missed you too Melog. Thank you for bringing Adora here. How did you find me?"

Adora being Adora starts to ramble…

"This morning I woke up earlier than usual and I couldn't find you in bed. At first I was worried but then I noticed Melog was gone too so I felt better knowing that they were most likely with you and that's when I saw your note. I tried to fall back asleep but I couldn't so I just went about my day. The morning went on and I went about my business, took a little flight with Swift Wind and then I went to see Razz to see if you were there. I was getting a bit more worried as it was nearly midday and I hadn't heard anything from you which was unusual considering you usually send me a *'good morning'* message when you're out and about like that but I tried not to stress about it. When you weren't there I started to become more worried because of the stuff Razz was saying but we all know what Razz is like so I thought nothing of it. But some of the things she said did confuse me so it did make my anxiety go through the roof…"

"Adora slow down. We've got plenty of time. Take a breather."

Adora follows my words and does as I ask. Melog telepathically whispers besides me…

"She's been like this ever since I told her what had happened. It's difficult to get her to calm down when you can't communicate with her like I do with you."

I simply roll my eyes at Melog knowing exactly what they mean. I know they mean well. I've had to deal with this side of Adora for years so I know exactly how to calm her down when she's like this. Once Adora has calmed down she speaks again…

“So Melog came and found me when I was leaving Razz’s and told me what happened. Well not told me as you know I can’t talk to them like you do but those translation lessons came in handy…”

“Glad to hear it.”

“...Anyway, I worked out that something was wrong very quickly. All of us: Bow, Glimmer, Entrapta and even Scorpia came here in search of you. We managed to clear the rocks but when you weren’t there I started to panic even more. That’s when I noticed a series of lights and we followed them. At first I thought it was a dead end. I was so angry and scared that I had lost you that She-Ra appeared and she took control of my actions. I don’t know what happened but when my sword was struck into a nearby rock, this place appeared. That’s when She-Ra faded and I haven’t been able to get her back since. Although now I think of it, that’s probably a good thing because I would have been an unmissable target.”

“Well if that wasn’t obvious enough... *Adora you turn into an eight-foot tall blonde warrior when you transform!* If we ever get lost all you have to do is transform and I’ll find you. If it was the other way round, I'd probably have to climb over crowds for you to see me.”

Adora laughs and her eyes avoid my gaze. She has that nervous look on her face...

"Adora? What happened?”

She giggles again as she speak...

“Well you see... turns out regardless of whether I'm transformed as She-Ra or not, it doesn’t necessarily mean that we won’t get spotted."

Adora is quick to notice the worrying look on my face and is quite to settle my nerves…

"It's okay though. I mean we lost them a while back and we haven't seen them since."

Grumbling slightly, I start to check over Adora and Melog, making sure that they're not hurt. Hopefully out friends are more careful than these two.

"Okay, fine. All that matters to me is that you two are okay. What happened anyway?"

Adora takes my hands in hers and gives them a gentle squeeze. It's our silent way of telling the other that everything is okay.

"I'm not quite sure. At first I thought we were doing okay, we hadn't run into anyone or knocked anything over but then we chased so we had to split up. Melog and I ran this way and the others went another way. Melog was unable to turn me invisible for some reason but we made it work. You won't believe it but that Etherian Moon Owl, the one we saw in the woods and at the ruins, found me and brought us to this door. They guided me to you."

Dusk guided Adora to me? What is that owl up to?

Mreow – Melog turns and points to the door. At that moment, the rest of the team come flying through.

"Catra! You're okay!" Scorpia squeals as she pulls me into a bone crushing hug.

"Are you okay? Who's ass do I need to kick!" Sparkles says as she comes around Adora, lightly punching me in the shoulder.

"I'm good Sparkles thanks. Scorpia… *could you…* please put me down for a second. *I need to breath."*

Scorpia squeezes me one last time, lifting me off the ground in the process, before releasing me from her grip. I have to rub my ribs to ease some of the aching.

“It’s great to see you all here. I’m surprised you manage to find me. There’s actually something I need to tell you all.”

Everyone looks to me curiously but Bow interrupts…

“I hate to say it Catra but that might have to wait. According to Entrapta’s tech-pad, we’re not the only ones in the area.”

Entrapta is quick to elaborate on Bow's words...

“There’s a large group of other lifeforms close by. If we leave now we might be able to outrun them. It’s going to be like the day we were running from the Horde and I got trapped in there… *only this time I don’t plan on getting trapped*. Although I would love to maybe stay for a while and see what this place is.”

“Sadly we haven't got time for that Entrapta and we don't intend on losing you again. Glimmer can you teleport us out of here?”

Adora voice sounds commanding as she strategies our next move. Sparkles grumbles in frustration as her powers seem to fail her...

“No can do. Already tried to teleport with no success. It’s like something is stopping me from doing so. Good thing is, I can still use defensive magic. Strange really as it doesn’t make much sense.”

“Okay well it’ll have to do. Scorpia, see if you can use your powers too. Bow, have your arrow at the ready just in case. Melog, keep trying to turn us invisible. Entrapta, stay close to Scorpia for protection and see if you can find a way out on your tech-pad."

Adora smiles and grabs my hand. She has that devilish smirk on her face...

"Adora?"

She smiles confidently and interlaces our fingers together...

"Look's like we're doing this the old way."

We make a run for it but this… this isn't right. I don't need rescuing.

"Adora wait. We're not in danger. There's something I need to tell…"

I don't even get the chance to explain anything before we're spotted and I end up being dragged along with the group on their 'rescue mission'.

--

"Why is it everytime we go on a mission something ends up chasing us?!"

"Where's your sense of adventure Sparkles? Not to mention we wouldn't be being chased right now if you had hit your target in the first place."

"Fuck off Horde Scum! I'd like to see you try and hit a target when running from these… whatever they are!"

Truthfully I'm thankful that Sparkles missed her target as no one got hurt. I've tried to stop and talk to my friends many times to get them to see that is nothing to fear but they don't seem to want to listen. All the adrenaline pumping in the minds seems to be blocking out my words. Melog can sense my frustration building and is trying to help me get through to them.

Many of our optional paths had been blocked by a series of guards. We have managed to keep them occupied for a little while longer by causing chaos within the corridors and village but we're now running out of places to hide. The only place that seemed reasonable to go to get some coverage was in the bush. However, I'm not starting to feel like we were being blocked off to head this way. I'm starting to feel like we're being led into a trap.

“Over there!” Scorpia shouts.

A bright opening is ahead of us. We all run towards it, hoping that it’s an escape route.

Bursting through the overhanging vines, we find ourselves in a part of the Whispering Woods that I have never seen before. This is becoming a common occurrence for this place. We run a bit further ahead, making sure that we have a fair distance from where we came from. We stop for a moment, simply to catch our breath.

“I think we lost them”. Adora says as she catches her breath.

I try again to get through to them why I have to chance…

“Adora, there is something I need to tell you. It’s going to sound crazy and may come as a shock but I need to tell you before anything else happens.”

Adora nods to me letting me know that I have her fully attention. However, it’s at this moment my sensitive hearing picks up on something… *danger!*

“Guys… What’s that?” - Arrow Boys voice jitters a little bit as he speaks.

Slowly I look to my side and see two large blue eyes glaring at us sharply. A large creature, almost the size of a tiger, prowls forward from the dense overgrowth. Their fur is a silverish grey, their body covered in scars from previous battles, their claws and fangs look freshly sharpened ready for the attack. Most noticeable of all is the nick at the bottom of their right ear…

Luna?

“RUN!” Bow screams running past us.

I thought he was meant to be one of the brave ones. Mind you, he probably has the right idea.

The others follow suit, darting past me, running further into the woods. Unlike the others, I remain frozen in place unsure of what to do. I'm not scared, maybe a little intimated, but moreover I am amazed.

Is this the creature Luna was on about?

Adora's hand grabs my own and my eyes meet hers.

"Catra we have run."

"You don't understand. It's not what it looks like. She's…"

The creature pounces towards us. If it wasn't for Adora pushing me out the way something scary have happened, even if it wasn't the creatures intentions.

The tugging of Adora's hand snaps me out of my current state and I reluctantly end up running with the others. The creature is quick to follow us, darting high up into the trees to get a better advantage.

"Glimmer are you able to teleport yet!?"

Adora asks as we quickly catch up to the others.

"Do you not think that I have already tried that!"

ROAR

The creature lands in front of us, hitting the ground with much force, causing the earth beneath us to shake. They start chasing us down another route. Arrow Boy lives up to his name and fires a few arrows but misses. I look back to see what's going on. The creatures looks enraged but scared at the time, *scared for my safety*. I want to tell the others that it's okay but it'll be a bombshell to drop on them, especially when we're running for our lives.

Mreow?

Melog speaks besides me, looking up at me in question the best they can whilst running.

"Do you want to try explaining to them that there is no real danger when *that* creature is chasing. It's not like I haven't tried to tell them Melog, but no of them seem to want to... OOF!"

I bounce off the back of Adora. Everyone has frozen in place. It's a dead end.

Grrrrr... ROAR!

The creature comes prowling towards us once more. Their full scale coming into view. *Talk about intimidating.*

Adora springs into action…

"FOR THE HONOUR OF GRAYSKULL!"

"Adora wait!"

She-Ra appears within a flash of bright blue light, blinding all of us. Adora's transformation is mesmerizing, a stunning sight to witness. I'm surprised she was able to transform with all the issues she was having before. However, now I think about it, we're technically out of Halfmoon's territory.

I wonder if Halfmoon's protective magic was having something to do with it?

The others prepare to attack as well, whilst I worry about how I can stop something serious from happening. The creature takes a harsh swipe at Adora, which she only just manages to dodge. Adora uses this to her advantage and lunges forward, narrowly missing the creatures paw and secondary swipe. She does however trip of the way of the creatures tail and she falls to the ground.

"ADORA!"

I desperately try to get Adora's attention but my cries are no use. The others surge forward to help her but Melog holds them back. Thank stars they can sense the same thing as me in this moment. I wouldn't be able to stop them all.

Whilst Melog holds back the others, I turn my attention to the ongoing battle. The creature in question looks at me worried, they're only trying to protect me. When the creature sees Adora blocking their path towards me, they growl deeply and get ready to pounce and attack once more.

Both charge towards each other with an alarming force. It's my quick thinking of diving between them both with my arms keeping them at a set distance that forces the two of them to come to an abrupt stop.

Adora almost runs into me and slips slightly. She looks to me confused...

"Catra what are you doing?"

The creature roars at me as if telling me to get out the way. I growl back, which ultimately gets the creature to retreat to their defensive stance. Once settled, their body posture becomes more relaxed, but their hard glare remains on Adora. I'm not about to lose either of them, *not again.*

"It's difficult to explain but it's not what it looks like. Adora, right now I need you to trust me and to get rid of She-Ra!"

"But…"

"Adora please... trust me."

Adora reluctantly allows She-Ra to fade. As she does, the others also let down their defensive stance and Melog's mane changes from a fiery red to a bright blue colour. Adora looks more confused than ever when I whisper my word of thanks. She goes to question me but I stop her…

“Trust me.”

Turning to the now calm creature I slowly walk towards them. In the distance I can see their allies coming forward but they stop when they see the scene unfolding before them. Cautiously, I reach the palm of my hand out towards the creature and let them come to me. When their forehead gently touches my hand a bright blue light appears and the creature fades. Luna stands tall and proud in their place.

Luna lets out a sigh of relief that she hadn’t realised that she had been holding. She slowly comes forward and pulls me into a tight hug, which I return with as much loving strength. I can sense that the others behind me are a little confused, possibly even gobsmacked by what they have witnessed.

Guess I have some explaining to do?

Luna releases me from her hold and looks to me with great concern…

“Are you okay? Did they hurt you?”

“I’m fine. I promise. They didn’t hurt me. They’re my friends. They were just scared that's all. They were only trying to protect me as I didn’t have the chance to explain all this to them yet.”

I turn to look to Adora and walk over to her. She slowly wraps her arms around me and I do the same, instantly relaxing in her hold. The immediate result is that I start purring up a storm. Adora whispers a silent *“sorry. I should have listened. I was only trying to protect you.”* to me but I tell her *“it’s okay. You didn’t know.”*

After a moment or two, I slightly adjust in Adora’s hold so I can face both her and Luna properly…

“Okay so this is not how I planned on introducing you two to each other but Adora, this is Luna… She’s my mom.”

“WHAT!”

As if in unison all of my friends and the Magicat guards that have followed us shout at the same time. The only one who didn't shout was Adora. Instead she looks shocked. She looks like she's been stunned with one of the Horde's standard issued stun batons. Believe me, we know what that feels like... *ouch.*

One of the Magicat protectors, one who appears young in age comes forward…

"Your Majesty… is it true? Your long lost daughter has returned? I'll admit I had my suspicions before when I saw her with you but I didn't want to assume anything."

Luna smiles and inhales deeply. She looks to me in question, and I nod letting her know that it is okay to tell them…

"Yes Jax. It is true. The young Magicat you see before you is my daughter."

Jax's jaw drops and they practically squeal...

"This calls for a celebration!"

Jax attempts to run back over to the other Magicats to tell them the news but Luna stops them. By the look in her eyes I can tell she worries that this is not what I'd want but I quickly put her thoughts at ease.

"It's okay Luna. We can celebrate if you want. There's no point in hiding it now the truth is out."

Luna smiles and orders Jax to report the news to the others. I guess tonight we'll be celebrating. From one of the trees behind us, Dusk the owl flies over to Luna and perches on her shoulder. This alone appears to be enough to snap Adora out of her shocked trance.

"It was them! That's the owl that lead me to you."

Luna looks to Adora confused and then over to Dusk...

“Who, this owl? This is Dusk. She’s my companion. She was the one who lead me here. I think she knew that this was where you and your friends would evacuate to.”

Okay now I’m certain that this owl is up to something. First she leads me to Halfmoon. Then she leads me to Luna. After that she guides Adora to me and now she’s managed to guide Luna to where my friends and I would come to hide… none of it makes any sense!

Unexpectedly, Dusk flies over from Luna’s shoulder and onto Adora’s. At first Adora is unsure how to react. She’s never seen an owl up this close before. Dusk's moves her head side to side as if she is inspecting Adora, trying to work out who she is. It’s wouldn’t surprise me, especially not after Adora transformed into She-Ra.

Thankfully, Dusk doesn’t seem spooked by Adora's character and nuzzles up against her cheek. Adora softly giggles just like she did when Melog first said hello to her. Adora gives Dusk a little scratch on the head before she fly’s back over to Luna’s shoulder. Seeing Adora smile makes my heart feel warm and fuzzy.

“Did I forget to mention that Adora is an animal lover?”

“I don’t recall you ever mentioning it. I also don’t remember you mentioning anything about your other friends either.”

Luna smiles and looks behind Adora and over to our friends. They’re standing a short distance away from us, waving nervously. I encourage them over with the tip of my head and with a little nudge from Melog they soon come to stand besides Adora and I.

“Luna meet my friends. Entrapta is over there. She’s the science geek who found the ruins of the original Halfmoon.”

“Oh. You're introducing me first? Okay... *erm...* Hello Catra's mom.”

Entrapta responds in her own unique way of using her hair to wave at Luna, who seems fascinated by its movements. If I recall correctly I had the same reaction when I first met Entrapta. *Must be a Magicat thing.*

"This is Scorpia. She's one of my oldest friends besides Adora. We met back when we in the Horde. Be careful because she's a strong hugger."

"Hi. Oh wow… it's an honour to meet you." Scorpia says as she reaches her claw out, shaking Luna's hand.

Luna smiles knowingly at Scorpia...

"It's nice to see you again Scorpia."

"Wait have we met before?"

"Yes but it was a very long time ago. You were only little. Your mothers, Autumn and Scarlet, we great friends of mine. I'm so sorry for what happened to them. If you ever want to learn more about them I'm more than willing to tell you more. I'm sure there are some old photos of them somewhere."

Scorpia smiles gratefully. I feel that she might take up that offer one day. Now it's time to get back to introducing Luna to everyone...

"Next to her is Arrow Boy, officially known as Bow. He is really good at making certain forms of technology for his arrows."

Bow reaches out his hand and shakes Luna's own as he speaks...

"It's a pleasure to meet you. Not to brag but I like to consider myself a tech-master, although some of my inventions are still experiments."

Luna hums and smiles as she speaks...

"Pleasure to meet you Bow. You know, I recon Jax would be interested in your arrow tech. They are an archer themselves so I recon you two would get on well.

Bow's eyes lights up with Sparkles in his eyes when he hears of a fellow archer in Brightmoon. Oh and speaking of Sparkles...

“This is his girlfriend Sparkles, formally known as *Queen* Sparkles. We call her that because if you haven’t already noticed she sparkles…”

Glimmer shoves me in the shoulder slightly and amusing grumbles. I laugh slight as she address's Luna properly...

“Glimmer! My name is Glimmer your majesty. I’m the current queen of Brightmoon. Your daughter here likes to try and annoy me with the nickname she has for me. Jokes on her though as I quite like it.”

Luna giggles sightly to herself but suddenly stops. She look as if she is thinking about something. After a second or two, Luna smiles brightly, maybe slightly shocked, almost as if she has realised something...

“Glimmer? You don’t happen to be Queen Angella’s and King Micah’s daughter are you?”

Sparkles smiles when Luna speaks of her parents… “Yes I am. Do you know my parents?”

“Do I! Glimmer they were my wife and I’s best friends. We used to on many adventures together. I remember when your mom told us that she was expecting you. I’m sorry that I never got the chance to meet you until today. You look so much like her. Angella and Micah must be very proud.”

Sparkles smiles, doing her best to hold back tears. Arrow Boy pulls her into a side hug and Adora does the same but to me instead. I think Adora can tell that there is still some stuff that I have yet to tell Luna about.

Mreow

Melog at some point has gone from my side and sat next to Luna, nudging up against her leg. She reaches down and gives them a good scratch behind their ears exactly how they like it. They lean into her touch and start to purr. I giggle slightly. They'll do anything for attention. At least Luna seems to like Melog. It's difficult to not fall in love with them...

"That's Melog. They're my Krytian friend that I told you about earlier."

"They're cute. Dusk has a new rival."

SCREECH

Dusk screeches at Luna in disapproval, which makes Luna laugh. She makes a suggestion instead…

"Alright. Maybe not a rival but perhaps a new friend?"

Dusk starts to inspect Melog from Luna's shoulder, before flying down and landing on their back. Both Melog and Dusk look at each other curiously, examining each other. They exchange a few friendly sounds between them before they start to chase each other back towards the cave opening, almost like they're playing a game.

The last thing I want is for them to get lost. Therefore, I turn to my friends...

"Are you okay to go and follow them. Make sure they don't get lost. Adora and I will catch up in a moment."

The others smiles at us, before following Melog and Dusk deep into the woods. I want to be able to introduce Adora to Luna properly without everyone else around.

"Finally, this is Adora."

Adora smiles nervously and reaches out her hand to shake Luna's…

"It's a pleasure to meet your majesty."

Luna takes Adora hand and smiles...

"Oh please none of this formal *'your majesty'* malarkey. Please… call me Luna."

"Okay, Luna. Sorry for taking a strike at you with She-Ra before. I was only trying to protect Catra. If I had known who you were I wouldn't have gone all *'Princess of Power'* mode on you."

Adora giggles nervously, maybe feeling a little guilty, but I give her hand a reassuring squeeze. Luna, unphased by what has happened, simply smiles and answers…

"Don't worry about it. I understand. You were simply trying to protect someone you care about."

Adora smiles and becomes more relaxed. She looks to me for reassurance. Gently, I lean up and kiss Adora's cheek and rest my head against her shoulder. At that point, my cheeks start to blush even, releasing what I have done in front of Luna. When my eyes turn and find Luna's, it becomes clear that she has a teasing smirk creeping on her face...

"I have heard many things about you Adora, good things rest assured, but judging from my daughter's blushing I feel that there is something more she is yet to tell me."

Adora starts blushing too. She wraps an arm around my shoulder and squeezes me softly. My tail moves to loosely wrap around her lower leg. Adora's beaming smile is all it takes for me to confirm Luna's suspicions...

"As you know Adora found me when I first got to the Horde. She gave me my name and took care of me. We made a promise to look out for each other no matter what: *'nothing really bad can*

happen as long as we have each other'. Growing up was difficult to say the least. We went through a lot to get to where we are today but everything turned out okay because I had Adora."

It's at this moment I look away from Luna and back to Adora. Her eyes threaten to tear up but she holds them back for me. Her smile is the most beautiful one that I have ever seen. Her mesmerizing blue eyes show an outpour of love...

"Adora was my everything. She is my everything. It took me a long time to realise that this feeling I had for her was something more than friendship. It was love. I was in love with Adora. I always had been. I was scared at first, afraid that she didn't feel the same way about me… but she did. She always did."

Looking back at Luna, it becomes clear that she is also trying to hold back tears. The good thing is they're happy tears. I know that from the way she is smiling…

"Adora… she's my soulmate. I can't wait for the day when I officially get to call her my wife."

That's all it takes for Adora's and Luna's tears to fall, which in turn causes me to let some tears stray as well. I would usually hug Adora when I get like this but it only feels right to go and hug Luna first. I give Adora a gentle squeeze of my tail before I make my way over to hug Luna. When Luna hugs me, I notice her reach out a hand towards Adora, pulling her into our warm embrace as well. It takes a few moments for our happy tears to subside. All of us aggressively trying to wipe our tears away like they were never there.

"Look at me. I thought I was out of tears for the day."

Luna says giggling softly. Adora and I end up giggling with her…

"How about we head back inside and get ready to celebrate your return *and* your engagement. However, we can keep that part a secret between us for a while if you'd like. Their can be a small celebration between us and your friends for that later if you want.

I'll have some guest rooms set up for you and your friends so you can spend the night if you'd like. I'll also get your *Sparkly* friend to send out a message to let her parents know that she is safe and with me."

The mention of Sparkles's parents causes my breathing to hitch slightly. I don't know how I'm going to explain the portal incident and Angella's absence to Luna. Adora picks up on this and answers for me…

"That sounds great. Thank you."

Luna smiles and leads us back the way we came. We meet up with the others on the way. Sparkles lingers at my side with her teasing smirk…

"Sooooo… Queen Luna is your mother. You know what that means right?"

"Don't even go their Sparkles."

Sparkles and Arrow Boy start to laugh when Adora looks at them blankly...

"What does it mean?"

"Really Adora? It means Catra is a *Princess*."

Adora stops when she realises that Sparkles has just confirmed my once *'worst fear'*. I grumble slight and try to catch Sparkles, but she runs off into distance before I can catch her. She and the others start to laugh even harder.

"I'm going to kill your friends."

"Please don't."

Adora laughs slightly now she understands what Sparkles means. Her all too familiar devilish smirk starts to appear across her face…

"So you're a princess? Does that mean I get to call you that next time we…"

"What?.. No!.. Shut up!"

Adora bursts out laughing even harder…

"Aww come on why not, *princess*."

"Knock it off. Besides that's my name for you. You can't call me that when that's my name for you."

Adora giggle-snorts and pulls me into a tight hug from behind, which later turns out to be a strategy to tickle me…

"Ah Adora! S-Stop it! Ha! Get off!"

With little force, I break free from Adora's grasp, laughing as I try to tackle her, which she expertly dodges. We end up chasing each other, eventually catching up to the others so we can head back to Halfmoon together and join in with the celebration.

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The feast is huge. The party is extravagant. Life bursts into colour all around. I'm surprised they managed to get the place decorated and organized within such a short space of time. The fireworks are creative too, colourful and bright, but completely silent. It's nice to be able to admire something without the unfortunate effects that come with sensitive hearing.

Entrapta sees the event as a chance to get some data on *'social behaviour'*. Scorpia has decided to join her to keep her from doing something that might have the other Magicats questioning her antics. Arrow Boy is talking to one of the Magicat guards, Jax I believe their name was, after Luna introduced them to each other.

They seem to be sharing ideas about arrows and designs. Melog is off somewhere in the bush, playing hide and seek with a few of the younger Magicats who have taken an interest in them. They were initially with Dusk the owl but she has disappeared somewhere. Melog doesn't seem to mind though, they're liking the attention.

Sparkles and Adora are near one of the side trees talking with Luna. They're smiling, maybe even laughing. It makes my heart soar to see Luna, *my mom*, getting on well with my friends, *my found family*. I walk over to them, interested in the conversation that is taking place.

"Hey Catra. Over here." Adora calls, taking my hand as I get closer.

"*Hey Adora*... What are you guys talking about?"

Sparkles giggles slightly before she answers me...

"*Oh nothing much…* a part from the fact that I now agree with Adora over how cute you were in your kitten years."

"I'm sorry what?"

Adora starts to laugh as well as she hugs my waist...

"Luna showed Glimmer and I the picture she has of you from when you were a kitten. You know the one with you, her and your other mother Dawn." Adora states as Luna hands me the picture… "You look even fluffier than I remember."

"Well you did want to name me fluffy at one point. Which I am so glad you didn't…"

"The only reason I didn't was because you growled at me. Although now I think of it, even that was cute. You were cute and you still are."

"I am not cute!"

Adora, Sparkles and Luna all start laughing at my protest, causing my cheeks to burn bright red. I grumble slightly and I hand the picture back to Luna who is next to speak...

“They’re not wrong Catra. You were a very cute kitten. Your mama would probably say the same thing even now after all these years.”

Luna’s expression falls slightly as she looks up towards toward the sky. It’s clear that the day will soon be coming to an end, judging from the fading sun light coming through the gaps within the mountain top. Luna sighs quietly before addressing us again...

“Well this has been lovely but I *unfortunately* have somewhere I need to be. Please, go and enjoy the rest of your evening. Explore a bit, see what Halfmoon has to offer. Your rooms are prepared for you should you choose to retire for the night. Should you need me, Catra will show you where I rest.”

Luna says her goodbyes and makes her way into the thick overgrowth, heading towards Halfmoon castle. She makes sure to give Melog a scratch on their head before passing them by.

Should I follow her? There’s so much I want to ask, so much I want to know.

Adora gently nudges my shoulder and whispers in my ear… “What are you waiting for? Follow her.”

I look to Adora, her encouraging smiles telling me to go but what about her and the others…

“Are you sure? What about you?”

“I’ll be okay. I have Glimmer and the others to keep me company. I can tell you have question you want to ask Catra, so why not go and ask her. I’ll meet you in our room when you come back.”

Reaching up, I lightly peck Adora on the lips, a silent thank you some might say. I ask Melog to keep an eye on Adora for me

whilst I’m gone. I don’t want to have to deal with another drunk Adora case, especially not tonight. Who knows how long she’ll last on Halfmoon's drinks. Once that’s settled, I follow Luna from a distance into the bush, letting her guide me to our next destination.

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Following at a far distance, Luna guides me to an area just outside of new Halfmoon's territory. It’s a cave opening, well hidden by an overhanging vine drape that is located behind the castle. *There appears to be a lot of caves and tunnels around here.* It leads outside of the protected area and into another part of the Whispering Woods that I have never seen before. To be honest, it doesn’t even look like it’s a part of the Whispering Woods that I know. It’s like it’s a completely separate part all together, an area that can only be reached by going through new Halfmoon itself.

Luna comes to a stop when she enters a flower bed of pure white chrysanthemums. If Perfuma was here right now, she’d be telling me that these flowers represent love and well-being, but also resemble peace and memory...

How do I even know that! Urgh I’ve been spending too much time with the flower princess and Scorpia.

Luna reaches down and carefully cuts a bunch of flowers from their roots with the gentle, precise swipe of a single claw. She then takes a piece of string from her pocket and ties the flowers together in a neat bow. She smells them, taking in their heavenly scent. Unexpectedly, Luna smiles and then turns to face my direction. Doing my best to not get caught, I quickly hide behind the nearest tree. I hear her giggle slightly.

“You should know from being Magicat yourself that hiding will not do you any good. I can pick up your scent over a mile away.”

Damn it! *How did I forget about that?*

Accepting the fact that I have been detected, I give in and walk to stand beside Luna. She smiles when I join her.

“Guess I forgot you were a Magicat for a moment there.”

Luna laughs but her smile quickly fades. Guess I better explain what I was doing hiding…

“I wasn’t spying I promise. I just wanted to see if you were okay. You seemed a bit upset back at the celebration.”

Luna looks up to the sky, the last remaining daylight is fading fast. She then looks to me and smiles as she speaks…

“There is someone I need to go and see tonight. You’re more than welcome to join me if you’d like.”

Sensing that Luna's word are probably a silent request more than an offer, I decide to join her. If I'm being honest, I can tell from her body language that she doesn't really want to be alone and that she is happy I have followed her. We continue to walk further up the path ahead, the only sound that can be heard comes from the whistle of the wind.

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I’m not sure how long we have been walking but we come to a steady stop when the canopy of trees disperse. The surrounding area seems to be enclosed by tightly packed trees and large rock faces behind them. The sky above the trees is clear, open to see the sunrise and sunset at the start and end of the day. The night

sky will soon appear and be filled with the brightest stars imaginable. This place feels slightly enclosed but also safe and secure. To my right is a tall standing waterfall, which turns into a smooth flowing stream heading across our current path. There are stepping stone across the water, leading to a small area of land on the other side.

Luna takes a deep breath before stepping over the stones leading to the other side. I am quick to follow, being extra cautious to not lose my footing. Last thing I want is to fall into the water. I'm not sure how deep it is.

When we reach the other side, it becomes clear to me where Luna has brought us. There is a tall standing tree, one that is great to sit in and enjoy the view. It turns out that this is where Dusk, Luna's companion owl, has come to roost. She is perched up on the large tree branch that provides shade for the stone carved bench that sits across from it at a slight angel. Dusk watches our every move curiously. The faint sound of Luna's footsteps leaving my side captures my attention. She walks forward a few paces before carefully crouching down, placing the flowers she picked neatly on the grassy floor in front of a well-crafted stone. She then re-stands and backs away slowly, coming to sit on the bench behind her.

This is Dawn's memorial: her final resting place.

"I wish she could see you know. She'd probably hold you tight and never let you go."

Luna speaks with a smile on her face, tears threatening to fall from her eyes. I move to sit beside her on the bench, letting my thoughts wander for a little while.

"How did you two meet?" I ask curiously.

"Well that's a story to tell. We were young, probably eight or nine. I snuck out one day as my parents were getting on my nerves. They were trying to lecture me on the *'idealist of a future queen*'

and how I was not meeting their expectations. I never wanted to be queen but I knew that one day I would have to lead the Magicat kingdom. I just didn't want to be someone I wasn't. I didn't want to be made into some authority figure were I wasn't free to live my life how I wanted. I wanted to be myself, to live my life full of adventure and to rule my kingdom how I felt best for my people. My parents were very old in terms of the society outlook and didn't like that my views were different to their own, so I snuck out to *'cool-off'* as Dawn would have said. I got about three quarters of the way away from home when Dawn, *your mama*, feel out a tree and landed right on top of me, practically crushing me."

That has me laughing, which also has Luna laughing too. I guess Dawn is the reason why I'm not the type of Magicat who lands on my feet. Once my laughter dies down I manage to speak…

"Take it she was one for making quite the entrance."

Luna wipes a single tear of laughter away from her eyes before she responds to me…

"Oh she was. It was also at that exact moment that I learnt that not all Magicats land on their feet. Anyway, when she got up off me we noticed that she got her tail stuck in a gap in the tree. The impact broke the top part of her tail. At first she panicked and was worried as she didn't know what to do. She was in a lot of pain. I however, *as you already know*, am a self-taught healer. I had been practicing my abilities not long before I first met Dawn but had not been able to be heal anyone successfully, but I still offered to try and help. I managed to get your mama to calm down and I was able to fully heal her tail. It might have left a slight kink in her tail tip but it was the best I could do and her pain was gone. It was the first time I had ever successfully healed someone."

Luna smiles brightly, almost as if she is reliving that day. It's nice to see her smile. It suites her.

"So I take it that's how you two became friends?"

“Yeah it is. We spent a lot of our time together after that. Dawn didn’t see me as royalty. She saw me for who I truly was. She liked me for me. I didn't have many friends growing up so Dawn was special to me. She was my best friend.”

Luna inhales deeply and I see her shake her head slightly as she finishes her sentence…

“My parents however were not so sure what to make of her simply because she was different.”

“Different? Different how?” I ask curiously.

Luna takes a moment of silence to herself. I can see the cogs ticking away in her mind, trying to work out how best to answer me. When Luna has the answer she faintly smiles…

“Your mama was an inventor. An artist. She loved to tinker and create new inventions that could help people. She also loved to draw and paint. It was her family’s trade. Back then it wasn’t considered *'normal'* for a Magicat to be into that sort of stuff, but it was one of the many things that made me fall in love with her. She started to show me how to create new and interesting things such as hand crafted arts and how to paint using different techniques. Alternatively, I started to get her to explore the wonders that Etheria had to offer, getting her to connect with nature and the magic that flows through the Whispering Woods.”

Well I’m starting to see little bits of how I am like my mothers. It’s clear that I get my creative side from Dawn if she was an artist and my singing talent from Luna.

I wonder what else we have in common?

Smiling brightly, I carefully listen to every word Luna speaks...

“I enjoyed spending time with Dawn. It was a nice distraction for the both of us. I, *as you can probably guess*, had some issues with my parents because I wasn’t meeting their views on how they felt a royal should lead. Some say I had it rough having to

live up to so many expectations but Dawn had it worse. She sadly lost her mother at a young age, leaving her father to raised her. For a long time they only had each other. Sadly he too died some years later when she just turned fifteen. His dying wish was that we looked after each other and that we'd find happiness in dark times with each others light. I was there for her through it all, the good and the bad. We started to become closer…"

The classic friends to lovers trope. Sound familiar to anyone?

"It was scary when I first started having feelings for your mama. It was not as simple for me as going up to my parents and asking what this strange, *new,* yet wonderful sensation was. The only person I could talk to about it was your mama, and that was increasingly difficult not to make it obvious."

A faint snicker escapes me as I can guess what's coming...

"Let me guess… *it was obvious?*"

"Oh yeah completely obvious! So much so your mama teased me about it for ages. She never let me live it down. It was torture, but in a loving way."

Unable to control my laughter I start to giggle. This is almost as funny as Adora and I coming to terms with our feelings for one another. However, the only difference there is that we were both useless lesbians who were too scared to make the first move. If it wasn't for the end of the world moment happening in front of us, I wonder how things might have turned out. Besides, I knew that I loved Adora, I just never thought she'd feel the same way about me. I wanted her, but I was scared of rejection and loosing what we had only just regained so I kept my feelings hidden.

Luna has started to giggle with me. She tries to form words thought her laughter…

"Looking back now I should have seen through her teasing. Turns out she felt the exact same way about me for a long time but was too scared to say anything, scared that her feelings wouldn't be

reciprocated and we'd lose the friendship we had. So, after confession how we felt about one another, we gave into our feelings and decide to give it a go. For a while everything in our relationship seemed perfect. We were happy, we were in love... but it wasn't as simple as it seemed."

Luna's once bright smiles starts to fade and her ears move to lie flat against her head. Her tail behind us stills it's movements and her words become some form of silent whisper…

"For a long time we had to keep our relationship secret. My parents didn't mind the fact that we were friends, *but lovers*, I feared that that would set them off. It wasn't so much the fact that I was in love with Dawn, it was that I was in love with someone they didn't approve off as an eligible member of a royal family. Unfortunately for your mama and I, they somehow found out about our relationship and they never spoke to me again unless they had to. By that I mean *'diplomatic matters'*. Even then they only spoke to me when addressed. I swear it was the old general who told them. Dawn and I never liked the bastard anyway. However, it was quite funny when Dawn gave them a piece of her mind. I'd never seen them look so scared before in their lives. They were cowering with the tails between their legs after that whenever they saw her"

Luna smiles slightly as her hand moves to hold her sun necklace in her hand. She takes a deep breathe and speaks once more…

"I ended up becoming leader of the Halfmoon when I turned nineteen. Many had mixed views on my outlook as queen but I knew I could do it. I wasn't going to be like my parents. I was going to make way for a better future. My first official decree was to join the Rebellion, to forge new alliances and come out of hiding. For my coronation, Dawn created me my crimson red mask, the one that I gave to you that fateful night. I wasn't given a crown or a sentiment piece which all royals should receive when they turn sixteen. As my parents didn't approve of me I never received one. I discussed with Dawn about dropping royal statues after all that happened so that no one ever felt the need to rule if

they didn’t want to. However, even though I did eventually come to that decision, Dawn made me a royal sentiment piece, reminding me that although I many not have wanted to be Halfmoon’s queen, *heck* I was a good leader and that deserved to be recognised.”

Luna’s eyes then move to look at Dawn's memorial grave. She smiles brightly but a few tears threaten to fall from her eyes. She swallows them back as she does her best to finish her tale…

“Your mama proposed to me a year later on the anniversary of the night we first met. Our wedding was a small one but we celebrated with the most important people in our lives. Although we exchanged rings for our wedding, we also followed Etheria’s old tradition of exchanging personal items. However, we wanted to be creative so we made each other something unique. Dawn made me this gold sun necklace. I always used to say how much I loved to watched the sun rise as it reminded me of her. Her bright smile, her beautiful eyes, her warmth… she was my soulmate.”

A few tears happen to escape Luna’s eyes and she has to take a moment to wipe them way. As she does so, my tail gently moves to stroke to tip of her tail. I hold myself back from saying any words as I know Luna will speak in a moment or two when she’s ready…

“Secretly, I had been taking craft classes and I made her a silver arm shield with a blue gem at its centre. Dawn always said she loved the colour blue as it matched my eyes and the night sky. When the gem was pressed, the arm plate opened up to be an artist kit. I purposefully made it so that she could tinker when out and about on our many adventures.”

Luna hums softly and takes a moment or two to collect her thoughts. She still has a gentle hold on her sun necklace when she speaks again…

“For our wedding itself I wore a dress and she wore a suit, a hint of blue and white within both our styles. We didn’t see each other

the day before the ceremony and my stars it was hell. We missed each other so much. So much so we forgot about the crowds and shared a kiss before the wedding even began. The reason I picked those flowers for her grave was because she wore one on her jacket lapel on our wedding day. I had a bouquet of them. They were our favourite flowers. It was one of the best days of my life, marrying my soulmate. I thought life couldn't get any better but then we were blessed with you… our little miracle."

Blushing slightly, my hand moves to rub the back of my neck, feeling a little embarrassed for some strange reason. I giggle nervously. My eyes avoid Luna's warm, loving gaze...

"I wouldn't go as far as calling me a miracle."

Luna leans forward and places her hand over mine, forcing me to look at her…

"But it's true Catra. You were our little miracle. You see, your mama and I… having a child didn't come as easy for us as we hoped."

Curiosity leads me to ask more...

"What do you mean by that?"

Luna's eyebrows furrow in contemplation. She's definitely trying to figure out how to word this without making it sound awkward…

Please don't let this be another version of the birds and the bees talk. It was bad enough having to sit through that one mandatory lecture in the Horde on 'Mammalian Reproduction 101' when we were thirteen. All I'm going to say is that Adora and I are way past that part in our relationship.

"Well, you see… Magicats can do *many* impressive things, including being able to conceive with partners of the same sex."

Oh no! Does that mean..?

My fur starts to bristle on end and inner panic starts to set. Either Luna can read my mind or read my body language almost perfectly as she quick to ease my worrying thoughts…

"It's not like that! You don't need to worry about that! I should have mentioned that only Magicats with other Magicats are able to do that, and only at *certain times* when the moment is right. If you and Adora ever choose to have kids of your own you'd probably have to go to Mystacor for some help."

Almost as if I had forgotten how to breathe, my body forces me to take a few steadying, deep breathes. Out of curiosity my hand flies to my chest to check my pulse rate. It feels like my heart is about to explode…

"Geez Luna! Don't scare me like that. Did you not think of perhaps mentioning that part first?"

I'm not even sure if I want kids. I'm not even sure if Adora wants kids. We didn't exactly have a great parent figures to look up to when we were growing up. If the time ever came where Adora and I would consider maybe having kids, I would at least like to discuss it with her before that happens.

Luna laughs slightly, easing the mood in the atmosphere. She gave me quite a scare. Once Luna's laughter dies down she looks over to Dawn's memorial and she continues to talk…

"As I was saying, having kids didn't come easy for your mama and me. We had always wanted children, we had discussed it for a long time, but life seemed to have other plans. I started to think that I wasn't good enough to be a mom and Dawn started to worry that she was the problem. We went for examinations in Mystacor and for help but nothing seemed to work despite all being fine with us biologically. It felt like we were being punished but for what we didn't know. It took its toll on both of us. At one point, not long after we found out about the war that was beginning to arise, we came to accept the fact that we might be

one of those couples who sadly would never be able to have children of their own. It's something we learned to accept."

There is a hint of sadness in Luna's voice. It mustn't have been easier for her or Dawn. I know what it's like to feel useless and unwanted and like you're being punished for simply trying, but those feeling happened to me for completely different reasons. However, Luna's smile soon returns. She looks to me from the corner of her eyes and speaks once again…

"That was until I started being really unwell one day. At first I thought it was food poisoning because Magicats rarely get sick. However, as the days of sickness continued I thought it to be something more, but I refused to let myself hope. After so long of trying one tends to lose hope of any hopeful outcome, but your mama advised that I did a test anyway so I did. Your mama sat by my side nervously as we waited for the result. Shortly after, we found out that I was pregnant with you. I can't even begin to tell you how many hours I cried with tears of joy. The whole castle thought your mama had gone mad as she did zoomies for I don't know how many hours. Dawn would talk to you before we went to bed at night, read you bedtime stories and you would kick her hand when she placed it over my belly. You gave a few fair kicks that I remember. You could be a little shit at times as you never missed your target but I didn't care as long as you were okay. We were so excited to meet you, but then some changes started to worry us…"

Luna's eyes turn saddened and her ears move to lie flat against her head again. She has to take a steadying breather before she continues...

"About four weeks from your due date I started to sense that something was wrong. You stopped moving as much. You weren't responding as quick to your mama's touch. Your kicks weren't as strong, sometimes they were absent. We started to worry so your mama and I went to have you checked… you ended up being born early."

Surprisingly, shock takes over me a little bit. I'm not sure why but it does. I guess it's just scary to hear. Scary to hear that even before my life had officially begun I was fighting to survive. Luna notices the shiver in my body and moves slightly close to me. She places a comforting hand between my shoulder blades in an attempt to ground me. This time instead of continuing her story she checks in with me.

"You okay? I know that might have been quite a shock to hear. It certainly was for your mama and I."

"Yeah… *yeah I'm fine*. Just a bit difficult to hear that I suppose, especially after everything I've been through."

Luna looks to me concerned. I have to be careful what I say as I have yet to tell her about my life in the Horde. Sensing that I'm better changing the subject I ask Luna to tell me more about what happened...

"W-what was it like… when I was born? What happened?"

Luna, after seeing a reassuring smile from myself, notices that I am settled once more, decides continues her story…

"It was a long, difficult labour. To make matters worse your mama and I were only able to hold you for five minutes after you were born before you were taken from us to be put in an incubation pod. I remember looking at you in that pod, fearing for your life. Your eyes were still tightly closed. Your ears lay flat against your head. Your tail remained curled all the time. It pained me when you were restless, mewling for reassurance when the doctors dealt with you because I could do nothing but stand back and watch, letting them do what they needed to do. I want to take you in my arms and tell you it was okay but I wasn't allowed to interfere. I spoke to you just like any Magicat mother would when trying to sooth their kitten but you were still very unsettled when you were separated from us. Your mama and I were only able to hold your tiny hands through the incubation pod holes. It was an upsetting, worrying time for both of us. Your mama and I spent

many nights sleeping by your side. I sang to you each night, helping to sooth you when you whimpered looking for one of us. It would you calm you down almost instantly. Even though you couldn't see us you knew that we were there by your side. Your mama promised me every night that you were strong, that you'd pull through. I'm so thankful that she was right."

Luna's smile returns once more. Her hand leaves my back and comes to rest over mine on the bench. Her eyes leave mine and look towards Dawn's resting place…

"When the four week mark came and all assessments came back clear, we were finally able to hold you again and take you home. Your mama insisted that I held you first, saying that I had done so much to bring you into this world that I should 'officially' say hello first. I held you close and I never wanted to let go. You instantly began purring and started kneading against the fur on my chest. Your mama was nervous to hold you at first. I had to show her what to do, how to support you in her arms. She cried so many tears of happiness and relief that day Catra. We hadn't expected you to open your eyes there and then but you did. One blue, one amber: a reflection of us both. I often said that you heard us saying that we wanted you to have your other mothers eyes, so you decided to share the best of both of us. We had discussed many potential names for you but Dawn suggested a new name in that moment and we knew it was a perfect fit. You were perfect, our little miracle."

Curiosity leads me to ask the next question… "What did you name me?"

"Cyra... although we did just call you kitten a lot of the time. Dawn called you princess once and you hissed at her and I mean *hissed* at her. She called you furball after that. But, like I said before, Adora picked out a really nice name for you… I'm sure you mama would approve."

I laugh slightly as a new thought comes to mind… "Wait till you learn what the full version of my name is. You might think

differently then. Adora's full name is just as bad."

Overwhelmed with emotion I turn to face away from Luna and instead turn my focus to Dawn's memorial…

"My mama… what was she like?"

Luna smiles and looks to me once more before following me line of sight. She hums softly and speaks from the heart…

"She was one of the most caring, loyal, *sometimes goofy*, and wonderful Magicats I have ever met. She never gave up on anyone or anything. Annoyingly, sometimes put other peoples needs before her own. I end up dragging her back to bed some nights, forcing her to rest. However, when you were born all that changed. You became her top priority, her everything. She used to say to me that she worried about you growing up to fast, worrying that she'd lose her little kitten when you became a strong, independent Magicat. Although no matter what you'd always be out little kitten. However, she then used to talk about her hopes for you in the future. She wanted nothing more than for you to be happy, to find someone who loves you and treats you like their everything. I'd say you found that…"

Great, now it's becoming increasing difficult to hold back tears. Don't let your tears fall Catra… not yet.

Luna voice hitches slightly when she tries to speak again...

"After she passed I laid her to rest here, along with so many other innocent lives lost that night. Each one has their own resting place safe within this area. They'll never been disturbed again, simply left to rest in peace and remembered. I took the gem out of her arm shield that I made her and secured it into the centre of my sun necklace. Whenever I miss her or think about her I hold it tightly in my hand. It reminds me that even if we are a part, she is always with me."

Luna leans forward slightly and places a hand on my shoulder. The warm touch alone forces me to look at her, tears threatening

to fall. Ours tails wrap around one another, a comforting gesture that Magicats do...

“Your mama would be very proud of you Catra. She might not be here to see you in person, but she is always in here.”

Luna places a gentle hand over my heart. It’s enough to cause my tears to fall. At the same time Luna starts to cry as well. We hold each other close, letting our emotions wash over us. I really wish I could have known my mama, or at least known her better. She sounds like an amazing Magicat.

How is it possible to miss someone you don’t remember much about?

The final bit of sunlight fades and the night sky awakes. The stars that night shine brighter than ever before as they watch over us.

Chapter End Notes

> Who's cutting onions? Someone pass me the kleenex 🤧 😂
> - Hope you all enjoyed reading chapter nine of Finding Halfmoon. We're so close to the end of the fic with only six chapters left.
>
> I hope you enjoyed the little parts I added about Catra learning more about her mom's and how her life began. There will be more moments between Catra and Luna, especially in the next chapter coming on Monday when we get to see Luna and Catra bonding as Mother and Daughter (Bonus points if you can guess the chapter title 😉).
>
> So what do you think will happen next? Do you recon Catra will tell Luna about her past? Will she ever be able to find the power to address Luna as her mom after all these years? Let us know you thoughts and find out in the next few chapters. Next update is on Monday. See you then. 😊

P.S - There is more to Catra's official full name which you will find out about very soon in a extra content chapter so stay tuned. Also, I know this chapter was a lot of Luna talking so I tried my best to make it flow and keep big, big chunks of text separate. Hope I did okay.

P.S 2 - This chapter is one of the longest there is in this story so thank you for taking the time to read it. It means a lot to me that you're enjoying and commenting on my fic 🥰

Like Mother, Like Daughter

Chapter Summary

> About a month has passed since Catra met Luna and Halfmoon was discovered.
>
> Catra and Luna spend the day together whilst Adora is back in Brightmoon.
>
> Come nightfall, Luna has a surprise for Catra that she has waited years to share with her.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Nearly a month has passed since I first met Luna and the others found me at Halfmoon. Adora and I have spent most of the month here so that I could be closer to Luna whilst I still get to know her as my mom. Time away from Brightmoon and the others has also given Adora and I some much needed relaxation and alone quality time, something we are both *very* grateful for. It's been interesting to learn what it's like to be around other Magicats, to learn about their history, culture and connection with the natural world. Many things that I once might have been called weird for in the Horde turns out to be the norm here.

The others spent about a week here with us before returning to their kingdoms. Sparkles and Arrow Boy visit quite regularly but stay here for no more than a day or two. Life a rulers seems to be a busy one. I think they mainly visit to get away from it all. We have tried to find Madam Razz a few times but so far we've had no luck of finding her or her hut. Knowing the Whispering Woods, the magic is probably telling us that it's not the right time for Luna to meet Razz again just yet. On a more positive note, Micah came to visit last week. Seeing Luna once more brought up all kinds of memories for them both. At first it was like they had seen a ghost, but that quickly faded and the two friends rejoiced in their

reunion. Sadly, the topic of Angella did arise at one point but Micah didn't let it slip that I am the reason as to why his wife, Sparkles's mom and one of Luna's old friends, is trapped between dimensions.

I'm going to have to tell Luna the truth about my past eventually… *but not yet.*

Sparkles and I enjoyed listening to Luna and Micah talk about the stupid stuff our parents got up to in their youth. Turns out Dawn, my mama, was quite the trouble maker, always raiding the kitchens when they had overnight events at Brightmoon and old Halfmoon. Apparently Micah was no different and it was down to Luna and Angella to keep them out of trouble. They also shared some old photos. Even baby Sparkles looked *'glitterfied'*. As for me it was like looking at a reflection of the younger versions of Adora and myself when Luna showed me a picture of her and Dawn: both individuals hopelessly in love but have no idea of their feelings for one another. Funny how pictures can capture moments like that. To say this month has been eventful is an understatement, especially with what Luna has planned for us today.

"Are you sure you're going to be okay? I don't have to go if you need me here."

"Adora I'll fine. It's not like we've not had nights away from each other before. Besides, I'll have Melog to keep me company…"

****SCREECH****

"… and Dusk too. We'll be fine."

Adora and I have claimed one of Halfmoon's guest rooms as our own, with the permission from Luna of course. We've made it our own. It's a similar layout to our room back in Brightmoon but the waterfall is no existent, something that I know Adora misses. The walls are a nice shade of blue and grey, allowing the room to have a calming sensation. Thankfully, unlike Brightmoon, these colours

don’t blind me when I enter the room. We added a few personal touches here and there, including a perch for Luna's owl Dusk as she likes to occasionally fly in through our balcony window sometimes at night and in the morning. We have no idea why but it’s within her routine. Dusk sometimes tries to tuck a stand of fallen hair behind ears before bed. It’s not easy when you have wings and talons but she somehow manages it. *Weird owl.* Melog also has their own bed across the balcony window. They say they enjoy watching the stars at night and watching the sun rise in the morning.

Anyway back to what I was saying, Adora has been summoned to a meeting in Brightmoon. Apparently there are some interstellar matters to attend to and the planet’s council want to speak to She-Ra over the head of the Etheria’s royal alliance. They initially wanted to see me also. Being the royal advisor of Brightmoon has its duties and downsides but Sparkles managed to persuade them that I had more important matters to attend, which I was grateful for. I fear if I leave this place I may not be able to find it again. Unfortunately, the situation for Adora was different. They refused to come to any conclusion without the consultation of Etheria’s hero. Really I think they just want to see Adora in all her She-Ra glory and I can’t really blame them. Adora’s version of She-Ra is… *attractive to say the least.*

“I really wish I didn’t have to leave you. It’s probably nothing important anyway.”

Adora states as she turns on our bed. She wraps her arms tightly around my waist before resting her head over my shoulder, looking at the picture I have almost finished drawing.

“I know but duty calls. At least it's not one of those missions where your gone for days at a time. The worst one was when you were gone for a whole month. Anyway, it's not like I'll have nothing to do. If you remember Luna and I have plans for today. She said she's going to show me how to make Blueberry pie today and then later tonight she wants to show me something, teach me a new skill.”

“Sounds like some mother-daughter bonding time.”

“Yeah, it does doesn’t it.”

KNOCK, KNOCK, KNOCK

Three knocks are heard at our door and a voice sounds from the other side…

“Sorry to disturb you both but that flying talking horse that Catra warned me about is here for Adora. He said his name is Swift Wind and that he would have come in through the balcony window but he’s not sure what room it is… *also that Adora gave him a mouthful the last time him did that because of something he didn’t care to mention,* which again he says he is sorry for.”

The voice in question belongs to Jax, one of Halfmoon's lead generals. They’re pretty decent and polite compared to some other generals from other kingdoms that I have met. They’re a few years older than Adora and I but have enough experience to lead an elite team. According to Luna, their grandfather was the old general before all the chaos that occurred back down in old Halfmoon. Despite Jax being raised by their grandfather, they didn’t have the greatest of relationships. Why that was Luna has never said, but Jax has made remarkable milestones as Halfmoon’s general since his promotion. Arrow boy gets on with them very well. They both have a taste for archery and technology so it’s really no wonder they get on so well.

Adora is the one who answers…

“Thanks Jax. Please let Swifty know that I’ll be down in a moment… and before he asks, yes I do have apples for him.”

With that we hear Jax’s footsteps slowly walk away. I place my art pad down and turn in Adora’s hold so that I am now facing her. My hands run up and down the lapels of her jacket. I can see the worry lingering in Adora’s beautiful blue eyes.

“You call me if you need anything or need me to come back alright… promise.”

“I promise, but I'll be fine. Now you better get going before that horse of yours barges in here by following the smell of those apples.”

Adora laughs and places a soft kiss to my lips. I know it only for a day and one night but I’m going to miss her. Adora gets up from our bed, put her boots on, gives Melog a good scratch under their chin, Dusk a stroke down her back and places another kiss to my forehead…

“I’ll be back tomorrow night. I love you.”

“I love you too dummy. I’ll call you later tonight. Don’t let those space weirdos push you about.”

Mreow?

“Not you Melog. You’re not a weirdo. I was on about the one's from last time.”

Mreow

Adora hums in amusement... “They asked if you meant them didn’t they?”

“Yes they did and I told them that doesn't include them. Melog is a unique and wonderful alien in their own way. Now get going or you’ll have to deal with the rath of Sparkles.”

Adora’s laughter can be heard down the corridor, fading the further she goes. Soon there is only myself, Melog and Dusk left in the room. It’s calm, peaceful, and a little bit too quite for my liking but overall it's nice. It’s been nice to spent some time somewhere new. However, as much as I like Halfmoon, I could never see Adora and I calling this place home. It’s similar to the situation in Brightmoon. I feel like we need somewhere in between both Halfmoon and Brightmoon, a small home in the middle of

nowhere to call our own, if we are ever to truly able to say *'there's no place like home'*.

Looking at the time, I realise that I have about an hour left before Luna asked me to meet her down in the kitchens. That gives me enough time to finish my drawing. Getting comfy on the bed I retake my drawing pad and start to focus on the individual I have been drawing.

Dusk is the perfect little poser. She tends to sit still most of the time unless she is preening. Adora told me that preening means that she is cleaning her feathers, taking them in her beak and brushing through them, sometimes even fluffing up. It's apparently a fancy bird term for grooming. I knew Adora was an animal lover but wow, I didn't think she knew all these fancy terms. Anyway, I've been slowly drawing Dusk over the past few nights when she come to visit. She tends to sit in the same spot and position constantly so that makes it easy to continue with my drawings. Feathers have proven a challenge to draw so it's been interesting to develop that skill. I have shown Luna some of my work before now. She says I have my mama's talent. A keen eye for detail and a gentle hand for style. I hope she likes this one of Dusk too. Dusk is proving not as easy to draw as Melog is but I am always up for a challenge.

"Almost done… and finished."

The final stroke of my fine tip pencil, a little bit of shading to her eyes and it's finished. I can honestly say that I'm impressed with myself, especially with this being my first time drawing an owl.

Dusk's head perks up and she flies from her perch and onto my shoulder. I hold my drawing pad out in front so she can get a better look and she starts to turn her head as if she is inspecting my work...

"What do you think Dusk? Do you approve?"

Dusk's head tilts sideways slightly more before she chirps and flutters her wings. *I guess she likes it.* Dusk brushes herself up against my cheek showing that she in fact does approve. It tickles slightly.

Almost forgetting the time, I look back to the clock and realise that it will soon be time to meet with Luna...

"Well, guess we better get going. Melog, care to join us?"

From their position on their balcony bed, Melog rolls over and stretches, before shaking their wavy mane side to side. They then trot on over me and sit by my feet…

"Of course. I'm your chief bakery taster aren't I? How else do you expect me to taste your pie if I am not there to try it?"

Melog smiles brightly and I give them a scratch behind the ears. I put my drawing pad down on the bedside desk and get ready to start the day. Dusk remains on my shoulder the whole time as the three of us exit mine and Adora's room and make our way down to the kitchens to meet up with Luna.

--

Our journey down to the kitchens is pretty quiet. I'm honestly surprised that I haven't seen many other Magicats this morning. Maybe this is what Halfmoon life is usually like. I have noticed the atmosphere becoming more calm since they are now aware that there is no significant danger. Probably my arrival put them on high alter for a short while. Can't really blame them, especially not if some have somehow found out about my past… *which I doubt but you never know.*

When we arrive at the kitchens Luna is already there. She seems to be preparing some stuff for our baking session. All the basics

are already set out. It's literally just the making and baking part that needs to be done.

Luna notices us when she turns around, fresh blueberries held in a glass bowl…

"Catra. Glad you could make it. How was your night?"

"Hey Luna. It was good thanks. Nice and peaceful. Hope you don't mind but I brought Melog and Dusk along with me."

Melog *murps* and smiles. Dusk flies over to Luna's shoulder and softly pecks at a loose strand of hair. Luna giggles and responds by giving Dusk a good scratch on top of her head...

"Not at all. It'll be nice to spend some time with our little companion friends. As for Dusk, I was wondered where she went last night… *and what is it with you playing with my hair?"*

Luna's attention turns from me to Dusk as she faintly laughs through her words. As she was speaking, Dusk was lightly playing with a few loose strands of Luna's mane. Luna gets Dusk to perch on her hand before walking over to a purpose built perch by the window sill. Dusk fluffs up making herself comfortable. Melog soon joins dusk as they soak up the morning sun.

"I know right? She has a habit of trying to move a strand of fallen hair behind my ears every so often when it falls out of place. My hair is back to that weird phase between being short and growing longer again. It's cute watching her try and sort it with her little talons." I softly giggle as I walk over to the sink to wash my hands.

Luna some comes over to do the same...

"Tell me about it. Dusk has a habit of trying to loosen my hair band when I've had my hair tied up for too long. She'll climb over my shoulder and gently try pulling it out with her beak. She succeeds more times than not, but when she fails she decides to snap the band with her beak. Your mama used to take my hair

out of its braid at night. She'd often have a go at me when I left it in too long, saying that I'd go bald if I didn't let it down once in a while."

"Haha. That's exactly what I said to Adora back when…"

My words run short when I realise what I was about to say. I have yet to tell Luna about Prime, and about all the other stuff that happened in my past. The only reason I haven't yet is… *well…* I'm worried, scared what she'll think of me when she finds out the truth. Things are going so well between us right now and I don't want to screw things up, but I know I'll have to tell her sooner or later.

Luna looks to me curiously waiting for me to finish my sentence. *Quick Catra think!*

"…back when we were cadets in the Horde. Adora's was an early bird so she slept with most of her stuff prepared for the next day, her hair being up was one of them. She was insistent that it saved time. I've only just managed to get her to sleep with her hair down. She says she likes it when I run my claws through it. It soothes her, helps her to relax."

My tone of voice gives Luna the hint than I am partially lying. She looks at me slightly suspicious but doesn't question it. Instead she hums and responds…

"Well that doesn't come as a surprise. You always did like playing with people's hair when you were young. I remember when you were little you used to love running your claws through mine and you mama's mane when we held of you. We'd let you do it for hours as it brought you comfort and helped you to settle. You were very much like your mama in that sense. She always used to tuck any loose strands of hair behind your ears before bed, otherwise you'd be trying to catch them all night. I see more of her in you everyday."

Luna has been more open about Dawn these past few weeks. Adora is convinced that having me around has allowed Luna to process her hidden grief and remember the good times from her past rather than the painful memories. I like hearing about my mama and how some of my mannerisms and talents are like hers but I want to be able to connect to Luna on that level too. So far all I know is that my singing talent comes from Luna. That tune she sang to me on the night we first met was the same song that I used to sing to Adora when she was sick back in the Horde. When I told Adora that I now know where the song came from she was stunned. Finding out that my singing talent is a gift that I have inherited from Luna has made me appreciate my talent more. However, that's the only way I see my connection to Luna at the moment. There's got to more than just that. It's why today is so important to me. I want to get to know Luna better. I want to get to know her as my mom. You know what they say: like mother, like daughter. I need to feel it, I want to see it.

Luna finishes washing her hands and I'm not too far behind. She tosses me an apron...

"Anyway, it's become clear to me that Dusk is very fond of you and Adora. It's nice to see her enjoying spending time with you both. Right get that apron on and let's get baking."

I put on the apron and read what it says on the front… *"Mini Star Baker?"*

"What? It makes sense when you read mine." Luna says as she turns to face me. Her apron says, *'Star Baker.'*

It's so cheesy I can't help but laugh… "Okay that's just... *pftt-ha...* At least it's better than the one Wrong Hordak wears: *'Kiss the Chef'*."

"Who's Wrong Hordak?" - Luna asks, her voice grows stern with concern at the mention of a name familiar to one she recognizes from long ago.

Luna is aware that Hordak is still around but has since been stripped of his titles after the war ended. He has been placed on *'house arrest'* in Dryl under the watchful eye of Entrapta… *and some of the other princesses that she isn't aware of.* However, the name alone is enough to send Luna back into protective mother mode.

Coming over to Luna's side I do my do my best to reassure her that Wrong Hordak is a friend of mine and not a threat. I speak calmly and choose my words carefully...

"Wrong Hordak is a misunderstood friend of mine and Adora's. A good friend of all the Rebellion members actually. He was a defective clone that choose to leave the evil doings of the Horde when he realised he had been lied to all his life. He actually helped us a lot, got us to secret places and gave us some answers that we didn't know we needed until later that helped us to defeat a greater evil. He is nothing like Hordak I promise. Actually, he is the exact opposite. He has a passion for cooking and makes sure that everyone is well fed on our trips. He even remembers everyone's favourite meals. If you ever get to meet him just give him a chance. You'll see what I mean."

Luna seems cautious at first but then sighs in defeat knowing that my request is reasonable…

"I suppose it would be wrong of me to not to give someone a fair chance having never me them before. I know far too well that you should never judge a book by its cover. You should always give them the benefit of the doubt before making a judgement… Alright. If I ever get to meet this Wrong Hordak friend of yours I promise to keep an open mind, but we'll cross that bridge when we come to it. But now it's time to bake."

Luna and I spend the next hour creating, baking and decorating our blueberry pie. It's a bit of a messy job. We end up having a flour fight with some of the left over supplies because why not, we're all children at heart. Melog gets covered in flour and joins in, whereas Dusk does not seem overly impressed. We also draw

little faces in the flour left on the counter from making the pastry. I draw my usual little sketch, whereas Luna draws a *'tiger-like'* creature against a moon. The drawing leads me to be curious.

Is this clue towards what Luna has planned for tonight? I know it's meant to be a surprise but I can't help but wonder. She could be leaving clues throughout the day about tonight.

When I look to Luna she has the sneaky smirk on her face. *Yep this is definitely a clue.* As I go to ask what it means the timer dings, letting us know that the pie is officially baked.

Luna passes me a pair of oven mitts… "So you don't burn your hands. Would you like to do the honours."

Luna opens the door whilst I remove the pie. We clean up our mess whilst we wait for the pie to cool down a bit. It smells delicious but the question is *'does it taste any good?'*

Once cool enough Luna cuts three standard slices for me, her and Melog, and a tiny slice of her piece for Dusk. I didn't think an owl would like to eat pie but then again if I've learnt anything over the course of this month, it's that Dusk is no ordinary owl.

"Ready to try your pie?"

Luna asks with a smile on her face. She places the plate and slide down in front of me.

"Definitely. I've never made one before so this will be interesting. Melog is usually my chief bakery taster so I hope you like it buddy."

Tucking into the pie it feels like I've entered heaven. It tastes exquisite, delicious, perfect if I do say so myself.

"Not bad for my first attempt if I do say so myself. What do you think Melog?"

"I would like to place an order for mini blueberry pies please. These are delicious."

Chirp

"This is really good Catra and I think Dusk likes it too with that sound. This is really good for your first attempt. Tastes better than I could ever make it. We'll have to do this more often if you'd like. I could show you some other stuff that I love to bake."

Blushing slightly I respond to Luna… "I'd like that. I enjoyed getting to bake with you. This… this was nice."

We tuck into the rest of the pie, being sure to save a slice for Adora when she gets back later tomorrow night. With our bellies full and a few hours left till sunset, Melog decides to go and sleep off some of the pie, saying that they'll meet me later tonight. Dusk decides to follow them but I doubt she'll be going for a nap. She tried sleeping on Melog's back once before and they nearly crushed her when they rolled over thanks to their sheer size. It was funny to say the least and thankfully no birds were crushed.

Luna and I are the only ones left in the kitchen now, contemplating what to do next…

"So, what do we do now?"

Luna appears to be thinking before her eyes light up with an idea...

"Well, if you're up for it, I can show you the training grounds we have here. I noticed that you and Adora quite like sparring when you get the chance but the bushes don't provide you with much cover."

Oh Shit! She noticed that? Thankfully we were just having a friendly sparring match after Adora challanged me to a tickle fight and nothing more… but why?... oh great now my cheeks are burning even more. Why does this always have to happen to me?! URGHH!

I try my best to laugh off my embarrassment before responding to Luna...

“Sure. What’s in these training simulations?”

Luna smiles and stands, offering out her hand for me to take…

“Why tell you when I can show you. Who knows, you might even be able to work on your climbing skills whilst we’re there.”

“Haha, very funny. That cliff was slippery.”

“Sure it was.”

Luna starts to laugh as I take her hand. She helps me up and we venture out of the castle and deep into the back of Halfmoon's gardens, into an area I have not been before.

--

“Welcome to the training grounds. There is another main building just outside of the castle that has more training grounds and simulation rooms but this place… I created it to replicate the one we had back at old Halfmoon, the one where your mama and I used to train.”

This area is quite open as in you can access it easily if you know where you are heading. However, it is also well hidden from the rest of Halfmoon’s castle gardens as it’s cut off from the main area but a tall hedge. There’s battle staffs on a rack at the side, targets lined up against the back wall, climbing frames at the side that look like they extend across the area to make a set scenery. However, the one thing that catches my attention is the unusual looking stone pedestal that is standing right in from of me. My hand runs over the top of it, feeling the stone carvings that have perfectly been etched into it.

“What is this?”

“That is the control panel. It’s not set up for you to use yet but we can easily arrange that if you like it here after trying it out. It simply scans your hand and then you can set the arena to look how you want. Here I’ll show you…”

Luna places her hand over the stone top and it illuminates a bright blue. Surprisingly, despite looking like some form of ancient technology, a holographic screen appears in front of us, illustrating different layouts of the training grounds that are available...

“These here are different layouts and backgrounds. When selected the arena will set up how you choose it to be. Alternatively, you don’t have to select a scenery to train. You can practice and train with the equipment laid out over there. However, your mama and I loved to try out different *‘locations’*, especially this one.”

The area around us turns into a specific area of the Crimson Waste. There are large rocks of different shapes forging a series of paths, large cliff faces stand out at different heights, bones of long gone creature littering the plains. I'm amazed by it all...

“Wow.”

“Pretty cool right?”

“Pretty cool? Are you kidding me! This is awesome! It’s look exactly like some place you’d find in the Crimson Waste.”

There’s a chill in the air as my words escape me. *Shit I was not meant to say that!* Shyly, I turn to face Luna. She looks curious by my words. I can tell with the way her ears are standing in an alter position and her pupils has become a little sharper than usual. Luna decides to ask her thoughts but with caution...

“You’ve been to the Crimson Waste?”

Don’t act too suspicious Catra. You don’t want to have that conversation with her just yet. Just play it off as if it was a standard mission for the Horde. Technically you won’t be lying.

“I mean yeah but only on a certain mission for the Horde. They wanted me and a few troops to get some tech to help with their armory. Nothing major or anything like that but I was there long enough to see what some areas looked like. Have you ever been to the Crimson Waste?”

Luna’s concern fades but her cheeks start to turn red slightly. She avoids my eye contact. I think I've caught her out. Luna clears her throat before she answers...

“I mean I have but a very long time ago. Snuck out a few times to see an old friend of mine back when it was owned by the Scorpioni kingdom. The heat and dry conditions were prefect for their exoskeletons. It probably doesn’t look the same anymore. It only became an area for outlaws when the Horde claimed the land and took it for all it had. Now I imagine it looks even worse than this. I don’t understand how anything is able to survive out there.”

Believe me you'll be surprised what can survive out there.

Trying to get away from this topic so I don’t have to discuss what I was really doing in the Crimson Waste, I decide to get the conversation back on track… “So how does this work? Do I get points for ever hit I land on a set target or is it the first to the top?”

My questions capture Luna’s attention… “Wait you actually want to try this?”

“Sure why not. I used to love training with Adora back in the Horde. We used to have training simulations like this all the time. How hard can it be?”

Luna smiles and hums softly. She then leaves my side for a few moments but quickly returns with two sets of target armour and two staffs in hand.

“Put these on. You’re going to need them for the point system to calculate your score.”

Wasting little time I get the armour on. There are two forearm plates, a chest and back cover as well as a set of shin pads. Once set and the armour is secure I notice they light up a shade of red. When I look up to Luna’s I notice her armour shines a deep ocean blue colour. Luna runs through the system set up with me before we begin...

“The aim of the game is to hit any of the targets on your opponent’s armour with your staff. Alternatively you can use your hands and feet. However, if at any point you use your claws to hit the targets, five points will be deducted from your total score. Being a Magicat, it’s important to learn when to use your claws as it can become painful if they get damaged.”

Believe me you don’t have to explain that to me. I’ve lost count of how many times Adora helped to wipe the blood from under them from scratching the walls when I was trying to get away from the witches grasp… come on Catra focus. Now is not the time to be thinking about that.

“Catra?”

Luna’s voice snaps me out of my trance. She looks to me with great concern...

“Are you okay? You looked a bit distant then.”

“Who? Me? Yeah I’m totally fine. What makes you think that I’m not?”

“Well for starters you were looking at your claws when I mentioned if used at the wrong time it can cause serious injury and great pain. Secondly, your ears when flat against your head and you tail went incredibly still and fluffed up. Those were all signs that told me something was wrong.”

Curses. I forgot she could read me well being a Magicat herself.

Retracting my claws quickly, I move my hands behind my back and try to laugh it off…

"I'm fine, honestly. What were you saying again? After the claw thing?"

Luna appears reluctant to let her worries slide so easily, but she lets it pass to the back of her thoughts for now.

"As I was saying, the use of claws will deduct five points from your total score. Results will be tallied and calculated up on that score board. An arm hit is worth one point, leg hit is worth two points and a chest or back hit is worth three points. Each simulation is thirty minute long. The sound of the whistle means the start and end of the simulation. Any other questions?"

"Yeah. What does the winner receive?"

"Bragging rights."

"Ohhhh now that I like the sound of. Hope you're ready to lose Luna. I've had many years' experience at this sort of thing."

As I get ready into position Luna copies my movements, giggling slightly as she moves away from me… "Oh my sweet dear kitten. Who do you think you inherited your fighting skills from?"

WHISTLE WHISTLE

~Simulation Begin~

Luna's words are a momentary distraction. As the whistle blows she pounces over me and climbs up to the high platforms at an exceedingly fast pace…

"Well what are you waiting for? Show us what you've got!"

Bring it on!

Our battle rages on back and forth for quite a few minutes. Luna is stronger than I thought, very agile too. She's able to easily dodge my far range strikes. A little teasing here and there is shared between us...

"You're quite agile for a Magicat of your age."

"HA! Are you calling me old Catra? I thought someone of your age and so called skill would have been able to climb up here quicker than me. Guess you proved me wrong".

Okay so I lost my balance slightly on one of the cliff faces. Maybe I am a little out of practice with climbing but at least Luna was there to catch me. The back and forth banter and trash talk is all part of the game. It's also a good stress reliever for us both and an opportunity for a distraction that can work in either ones favour.

The scores are evening out, both of us making some impressive hits. There's only three minutes left on the clock and no sign of a clear winner yet. If I'm to win this thing a chest hit is all I need, but how to get one accurately proves a challenge. Luna is already crafty at seeing through my back target strikes and is very good at dodging my far range attacks. I've only been able to land a secure hit when she's stumbled slightly.

CLASH

Our staffs meet and Luna tosses me backwards with some force. It's not enough to send me flying but it's enough to make feel the force behind her hit. Her staff comes at me again but I block it with my arm.

DING

Great now Luna is two points in front of me.

"Less than two minutes left Catra. I thought you were meant to be good at th-..."

Luna stumbles slightly on an uneven shaped rock as she walks away from me. She regains her balance but it left her chest target exposed momentarily. I have an idea

"This match isn't over yet Luna. Besides, I have one more tick up my sleeve."

Retaking my staff I get ready in position. Luna's devilish smirk reappears as her focus sets in. She takes a few steps back, unaware of the wall behind her.

~30 seconds remaining~

It's now or never.

Charging forward I raise my staff high. Luna does the same, expecting me to aim for her arms. However, at the last minute, I drive my staff into the ground causing it to propel me upwards and into the air. My feet land on Luna's staff and she brings it into the air to block my attack.

~20 seconds remaining~

The shock of the impact causes Luna's arms and legs to wobble slightly. She starts to lose her grip. Seizing my opportunity, I wrap my tail around her staff and rip it clean from her hands leaving her defenceless. I use this upward force to dive myself forward and towards the wall behind Luna.

~10, 9, 8...~

Pushing off the wall, I then use my forearms to push Luna forward by the shoulders. She tumbles face first to the floor, simulated dust flying up around her. I use this moment to prepare for my final attack.

~7, 6, 5...~

Using my full force I pounce into the air once more, staff ready to make contact with my target. All that is needed is for Luna to fall

for my trap and turn around.

~4, 3, 2…~

As predicted, Luna turns to face me but has little time to react. Her arms instinctively move to cover her face, leaving her chest target completely unexposed.

~1…~

BAM

My staff makes contact with Luna's chest target at full force as I land back on the ground beside her. The blue target shows a white **X** symbol in the centre, showing that contact has been made and recognised.

WHISTLE WHISTLE

~Simulation Concluded~

Luna's arms fall flat besides her as she accepts defeat. The score board shows that I am the clear winner by one point. To say that was a thrilling experience is an understatement. Luna's laughing from the floor alters my attention…

"What's so funny?"

"Nothing. It just… wow. I haven't had that much fun in years. You weren't kidding when you said you've had years of experience. You're definitely me daughter, especially with those skills, talent and determination. The trash talking though... *hehe...* that all you. "

I smile at Luna and offer her my hand to help her up. She gratefully accepts. We remove our target armour and place it at the side as the simulation grounds fade away. It's only then that we notice that the sunset is starting to begin. Luna looks up before looking back to me. She smiles before she speaks…

“It is time. If you would like to follow me, I’ll show you what I wanted to teach you tonight.”

Luna and I exit the training grounds together and she leads me out of Halfmoon and back to the place this journey began.

--

Pulling the overgrown vine drape away from the passage opening, Luna and I enter a sacred place that is well hidden within the grounds of old Halfmoon’s gardens. Turns out the way to this place was through a secret opening around the side memorial wall where I first saw those three handprints. I have since come to learn that the handprints belong to Luna, Dawn and my younger self. It was a simple something they wanted to create a few months before the war took old Halfmoon as one of it's victims.

The passage way only relieved itself when Luna removed a strange looking runestone from the wall, which I might add wasn’t as small as I internally though. It’s big enough to have to carry with two hands, or at least rest on your hip. It was as if the runestone was some form of key. It took us to the back of old Halfmoon’s gardens, possibly most likely once a secret escape route should it have ever been needed. I can only imagine when it was once used. Luna then took me deeper into the gardens before revealing the place I now find myself at.

The hidden area is enclosed by tightly compact low growing trees. There not low enough for a Magicat to jump over but they are certainly low enough for say a large creature to jump. The fast approaching moonlight is visible up above. It looks different tonight for some reason. A hue of orange is covering the moon. Long vines have started to grow across the back wall as if they are hiding something, protecting something from view. In front of them is a large pool of water. It doesn’t look deep enough for

someone to fully submerge into it, but it appears deep enough so that one can see their reflection clearly. I'm surprised to see that despite all the chaos and destruction that occurred here many years ago, this place is still able to sustain life, life that seems to flourish here. If anything, this specific place looks completely untouched.

"What is this place?" - I ask full of wonder and curiosity.

At first Luna does not answer, which I find rather strange. I turn to her, looking for answers. Rather than speaking, Luna walks forward to the vines that cover the wall. She turns to me one last time and smiles.

What on Etheria is she up to?

Reaching up, Luna pulls down the vines with great force. As the vines fall to the floor, fireflies appear from the overgrown bushes underneath. The sight before us startles me slightly. I've never seen anything like it before. A stone creature, roughly the size of a tiger, stands before me in all its glory. The markings on the stone statue follow a set pattern, curving and bending with the body of the one carved in stone. It's face can been seen as a clear reflection in the pool in front of us, as if it were looking at its own reflection. The stone creature, despite not being alive, looks peaceful and tranquil. The only thing that makes me question its appearance is its right paw. It's lifted up off the ground almost as if it should be resting on something, as if something should be placed underneath its paw.

Luna's voice captures my attention...

"This place is the called the Tiger's rest. It's the place where Halfmoon's guardian rests and the place where Magicat's come when it's their time to learn how to transform into the creature that is gifted to members of the royal bloodline. It was a gift given to us by the first Magicat royal, the one who fought the First-Ones, the one who brought the creature within to life. I brought you hear tonight Catra to learn how to transform into that

creature. It is a gift that all parents of this bloodline share and teach their kittens when they come of age. Sadly, I never got the chance to teach you this gift when it was your time. However, I have been given the opportunity to share this moment with you now, that is if you would like to learn how to transform."

Walking around the pool of water I let my thoughts wonder for a little while. My hand rest above on the tigers head as I feel myself somehow connect with my ancestors of the past.

Is this gift part of the reason I felt so powerful when in combat? I always knew that I was more powerful, stronger than I let myself believe but I never knew how to achieve it. I always held back as to not hurt those I love, fear that I would somehow lose control.

"Why did you bring me here tonight? Why not any other night?"

"The reason I brought you here tonight rather than any other night is because according to ancient scripture first transformations are only successful if they occur under the tigers moon. It happens about once every three months, mainly with the match of the changing seasons. The sunset has an orange haze with grey marks of dust across them and as the moon starts to rise it starts off as a dusky orange colour, before turning a lighter shade of bluish-grey. I had these nights marked on my calendar even since you become of age, just in case you ever found your way back to me and chose to accept this gift. First transformations can be difficult. I know it took me a few attempts before I succeeded with my first transformation. Let's just say that my parents saw me as weak for not being able to transform on my first attempt and that had its effects."

"Why weren't you able to transform the first time you tried? Who's to say that that won't be the same case for me?"

Luna takes a deep sigh and moves to hold her sun necklace in between her hand. She twirls it a few times and continues to speak after she has collected her thoughts…

“The creature can only be summoned if the individual trying to transform is able to completely empty their mind, control their emotions and feel a deep connection to those they love. If they start to let their emotions, whether it be anger, grief or fear overcome their mind, the creature will start to fade. Severe injury can also have the same effect. It’s why I sadly wasn’t able to transform the night of the attack on Halfmoon many years ago and why the creature started to fade right before I got the nick in my ear."

Luna looks slightly angry at herself for letting her emotions get the better of her. I'd be lying if I said that I don't relate to her. Luna looks up to the night sky and takes a few moments to herself and speaks again...

"During the time of my first transformation I was under a lot of pressure from my family. I had only met Dawn a few weeks before hand. The pressure and disappointment from my parents was enough to block my connection to the creature within. I was only able to successful transform after I had spoken to Dawn about what happened and about what was troubling me. Her words brought me comfort and reminded me to never give up. Dawn was always best at giving advice and guiding people. She always knew what the best things to say and do where. During the next tiger moon I was able to transform because I had created a deep connection with her, even if I didn’t quite know at the time that that connection was love."

A stray tear escapes Luna's eyes as she speak of my mama from all those years ago. I can tell from the way she speaks about her that she misses her every day. However, Luna smile shines brighter than ever and she looks to me once more...

"You Catra have one of the deepest connections of love that I have ever seen. You found your soulmate at a very young age and from what I can tell, despite not knowing the full story about your past, your destinies were intertwined from the start. I imagine your love for each other saved you both on more than one

account. That love, the love you have for Adora and the love she has for you, is the most powerful kind of love there is."

Luna walks towards me and take my hand into hers. She gives them a gentle squeeze before looking into my eyes and speaking once more…

"Catra I need you to understand that I am not going to pressure you to try and transform if that is not what you want. If you choose to try and fail that's okay, we can keep trying until we get it right. I won't be like them. I won't be like my parents or anyone else who did you wrong in the past. I will be supportive and proud of you simply for trying... but I need to know if you want to give this a try. No matter what I am here for you."

Luna's words are enough to threaten tears falling from my eyes. It's becoming all too clear to me that Luna didn't have it easy growing up. Sure she had parents but did they truly see her as their daughter or did they simply see her as a chance to continue their idealist ways. Luna wants to share something with me, something that she can form a good memory from. I'm willing to try, I want to try, for Luna and for myself.

Taking a deep breath I clear my mind and my worries. Once ready I smile at Luna…

"Okay. Let's do this. I want to try."

Luna smiles and brings the runestone that we took from the memorial wall earlier forwards. It's green shine causes a bit of unease deep within me. It reminds me of a *certain someone*.

"This is the Tiger's Emerald. It is the Magicat runestone that all Magicat royals are connected to. Unlike the other royals who are able to use elemental powers, our runestone unlocks the key to becoming the creature within. The stone tiger once guarded the emerald but we were later forced to moved it, securing it in the wall as an entry key when we discovered the Horde's plans after they took the Black Garnet for their own gain. Only a Magicat who

is connected to the creature within can remove it from the wall and reveal this place. I must make you aware Catra that once I place the emerald back where it belongs under the guardians paw, you may feel a slight surge of power as you are, in some way, connected to the runestone despite having never transformed before. I'm not saying you will but it's been years since the runestone was last activated and the stone guardian awoke. I'm not quite sure what to expect."

"Hang on a second. When you say awoke you don't mean that the stone creature is going to come to life and like… prowl around?"

That might sound a bit strange but believe me after everything Adora and I have encountered since the release of Etheria's magic anything is possible.

Luna chuckles under her breath… "No it won't do that. It will stay where it is but… well, it's probably easier to show you than explain."

Luna places the runestone under the stone tigers paw before joining me at the other side of the pool of water. At first nothing appears to happen but then a bright flash of green light blinds me.

Instinctively, my arms reach for Luna and I bury my head against the fur on her arm. My tail moves to hold hers as I know it's how Magicat's comfort each other. Flashes of the horrors I once experienced threaten to invade my mind...

"Please not again. Not him. Not Again."

The feeling of Luna's arms gently wrapping around me helps me to relax. I take a few deep breathes, taking in her scent and the soft feeling of her holding me close. My fur starts to soften once more when I hear her soothing voice, reassuring me that all is okay. Trusting Luna, I open my eyes to face the stone tiger. The sudden flash of light appears to have come from the moonlight hitting the runestone. Alternatively, it could have been the tigers

eyes which have somehow now opened. They appear to be a bright amberish-green colour that many Magicat's seems to have. Thankfully, that colour doesn't remind me of *him*.

Slightly embarrass by my reaction, I look up to Luna who still holds her soft embrace around me. Her eyes show great concern and worry...

“Are you okay? You don’t have to do this if you don’t want to.”

“No I’m okay I promise. This might sound weird but the colour green and I don’t have a great association with each other. It’s kind of a long story. The flash of light caught me off guard that’s all.”

Luna starts to soothingly purr. I know she is only doing this to help calm me down. It’s not exactly easy to purr when concerned or worried. Luna takes a slow breath. I can tell she feels slightly guilty even though she doesn't know why I freaked out...

“I apologies for the sudden flash of light. It never used to happen. I can only assume that the absence of the runestone has resulted in its activation becoming brighter. At least it’s starting to adjust now. If I had known that was going to happen I would have warned you… Are you sure you still want to do this?”

I look to the stone tiger once more and take a deep breath, literally setting my decision in stone… “I’m sure. I want to feel more connected to my kind, to my family, to you. I know that I can do this. I'm ready.”

Luna smiles and places a gentle kiss to my forehead before releasing me from her hold. She guides me to the edge of the pool and gets me to kneel down. I am within arm’s reach of the stone tiger. Luna kneels besides me…

“I’ll be right here next to you. I promise.”

With those wordsI know that we are ready to start. *Here goes nothing*.

Luna gets me to look at my reflection in the pool of water, the tigers face reflecting across from my own. I have noticed that their eyes are starting to glow.

"Okay Catra. I need you to concentrate. Close your eyes, clear your mind and open your heart. Feel the magic of Etheria flowing beneath your hands. Listen to the wind carrying the voice of the night through the woods. Picture your friends, your family and the one you love most. Think of your happiest memories. See them in your minds eye and feel them in your heart. The creature will only be able to come forward when you feel the connection to those you love and accept the love that you have for yourself. When you feel ready, when you can feel that connection, give me your hand and I will place it on the tigers paw, allowing you to connect with our runestone."

I can feel some form of connection building deep down inside me. I can hear the voices of the night carried on the wind and I can see my happiest memories. My hand reaches for Luna's but she doesn't move it forward yet. Instead she encases it her own. She can feel that I am trembling. Luna doesn't speak, instead she waits for me to speak my fear and worries. I know I can open up to her, I can trust her…

"I'm scared that this won't work. I'm afraid that after everything I have been through, after everything I have had to do to survive, I won't be able to connect with the creature within. All I want is to make you proud and I worry I won't be able to do that."

My eyes stay tightly closed to prevent any tears from falling. There is still so much I feel the need to tell Luna about, so many things I need to get off my chest. She knows some parts of my past but not the whole truth. I want to tell her the truth and the whole truth but I don't know how.

How can I make her proud when I struggle to achieve the simplest of things, when I have to fight for everything I have earned or gained.

The smooth circles that Luna draws over the top of my hand provide me with a sense of comfort and allow me to relax once more. I can tell from the way Luna speaks that she is worried about me and maybe has a few tears threatening to fall from her eyes…

"It doesn't matter what you did in the past Catra. You did what you had to do to survive. Your connection to your family, to me and to who you really are will not be judged by your past character. Getting to know you this past month, getting to know you as my daughter, has been one of the best moments of my life. I can clearly see the powerful, caring and courageous young Magicat you have become shining through. You were given a path to follow and despite it all you created your own destiny. You found love along the way and you have let that love guide you. I never thought I'd get the chance to reconnect with you and yet here we are, bonding with one another as mother and daughter. You are more powerful that you may ever know Catra. I am more than proud of you. I was always proud of you."

Luna's words provide me comfort and my worries fade away. My nerves disappear as if they were never there. Before my tears can fall I feel Luna place my hands on the stone guardians paw. Her hand stays over the top of mine.

Visions of my most treasured memories flood my mind: the first time I met Adora, the day I gave Adora her red jacket as a birthday gift before making my own little adjustment to the sleeves, the day I got promoted to Force captain, the day I met Melog, the day I officially joined the Rebellion, the day I first baked cookies with Madam Razz, the first best friend squad road trip, our first campfire with Scorpia, Adora and mines first official date and the night Adora and I decided to go all the way, and the evening Adora proposed to me.

More recent memories include being followed by Dusk the owl, meeting Luna for the first time, her meeting my friends, baking pie earlier today and combat training all the way up to this moment. I smile at every memory, letting the strong feeling of

love overpower me. I can feel a change inside. All of these memories remind me of how lucky I am and how loved I am by those I call my friends and family. However, the most powerful memory that brings me the most joy is back when Adora told me that she loved me. Our first kiss is the most memorable. Our love for each other literally saved the universe and each other.

A sudden roar escapes me as the memories start to fade. I have no idea where that came from but whatever it was, it felt incredible. When I open my eyes a new reflection stares back at me. They have heterochromic eyes, one blue and one amber. Their fur and stripes are identical to my fur colour but look slightly thicker. Not only that but they look much larger in size, almost the size of a tiger…

Hang on a minute… the reflection that I'm looking at… th-that's me!

I-I did it. I turned in the Halfmoons creature. I connected to the creature within.

I look for Luna, wondering where she has gone. Like she promised she is by my side, but compared to when I last saw her she now has tears in her eyes and a beaming smile on her face. Overcome with joy I leap towards her, forgetting my change in size. Thankfully Luna is prepared and manages to dodge my pounce before enveloping my now enlarged skull in her arms. I nudge myself further into her hold whilst purring up a storm. It's strange to hear as I sound much louder and deeper than when I purr I in my normal Magicat form. It feels so much louder and stronger that I can feel my whole body trembling with happiness.

Luna wipes away her tears before speaking…

"I knew you could do it. I'm so proud of you Catra. Never think for one moment that I am not proud of you. I'm so proud to call you my daughter."

Luna and I stay like that for a while as I get used to this new larger form. It’s a strange sensation if I being honest. I think I’ve tripped over my tail at least twice by now. It's like learning to walk all over again. Once I feel more comfortable in my new body Luna makes a suggestion…

“Now that you’ve got the hang of things, how do you feel able going on a little adventure? I can show you all the best places to go when in this form. You know, have a little extra mother-daughter bonding time before we head back to Halfmoon.”

It’s at this moment that I realise that I am unable to respond to Luna with my normal words. Therefore, I'm left with no other option that to roar and hope Luna knows what I mean.

Looks like I’ve got a whole new language to learn.

Luna giggles slightly… “I’ll take that as a yes then.”

Within seconds Luna transforms into her version of the creature and guides me over the tall canopy of trees that hide this place. I am quick to follow and she leads me back towards the Whispering Woods.

We send the rest of the night exploring as the creatures and I get the hang of learning some new cool techniques that will help me in combat should I ever find the need to put them to use. We also chase some fireflies and even a few larger creatures, reaching speeds that I never thought I could achieve. After a few hours Luna leads me to the top of the mountain that keeps new Halfmoon hidden and secure. The view from up here is beautiful, I’ll have to bring Adora up here one day. After about three hours, the creature fades and I return to my normal form. Luna says that the creature fading on the first night a few hours after transforming is natural as the creature within us also has to adjust to being awoken. She’s was however surprised I was able to hold my connection for as long as I did.

We spend a little while longer at the top of Halfmoon before our way back home and turn in for the night. When I return to my room Melog is already there and waiting for me. They greet me happily and immediately ask for cuddles. Dusk however is nowhere to be see. She's probably with Luna. When I call Adora that night I tell her how amazing my day has been. Not only do I feel more connected to Luna but I was also able to transform, and on my first attempt too.

Looking at me from the outside you'd say that today has been amazing, no worries what so ever. But, if you were to look on the inside, you'd see how my worries about confronting my past and letting Luna know the whole truth are causing me to lose sleep.

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you all enjoyed reading chapter ten of Finding Halfmoon. Only five chapters left. I can't believe how quick it's gone. 😱
>
> Well done to those who guessed that Catra could also turn into the creature that Luna transformed into in the last chapter. In this chapter, I wanted to explore parts of how Catra is like Luna and hopefully show that Catra is feeling more connected to Luna being her mom as time goes on. However, there is still the worry of telling Luna about her past... but that part is coming very soon. Question is how do you think Luna will react?
>
> Let us know your thoughts. I love reading your comments. The next update is Friday and an extra content chapter will be coming soon after it. I hope to see you then. 😊
>
> P.S - Based on some comments from the last chapter, I have altered the text slightly especially in the first part. Catra's reaction was mainly a heat of the moment thing but it soon became clear that I could have written it a little better as I wanted Catra to be hesitant about running away but she only did it to protect Adora and her friends. I have now edited it to

make this more clear. Apologies if you kept getting emails about it being updated 😅. Hopefully I won't need to touch it again. Hope you enjoy. 😊

Never Ending Worries

Chapter Summary

> Insomnia sucks, so Catra decides to give one of her good friends a call.
>
> After talking over her worries, Catra goes to speak to someone important to her.
>
> When Catra arrives back at Halfmoon, a surprise is waiting for her.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Sleep does not come easy at all that night. You'd think after the incredible day I've had I'd be exhausted but clearly that's not the case. I loved getting to connect with Luna and spending the day with her, discovering how I am like her in way I couldn't imagine. It's been nice getting to bond with her as her daughter but these never ending worries have been keeping me awake. It's like I'm back to square one again, back when the visions first began long before I had the answers I yearned to know. Now I have those answers, now I know what it feels like to have a mother figure to look up to, I'm afraid that the truth will take that away from me.

Melog stirs beside me, stretching along the side of my body. I've managed to get a few hour sleep but not as many as I would have liked. *Insomnia sucks*. The warm sense of Melog beside me has been the only thing helping to ease my racing thoughts. I'm not sure where Dusk is. She's probably with Luna but I'm surprised she didn't come to visit me when Luna and I got back last night. It's not like her.

Melog's eyes slowly start to open and they rest their giant head on top my stomach. They purr happily as I run my hand through their mane.

"I can tell something is bothering you. I think you forget sometimes that we are connected through our 'scared bond' as Swift Wind would say."

Melog words results in a faint giggle and smile on my behalf. Melog has since gained a good sense of humour from developing their social skills over the past year. They know I hate calling our connection that so they only deliberately say it when I need cheering up...

"Please don't ever call our connection that again. You know it sounds too weird for me."

Melog knows exactly what troubling me, what I'm feeling deep inside. I've discussed it with them many times, even when words haven't needed to be said. I worry that I bore them sometimes but they have reassured me many times that a problem shared is a problem halved. Besides, they're always going to be around to support me and make things like this easier to get through.

Melog has suggested talking about some of my worries to Perfuma before now. She knows a lot about how to deal with this kind of stuff and she can probably offer more guidance on the matter at hand compared Melog. There is only so much one individual can give advice on.

You know what I might give it a try. It's only about and hour or so before sunrise and knowing Perfuma she would be up by now.

Leaning over to the bedside, I reach for my communication pad and dial Perfuma. I just hope she has had her morning tea before this call. Believe me, you do *not* want to see Perfuma before her morning tea ceremony. If you interrupt it, she'll let you know about it.

A few rings and Perfuma answers…

"Good Morning Catra. I have to say I wasn't expecting to hear from you today or this early in the day so this is quite a pleasant surprise. How are you doing?"

“Hey Perfuma. I’m okay thanks. I haven’t woken you up or anything have I?”

“Oh not at all. In fact, I’ve been up for the past hour. I forget the seasons changed last night and got up an hour early by accident. *Whoops.* You know what I’m like for wanting to greet the day when the sun rises. Scorpia is not so much of an early bird but she tries to be. I told her to stay in bed this morning, especially with all the work she is putting into reclaiming her Kingdom.”

Perfuma voice is as cheery as always. She appears to be sitting in her meditating garden so I at least know she has already had morning meditating session and herbal tea. Her and Scorpia’s relationship has been blossoming really well. I mean it took Scorpia a while to act on her feelings, heck she even came to me for advice on how to ask Perfuma on a date, but they worked it out in the end.

“Yeah I know exactly how she feels. I’m not one to be an earlier riser either. ”

Perfuma smiles and her eyes have that questioning gaze...

“I take it something must be troubling you to have called me so early then?”

Perfuma can see right through me. She’s very good with this sort of stuff. Recognizing when things are bothering someone and seizing the opportunity to approach that someone about their current situation at the right moment.

My eyes avoid Perfuma’s gaze on the screen as I try to hide my embarrassment. I know I shouldn't feel embarrassed or ashamed about asking for help or guidance but being raised to believe for a long time that asking for help was a weakness has that affect on you. It's something I'm working on seeing through…

“Do you mind if I ask for you guidance and advice with something please. I would have spoken to Adora about it and I plan to do so when she gets back from Brightmoon later tonight. I have spoken

to Melog and they suggested that I have a quick chat with you, especially considering how good you are with this sort of stuff."

Melog *murps* at my side, letting me know that they're still there to comfort me, to help me through it if needed. I stroke their head and they settle back down. I then look back to Perfuma waiting for her answers…

"Well of course Catra. I'm always happy to help. That's what I am here for. Tell me, what's troubling you?"

Okay deep breathes Catra. Speak how you feel and see where it goes.

Taking a few deep breathes I clear my mind and my thoughts. I no longer have to be afraid that when I speak my fears or worries that someone's secret shadow is watching, waiting for an opportunity to catch me in the night and burn me with the consequence of showing fear. Nevertheless, I still take a quick, cautious glance around the room to make sure that Melog and I are the only ones here.

Melog notices the slight bristle of my fur and moves to rest their giant head in my lap, before promising me that all is okay, that we are alone and that they'll keep me safe should anything happen, even though we both know that there is nothing to fear. Melog's words relax me and I find the strength to answer Perfuma...

"Okay so long story short, as you know I found my mom, Luna, a month ago in Halfmoon. I have been here ever since trying to connect with her and learning about my family and what really happened concerning my life before the Horde. Last night I felt more connected with Luna compared to all the weeks I have been here. I felt like I was worthy of being her daughter, as if it was something I had to earn. However, as great as things feel I can see Luna's growing concern. A few things slipped out when we spoke yesterday, mainly about my life in the Horde… *and him*. Nothing was said in too much detail but I know that Luna can sense something is wrong. My worry is that when she finds out

the truth about my past, when *I* tell her the truth about my past, she'll want nothing to do with me and our relationship will be over. I don't know how to approach it or deal with something this big. Do you get what I mean?"

Wow, I really surprised myself that I was able to get through all that without having a breakdown. I guess processing my trauma in therapy and talking about my past has helped me to progress as an individual. Don't get me wrong, some of the nightmares still occur and there is still the occasional panic attack happening over seeing shadows and hearing loud noises but that... being able to speak what's on my mind without stopping... that's progress.

Perfuma looks deep in though for a few moments, making a few notes and sipping at her tea occasionally. I look down to Melog for some reassurance. Their blue flowing mane and smile tells me that there is nothing to be worried about. They nuzzle into me closer and I wrap my arm around them. This may be a sign of Melog showing affection but a the same time they could just be trying to steal my body heat to keep warm. I saw their mane shiver and it is a little cold in here. Either way I don't care, I'm just glad that they're here with me.

Perfuma's voice catches my attention once more…

"It makes more sense than you may think. After everything you have been through it is only natural to worry about something like this. It has more or less become a natural instinct. As well as this, it is natural to fear the unknown. Therefore, I wouldn't worry to much about those thoughts to much. However, what concerns me the most is why you feel like you have to earn the right to be someone's daughter?"

I had a feeling that question might be asked. It was something I could sense was coming. When I look at my past, at everything I have gained and lost, I have had to fight for it. I've had to earn it. No matter how big or small it was, whether it be a ration bar or a promotion, I had to fight for it, earn it. Even after I achieved it, it became clear that it was never enough for some people... *that I*

was never good enough for certain people. To make matters worse, my hard earned work and efforts were then taken away from me, especially when I reach the point where I was happy with what I had. It's why I fought so hard to be in control back in the Horde. If I was in control I would have the power to say what was done, how it was done and when. No one would ever doubt me... *I wouldn't doubt myself.*

Taking I deep breath, I answer Perfuma…

"Everything I have ever gained in life I have had to fight for. Everything I then achieved was taken away from me. The only thing good in my life that I managed to hold onto was Adora. Even she at one point was taken from me because of some stupid, *fucked up* destiny. We might have lost each other on the way but we found each other gain... But even after that I had to fight to get her back. If I hadn't fought for her, fought for us, would we even be here today. Now that I have gained something else good in my life I feel like I have to earn the title of being someones daughter, of being Luna's daughter. For the first time in my life I didn't fight to know who she was, it was an accident that I can across her. I was just lucky enough that she opened up to me. If we hadn't found those ruins would have I found her somewhere else down the line or would have I still be left in the dark with unanswered questions? I guess it all goes back to the fear of loosing the good things in life."

'Some people have a bad day. I've had a bad life. If I want something it's taken from me. If I win the fight I lose the war. Threats only work on someone who have something to lose. But me? I've already lost it all! ' – That's what I once said when I was in the Crimson Waste. I had never spoke truer words with such force. Back then I had nothing to lose as I had nothing to gain. Now I have a lot to lose, including those who mean the most to me.

Perfuma, seeing to now understand more clearly, nods and continues to speak…

“I know from talking to you that life in the Horde has given you a different prospect on life, but you don’t have to earn the right to be someone’s daughter. If anything, they have to earn the right to be your parent, to be your guardian, to be included in your family. Blood relations doesn’t always make a good family Catra. Love, support, compassion and understanding does. If Luna is worried about you and you can see it then it shows that she cares about you. She’s probably unsure of how to approach the situation it as she is just as scared as you are. Luna is probably scared that if she pushes you too hard she’ll end up loosing you again. Is there maybe someone you could talk to besides myself, Adora and Melog. Maybe talking to a mutual individual will help you. Someone who has been in a similar situation to you. Someone who you can have a trail run with over what you want to say to Luna before you actually sit down to tell her everything. It’s clear you want to try so don’t let you’re worries stop you. All I ask of you Catra is one thing…”

I look to Perfuma with wide eyes. My tail stills in question but also worry of what she might say. Even Melog perks up, their head becoming visible on the screen, wondering what she’ll say…

“Let yourself enjoy these moments as Luna's daughter. Treasure them forever because you never know what life has in store for us.”

I know from talking with Perfuma that her words have a hidden meaning. Perfuma sadly lost her parents when she was fifteen when the Horde first swept through Plumeria. She became the leading princess of her Kingdom at a young age and a parent figure to her younger siblings. I know for a fact that if she could spend one more day talking to her parents again she would.

The more I think about what Perfuma has said, the more I realise that their is a neutral party that I could talk to. Some who will listen even though they can't speak...

“Thanks Perfuma. I really appreciate it. Talking to you has helped and I will take your advise on board. I think I know just the

person who I can speak to.”

Perfuma smiles and we say our goodbyes before ending the call. I still feel slightly conflicted about what I’m about to do but I doesn’t hurt to give it a try. I look out my balcony window, the moon starting to settle down for the dawn to rise. Setting my decision in stone, I move off our bed and get myself ready for the day. Melog offers to accompany me but I tell them that this is something I need to do on my own. They might not understand it now but they will one day. Accepting my simple reasoning, Melog curls up back on the bed and makes me promise to call them should they be needed. I give Melog a little scratch on the head before leaving Halfmoon’s castle and heading in search of the person I need to find.

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It's a short walk from the castle to where I want to go, but I do make a slight detour on my way to collect something before arriving. I know in theory that a peace offering isn’t require, no form of payment is required, but something about bring these to them feels right.

When I arrive to the cave opening I pull the ivy drape to the side and walk deeper into the heart of this resting place. Once I reach the steady flowing river I carefully hop over the stones and over to the other side. When I look up to the tree branches in front, I notice Dusk, Luna’s Etherian moon owl companion. She must have spent the night here. Dusk starts to wake and watches me curiously. I simply smile up at her and go back to what I was doing.

Gently, I place the bunch of white chrysanthemums down onto their soft grassy bed. Rather than sitting on the bench where Luna and I once sat, I opt to sit on the floor, directly facing the person,

or rather their memory, that I have come to visit. Sighing deeply I look up to the sky. The final phase of moonlight is starting to fade and the dawn is starting to break. It's a beautiful sight, one that strangely provides me with a sense of comfort and peace. The only sounds that can be heard are the whistling wind, the steady flow of running water and very quiet, steady purr which comes from myself.

Once comfy, I decide it's time to let out my thoughts and speak from the heart…

"Hey mama. I know we haven't really spoken for a while but I wanted to come and see you. I hope you don't mind me calling you mama. Luna told me that I used to call you that when I was younger so I thought I'd stick with it. Do you mind if I stay here for a while and talk to you about something that's bothering me. I know we can't talk to each other like we probably would if you were here in person but I could really use you guidance. Luna always said that you were the best at giving advice and guiding people… I can't imagine it's been easy for her without you by her side."

As expected there is no answer but the calming atmosphere remains the same. Dusk's movement up above catches my eye momentarily. She ruffles her feathers before flying down to a lower branch directly behind Dawn's grave stone. Dusk looks as if she is getting herself comfortable, turning slightly to face me. I pay little attention to her even if it does appear that she is listening in on our conversation. I take a few more steady breaths and continue to speak…

"I have really enjoyed getting to know Luna as my mom. For a long time I thought I was abandoned at the Horde's doorstep at a young age. I thought I was unwanted, unloved. It came quite a shock to me when I discovered that I wasn't the only Magicat left and that I had a family, a family that loved me, with parents who loved me more than anything and fought to keep me safe. I feel so guilty for ever thinking that I was alone, thinking that my own family hated me, but when you're led to believe your whole life

that you are unworthy and only alive because of someone else it makes you think things like that. I never imagined myself to be so lucky as to have parents who loved me or be so fortunate as to meet my mom's… *or at least one of them."*

My eyes start to water slightly but my breathing exercises keep them from falling. A few more moments of silence pass before I speak again…

"Luna… she's incredible. Everything I had hoped for in a mom. She's kind, caring, she's one of a kind. I mean she scared me at first when I first saw her back in old Halfmoon but there was something about her that told me to trust her, to let her help me. I don't know if you're aware but I injured my knee during a rock slide when I was chasing after her. Luna look so concerned and worried even though at the time she didn't know who I was. She healed me leg, only a faint scar remains. She said it was the first time she'd been able to heal someone in many years."

A faint smile appears across my face as I remember that day. It's certainly something we'll probably laugh over now, especially when you consider how far we've come...

"I was a little nervous when Luna first met Adora, who is my best friend and *fiancé.* Adora is She-Ra and I know Magicats didn't have the best time with the First-Ones but Adora is nothing like them… she's Adora. She's kind, lovable, *a bit of a dummy at times*, but she's wonderful. When Luna turned into Halfmoon's guardian Adora transformed out of fear. She was just trying to protect me, they both were. Thankfully after that misunderstanding of events Luna and Adora started to connect with each other. It was nice to see Luna getting along with my friends and her future daughter-in-law. Adora probably would have come with me to see you today if she wasn't on this mission."

Adora, *oh how I miss her*. I know I'll see her later tonight but for me that can't come any sooner. I smile brightly as I speak once more...

"Despite Adora proposing to me long before I met Luna she still insisted that she asked Luna for my hand in marriage. Luna says I definitely found my soulmate, someone who makes me happy. Anyway, I've been getting to know Luna a lot better recently. She taught me how to bake my favourite blueberry pie, it was delicious. She showed me your favourite training simulation from when you and she used to train back in your youth. Above all she taught me how to transform into the creature within last night. I had never felt more connected to her in my life. She's an incredible Magicat… and amazing mom. I felt like I was worthy of being her daughter, someone that both you and her can be proud of. Luna says that she can see you in me a lot. She talks about you a lot… she really misses you."

Turns out this is harder than I thought it would be but it feels good to get this off my chest. It's been eating away at me for some time now. Building and growing up to a point where it's starting to affect my sleep and my moods.

In the corner of my eye I notice Dusk moving closer down the tree branch and closer towards Dawn's memorial stone. I have no idea what it is with this owl. It's like she actually listening to ever word I am saying, but that can't be true… *can it?*

Collecting me thoughts I start try and start to speak again. My voices catches a little bit as I try my best to hold back the tears that threaten to fall. Maybe I need a few more minutes to collect my thoughts. The dawn has now officially began to rise and the morning sun's warm starts to peer through the trees. It's not completely risen yet, but it's rising…

"I wish I was given the chance to know you in person, to get to connect with you as my mama like I have been able to connect with Luna as my mom. Luna says you were an amazing mother and that I have no doubt about it. She's tells me all these wonderful stories about you, stories that I sometimes feel are too good to be true. She told me how you met, how you spoke to me when I was growing inside of her, how you stayed strong for us both when I was sick. Apparently I used to love chasing your tail

and racking my tiny claws through your mane. My claws aren't as small now as they probably were then but you get the idea. The more Luna's speak of you the more I start to remember things from my past. It's like a light has be switched on once more and I start to remember what I lost long ago... what I fear I may lose again."

A few slow tears start to escape my eyes and rather than wiping them away I let them fall. They land onto the grass beneath me without a sound. The soil absorbs them to keep and live from. When I look up, I notice Dusk jumping from the branch behind onto the top of Dawn's gravestone. She tilts her head sideways a few times, her face almost appears to be showing compassion. It's almost as if she is trying to communicate with me. For a moment, Dusk ruffles her feathers up so she looks bigger than what she actually is. At first I think she is going to fly off but then she sneezes and shakes her feathers back to their normal form. It's a cute sneeze to be fair, a bit like Melog's sneeze, which ultimately mimics my own sneeze. Either way it's enough to make me smile and earn a light-hearted giggle. Dusk looks impressed with herself. It's almost like she's trying to smile.

Once my thoughts are collected again I speak once more…

"I feel terrible that I haven't yet called Luna mom. I really want to call her mom and I know that there is no pressure to do so, but she is my mom. She deserves to be addresses as my mom. It's just easier for me to not call her that yet because… *because…* I fear that she will no longer want to know me when she finds out the truth about my past..."

Okay now I know Dusk is definitely listening in on this conversation. She's titled her head right over to the side as if to question what I mean.

"When I first found out Luna was my mom I said that *'I can't be her daughter. I believed my whole life that she never wanted me, that I was abandoned, that I was never loved. I let it control me. I let that anger drive me into doing terrible things. They created a*

monster…' I did many terrible, unforgivable things when I was back in the Horde. I started as a cadet in their war, tortured and tormented by the one who you fought to protect us from. You'll be happy to know that she is no more and that I overpowered her, but that then lead to me becoming one of their leaders. A leader who order many terrible acts to be carried out."

I won't deny that being a commander felt powerful. I felt like I could make an impact and show my worth, but it was only once I lost everything that I realised that it was never what I really wanted...

"Everytime I was ordered to plan out and conduct an attack I did my best to ensure that little life was lost, but I knew that some innocent lives would suffer. At one point I had enough. I tried to escape many times but I couldn't, no matter how hard I tried or wanted to leave, I was trapped. I know see that I was being brainwashed into believing that what I was doing was right, but I couldn't have been more wrong. By the time I realised the truth and was ready to finally take the plunge to escape things got dramatically worse. Etheria came out of despondos and pure evil arrived. He called himself Horde Prime. He claimed that he wanted purity for Etheria when really he wanted power. He controlled me, manipulated me, made my live my worst nightmares. If it wasn't for Adora saving me, I probably would have died at the fate of his clawed hand."

My hand stokes the back of my neck, running over the scar that was left behind from his chip. Sometimes I see him in my nightmares. I see those green eyes, the green pool and the person I love dying in my arms because I was unable to control what *he* made me do. It terrifies me. Adora has held me close many night as I let me tears fall. I may not be getting the flashes or panic attack anymore when I touch the scar anymore, but it will always serve as a reminder of what happened…

"I am scarred for life, both figuratively and literally, both because of my actions in the *Horde*, because of *Shadow Weaver*, because of *him*. I was simply doing what I had to do to survive but I am

afraid when I tell Luna all this that she won't see it that way. Many have forgiven me for my actions, saying that they understand why I did what I did and that they can see that I am not that person anymore. I was a scared individual who was simply trying to survive. I never really understood how my friends, my family could forgive me for all I did but they did and it's their love for me that has helped me to move forward with my life. Now I know the truth about my past, about who I really am and how my story in the Horde started I feel like I am almost complete. However, I fear that when Luna learns all of this that she will abandon me for real and want nothing to do with me. It's why I haven't called her mom yet. If my fears happen to be true it will be easier to part ways having not formed a complete emotional connection to her yet. I know what it feels like to lose someone you care about, to almost lose someone you love. I can't go through that again. I can't lose my mom."

I take a few deep breathes and use my hands to clear my eyes from their watery gaze. I've been worrying about this for a really, *really* long time. I'm afraid that I'll lose everything that matters to me most. The dawn starts to break and a warm ray of light start to illuminating the secret grounds. It provides me with a warm sense of hope. Call it strange, but I feel like this is a sign, a sign from my mama as if she is saying that everything will be okay.

I smile brightly when the suns warmth touches me cheeks, which in turn dries my tears. I take in a deep breathe, smelling the fresh morning air. Everything feels at peace. I know now that everything will be okay. I look back to Dawn's grave once more…

"I'm sorry that I never got to know you properly after the war ended but thank you for giving me the chance to live. If it wasn't for you fighting to protecting me and Luna, I might not have been lucky enough to reconnect with her… I love you mama."

Feeling more relaxed now that I have spoken openly about what is bothering me I decide it's time to leave my mama to rest and head back to my room in Halfmoon's castle. Adora's not due back

for a little while yet so I might go and explore for a little while, or even try something new in the training simulations.

As I stand a gentle breeze of the wind flows through my slowly growing mane. That's when I properly acknowledge Dusk for the first time since I've been here. I haven't been ignoring her as such, but I was in the moment of talking through my worries so I didn't want to interrupt that train of thought whilst I had it. Dusk looks as me happily, almost as if is is smiling. It's like she now completely understands me and sees me for who I am compared to when we very first me back in the Whispering Woods all those months ago. I have never really felt a connection to Dusk like I have with Melog, but she has taken a liking to following me around, almost as if she is my little guardian. In saying that, she has been there for Luna for many years, being her moment of light and happiness when needed.

I smiles to Dusk and speak to her directly… "Thank you for looking after my mom. I know she hasn't had it easy. I really appreciate it, so thank you for being her little guardian."

Dusk looks taken back for a moment, almost as if she wasn't expecting to hear those words. When her senses return she chirps happily a flutters her wings a little bit before flying over to me, perching on my shoulder. She starts to nuzzle up under my chin whilst chirping. It's more affectionate than when she usually does it. It tickles a bit and I start to laugh. When Dusk stops her movements I give her a little scratch on her head. Dusk looks at me curiously and uses her beak to move a loose strand of my growing mane out of my eyes and behind my ear. She mumbles in approval before flying back to Dawn's memorial stone. She sits on top of it for a few seconds and turns her head to look back at me. She chirps happily once more before flying high up above the trees into the rising sun. I watch her go before I lose sight of her as the bright sun blinds me.

I have the feeling that my mama never really left my moms side. She was always there beside her, watching over her.

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My journey back to Halfmoon's castle is a slow one as I decided to walk the long way back. Adora won't be back for a while so there's no rush to get back there just yet. I would have gone to the training grounds but I'm not sure if Luna has set it up for me to use yet and I have more or less explored all that Halfmoon has to offer. Really I should have brought my drawing pad with me to keep me occupied for a little while. There are so many beautiful things to draw here, the views are astounding from the trees. I like to watch the village awake in the morning, observe life burst into colour as the sun rises. The towns people are really nice to talk to. They don't treat you like royalty, they simply treat you like a normal individual. It's nice. Being treated like a royal seems to formal for me anyway, I'm glad they see me and treat me like... *like Catra*. I have enough of that *'diplomatic/royal crap'* when I attend diplomatic meetings back in Brightmoon with Sparkles. Some of the Magicat kittens asked where Melog was and when could they come and play. Turns out they have a fan club. It's quite cute.

It's probably about midday, or at least almost midday when I arrive back at Halfmoon's castle. I am a little tired from my restless night so I feel that relaxing on a nice comfy bed to get a few hours sleep before Adora gets back won't do any harm. I love to sleep in the sun anyway. The castle seems quite which I like. I'm not in the mood to make small talk right now. Right now I just want to fall face first on my bed, cuddle up to Melog considering Adora isn't here and get a decent bit of sleep before she returns.

Yawning I reach for the handle to mine and Adora room but I stop when I hear a voice coming from the other side…

"Haha. Aww I missed you too. I hope you've been good for Catra. By the way can I ask…"

Instantly recognizing that voice I forget my momentary tiredness and burst through the doors. They slam violently as they hit the walls, causing Melog and their friend to jump…

“Hey Catra… Surprise!”

Adora has that stupid beaming smile on her face as she stands up from our bed and opens her arms in greeting. Wasting no time I run into her hold. The sheer force alone causes her to stumble backwards a little bit but Adora is very good at keeping her balance. Thankfully we don't fall over. My arms wrap around her tightly, holding her close to me.

My words are muffled slightly against her jacket… “I thought you weren’t due back until tonight.”

Adora chuckles and responds… “I wasn’t but the meeting ended earlier than expected and I had Swift Wind fly me back early. I missed you… and I was worried about you.”

Adora’s words fall quiet and I can feel the sense of concern in her body. I moves to cup her face in my hands and she looks at me with that stupidly gorgeous smile of hers. Despite her smile, I can see the worry in her eyes…

“Why were you worried about me? I told you I had an amazing day.”

“Because I know you Catra. I don’t doubt that you had an amazing day getting to spend time with Luna but I could sense that something was bothering you. I didn’t want to ask as I know you’ll tell me when you’re ready.

Classic Adora. She can read me so perfectly.

Accepting the fact that lying to Adora will do no good I decide to tell her everything. I move out of her hold and take her hands, guiding her to our bed. She automatically knows what to do. Adora rest’s herself against the headboard whilst I settle between

her legs, resting my head against her chest, wrapping our arms around each other. Once settled I start to speak…

"I went to visit my mama this morning. I wanted to talk to her about something. I didn't sleep very well last night as some worries started to creep in after the amazing day I had with Luna. I called Perfuma for some advice and she suggested talking to someone mutual who would simply listen who wasn't her, Melog or you. I knew that that someone was Dawn, my mama. After yesterday I started to worry about what will happen when Luna finds our about my past. Some things slipped out during the day, stuff about us growing up in the Horde, mentions of the Crimson waste… *him*. I could tell that she wanted to ask what I meant by them all but she wouldn't. Perfuma thinks she doesn't want to scare me away as she's afraid she'll lose me again. I'm scared that when I tell her the truth about my past, about how evil of a person I became…"

"You are *not* evil Catra. You *never* were." Adora's voice is stern and she squeezes me tightly. I didn't mean to use that word but it gets my point across…

"Alright maybe *'evil'* was the wrong word to use but you get what I mean. I'm afraid that when Luna finds out the truth about my past she'll want nothing to do with me. That she'll be ashamed that I am her daughter… and she'll abandon me for real."

Melog comes up to Adora's side and rests their head on her knee. They then nudge my hand getting me to stroke the top of their head, helping to relax my racing thoughts. Their soothing purr makes me smile.

Adora places a gentle kiss to the top of my head, which results in me looking up at her. She's smiling down at me. She reaches for my free hand and laces our fingers together. Taking a deep sigh Adora speaks…

"I may haven spoken to Luna this morning Catra. I bumped into her when I arrived back here. Well, I didn't bump into her but

Swift Wind did."

"I bet that was something. Has Luna met Swift Wind before?"

Adora laughs... "I think they've met each other in passing but not properly. Anyway that's a story for another time."

"Alright but I'm holding you to you word. So... what did Luna have to say?"

Adora smiles and hums to herself. Her arms squeeze me a little tighter as she speaks...

"Luna loves you Catra, more than anything, but she's worried about you. She can see that something is bothering you. She wants to help but she's not sure how. I understand that you're worried about what will happen when you tell her the truth but she's here willing to listen when you're ready to tell. She wants to know and help. If Luna truly loves you then she will listen to what you have to say and take it with an open mind. She will understand that you did what you had to do to survive. A good mother will love you unconditionally, no matter what. If your worst fears are confirmed then she will be giving up on the most incredible, amazing Magicat there is in the whole of Etheria… *now I think of it,* in the whole universe! However, from speaking with Luna and getting to know her over the past month I think she'll surprise you."

Adora's smile reflects my own and she leans in, passionately kissing me. She rests her forehead against mine and my purring grows louder…

"Catra... please remember that you don't have to do this alone. If you want, Melog and I will be by your side the whole time. Just say the word and I'll be there."

I move slightly back so I can look at Adora in all her glory. Things haven't been easy for either of us but we always come out fighting strong. I can ask anything of her and I know she'll be there for me.

My hand moves to rest against her cheek. My thumb slowly brushes along her cheek bone. Her hand comes to rest over mine, holding mine against her cheek for a while. Adora's eyes are full of love as I speak the simple words that carry more than a thousand words…

"You promise?"

"I promise."

Adora and I share another passionate kiss. It's soft and loving, gentle and caring. We remain like that for a few hours. Sleep lures us into a world of soft dreams. When we awake I get Adora to try some of my blueberry pie that I made yesterday. She devours it in one, saying that Razz has some serious competition, before demanding that I make one for the rest of our friends when we head back to Brightmoon. Before nightfall Adora and I speak with Luna. We arrange to meet tomorrow and discuss my never ending worries that will hopefully soon be laid to rest.

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you all enjoyed chapter eleven of Finding Halfmoon. There's only four chapters left to go 😱. Where has that time gone. It feels like only yesterday I started to share this story with you.
>
> So the next update on Monday will be the big moment that will define Catra's and Luna's relationship moving forward. Catra is ready to open up to Luna about her past but the question now is how do you think Luna will react? Let us know your thoughts in the comments. Hope you enjoy and I'll see you then. 😊
>
> With this update, we also have a release of another extra content chapter (link here: https://archiveofourown.org/works/39704697). This one will explore what Luna and Adora where discussing before she went back to their room and Catra came in. There is only one

more after this. We're so close to the end. Hope you enjoy.
☺️

Confronting the Past

Chapter Summary

> As the day begins, Catra prepares to confront her past once more.
>
> Luna listens to every word Catra says whilst Melog and Adora provide support.
>
> When all is said and done, Catra discovers if her fears become true or if Luna still wants to be part of her life.
>
> **Chapter/Content Warning: Reflections of the Past & Descriptions of Abuse (Child/Adult)** - (Nothing graphic but warning necessary).

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Are you sure you want to do this?"

"I'm sure. Luna deserves to know the full story."

Today's the day. Today's the day I tell Luna the full story about my past, about who I was compared to who I am know. Hopefully she'll keep her word back from when I first met her and she'll take on everything I say with an open mind, listening to both the good and the bad. I know that I'm not *that* person anymore, the person who was manipulated, angered and scared, but it's will Luna see that? Will Luna see me for who I am now or will her image of me change forever?

Will I still have a mom at the end who wants me to be in her life?

"Okay well you let me know if you need a break or want to get out of there at any point. Melog and I will be besides you the whole time, I promise."

Adora has been reassuring me all night and day with her loving words and *obvious* concern. I think she has been able to understand how nervous I am simply by looking at Melog. They've been a bit distant this morning, as if they were *'staring into space'* as some might say. It's clear that both Melog and Adora are nervous and worried for me.

I lean across, lightly pecking Adora on the cheek… "Thank you. I really appreciate it. You're the best, you know that?"

It's a rhetorical question but of course Adora answers…

"Well I didn't until now. Seriously though, if you need anything just ask… but believe me if Luna for one minute doesn't understands that you did what you had to do to survive I will be getting involved. No promises on holding She-Ra back if that happens."

Over-protective Adora. Got to love her.

Laughing slightly, I squeeze Adora's hand a little tighter as i lean to rest my head on her shoulder...

"I doubt it coming to that but thank you for looking out for me. I'm really glad you're here."

Melog comes up beside me and softly *mreows*, nudging into the side of my leg. Reaching down, I give them a gentle scratch between their ears. They begin to purr, which starts to help me relax slightly, something which is very much needed right now.

Taking a deep breath, I finally decide to look to the door in front of us. It's a scary feeling, knowing that when I walk through that door I'm going to exit with one of two possible outcomes: a parent who loves me unconditionally and supports me despite of my past doings or a I'll become a Magicat who this time, *for real*, has been abandoned by her true family for her mistakes.

Adora, sensing my worry, wraps her arm around my shoulders so she can pull me into a side hug. She places a gentle kiss to my

forehead…

“You can do this. I believe in you.”

Adora’s words provide me with all the encouragement and comfort I need. If my worst fears do come true I know that no matter what I will still have Adora besides me. If our relationship has proved anything it’s that those who truly love us will look past our mistakes and love us unconditionally.

Not to mention our love for each other literally saved the universe but you get the idea.

Taking Adora’s hand in mine once more, I give it a tight squeeze. Three knocks to the door and a familiar voice on the other side allowing us safe passage is the first stage of confronting my past.

--

Luna looks incredibly nervous. I can sense that she is worried, what about exactly I’m not sure. If I had a guess Luna's probably worrying about the unknown, anticipating what I might say. I guess only time will tell if I'm right. Luna greets us as always and offers us a brew or water with a side order of some of her well baked cookies. Melog and Adora each take one of the cookies offered, with one or two being saved for me later. At present, I don’t really feeling like eating or drinking but a glass of water might come in handy. My throat is already starting to feel dry.

Per my request, we’re having this conversation in Luna’s room. It’s the one place in this castle that I feel… *well…* at ease. Yes Adora and I have or own room but I don’t want any *‘bad’* memories to be made there. Besides, if things turn out to be how I fear they’ll turn out, it won’t be our room much longer.

Luna offers us a seat on the sofa where I slept on my first day in Halfmoon, the day after we first met. Adora sits beside me, her hand still holding mine. Melog sits on the other side, their head resting on my lap. At the moment their mane is a calm blue colour, but I worry that may change when it comes to talking about... *him… and her*.

Out of everything, my main worry is how Luna will see Adora and my friends after she finds out what was the start of my demise into the monster the Horde created. Adora and Luna are getting on really well, I don't want to destroy their friendship. Adora says it doesn't matter to her if Luna changes the way she views her but it matters to me. Adora has always mattered to me so I will worry about *that* part of our story.

Luna takes a seat across from us on another sofa that she has most likely brought in from another room. I appreciate her efforts for trying to make this conversation seems as informal as possible. Dusk is roosting on a perch near the balcony window, letting the cool breeze blow through her feathers. She turns her head towards me and appears to smile, *or whatever you would class as a smile for an owl*, before settling down and facing towards the Whispering Wood scenery once more.

Okay deep breathes Catra. You can do this.

"Thanks for agreeing to speak with me today."

"Well of course. Your my daughter and I will always make time for you, no matter what time of day or night it is."

Luna speaks with her usual cheery voice but the bristling of her fur gives away her underlying worries. She's putting on a front as to not make me more anxious.

"Well I really appreciate it."

Gently, I start stroking my fingers through Melog's mane to keep my thoughts at bay. I feel that I should prepare Luna for somethings to expect when I'm talking about certain aspects

about my past. Nothing drastic but it's probably best to make her aware of things that might happen…

"Before we start there are so things I need to make you aware of. I asked Adora and Melog to join me because some of the stuff I want to tell you won't be easy for me to say. You deserve to know the truth, the whole truth about my past. I've always struggled with confronting my past and it's taken a lot of therapy and self-healing to get to where I am today. Melog's mane may change colour when I talk about certain things. This is natural as they reflect my emotions. However, there may be a point where Adora will have to speak for me. Back when I was in therapy… I-I struggled to talk about some of the stuff that happened to me. Adora has my permission to tell you everything I want to tell you should that happen. But Luna there is one thing I have to ask of you…"

Luna leans forward slightly and her ears prick forward. She places a gently hand over my knee, one which I surprisingly don't pull away from. Usually my reflex reaction, unless it was a touch from Adora, would make me pull away but that doesn't happen. Luna's touch is comforting and supportive, not manipulative and controlling like my memories of the past reflect.

When I look up at Luna I notice that she has a bright, encouraging smile on her face as she waits for me to continue. Taking a deep breath, I finishing telling Luna what I need from her most…

"I need you to let me get through it all before you ask me anything. It's sometimes easier for me to put it all out on the table before I'm asked more about what happened. Promise me you'll do that?"

Luna smile shines even brighter and I can see that her eyes are starting to become slightly glassy, with a hint of hidden anxiety behind them. I have a feeling mine will be the same shortly.

Thanks stars there's a box of tissues besides Adora should I need them.

Luna speaks softly when she answers…"I promise."

Leaning back, Luna settles down more comfortably ready to hear everything I'm about to tell her. Adora's thumb brushes gentle circles over the top of my hand. Adora's smile is all the encouragement I need to start…

Here we go.

"So you already know that Adora found me in the Fright Zone all those years ago and we've been best friends ever since. I never really left her side when we were kids, but there is a little bit more to the story of what happened when Adora first found me. There was this woman who wanted to dispose of me, hurt me, torture me in any way possible. *She* called me an abomination. This *bitch* over time would use her powers to spy on me, torment me and physically hurt me. Adora would patch up my wounds every night and make the healing process bearable. Fearing what would happen if I spoke the truth, I kept the truth about my injuries hidden from Adora for a very long time. As we got older Adora got suspicious of why my injuries looked electric and left traces of burns across my skin."

Shivering, one of my hands traces a now faded burn on my forearm. If you weren't there to see the original injury, you wouldn't even notice the scar that now hides under the fine whisps of fur. However, Adora and I will always know it's there, just like all the other scars that are hidden under my clothes.

Noticing the pause in words, Adora lifts my hand to her lips and places a gentle kiss to my knuckles. She reminds that *"It's okay. She can't hurt us anymore."* Despite that being true I still sometimes hear her voice in my nightmares, taunting me over everything I did wrong in life. However, I know that Adora is right. That *bitch* is gone, gone for good and she can never hurt me like that again.

Smiling at Adora, I take another steadying breath and speak to Luna once more…

"When Adora found out who was responsible for my pain she was unable to do anything as she was either stopped from saving me or was threaten by having me *'punished'* even more. At first Adora and I didn't think that the threats were real, but this witch didn't bluff. Adora tried everything to stop what was happening to me in secret, but she was always caught. The monstrous shadow spies were to thank for that. As the punishments got worse we couldn't risk it despite Adora's protest… I wouldn't let Adora risk it. *Not after last time.* I endured the bitch's wrath for many years. The person I'm on about... is Shadow Weaver!"

A deep growl comes from Luna's throat and her eyes become a sharp pin prick. Her claws are visible, making deep incisions in the sofa's cushions. Tears threaten to fall from her eyes, one does manage to escape.

"I'm going to kill her!" Luna growls through the grit of her teeth.

I know Luna promised to let me get through it all before she spoke but this was definitely within reason. Luna lost my mama, her wife, her best friend because of Shadow Weaver and now she is learning that I was abused by Shadow Weaver's hand.

I'm quick to put Luna's murdering mind at rest… "She's dead! She's already dead. She can't hurt me anymore. She can't hurt anyone anymore."

Luna appears to relax for a slight moment or too, letting her angry phase fade away. She does however look to Adora for confirmation that Shadow Weaver is in fact dead, which Adora does confirm. I can't tell if Luna's relieved that Shadow Weaver is dead or slightly disappoint as she wanted revenge. Either way Luna appears to now be back to her previous state, ready to listen to me as I continue to speak.

Adora gently squeezes me hand remind me that all is okay. She probably noticed my hackles slightly raised and Melog's mane turned a little red. Adora's gentle touch calms me almost instantly and Melog's mane returns to its calm blue hue again. I continue to tell Luna my story…

"Strangely it was that witch that brought Adora and I closer together. She never liked seeing us having fun and being happy around one another so she tried to target us against each another. It pissed her of that it only made us stronger and on track to be the strongest cadets in the Horde, along with our squadron team. Life wasn't all that bad in the Horde. Sure it was rough but we found ways to have fun. Adora and I would race each other down the corridors, spar for fun in our free training periods and we eventually found a place to call our secret hideout: the watch tower. It's the place where Adora told me her hard efforts had finally paid off as she had been promoted to Force Captain."

Looking over to Adora I smile, knowing that this is a certain part Adora is slightly worried about, even if she won't admit it. It was a day that should have been filled with happiness, and in hindsight I was happy for Adora, I was just pissed that I wasn't allowed on our first official mission. Sadly it was also the same night, leading into the next day, that I lost Adora for what I feared might be forever.

Adora can sense that this part of our story is coming. I can feel how nervous she is from her shaking hand held tight in my own. Comfortingly, I lean my forehead against hers for a moment or two as a way of silently showing that all will be okay. Adora, understanding what I mean, steadies her nerves so that I can continue to speak. She knows I won't say anything until we are both ready.

Luna notices the change in us both but she doesn't pressure us to speak. Supportively, Luna patiently waits and only asks if we are both okay or if we both would like a breather when I look back to her. Judging for Luna's eyes, I think she can sense something

major in our stories being brought up but her compassionate outlook doesn't fade.

When ready, I speak once more…

"Adora started having strange visions that night after she…"

Adora rolls her eyes, making me laugh slightly. She nudges me as if to say, *'Who really broke the skiff?'*

"…alright after *I* drove our skiff into a tree in the Whispering Woods. Happy now?"

Adora starts to giggle and nods her head in agreement. Luna smiles a bit brighter when she hears me tell Adora to piss off under my breath. I guess I should be happy that there is a little funny part to this fateful tale…

"Anyway, we were separated for a while and I didn't know at the time Adora had discovered She-Ra's original sword, the one the First-Ones created, and that was causing her visions. Adora being Adora, decided to go and investigate to see what it was. I was going to go with her but she asked me to cover for her, saying she'd be back before anyone noticed she was gone. Things happened and I had to delay certain events to avoid raising suspicions. Shadow Weaver however saw right through me and ordered me to bring Adora back by attending my first mission, the attack on Thaymor."

My mind blanks out for a little bit as I remember everything that happened that day. It all happened so fast, it's a miracle I even remember what exactly happened. Reaching out, I take a quick sip of my water, feeling my throat getting slightly dry…

"When I found Adora she had only just realized what the Horde was really doing, manipulating us to do their dirty work. I had known it for years but never felt that I could leave because I had nowhere else to go. Adora didn't want to go back to the Horde but I had to bring her back as Shadow Weaver had threatened to have my head if I failed my mission. I panicked as I couldn't force

Adora to come back no matter how hard I tried. I didn't understand why she was being so stubborn. However, it wasn't long after that that I realised why she was being stubborn… she was She-Ra, a *princess* no less."

Luna movements shift slightly, almost as if she feels a little uncomfortable. Adora's body slumps slightly feeling a bit ashamed. However, I do notice that Luna doesn't look disappointed at Adora. Quite the opposite in fact, Luna isn't looking at Adora at all. Instead, Luna looks dazed, as if she has just realised something. If I had a guess Luna has now maybe realised why the shock of being her daughter, *a princess*, didn't sit with me too well when we first met back in old Halfmoon.

Sensing that I'm probably best getting on with my tale, I clear my throat and continue to talk…

"At the time I was angry, blinded by the feeling of betrayal. We were taught to hate the princesses, to fight against them and their *'evil'* doing. I couldn't believe my best friend was one of them. Looking back now I realise that if Adora had come back to the Horde, they would have used her as their own weapon. Stars know what they would have done to her. They tried to brainwash her once so I have no doubt they'd have done that again or something worse."

Trembling slightly, Adora pulls me into a soft embrace. Melog nuzzles themselves in my lap further. I whisper over and over again to Adora how sorry I am for not releasing any of this sooner but she calms me with her soft words, reminding me that it's okay and that she is also partially to blame for the anger that stirred within me. I am haunted by the times when Adora's mind was erased and I was forced to watch it happen, only for me to be left with the memories taken from her. Micah and Castaspella are working to retrieve some of Adora's memories but I have told her all of what she is yet to regain.

Luna looks over to us sympathetically and asks if we are both okay. We will be okay, we just need a minute. I can tell from the

look in Luna's eyes and the look of her fur that she feels incredibly sorry that all of this happened to us, maybe even slightly guilty that she couldn't stop all this from happening. It makes me worry slightly about what will happen when I tell her about *him.*

Despite being calm once more, I remain leaning on Adora's shoulder. In return, Adora keeps a soft arm around my shoulders. I'm glad she is here with me…

"After that Adora left to fight with the Rebellion and I stayed with the Horde. She tried to reason with me many times to leave but I couldn't. I felt trapped. I felt even more trapped after I was promoted to Force Captain as I became a target, one who was recognised by many Horde members. I told Adora once that her leaving the Horde was the best thing that ever happened to me, but it wasn't."

Adora's chest jitters slightly. It's at this moment I notice that a few of her silent tears have started to fall. Doing my best to comfort her, I quietly start to purr. It's not easy but I'm doing it for Adora. Not only that but I'm doing my best to hold my own tears back.

"You okay?" I whisper.

"Yeah I'm good. I never wanted to leave you. You know that right? But I couldn't stay after what I saw."

"I know Adora and it's okay. I was too blind and angry to see it then. But you never gave up on me, not even after what happened to Angella."

Out of the corner of my eye I see Luna tilt her head curiously. Angella was one of her best friends so I'm worried how she will react to this next part.

Leaning up off Adora, I prepare myself for this next part. A few more deep breathes and I speak again, ready to tell her the real reason why Angella is no longer in Brightmoon…

"A while after Adora left I was sent on a mission to the Crimson Waste by Hordak to find some First-Ones tech to open a portal. It was a *'dead mission'* as we called it. No one usually returns from there. I was sent there on a *'mission'* as I let Shadow Weaver escape. She manipulated me again after she was imprisoned and used her magic to escape. I was so stupid that I didn't see it coming. Entrapta, the science geek who found old Halfmoon, was the one who gave me a fighting chance by suggesting the mission as Hordak's initial plan was to have me sent to Beast Island..."

Luna looks a bit curious by that but also surprised. She only recently found out about Hordak being under house arrest in Dryl. Let just say it did make her a bit suspicious of Entrapta, especially with her being the friend of one who tried to kill her many years ago. However, Entrapta has proved that she, unlike Hordak, is not a threat and was only trying to peruse the wonders of science and wanted to stop the portal from opening after the data showed catastrophic effects.

"Scorpia came with me to the Crimson Waste for reinforcements and we became good friends. We took over a gang and ruled there for a little while. Life seemed okay at that time but I was blinded by hatred again when I discovered where Shadow Weaver had gone after we captured Adora. I discovered that Shadow Weaver had somehow teleported to Brightmoon and gave intel on how to destroy the Horde. Hordak built a device to activate a portal to bring his *'brothers'* army forward and She-Ra's sword was the key. Entrapta advised me against it as the power was too chaotic, but I wouldn't listen. I had too much at stake, I needed to prove myself to Hordak that I was worthy… so I pulled the trigger, opening the portal to another dimension."

A few stray tears fall from my eyes. My hands move to rest on my knee, where they form fist as I desperately try to fight tears back…

"If I had known what was going to happen I never would have pulled the switch. I would have left the Horde when I first had the chance but I was too far in to leave now. The portal broke the

space time continuum and Etheria started to collapse in on itself. The only way to stop the madness was to remove the key causing the damage, the key being She-Ra's sword. Adora went to sacrifice herself but Angella wouldn't let her. Instead, Angella was the one who removed the sword and in doing so gave her life to save us all. She's stuck between alternate dimensions because of me."

Tears start to fall from eye. My arms wrap around Melog tightly as they force their head under my hands. I let their presence comfort me. I can feel Adora's hand soothingly rubbing circles across my back as I keep whispering how sorry I am for everything I ever did into Melog's mane. I don't even know who I'm saying sorry to anymore: Melog, Adora, Luna, Sparkles, Angella. Everything is such a mess.

My ears prick forward slightly from their resting position against my head when I hear a faint rustling sound. When I look up I realise that Luna is holding a small handful of tissues, offering them to me. Luna also has faint tears running down her cheeks but a comforting smile on her face.

Gratefully, I take the tissue from Luna's hand and wipe my tears away, blowing my nose as well. It's definitely not as cute as when I sneeze. I probably look a right mess.

When I've calmed down a little more, I take a sip of water so my throat won't sound as croaky as it feels. Adora also asks me if I am okay as she lets me rest my head against her chest. Her arms wrap around me in soft embrace.

When ready, I continue with my story once more…

"Things only started to get a lot worse from there. At first I thought things were great. I was promoted to the Horde's Second-in-Command but was soon treated like the leader of the Horde. Power started to change me. How could have I been so blind? I lashed out a people more often, sent them on grueling missions and turned those who stood by me throughout thick and

thin away and toward destruction. At first it was Adora, then it was Scorpia, then Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio. I drove them all away. About the only good thing I achieved was I lowering the mortality rate of civilians and soldiers when conducting attacks. I won't deny that lives were lost but I did my best to reduce innocent blood shed. *But even then it wasn't good enough. I was never good enough*. Double Trouble made me see that I never had it in my heart to be the enemy..."

Luna's tail still slightly. She has heard of Double Trouble a few times, both from Adora and myself. Although Double Trouble and I have rekindled our friendship and worked out our differences Luna is still a bit wary of their role in my story when she hears their name. However, she has promised to keep an open mind if she ever meets them.

"I though winning would be different, but my heart was never really in the game. Winning was never what I wanted, but it's what I had to do to survive. When Sparkles came to finish me off I didn't fight her, I simply gave in. I deserved to die after everything I did, but she must have seen something in me that changed her mind. I was at my lowest point of life. I didn't see the point in continuing… but then *Prime* arrived."

Melog's mane turns slightly red and starts to change form to spikes. Adora's hand also tightens slightly as she feels the trembling of my hands. His name alone is enough for me to want to panic, to run, to scream.

Luna seems to become more concerned and worried than I have ever seen her. She must be able to see and feel my fear.

I can do this… I can do this… he can't hurt me anymore.

"Prime, also know as Horde Prime, was the leader of the Galactic Horde that led to Hordak creating the Horde on Etheria. He sent Hordak down here as he was a defect, a clone who didn't meet *'Prime's light'*. At first I thought Prime saw value in me. I knew if I did what he asked then I'd be okay, I would survive. However,

when you're stuck on a ship, isolated with only a few clones and an imprisoned Sparkles to keep you company, you start think. I saw a different light and decided to do something good with my life. If I was to be trapped up there for the rest of my life and doomed with whatever came next then I wanted to do one good thing. So I did just that. I got Sparkles back to her friends and told Adora that I was sorry for everything. I warned her to stay away as Prime was after her. I never wanted to hurt her or anyone, and now I was about to pay the price."

My breathing starts to stagger and my body starts to shake. Visions are trying to torment my mind as recall his torture methods. I have to take a few deep, steady breaths to clear my thoughts before I try to speak again. This is what I always struggle to talk about…

"Prime decided to *'purify'* me. To *heal* me from my suffering. To take me into *his light* and make me *new*. I was stripped of my dignity, my freedom, my pride… and my mind."

Luna's once calm expression fades to shock and extreme concern. I've never seen this look on her before. Panic is wanting to set in but I don't allow it to, *not yet*. Helping Melog and Adora keep me calm, Luna leans forward and takes her hands in mine. When I look into her eyes, I notice that my vision is blurry, mostly likely from the waiting to fall tears…

"H-he dragged me into his green purification pool, tortured me in ways I never thought possible, shaved my mane away with the swipe of his metal claw and attached a control chip to the back of my neck. He intended to use me as a weapon against the person I loved the most. Adora came to rescue me despite me telling her to stay away, knowing full well what Prime had planned to do to her."

A few tears end up falling but I'm not prepared to stop just yet. Adora asks if she wants me to take over but I know all this will be better said coming from me. Adora nods understandingly as she tries her best to hold back her own tears. Melog rests their head

on my shoulder as Adora rubs soothing circles across my back. Luna also does something similar by gently squeezing my hands. Their support means a lot to me. Now more that ever I need to get all whilst I still can…

"I was forced to fight her, forced to try and kill her. I saw everything behind my green eyes, even thought they were *his* eyes. I was fighting against my heart and controlled mind. I was screaming for help but they could only be heard by him. I'm ashamed that I have given Adora scars because of that battle, because of many battles. I was terrified of hurting her, but she never gave up on me, no matter how difficult it was for her to have to fight back. Adora cracking the chip was the only thing that allowed me to speak with her one last time."

My hands move out of Luna's gentle hold and my arms move to hug myself. Adora instantly reacts by pulling me to a tight hug. I start to recoil in on myself, reliving that horrible moment as the panic and guilt settles in. Adora and Melog remind me to take deep steady breathes and that we are now safe and that *he* can never hurt us again.

That day haunts my sleep, gives me panic attacks and makes me feel more pain than I have ever felt in my life. I hurt the person who matters to me most and I can never take away her scars. It takes a while for the panicking phase to disappear. When I feel calm again I try to form words, sensing that Luna wants to ask what I mean by *'one last time'*. The issue comes when I struggle to form words even after having a drink of water. Adora asks if I want her to tell the rest. Slowly, I nod my head against her chest letting her know that's it's okay if she speaks for me. It's probably for the best anyway. All I remember after falling was blacking out and feeling my last life being taken from me. That was however, before a bright glow of warmth brought me back.

Adora's hold on my body remains strong yet comforting and she places a gentle kiss to my forehead. Luna is somehow able to sense that I am now okay and once again calm. Not wanting to

invade my space, Luna removes her gentle touch from my knees and moves to sit back on her seat as she listens to Adora.

Adora takes a light sigh and speaks the remaining part of this chapter…

"When Catra's chip cracked I was able to speak to her, the real her, for a matter of seconds. She thought that she didn't matter but to me she was everything. To me she had always mattered. I wasn't going to give up on her. She meant to much to me. I wasn't ready to give up so easily, not without a fight. When Prime got his hold back on her, Catra used all of her strength to fight him to regain control of her mind. It was a dangerous game. A game that he almost won."

This part keeps Adora awake most nights. She often awakes in tears, reliving the nightmare but this time with a different ending. My arms, which have moved to wrap around Adora's waist, give her a gentle squeeze. Quietly, I remind Adora that I'm here with her, and that I'm safe, all thanks to her. Adora does her best to hold back her tears as she continues to speak…

"Prime shocked her, causing her excruciating pain, which made her to black-out. She fell off an extremely high platform. I didn't hesitate and followed her, jumping down myself. She was in a terrible state when I got to her. I had never seen her so broken, so fragile. Using all myself, I crawled over to her. The height and force of my landing caused my legs to break, but I didn't care about myself in that moment. I needed to get to Catra. I didn't know it then but that fight took her last life. She was dying in my arms."

A single tear leaves Adora's eyes as she hold me close. My tail moves to wrap around Adora's hand and I do my best to purr. When all words fail, this is the best way to comfort Adora…

"The fear of losing Catra for good summoned She-Ra. I thought She-Ra was lost to me as I had to break the sword to stop the Heart of Etheria from activating. I took out all of Prime's main

clones one by one and got us out of harm's way. Healing was never easy as She-Ra. I had always struggled to heal and was worried that my efforts with Catra had failed. I thought I had lost her for good but by some wordless miracle I got her back. I held her close and never wanted to let go. I lost her once and I wasn't going to lose her again. She meant to much to me, even if I didn't know at the time that this feeling I had for her, the feeling I had always had for her, was love."

As Adora speaks, I feel myself starting to relax even further, especially now *that* part is said and done. Adora places another gentle kiss to the top of my head and continues to speak…

"I spent so many nights with Catra back on the ship on our journey back to Etheria. I didn't want to leave her side. At first we thought we were okay, but Catra had it much worse. The chip was still active and giving her flash backs. Catra asked Glimmer and I to cut her hair even shorter so it wasn't the slick mess that Prime made. Before Entrapta made her some new clothes I did a bit of DIY with my own, making sure that she has something comfortable and warm to wear. Once Entrapta removed the chip, Catra started to open up to me again. We were finally on our way home. Although, we still had the problem of finding out how to stop Prime before it was too late. His armada had managed to chip the majority of our friends back on Etheria so we needed answers fast. Melog, along a little help from Wrong Hordak, gave us the answers we needed."

Mreow

Melog perks up at the mention of their name and nudges my hand. I smile brightly at them, moving to stroke their mane. They instantly respond with a loud, vibrating purr. Melog's mane has thankfully returned to its calm, blue, wavy state.

"Thanks Adora. I think I can take it from here."

Adora smiles and places a gentle kiss to my forehead. As I move out of her warm embrace, Adora retakes my hand in hers, giving

it a reassuring squeeze. When I look to Luna it's clear that a tear or two has escaped from her eyes but I still have her full attention…

"Melog isn't from Etheria. They're from a planet called Krytis. They're the only remaining individual of their kind. Prime desolated their planet many years ago but left it destroyed rather than conquering and colonizing it. Why he ran we didn't know. That was until we met Melog. To say our first introduction went smoothly is a complete lie. It was far from it. We were both as terrified as each other, unsure of what the other individual was. Melog transformed into the form they're in now and after a little confrontation and investigation, decided that my friends and I were not a threat. They felt safe with me and decided to bond with me, which is why I can hear exactly what they're saying and they reflect the emotions that I am feeling. I'm surprised Adora didn't pick up on the fact that I loved her a long time before I told her simply based off how Melog acted around her."

Adora rolls her eye and giggles sightly, before leaning over and giving Melog a tickle under their chin. I notice Luna smile slightly. I take this as an opportunity to continue talking…

"Melog told us that Prime was the one who destroyed their planet and that his weakness was magic. That's how we knew we needed to find a way to stop Prime by potentially using the Heart of Etheria's magic source. When we got back to Etheria we discovered a failsafe system created by the She-Ra before Adora, that could stop Prime in his tracks… but even that came at a price."

Luna curiously leans forward slightly, interested to know more. Her eyes look a little red from all the tears she has shed or held back. Adora's grip on my hand tightens and loosen a series of times. I know she worries about this part. Adora decided to fill in the blanks for this part knowing that this part is best coming from her.

A hint of guilt can be heard in Adora's voice as she speaks…

“Only She-Ra could accept the failsafe and survive absorbing the hearts magic. At the time I was only thinking about saving everyone, especially Catra. I was taught to believe that it didn’t matter what happened to me as long as I fulfilled my destiny. I didn’t stop to think how my choice would affect others, affect the one who mattered to me most, until after it was too late. It drove Catra away from me. I lost her again. I had lost all that mattered to me.”

Seeing that Adora to this day still blames herself for my decision to leave, I decide to break my silence on the matter…

“But you didn’t lose me Adora, not really. I left as I couldn’t bare to watch you leave me again, this time through death, because you believed that your life was worth nothing. I left before you could leave me. Melog was the one who made me see sense."

Melog rumbles next to us. Adora and I smile as we give them a little bit of attention as thanks. Adora whispers *"I love you"* and I return the same words to her. Our short, tender moment doesn't last long as I know there is more to tell about my past. I look back to Luna once more...

"I had to get to Adora before Prime’s virus took over the planet. I forced Shadow Weaver to take me to her, to help me save Adora. It was the first time I ever stood up to her. I wasn’t going to take her shit any longer…”

A hums of satisfaction comes from Luna when she hears how I stood up to Shadow Weaver. There is still the hint of a glare in Luna's eyes when I mention *her* name but at least she is no longer a problem, at least not in this world.

“When I found Adora she was in bad shape. The Heart of Etheria’s guardian had taken its first victim and its venom, combined with Prime’s virus, was starting to affect Adora. I had planned to fight the creature myself, to make it suffer every last minute for hurting the one I love, but I too soon became its second victim. It’s the only time Shadow Weaver ever fought to protect us both.”

Luna leans forward slightly in questions but she doesn't say a word. Instead, Luna allows me to answer her question that is visible on the tip of her tongue…

"Shadow Weaver gave her life to allow Adora and I to live. She said that she was proud of me. I not sure if she meant it or if she said it to play with my mind but frankly I don't care anymore. At the end of the day, she was a bitch to me. Although I'm grateful for her sacrifice, it doesn't make up for everything she even did to me. I am the one left with these scars and haunted memories for life, *not her.*"

Shadow Weaver's death is something that Adora and I took a lot of time to process. The woman who hurt us was finally gone, but her final words not only confused us, but also tormented us. I'll never know if she spoke the truth in her final words, but maybe that's a good thing.

In the corner of my eye, I notice that Luna's claws have dug deep into the arm rest. *That* name must really make her blood boil. It seems strange that Dusk also appears to have do a similar thing with her talons on her perch. I'm not sure when Dusk started to listen in on our conversation but from the looks of it she's been listening for a while.

Before I continue I make sure that Adora is okay. As much as this is my story, Adora also plays a big part in it. Our stories, our destinies, were intertwined from the start. Once Adora confirms that she is okay, I go back to looking at Luna and finish the hard part of confronting my past…

"When we got to the Heart, Adora couldn't transform. She tried so many times to a point it caused her great pain. Time was against us. In the end, Adora begged me to leave her side, to save myself... *but I wasn't prepared to do that*. We made a promise when we were little to always look out for each other. We'd be together at the end of the world and if this was it, then so be it. Time went on and I could see Adora's pain, even though her body was almost lifeless in my arms. I could feel everything. Thinking

that it was the end, I confessed my love for her and begged her to stay. Prime's virus broke the surface and I was ready to see my fate but it never came. Adora, somehow on the brink of death, summoned She-Ra's shield and protected us both. I never thought she would love me back but she did. Turns out she had always loved me. We had always loved each other. We released the hearts magic together, Adora managed to destroy Prime and the rest is history."

Wasting no time, I gently guide Adora and Melog into a quick, tight hug before I round everything off. Melog starts to purr even louder whilst Adora hums and swiftly kisses the side of my cheek. She also takes the opportunity to gently brush my remaining tears away. I look to Luna and continue...

"After the war ended we made home at Brightmoon. It took a lot of therapy and self-reflection to work through everything that had happened us. As I imagined, not everyone forgave me for my past actions and I don't blame them. There's still a lot of work that needs doing here and there but I'm doing everything I can to make things right…"

Looking back, I realise how far I have come since the war ended. I'm happier, healthier but most importantly I'm surrounded by people who love me and support me unconditionally.

"I may never forgive myself for some of the things I have done. Many of those thing still haunt me today, but I'm working through it all. I want to be someone that my friends, my family and myself can be proud of. I am no longer the person I was. The past version of me was blinded by anger, confusion and fear. I'm trying my best to be a better person. I know I'm a better person because I found love and I've let love guide me ever since. I'm sorry that I didn't tell you any of this sooner but I was scared to do so… scared as to what you'd think of me once I told you the truth."

It's done. It's over. It's all out in the open. I feel relieved that I have finally told Luna the truth, the whole truth. However, now

that all is said and done I can feel my anxiety building as to what the aftermath of this discussion will be.

Cautiously, my eyes look over to Luna. Her expression is hard to analyse. Unsurprisingly, this is a lot for her to process. She might be a mix of emotions right now which is why her expression is hard to analyse.

Silence is never a good thing… right?

A few more moments of awkward silence pass. Even Adora looks to me concerned at one point, unsure of what to say, or if to say anything at all. My grip on Adora's hand tightens as I await Luna's answer. Tension is quickly building.

Luna doesn't speak a word as she leans forward slightly. Thankfully, Luna's recognizable soft smile soon appears. Her eyes are extremely glassy as she tries to hold them back. She takes a gentle breath and finally speaks…

"Thank you, for sharing all that with me. Do you mind if I give you a hug you?"

Well I was not expecting that reaction at all. Where's the anger? Where's the rage? Where's the disappointment? I was expecting something much different to this reaction.

Overwhelmed, fresh tears start to fall from my eyes as I allow Luna to pull me into a soft, warm, yet strong embrace. Luna also starts to cry. *Stars knows what she is feeling right now.* In the corner of my vision I notice Adora and Melog relax and smile beside me. I'll take this as a good sign.

When Luna and I part, she has a soft grip on my shoulder…

"You okay?"

Luna asks, in a less concerned voice than before. She still sounds concerned but this time she sounds softer when she speaks.

Wiping a stay tear out of my eyes I respond…

"Yeah. Yeah I'm okay. I feel better now I've shared all that with you. I know that it was quite a lot to discuss but you deserved to know the truth: the whole truth about who I was and what happened in my past."

Luna smiles and returns back to her previous seat once she's certain that I am okay.

She's bound to have questions. She's got to.

Luna takes a sip of her water and I do the same. All the while, Adora leans over and whispers in my ear… *"I'm proud of you."*

When I get the chance I rest my head against Adora's shoulder and respond… *"I couldn't have done it without you being here. Thank you."*

I also take the opportunity to thank Melog. I know I struggle to talk about my past sometimes but it mustn't have been easy for these two to relive it either. The memories of those days still haunt us, even if we all have different parts that affect us in different ways. We've had our share of reliving the past. Hopefully it will get easier with time. It's certainly easier that it used to be.

After a moment of two it becomes clear that Luna is now ready to speak and ask any questions she may have…

Be prepared Catra. I know things seem to have gone well so far but don't get your hopes up.

"First of all, thank you again for sharing that with me. I'm sorry you had to go through all that but it means a lot to me that you felt like you could share that with me. I now understand why opening up to people hasn't been easy for you, any of you."

Luna takes another deep breath and then looks to Adora. Automatically, Adora tenses up a bit but eases slightly when Luna gives her a reassuring smile…

“Secondly, Adora, thank you for taking care of Catra when I couldn’t. I know it mustn’t have been easy to leave her behind but as Catra said, you never gave up on her. If she is anything like me, which I can clearly see that she is, I can only imagine how stubborn she was…”

Adora and I softly giggle-hum at Luna’s words. Luna smiles at the sight and continues to speak…

“But seriously, thank you for saving her and for keeping her safe. My thanks also goes to you too Melog. It means a lot to me to know that she wasn’t truly alone all those years."

Melog *murps* happily, swishing their tail about in mid air. Adora however looks a bit hesitant, almost as if she wants to say something. However, before she can say anything at all, Luna stops her, knowing exactly what is ticking in Adora's mind...

"Before you say it, I know you and Catra a part for some years but it's clear to see that you never gave up on each other… no matter how difficult times became.”

Oh great now my eyes are filling up again. Don’t cry Catra… don’t cry, don’t cry.

Adora simply smiles. She appears to be lost for words. Luna goes to speak again but not before her claws dig into the pillows beside her…

“Also, you are both very lucky that *bitch* is dead otherwise she would have had me to deal with. Add that Prime *bastard* to that statement too. I can assure you now that they would have paid for everything they ever did to you. I would have made them suffer, used their own powers against them. They’ve both had a *lucky* escape from my wrath because I’m *not* one to hold back when someone hurts those I care about.”

SCREECH

Dusk appears to be in agreement with Luna, especially judging from the pitch of her screech. Adora and I chuckle slightly, Melog too shaking their mane in amusement. At least neither of them remain an issue to us and we are no longer losing sleep because of them… *well, at least for the majority of nights.*

Luna's expression suddenly drops. Her breath hitching slightly. Leaning forward, she looks me straight in the eye. Concern that was once gone from her expression has now returned…

"I really appreciate you telling me all this and I'm thankfully that you have finally had the courage to tell me. But Catra… what I want to know is why did you feel like you couldn't tell me all this sooner? That's the one thing I can't understand."

This is something that I feel should discuss with Luna alone.

Looking to Melog and Adora, I confidently ask…"Do you mind giving us a few minutes?"

At first, Adora and Melog look at me slightly confused but they soon give me a reassuring smile in understanding. Adora places a gentle kiss to the top of my head and reminds me that they'll be right outside the door should I need them. Melog *mreows* in confirmation of Adora's words and brushes their head against mine before following Adora. Luna gestures for Dusk to follow. Dusk graciously flutters her wings and lands on Adora's shoulder as she approaches the door. They all look back to us one last time before the door closes, leaving only Luna and myself in the room.

I take a few deep breathes before I answer Luna. Some loose tears start to roll down my cheek…

"I didn't tell you sooner because I was scared of what you'd think of me after I told you the truth, the whole truth. I've never been great at opening up about my feelings or my past but you deserved to know everything that happened. I could tell that you wanted to ask, wanted to know more but I was worried that once I told you everything about my past that you'd see me differently.

I was afraid that you'd be ashamed of me, abandon me for real and I-I couldn't bear the thought of losing you again."

My tears start to heavily fall and there's no stopping them. Instead of staying in front of me, Luna comes to sit at my side and pulls me into a gentle hug. Her tail links together with mine and she starts to draw slow circles across my back. Luna lets me cry against her chest as she holds me close. Through tears she whispers promising words to me… *"It's okay. It's going to be okay"… "I've got you"… "I'm not going anywhere".*

After a few minutes my tears start to slow down. Luna passes me a tissues to help clear my eyes from their pools of tears. When I find the strength to look up at Luna, it becomes clear that she too has been faintly crying.

Our eyes are definitely going to be sore in the morning.

Somehow, Luna manages to hold back her remaining tears so she can speak to me once more…

"How long have you been keeping that to yourself?"

Feeling slightly ashamed, my eyes avoid looking at Luna when I respond...

"Since the night I found out that I was your daughter. I wanted to be someone you could be proud of and all of *that* makes me feel like you'd be ashamed of me."

Suddenly, Luna places two firms hands on my shoulders. Her grip is strong but not too tight. It is however, strong enough for me to know that she wants me to look at her. When my eyes find Luna's she opens up to me and speaks from her heart, doing her best to put my fears at rest…

"I am *never* going to be ashamed of you Catra. I said what I meant back when I first met you. I don't care how painful the stories are to tell, I will listen to everything you want to tell me when you're ready. The good and the bad. I'm so sorry that I

couldn’t protect you from all that but you did what you had to do to survive. No one can judge you for wanting to live. If anyone were to walk in your footsteps, I bet they would have done the exact same. Anyone who says otherwise, you send them my way and I’ll give them a lesson they’ll never forget.”

That earns a slight giggle from me, helping to put my thoughts at ease. Luna continues doing her best to hold back tears…

“As for looking at you differently after telling me all this... I do in a way.”

Shivering, a little sigh of worry escapes me but the shake of Luna’s head tells me that it is not a bad thing. Confused, I look into her eyes, trying to find some answers. Instead of having to search for them, Luna tells me what she means…

“When I first met you and got to know you, I saw a strong, caring Magicat who had a story to tell. Now I see that and so much more. When I look at you now Catra, I see a courageous, loyal, persistent, and dedicate individual who did everything possible to overcome her struggles and make things right. You’ll probably be trying to make things right for the rest of your life, *believe me I know,* but it shows how much of a good person you really are.”

A teary smile on my behalf starts to appear. It’s hard not to smile when your fears and worries are starting to disappear. Luna’s smile reflects my own, but she’s determined to say what she needs to say before she lets her tears fall…

“I am proud to call you my daughter Catra. Nothing can ever change my mind about how much love I have for you. I have loved you from the moment I first laid my eyes on you. Not only that but I loved you a long time before I knew you were a possibility. You are my world Catra. I want you to remember that you can tell me anything, no matter the time of day. I will always be here for you. I will always be your mother, no matter what.”

Luna finally lets her tears fall and this time it is me who pulls her into a tight embrace. Neither one of us want to let go of the other. Tears and silent promises are shared. I finally know what it feels like to have the love and support of a parent who means everything to. I never want to lose her again and thankfully I know now that I never will. Luna will always be there for me through thick and thin, no matter what. Luna will forever love and support me unconditionally.

Fear and dread of losing Luna washes away and I am no longer scared to say the one thing I have longed to say from the very moment I found her. Holding Luna close, I speak from my heart…

"I love you mom. I always have."

Chapter End Notes

> There you have it. Catra finally opened up to Luna about her past and in the end everything turned out fine. Not only that but Catra has found the courage to call Luna her mom... someone pass me the tissues.
>
> Hope you all enjoyed chapter twelve of Finding Halfmoon. Special thanks to TheDoctor101 for reading over this chapter before it updated (go check their work out, they're ace). I was worried about updating this chapter due to it's sensitive topics but it was a vital part of the story. I just hope I did it justice.
>
> Only three chapters remain. Can you believe it. Next update is Friday. What do you think is left to come? Let us know in the comments. See you soon.
>
> P.S - Thank you all for your continued support throughout the fic updates, especially with the longer chapter updates like this. It means a lot to me 😊

Moving Forward

Chapter Summary

About a month has passed and a new chapter in Halfmoon's history is about to be written.

Adora and Catra arrange a little surprise for Luna.

As Catra still worries about an engagement gift for Adora, Luna helps her come up with the perfect idea.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"It still looks how I remember it. Classic Micah and Angella, they never really liked change."

"Really. You're seriously telling me that nothing has changed since you last saw Brightmoon?"

"Well little things here and there have changed but nothing major. It's still as bright and sparkly as I remember. I always said that it was called *'Bright'*moon for a reason."

Luna eyes look over to me, and I notice the teasing smirk just to see my reaction...

"That was a really bad mom joke."

Luna bursts out laughing when she see how unimpressed I am. She'd definitely going to fit in with Arrow Boy's dads. They're going to have some competition with their awful parent jokes.

It's been a couple of weeks since Luna and I had the conversation that I was dreading back at Halfmoon. Things have been so much easier between us. I no longer feeling like I'm stepping on eggs shells when bringing up things from my past and I more happy

and comfortable staying in Halfmoon knowing that Luna is not ashamed of me. It was like the air had been cleared and I was free to get on with my life once more.

Since our talk I have found it easier to address Luna as my mom. I was scared at first as I was afraid of how she'd react but it's never been easier. Luna shed many tears, happy ones, when I call her mom for the first time. I don't think she was expecting it at all, but in that moment it felt right. It's been a strange adjustment for us both but we quickly got used to it. Now I very rarely address Luna by her name.

A few others things have been said since our conversation. Little bits creeping in like where my fear of water can from and how I ended up loosing all my nine lives before Adora rescued me from Prime. However, you can't have the bad without the good. Luna seemed to really enjoy learning more about how mine and Adora's relationship developed over time and how Adora proposed to me. Speaking of which I could really do with getting back to figuring out what to give to Adora as her proposal gift from me. *I wonder if Luna could help?*

Anyway, after a month of planning and preparations, Halfmoon officially came out of hiding and was welcomed back into the new Etherian world. Many thought this is was a risky idea, but Luna reassured them that it was time for change. It was time for a new beginning and to move forward into the future. Some still choose to stay within Halfmoon's grounds which is fine, each to their own, but many of the younger Magicats have chosen to explore this new world, a world full of opportunity and adventure.

Today is the first day the Luna has returned to Brightmoon in over two decades. Today will mark the start of a new chapter and a new beginning.

"You ready to go inside and meet everyone?" Adora ask with full confidence.

Luna looks up to the castle entrance and smiles... “Ready as I’ll ever be.”

--

When we enter the war room everyone is there ready and waiting. News spread fast to the Rebellion when I first met Luna but this is the first time the majority of them will have met her. Sparkles is talking with Arrow boy and Micah. Melog is with Scorpia and Perfuma, who are giving them all the attention they desire. Mermista seems to be groaning about some *‘epic adventure’* that Sea Hawk is telling Frosta about. She can roll her eyes all she wants, I know how she truly feels about him. Netossa and Spinnerella seems to be in a world of their own as if they’re not even here in the room with everyone else. Wrong Hordak is observing whatever Entrapta is doing on her tech-pad with Emily in stand-by mode at her side. I wonder what Entrapta's next scientific discovery will be?

When the Rebellion finally notice us they all fall silent. It’s difficult to tell what the current mood in the room is. Some appear shocked and surprised, others are smiling. I can’t even tell how Luna is feeling as she is very good at putting on a front, keeping a firm and polite outlook. I on the other hand am not so good at doing that, at least not as good as I used to be. Adora notices the shift in my body language and decides to try and change the atmosphere…

“Hi Everyone? How are you all?”

Okay that clearly didn’t work as everyone is still standing in shock.

Thankfully, Micah is the one who manages to successfully release the silent tension in the room...

“Luna you made it. Welcome to Brightmoon. I doubt it looks much different from how you remember it. You know how much Angella *loved* changing things up.”

Luna chuckles slightly as she responds...

“Oh I remember alright. But if I remember correctly, you were both as bad as each other when it came to change.”

Micah laughs as he comes forward and formally shakes Luna’s hand before guiding her towards the holographic table in the centre of the room to greet the others. As Micah comes forward Melog makes their way over to me, distracting me from my thoughts. Leaning down, I give them a gentle scratch between their ears in greeting. Melog spent the night with Scorpia and Perfume so that Adora and I could get things ready with Luna for today. They appear to have had a good night.

Everyone starts to talk once more, all having questions filled with curiosity that they want to ask...

“You remember my daughter Glimmer?”

“Queen Luna it is an honour to see you again and have you here in Brightmoon with us.” Sparkles says as she reaches out to shake her hand.

Luna accepts and replies to her in a happy tone… “It’s a pleasure to be here but please none of this formal *‘queen Luna’* or *‘your majesty’* business. Please, call me Luna, and that goes to all of you. Just plain simple Luna. It’s feels and sounds far less intimidating.”

The whole room is filled with soft laughter and the atmosphere feels much more relaxed now that that is out of the way. I guess it’s time for formal introductions to be made. It only feels right that I introduce everyone to her…

“So I imagine you are all aware by now that Luna is in fact my mom. Mom, these are my friends and members of the Rebellion.

You've already meet Adora, Arrow Boy, Sparkles and Micah but allow me to introduce you to everyone else."

Scanning the room, I begin pointing out who is who and where they are from…

"This is Mermista. She is the water princess of Salineas who is incredibly talented with water. This is her adventure boyfriend Sea Hawk. Don't *ever* bring a boat here or he will set it on fire."

"Well that's not entirely true. I only do that when necessary." Sea Hawk softly argues trying his best to look convincing.

"You literally set the boat on fire last night after your latest Adventure." Mermista says as she rolls her eyes.

"Yes but what good is an epic ADVENTURE without a glorious ending. Besides the dragons daughter twelve was on her last sail. She deserved to go out in style."

The princesses start to laugh and Mermista simply groans. I do catch the glimpse of a tiny smile appearing though so she's not as pissed as she's acting. I continue with my introductions…

"With them is the mini ice breaker Frosta. She's the princess of the Kingdom of Snows. If you ever need a bounce for anything she's the princess you need. Believe me when I say you don't want to annoy her."

"I might be small but I am mighty." Frosta emphasizes as she forms strong ice fists out of thin air.

Luna chuckles softly and teasingly smiles… "Aren't you a little young to be in the Rebellion?"

"Some might say that but my experience says otherwise. Besides, I've been ruling my kingdom since I was eleven. I'm now nearly thirteen."

Frosta has no bite in her words like she usually would. Instead she speaks with confidence and pride. However, if I was to ask that question instead of Luna, we might have had a different outcome.

Tittering to myself, I continue with the formal introductions...

“At the back over there is Entrapta, the tech geek that I was telling you about who you've briefly have met before. The pet robot besides her is called Emily. She was the one who originally found Old Halfmoon before we even knew it existed. Entrapta sent her out on a scout mission when she stumbled across the ruins. The final member of the trio over there is Wrong Hordak. He’s a brilliant cook.”

Entrapta waves a strand of purple hair and smile back at Luna. Emily beeps and boops a few times as a way of saying hello. Wrong Hordak nervously waves. It’s not often he is invited to these sort of things so this might be a new and slightly scary experience for him.

“You’ve met Scorpia before so no introduction need there. The princess next to her is Perfuma. She’s the princess of Plumeria and she is also the one who has helped me work through at lot of the issues that I have spoken to you about.”

Perfuma gently smiles and speak… “It’s a pleasure to finally meet you Luna. I have heard so much about you.”

“It’s a pleasure to meet you too. I see Scorpia has found someone quite special. Catra has told me a lot about you both.”

Both Scorpia and Perfume start to blush and they struggle to hide their growing smiles. They’ve been together for a while but hearing stuff like that still causes them to blush. Scorpia is the one who answers…

“Yeah I have. Pretty much like Catra has found Adora… and Glimmer with Bow… and Mermista with Sea Hawk… oh and Netossa with Spinnerella.”

Luna lightly chuckles at Scorpia's words. Everyone in the room seems to have heart in their eyes when Scorpia mentions each other their names. I think Luna had worked out all of this before hand but it's nice to see that she appreciates it.

"And finally, this is Netossa and Spinnerella… aka the *ancient ones* of the Rebellion."

"Oh you went there!" Netossa jokes and Spinnerella laughs.

Sensing my chance, I decide to tease them a little bit...

"It's true though. You were here *long* before these princesses joined the Rebellion. Remind me, how old you are again?… Oh wait you don't need to tell me as I can see you slowing down on the netball court."

"That was one time... *one time!* Besides, Spinny and I can kick your ass any day if we really wanted to. Name your time and place and we'll prove it too you."

The room irrupts with laughter and Spinerella decides to continue the conversation… "It's a pleasure to meet you Luna. In case you haven't already guessed, Netossa and Catra are very competitive and we have a game of netball whenever she and Adora come round the visit. We enjoy having them round, getting to see their relationship bloom. Catra is quite a remarkable young Magicat, one we are very privileged to call our friend."

Great now I'm blushing.

Luna smiles and turns to face me… "I'm happy to hear it. I'm very lucky to have her as my daughter."

Great now I'm blushing even harder!

Adora pulls me into a hug from the side, reminding me that she is beside me. I try my best to hide my reddening cheek against her shoulder, much to a failed attempt.

Out of nowhere Frosta pipes up…

“Wait a minute? If Luna is the Queen of Halfmoon, and you’re her daughter… does that make you a…”

Quickly reaction, I try to stop Frosta from confirming her thoughts...

“No! Where not even going there.”

Unfortunately for me, my effort prove useless when Mermista stands and screams...

“By the love of Etheria you’re a Princess!”

Urgh great. Now I have to explain all this to them

“Technically... yes but I don’t see myself as one.”

I stumble over my words when I speak. There’s no denying the truth now. Even if my mom and mama decided years ago to drop royal statues, there is still no denying that I am from a royal bloodline.

Netossa starts laughing through her words… “Oh my stars. This is hilarious. You used to hate princesses and now you are one!”

The entire Rebellion start to laugh and for the first time I join in with them. It’s quite ironic isn’t it. The one who initially hated princess, fought against them to stop their *‘evil doings’,* just so happened to be one of them.

Arrow Boy pipes up when his laughter dies down… “I bet you were cute as a kitten.”

Luna's eyes prick forward as she tries her best to answer Bow through her dying laughter...

“Oh she was.”

Luna turns to me as she finishes speaking. A devilish smirk appears on her face. *Oh no. I know what she's about to do.*

"Mom?"

"It's funny you should mention it as I have a picture of her as a kitten if you want to see it."

"Mom!"

Luna swiftly hands the picture over to Arrow Boy before I have the chance to stop her. She giggles slightly when she see my cheeks burning bright red. She does however do her best to comfort me, even if there is a little tease behind her words...

"What? You knew this was going to come sooner or later."

I won't deny, I knew this moment was going to happen eventually. I have seen many of my kitten pictures now. Some look better than others. According to Sparkles, this moment is in the hand book of *'how to embarrass your child in front of their friends.*' It's a must do for all parents at some time in their lives.

Bow has stars in their eyes when he sees the picture. He speaks as he passes it over to Sparkles...

"You were so cute. Look at those ears. They're so big and fluffy."

Sparkles giggles slightly as she passes the picture over to Scorpia...

"Aww Wildcat. This is adorable. Who knew you'd grow up to be so spicy when you looked this adorable."

Luna chuckles slightly before she speaks...

"There's more where that picture came from. I have plenty more back in Halfmoon."

"MOM!"

Luna starts to laugh even harder, knowing full well what she is doing. I hide my embarrassment behind my hands, groaning over how my friends might see me now…

"I sympathize with you now Bow. I can't believe that I now know what it is like to be embarrassed by your parents."

Arrow boy laughs slightly as he comes to rest one of his hands on my shoulder...

"At least she hasn't got a picture of you in the bath tub."

"Oh, I have one of those too." Luna not-so quietly whispers.

"For the love of Etheria. Please don't show them that one.*"*

Luna comes to stand beside me and pulls me into a gentle hug from behind…

"Haha. Aww... Don't worry I'm not that mean. I might show it you and Adora but no one else. You can't deny it though, you were a cute kitten. Even your friends agree with me."

Accepting that this is a losing battle, I shake my head and smile. When I can, I jokingly respond... "It's a good job your my mom, otherwise there would have been consequences."

Luna hums as she releases me. I can hear a low purr building in her chest as she speaks...

"Oh really? I would like to see you try. You seem to have forgotten that you got your combat skills from me so I could likely predict your next move."

"Is that a challenge?"

"Maybe."

Looking up at Luna, I fold my arms and put on my best challenge face as Adora calls it...

“Alright then. Challenge accepted. When we get back to Halfmoon we’re going head to head in the training arena, only this time I pick the location. The loser has to bake the winner a blueberry pie why the other brags about winning.”

“Well I won’t say no to having my daughter bake me a blueberry pie because *she* lost. You’ve got yourself a deal.”

Luna and I playfully, although it might look a bit aggressive, shake hands. When we get back to Halfmoon the game is on. After, Luna turns to address the Rebellion once more...

“I would like to personally thank you all for welcoming me and inviting me to meet with you today. Please feel free to come and visit Halfmoon whenever you’d like. You are more than welcome and we would love to have you join us whenever you'd like. I’m sure that you all have many questions that you are yearning to ask, so please feel free to ask them. I will answer you the best I can. However, now it’s time to get down to business, or how my wife would have said, *'the boring part*'.”

The Rebellion members laugh sightly before Sparkles walks forward to address the group…

“Today marks the start of a new chapter for Halfmoon and the Rebellion. We welcome an old friend, one who we though long to be lost, back in Etheria and into the Rebellion. Halfmoon stands with us as we have all stood with each other over the difficult years. Really it would be much easier if we could just say *'okay welcome to the Rebellion'* but formal protocols dictate that a hearing needs to happen and a piece of paper has to be signed."

Sparkles, at this moment turns to Luna, addressing her as an individual... "I can see why your wife called these things boring.”

Luna chuckles slightly. I think Sparkles has also had enough of *‘diplomatic responsibilities’* for a long time to come. I wonder if she'll ever find a loop-hole to these kinds of things. It’s not easy

being queen. I'm glad that role will never fall to me thanks to the decision my mom and mama made all those years ago.

"All those in favour of having Halfmoon join the Rebellion, raise your hand."

Everyone, *except for Luna obviously*, raises their hand in favour of the decision. Sparkles smiles at the unison in decision, but then groans as she realises that she still has to say this next part...

"Even though it is clear that we're all in favour I still have to ask this… any objections?"

Not a single hand raised. Everything is almost completed.

This is really happening.

A piece of paper stating Halfmoons initiation to joining the Rebellion is passed round the table. Each princess signs it stating that they're in favour of this new alliance. It's not long before it reaches Luna.

Sparkles looks over to us and now addresses Luna personally...

"When you sign this you will officially be welcomed into the Rebellion. We will stand by you in your time of need as you will help us when another is in trouble. When you are ready, please sign here."

Sparkles hands Luna a pen ready to sign the sheet. Nervously, Luna looks down at the piece of paper and takes a deep breath. There shouldn't be any worry with this, it's just a piece of paper, but it still feel like a big commitment to make.

Luna speaks before she signs… "Can more than one person sign this? Can I have another stand besides me in the Rebellion?"

What? What Is she doing?

Confused, I try to search for answers in Luna's eyes. All of the Rebellion members seem to be smiling for some strange reason. Sparkles nods her head in answer to Luna's question. Luna signs her name before she looks to me and goes to hand me the pen...

"Mom… w-what are you doing?"

"My time with the Rebellion happened many years ago. I remember sitting here with the original members and signing a similar piece of paper. This is the new Rebellion, one that deserves a new leader to represent Halfmoon."

"I... I don't quite understand. I thought I would never be Queen of Halfmoon. You and mama made the decision to have the royal duties diminished after what happened, so that no one felt pressured to lead. How can I sign this for Halfmoon if I will never be leader?"

Luna smile softens. It's clear that she understands why I'm slightly confused. I know I'm Brightmoon's royal advisor, which is similar to this as I work alongside Sparkles, but is it okay for me to sign this too?

Luna gently takes my hands in her as she tries to wash away my confusion and worry...

"Because even in spite of the decision my by myself and you mama, you're still one of royal blood. You are the reason that Halfmoon is now out of hiding and changing for the better. You are the reason for this new beginning. It only feel right that Halfmoon moves forward with a new leader, a new voice who speaks for them. Someone who I am very proud of and know will do great things in the future."

Do I really want to do this? Is it right for me to sign my name on behalf of Halfmoon after everything I did?

Sensing my unease, Luna rests her forehead against mine, gives my hands a gentle squeeze and whispers to me softly… *"You don't have to sign this if you don't want to. I won't force you too. But*

just note that even though your name is on the paper, you won't owe anything to Halfmoon or the Rebellion. It is me who will have dealing with them. All this means is that if anything happens, they can also speak to you about Halfmoon's role in my absence. This is basically your name on a piece of paper alongside mine."

Well that puts me at ease. It's pretty much the same as my royal advisor role for queen Sparkles, but this time for Halfmoon also. Give me the damn pen and let's sign this thing.

Taking the pen for my mom, Luna moves to the side as I walk forward to the piece of paper in front of me. When I look to my friends they all have encouraging smiles on their faces, all waiting for me to put pen to paper.

I sign my signature and seal the deal… *Catra Applesauce Meowmeow.*

Sparkles giggles slightly, trying her best to act professional as she hides her smile under her hand. It's not like she didn't know that this is my full name that Adora gave me when we were kids. Over my shoulder, Luna also sees the name I have signed and also starts to giggle. Before she can ask why I signed under that name, Sparkles announces that Halfmoon is officially a new member of the Rebellion. Celebrations are in order as Wrong Hordak starts to bring in some of his delicious meals, including some tiny mini meats for Melog.

Whilst all the others go for food, Luna finally caves and asks...

"Catra Applesauce Meowmeow?"

"Told you you'd think twice when you found out what the full version of my name was. Blame Adora. She's the one who named me. Believe me, it's much better than what I ended up giving Adora as her middle and last name."

"What are you guys talking about?"

Adora asks curiously as she comes over to Luna and me with a plate full of food for us both.

"Catra was just telling me what the full version of her name was. You know, the name *you* gave her. She then said it was better than yours. Now I'm interested."

Adora turns bright red and tries but fails to hide behind her jacket lapels…"Oh no."

"Mom, allow me to formally introduce your future daughter-in-law… *Adora Happysmile Rainbowfist.*"

For a moment or two, Luna is speechless. It isn't long though before the tell-tale signs of a smile appear and she bursts out laughing, tears threatening to fall from her eyes. Despite our glowing red cheeks, Adora I also find it quite funny and begin to laugh.

"Can you imagine if we had to say our full names at our wedding vows? Sparkles would never let us live it down."

"And that is exactly we won't saying our full names during the ceremony... that is unless you want *C'yra Elizabeth D'riluth*."

"Ohhh no. Please no. Don't ever call me that again. It sounds weird. Sorry mama but I definitely prefer the name Catra."

"And so do I. I know if your mama was here now she'd agree with you. Adora did give you a nice name, one that suites you too, even if the middle and last part is debatable. You two are absolute nutters… you're prefect for each other."

Luna pulls Adora and I into a warm hug before going to speak with the rest of the princesses and to try some more of Wrong Hordak's mini food selections. He seems overjoyed to hear that she likes them. The princess also seem to be enjoying talking to Luna too. She fits right into the crowd. Adora and I hang back for a little while, watching this new chapter unfold.

--

“There was something I want to show you before we head back to Halfmoon.”

Luna looks to me curiously, intrigued by what I mean, before she sits down on mine and Adora’s bed. Melog is lying behind her. The mewl at her presence and Luna gives them a few scratches on their head. Melog leans into her touch and begins to purr. They have bonded with Luna quite well, it’s nice to see the getting along.

Luna spent about an hour talking to the Rebellion princesses before going for a little walk with Micah. I believe they went to Angella’s memorial so that Luna could pay her respects to her lost friend. Luna is aware that I am trying everything to right my mistake and free Angella from her trapped state. So far everything we have tried doesn’t seemed to have worked but Luna has since offered to help up in any way possible, saying that some technology in old Halfmoon might prove useful. There is no telling yet if any material or research we have will prove useful, but it doesn’t hurt to try. Besides, if it’s one thing I’ve learnt these past few months is that you should always hold onto hope.

Initially, Luna was surprised to see that Adora hasn't joined on our walk to our room, but I later explained that Adora went to speak with Sparkles and Arrow Boy for a while as she hasn't really had the chance to catch up with them recently. *However, I know that’s a lie.* She's actually out with Swift Wind on a scouting mission to make sure all is okay. Adora has promised that she’ll be back in time for when we plan to take Luna back to Halfmoon. We do have a little detour planned for our journey but this comes first.

Whilst Melog keeps Luna entertained, I begin to reach to the back of my wardrobe, pulling out a large cardboard box. Inside, it holds

something sentimental wrapped up in my old blue blanket from my Horde days. Carefully, I hand it over to my mom, who looks at me in question.

Sitting beside her I say no words. My only movement comes from my hand, pulling back the folded edges of the blankets. Luna gasps slightly when the blanket folds fall away and reveal my broken mask. Luna places the mask on her lap and lets one of her hands run over the two halves...

"Adora and I found it not longer after the war ended. We had to go back to Prime's ship to make sure that all contents that could be a threat were destroyed. We found it near the pool where he... *where he corrupted my mind*. I remember him slicing it in too as he poorly cut my mane. It's why I'm growing it back out as I didn't make the choice to cut it short. I want to feel like I'm back in control of what happened to me. When we found my mask we brought it back here to keep safe."

A single tear starts to fall down Luna's cheek. Her full attention remains fixated on my mask. Melog comes to my side and rest their head on my knee. After a moment or two Luna finally finds the words to speak…

"You kept it… after all these years."

"Of course I did. To many it's simply a mask but to me it's much more than that. It's a reminded of everything I've been through, everything I have overcome to get to where I am today. Back in the day, it served the purpose of making me safe and protected. I know that sounds silly but when I wore it I felt like I was someone else. It wasn't scared, I wasn't hurt. I was strong and powerful, ready to take on the world. Adora is the only person who knows that the other reason I always wore it was because it reminded me of someone… *that someone was you."*

Luna breathing hitches slightly. It becomes clear that she is trying to hold back tears. Doing my best not to startle her, I gentle rest my hand over hers and continue to speak...

"I might not have know or remembered who you were at the time, but I know it was given to me for a reason and that's why I kept it. It kept you close, even though I didn't know if you existed until a while ago. I wanted to show it to you as I know it belonged to you. I wanted you to see that even though times in the Horde were difficult that even I never let go of hope, hope that someday things would be better. I know some might think it's silly to keep hold of such a small, now sadly broken thing, but to me it's important. It's a reminder of what happened before the Horde, a reminder or everything I've been through and a reminder that I am no longer the person I once was."

Silence. Not a single word is said. I quickly wipe away my own tears before they can fall. However, my effort are a clear waste of time when my mom gently puts down our mask and pulls me into a strong, warm hug. Without hesitation, I hug her back just tight. Tears are shared and not a single word is said. No words need to be said.

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"Okay, what are you two up to? Where are you taking me?"

"Back to Halfmoon like we said we would."

"I wasn't born yesterday Catra. I know that the Whispering Woods likes to shift and change every so often but *this* is definitely *not* the way we originally came."

"But it is still away back to Halfmoon. We're just taking a little detour. Trust me, it'll be worth it."

Teasingly smirking, my eyes turn to Adora asking her to back me up. She gets the message...

“Catra’s right Luna. Her detours are always fun and at least this time there’s no possibility that she will drive a skiff into a tree because we’re walking and not *‘skiffing’*.”

“*'Skiffing'* isn’t a word Adora. Hovering is the term you're looking for and I apologies for that years ago.”

Adora and I start to get lost in our own little conversation as we walk deeper into the Whispering Wood. I faintly hear Luna ask Melog if we are always like this and they do the best to tell her that we are. She chuckles slightly as we continue to walk ahead.

We come to a sudden halt when we find what we are looking for…

“We’re here.” Adora says as she looks back to Luna.

Shocked, Luna comes forward and her jaw drops when she see what’s in front of her. There is a small hut literally a few feet ahead of us in the middle of nowhere. The chimney is smoking so something much be baking and someone is definitely home. A long carpet drape acts as door in front of the house.

“How did you find this place?”

Luna asked, shock overtaking her. Adora and I smile brightly knowing we have managed to achieve this.

“Catra may have told you a little while lie about where I was earlier. Swift Wind and I went on a little scouting mission to see if we could find this place. We thought it’d be nice for you to be reacquainted with an old friend.”

As Adora speaks, the drape moves to the side. A rather small, ancient looking woman with huge glasses that make her eyes look the size of a bugs, comes out into the open, brushing away the dust at the entrance with her trusty broom. Adora is first to go and greet her…

“Hey Razz.”

When Razz notices Adora, she smiles brightly and opened her open wide to accept a hug.

“Adora dear. It's so nice to see you again. See broom I told you she’d visit soon. Broom said that you were off seeing an old friend of mine. I hope you had a nice trip to visit them.”

“Yeah we did. Catra and I actually have someone we want you to meet.”

Adora looks back to us and gestures us to come forward. Melog is the first to run over to Razz and she gives them gentle pets…

“Hello Melog. And how are you today?"

Melog *mreows* in greeting as Razz re-addresses Adora again... "Adora you silly thing. I have met Melog before. They come and visit me regularly.”

“No not Melog Razz. It’s someone else, but I think they’re a little shy.”

“Oh no need to worry about that. I know they’re over there with Catra but I can't see them properly to make out who they are. But, I know they’ll come over when they’re ready.”

Razz and Adora continue to talk whilst I stay back a little while with Luna…

“Mom? Everything okay?”

Luna snaps out of her daze for a moment or two. Guilt and worry are shown in her eyes…

“What if she doesn’t remember me? It’s been over twenty years since I last saw her Catra. I thought she had scummed to the tragedy war.”

Sensing Luna's anxious state, I smile brightly and nudge her shoulder to get her attention. It’s now my turn to reassure her,

just like she has done with me so many times before…

“Hey. It’ll be okay. Razz might be old and *ancient looking* but she seems to remember everyone she has ever met. She remember who I was long before Adora took me to meet her. She even knew who Adora was before she even met her. I highly doubt that Razz would have forgotten who you are.”

Luna visibly starts to relax and decides to take the ultimate leap of faith. We walk towards Razz together. For me it’s like a normal day where I go to visit Razz. For Luna, it’s seeing an old friend again for the first time in years, *which is exactly what this is.*

“Catra dearie. How nice to see you again. Adora was telling me that you recently learned how to bake blueberry pie. Good for you. I knew that Luna would show you one day.”

“Hey Razz. It’s nice to see you too. Speaking of Luna, there’s someone here I want you to meet.”

Adora and I move away from each other slightly and Luna comes into view. For the first time in what must be forever, Razz becomes completely speechless. Her broom literally hits the floor. Razz adjusts her glass slightly before finally finding the strength to speak…

“Luna?”

Luna fur is a little bristled and her tail is still, clear signs that she is a little nervous. However, despite all that her bright smiles remains the same...

“Hey Razz.”

Within seconds, Razz is running over to Luna and pulling her into a tight hug. There isn’t a dry eye insight. Well, that is except for Melog. They technically don’t have tear ducts so they can only show emotions through facial expressions, sounds and the colour change of their mane.

“Luna dear it is so good to see you again. I told you you’d find your kitten didn’t I. She’s done you proud.”

“You told me Razz. Thank you. Your words gave me hope. I’m just sorry that I wasn’t able to find you after you saved me. I thought you long lost to the war.”

Razz and Luna part momentary simple so they can clear their eyes from their happy tears...

“Ah don’t be silly Luna. It takes a lot more than some old creepy alien figure to stop Madam Razz. Besides, your companion Dusk gave me updates on how life in Halfmoon was going.”

For a moment or two everyone falls silent. Dusk stayed behind in Halfmoon today after her late night adventure. She did look like she wanted to come but Luna suggested that she stay behind and get some rest. However, now I'm beginning to wonder if Dusk has been venturing off to see Razz on some nights, just like Melog and Swift Wind occasionally do.

Luna is the first to break the silence...

“Wait? Dusk came and visited you?”

“Yes she did. She visited everytime she went over to the Fright Zone. She gives me updates on how Catra was and then tell me how life in Halfmoon was developing.”

Mine and Adora’s jaw drop. Surely that can’t be right.

Adora is the one to ask what we long to know… “Razz? Are you sure that the owl that Catra and I used to see flying over the Fright Zone every now and then from out lookout point was Luna’s owl?”

Unfortunately for Adora, I’m unable to pull her out the way before it happens. She really needs to work on her reflexes…

BONK

“Listen up Adora. I just answered what you asked.”

Now Luna is the next one to ask… “Razz that can’t make any sense. Owls can’t talk…”

BONK

Razz’s broom whacks Luna on her head also. It’s even funnier than when it happens to Adora as Luna’s fur literally jump when the broom makes contact with her head. Luna rubs her head, slightly hissing at the pain. I think I am the only one left who hasn’t been broom-bonked on the head by Razz yet. I must be doing something right.

“Don’t be silly Luna. All animals can talk but some don’t speak words like you or me. Some screech, some purr, some roar and some glubb. I think Swift Wind is the only animal who can form words. There are many different ways that animals communicate but they all talk, just in different languages. You just have to learn how to listen and understand what they’re telling you.”

Razz does, for once, makes a lot of sense. I know that I can communicate with Melog differently to others but Adora has learned how to communicate with them in different ways. It’s similar to how Luna communicates with Dusk. They read their body language and listen to the tone and pitch of the noises they make. Some translations might not be accurate but it doesn't matter as long as the message is sort of received.

I wonder if Razz can speak with the animals of Etheria in a similar way as to how I communicate with Melog, or if it is a case of she has learned how to understand them.

Out of no where Razz pipes up again...

“Besides, you should know this Luna from your childhood years.”

In the corner of my eye I notices Luna's cheeks starting to blush...

“*Oh no*. Razz the girls don’t need to know about that.”

Luna is quick to pause Razz's words as her cheeks begin to burn even brighter. I on the other hand am quick to get Razz to continue. If my mom can show my friends photos of me from when I was a kitten, then I can learn something embarrassing about her too..

"No Razz continue please. What was is it my mom used to do in her childhood days?"

A teasing smile appears across my face and Luna knows that she is too late to stop Razz from answering. She tries to hide her reddening cheeks behind her hands as Razz answers…

"Luna here used to go around making weird animal sounds to all her animal friends when she was little. She would glubb at the fish in the water, ribbit to the frogs, whistle to the birds and even chase the boars. She was adamant that they could understand her as some would call back to her."

Adora and I start to burst out laughing, unable to control the tears that fall from our eyes.

"Oh that is brilliant. I knew my mom was an animal lover but wow."

Luna removes her hand from her face and smile… "There's more."

"THERE'S MORE!"

Some birds dart out the nests in the tress above as our mine and Adora's voice echoes, carried on the wind. Luna takes a amusing hum and say what is left to be said before someone else answer for her...

"When I first met Dawn I stopped communicating with animals. I found it embarrassing to say the least, even though my animal communication skills had gotten better over time. I didn't want her to think of me as a strange Magicat. I had a hard enough time making friends as it is. Your mama caught me one day talking to one of Etheria's ancient creatures, it looks like a giant rhino to be

honest with you, but I couldn’t say what its name was as I was still learning about the world outside of Halfmoon..."

Adora faintly says *'ohhhhh'*. I think we both know what creature Luna is on about. It was one of the first few we saw when the magical wildlife returned to Etheria after the hearts magic was released. We wait for Luna to continue.

"Anyway, it turns out that Dawn was secretly watching me communicate with this creature and had begun to draw me. However, as she finished her drawing she stumbled and altered her presence to the creature. It's once calm focus on me changed . It turned towards the sound and began to charged in her direction. She was nearly trampled on. I ended up saving her life. It turned out that that one occasion would not be the last time where I had to save her from similar situations but that’s stories for another day. Anyway after that I start to teach your mama how to communicate with the animals too. It helped us to connect with each other; it was something we both enjoyed doing.”

I have often enjoyed learning more about the adventures that my mom and mama had in their youth. It makes me it easier to feel connected to them, easier to see how I am like them both in more ways that one.

From behind we hear Razz sniffle slightly. She speaks with a bright smile...

“Dawn was a remarkable young Magicat. One who was sadly taken from this world far to soon. Madam Razz is sorry that she was unable to warn you about the times ahead but rest assured that Dawn is still with you, in here.”

Razz points to Luna’s heart as she speaks. I always felt that my mama never really left my mom's side, whether that be in physical or spiritual form, but that is something for Luna to realise on her own. I think my mama has always been closer than she realised.

Ding

“Oh the pies done. Who wants a slice of Blueberry pie?”

Well I for one won’t say no to that.

Adora and Melog follow Razz into her hut to help her prep the pie whilst Luna and I stay outside for a few more moments. When I look to Luna she has a beaming smile on her face. She used her claw to wipe away a single tear that threatens to fall. She looks to me and speaks…

“Thank you.”

“You’re welcome."

A few more silent moments pass. The air from the Whispering Woods flows around us, carrying with it a sense of clam and peace. I however, decided to break that peace with a little bit of teasing...

"So you used to talk to animals. How embarrassing that must have been for you.”

Luna groans and tries to hide her once again reddening cheeks behind her hand.

"You've definitely your mama's daughter. You've got her teasing nature."

I start to laugh knowing that I now know something I can tease my mom about, but also hearing that I am like my mama.

“Hehe it’s okay. I won't tell anyone. In a way, Adora’s pretty similar in terms of talking to animals. It’s funny but also cute."

My cheeks start to redden a bit when I consider asking this next part, but we've come this far so there's no harm in asking... "In fact, do you mind showing me how to do that one day, how to communicate with animals that I can't talk to like Melog and Swift Wind. I'm mainly asking so that I know what to do if I ever find an animal charging at me if I try and draw them up close.”

Luna smiles and moves her hand to hold the sun necklace around her neck, the one that was given to her by my mama. She looks up to the sky, breathes in the fresh afternoon air and answers… “I’d love to. Why don't you bringing Adora along to. It could become something you can learn to do and enjoy together.”

Instinctively, I move closer to my mom and rest my head on her shoulder and she rests her head on top of mine. It’s a simple and quick alternative way of giving each other a hug. We both start to purr as we head inside Madam Razz’s hut for a piece of pie before heading back to Halfmoon.

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When we arrive back at Halfmoon Adora and Melog retire back to our room whilst I spend a little more time with my mom in her room. Dusk seems excited to see us both as flies over to us the second we enter the room. Luna gives Dusk a good scratch on the head before she flies over to me and perches on my shoulder. She nuzzle against the fur on my cheek before settling down. It’s a rare occasion that Dusk decides to perch on my shoulder but she has taken a liking to resting there.

Luna's brightly smiles as she speaks and turns to face me...

“Today was a good day. A new beginning that'll all been made possible thanks to you. You’ve come so far Catra. You made the best out of a difficult situation and came out strong. I’m proud of you."

“Thanks mom but I can’t take all the credit. There was a lot a stuff in between that lead up to this moment.”

I try my best to smile through my words but with little to no luck. Luna notices this and comes forward, taking my hands in her, worry visible in her eye…

“You know you can tell me anything.”

Luna's words remind me of here recent promise that she is here fore me no matter what. She knows exactly when somethings wrong and knows exactly what to say when needed.

Taking a deep breathe I sit on the edge of Luna’s bed and I gesture for her to sit beside me. When I’m ready I tell my mom what my worries are I speak…

“I feel bad that I haven’t found anything suitable to Adora as an engagement gift yet and it’s starting to play on my mind again.”

Luna hums knowingly...

“Does Adora know about this?”

“Yeah she does but she says I shouldn’t let it bother me and I don’t have to give her anything. I know I shouldn't let it bother me but it does. This wing pin that I wear... it was hers. It was her engagement gift to me. It’s a symbol of her love for me. When I look at it, it reminds me of her. Reminds me that she loves me and that I am her world. I want to give something to Adora that means the same. But I don’t want that something to be simple. I want it to represent us. Does that make sense?”

Luna appears to be deep in thought. Her eyebrows bend in concentration and the tip of her tail bats side to side curiously. After a moment or too Luna hums, smiles and answers…

“It makes sense. Even though she knows that you love her you want others to know how you feel about her too. It makes sense to want to give her an engagement gift too. What do you have in mind? Maybe I can help you.”

Now it’s my turn to take a few moments to think. I have a few idea’s in mind but I’m not sure how I can make them work…

“I know I want it to be something special, something unique, something that says how much I love her and how much she

means to me. I know that it’s tradition to give your partner something that belongs to you, something that’s meaningful. Adora used to have this wing pin attached to her belt. She got it after she joined the Rebellion. When she gave it to me she said it resembled a new chapter, hope and love. She kept it with her wherever she went. It was like it was a part of her. It’s weird to see her without it. I know whatever I give to Adora I want to represent the love I have for her, the love I have always had for her."

And now this is where the problem lies.

A slight sigh escapes me and Luna notices this. When I look to Luna her expression changes. She knows what I'm going to say before I even say it, but I say it anyway...

"The problem is that I don’t own anything that has that sort of value and meaning. I haven’t really owned anything that I can claim as my own. The only thing that I have that has any sentimental meaning and something that does belong to me is my crimson red mask that you gave to me but even that’s broken. I don’t know what to do.”

My head falls into my hands and I rub my forehead as I try to easy my increasing, frustrating headache. Surely something like this shouldn’t be this difficult. It’s only when Luna’s hand stops rubbing circles across my back that I notice her mood change…

“I think I might be able to help you.”

My mood instantly changes as I shoot up ready to hear whatever she has to say… “Really?”

“Yeah really. Your mama might have been the artist but I was the brains behind some of her ideas. Hear me out and see what you think.”

Luna discusses what her idea is and how she thinks we can get it to work. It’s a genius idea, I’m surprised I didn’t think of it myself. For the next hour or two Luna and I get to work on setting up a

plan on what I intend to create. I will get all the stuff I need next week and Luna will help put my plan into motion.

By the time I get back to mine and Adora's room, Adora is already fast asleep. The days events have caught up with her. Melog is curled up by her side. My heart warms at the sight of the love of my life peacefully resting. I do what I need to do, get into my pajamas, gently release Adora’s hair from it's tie, give Melog a gentle scratch on their head and settle down besides Adora. I place a gentle kiss to her forehead and wrap her arms around my body.

Everything in the world feels right. Now I just have to make my proposal to Adora perfect. Beside I know she’ll say yes… *hopefully.*

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you all enjoyed chapter thirteen of Finding Halfmoon. Can you believe there's only two chapters left? 😱 I can believe this time next week Finding Halfmoon will have concluded. I just hope you enjoy the last few chapters.
>
> So what do you think Catra has come up with? More importantly, will Adora say yes? Find out on Monday with the next chapter update. See you then. 😊
>
> P.S - Chapter 14 is technically the final chapter of the story, with chapter 15 being the epilogue (bonus points if you can guess what it is). There is also one extra content chapter to come. Enjoy. 😊

Together Forever

Chapter Summary

Catra has a very important question for Adora.

Looking back, we see Catra's plan fall into place, along with a special surprise.

When all is said and done, the big question is will Adora say yes?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Come on Catra. You can do this. Deep breathes. There's nothing to be afraid off. This is Adora we're talking about. If she can do this then so can you. She loves you and you love her. You've always loved her. She's your soulmate. You can do this!"

I have been planning this day for months. So much time and effort has been put into making this very moment perfect. To be honest, this moment doesn't really need to be perfect, it just needs to be us: me and Adora… *but when has a little bit of perfection hurt anyone.*

Hidden carefully in my pocket lies a hidden secret. I spent a lot of time working on it, creating it to make it as unique as possible with a little help from my mom Luna. To say that I am proud of my creation is an understatement, I just hope Adora likes it too. Moreover, I hope she says yes.

The cool morning breeze glides across the meadow beneath. The birds are starting to sing as they awake from their slumber. This sun has yet to rise but I don't think it will be too long now until the dawn breaks. Adora has always been an early bird so I know she'll be up already. As well as this, I know from our many trips that Adora loves to watch the sun rise and that Etheria glows

beautifully from this exact point when the sun completely awakes. Melog is with her having been in on the plan for months.

Where am I you ask? – The place where on of our many new beginnings started.

Only Adora and I know what lies beneath our feet at this very location: The Heart of Etheria. It once beat to a chaotic rage, now it beats at a steady, peaceful tone. So much happened down there. The love of my life was almost lost to Etheria and I feared she'd never know how much she meant to me. Now look at us… we left as lovers, discovered that our destinies were intertwined as soulmates and now we're to be future wives. We entered the heart not knowing how much we loved each other and exited together, starting a new chapter of our life's journey.

This area looks magnificent when the sun shines above it. The magic was strongest here when it was released, meaning that new life and magic flourishes the most here. I know for certain that this is the place to make this moment even more perfect.

Mreow

From behind I hear Melog slowly trot over to me. Their mane is a smooth blue colour, which surprises me considering how nervous I feel about this moment right now. They come to my side and I crouch down to their level, giving them a good tickle under their chin.

"Your mate will be here any moment. I ran ahead to let you know. I can tell you're nervous but remember you've got this. The love you both have for each other is the strongest kind of love there is. It's the most beautiful kind of love there is. Believe me I should know... I could feel your love for her before you even admitted it to yourself."

Quietly, I hum to myself, remembering all the times they questioned why I was afraid to tell Adora how I felt about her, how I had always felt about her. Now looking back to those times

I reckon Melog could sense Adora's feelings for me too. I'm going to have to start calling Melog the love expert.

Before I can respond Melog smiles and trots off into the distance. They've probably gone down to meet with the others at the bottom of the hill who I know for a fact are hiding somewhere at the front of the Whispering Woods, silently waiting for the next moments to unfold.

A gentle breeze flows through my fur. I can sense that someone is behind me. I take a deep breath before turning.

You can do this Catra. Have faith in yourself… why do I suddenly feel so nervous?

My smile continues to grow when I see Etheria's most beautiful sight approaching me. I'm practically lost for words…

"Hey Catra."

Adora smiles as she sort of uses my catch phrase, causing me to blush even harder. She starts to walk forwards, slowly taking my hands in her. It's only when I feel Adora's touch that I find myself able to speak once more…

"Hey Adora. Wow you look… *beautiful.*"

Adora has always been beautiful, especially to me. Even on the days where she has dark circles under her eyes from a restless night's sleep and her hair is all over the place, looking like she taken a very wild ride with Swift Wind. I remember my mama saying many years ago that beauty is something found within and something that you feel for someone who means everything to you. To me that is the definition of Adora. Adora will never stop looking beautiful to me.

Adora has decided to wear her blue jacket, the one I made for her as a gift for her birthday, and has let her hair loose, hanging it over the side of her right shoulder. Her smile is radiant and her piecing blue eyes are full of life and love. It's so easy to get lost in

them. She's wearing a pair of matching blue boots to go with her jacket and a silver watch which Luna gifted to her a while back. The only thing that seems to be missing from Adora's attire that I have come so used to over the years is a pin badge on her belts.

I feel slightly under-dressed now compared to her. I mean I too am wearing something different to my usual attire: black pants that have a part that wrap around my feet so I'm almost bear footed, a red blouse that contrast well Adora's wing pin that she gifted to me as my engagement gift and a red and black jacket with golden seams that I have next to me on the floor, ready to wear incase I get cold. We both dressed up for this special occasion, only Adora doesn't know what the *special occasion* is yet.

Adora starts to blush at my words…

"Says you. Have you looked at yourself in the mirror this morning? You look rather beautiful too. Dashingly handsome if I do say so. It's fair to say that I have some competition."

Adora gently lures me into a kiss. Hopefully she won't be able to see the growing blush on my cheeks. Taking compliments like this have never been easy for me, has never been easy for both of us. I personally was always ashamed of my 'cat-like' features. Feature that make me… me. Adora always felt like she wasn't worth loving or seen as anything special unless she did what her *'superiors'* ask of her or if she was She-Ra. However, over time we came to learn and understand that we are unique individuals who are beautiful and wonderful in their own way. Loving each other was a part of that. Understanding that has helped us to both understand that we are worthy of love and being loved for who we are.

As Adora pulls away she speaks again… "I'm not overdressed am I? I wanted to look smart for whatever you had planned for us today but you didn't give me much intel on what you have planned so I really wasn't sure what to wear."

Adora's expression changes slightly. She almost looks a little nervous, maybe slightly embarrassed. Giggling to myself I pull Adora closer to me so that I can rest our foreheads together easily. This has always brought us comfort and relaxed the other when needed…

"You look great Adora. You always look wonderful. For me you could show up in nothing but your underwear and you'd still look amazing."

Adora giggles slightly...

"You would have liked that wouldn't have you?"

"I think you already know my answer."

Adora starts to laugh and pushes my shoulder me slightly. I will never get tired of hearing her beautiful laugh, of her beautiful voice that sends wonderful chills down my spine. Her laugh was one of the very first things that I fell in love with. Everything about her is prefect.

When Adora's laughter dies down once more she speaks again…

"So go on, what's the *big* surprise you have planned for me today that was *so* important that you wanted me to meet you here before the sun rises?"

Looking to the horizon, I notice that there is a short amount of time to kill. I recon a bit of teasing won't hurt anyone...

"You haven't guessed?"

"Honestly I haven't got a clue and that's the truth. I know you're not an early bird so the only thing I'm certain of is that whatever you have planned must be important to you."

At first I though Adora was lying, playing the game, teasing me if you will. But the more I examine the look on her face the more I realise that she is telling the truth.

Adora you're such an idiot… but you're my idiot.

In the distance I can see the sun slowly starting to rise. The first bit of warmth hits the base of my feet. Nerves wash over me as I take a few deep, steadying breathes. My hands gently squeeze Adora's as I try to clear my mind. When I look into her eyes they're filled with endless, unconditional love that has always been there for me. Adora's smile gives me the courage I need to speak from the heart.

"Adora… there's something I need to ask you."

--

****Earlier this month****

"Almost done… and finished!"

An exhausted sigh of relief escapes me when I manage to place the tiniest of runestone pieces into the centre of Adora's engagement gift. So much planning, work and effort has been put into creating this and now it is finally complete.

"What do you think?"

Melog and Luna come closer as I hold my creation up high so that they can examine it better.

My engagement gift to Adora is a unique, specially designed and hand crafted by myself. I created a belt pin. After I mentioned to Luna a while ago that it was weird seeing Adora without her pin, especially considering the one she previously had was her engagement gift to me, Luna suggested making her a new, personal one, one that was designed by me.

At first I wasn’t sure how that would work, considering that it’s traditional to give your future partner something of personal value. However, that’s when Luna expanded on her brilliant idea and suggested that we create a new pin from my old mask. All we had to do was melt down my mask to it's liquid form and later re-mold it into something new.

At first I was dubious of the idea, stating that my mask was initially a gift from my mama to my mom, but Luna later argued that this is something that my mama would also likely suggest if she was still here. Besides, my mom had something to remember my mama by, her sun necklace. The crimson red mask was technically mine after she gifted it to me. The more we spoke of it the more I became intrigued of the idea.

Despite the idea being intriguing, we hit a slight problem when I was trying to figure out what to create for the shape of a new pin. I knew that I wanted whatever I gave to Adora to be unique and meaningful, something that represented us both and the love we have for each other… and that’s when it hit me.

I spent many nights awake once Adora fell asleep designing the new pin in secret. I knew Adora might have gotten suspicious if she saw me looking at my old mask and She-Ra’s old sword, rearranging a design to see what would work and look best Thankfully, Adora never cogged onto what I was doing and she was a heavy sleeper so she never heard when I accidentally dropped my pen or pencil in the night. Melog on the other hand struggled to sleep most nights due to my anxious and stressful times, but they understood how important this was to me so let the occasional sleepless night slide. Besides, I made it up to them by making some of their favourite mini meats when I kept them awake… *sorry Melog*.

The final design was perfect, my mask was the outer edge with She-Ra’s sword going down the centre. I had attempted to add the Heart of Etheria symbol to the design but I wasn’t sure if it looked right. Besides, I know that Adora sometimes feels uneasy about the scar that it left on her chest, which ultimately led me to

the design of leaving it out of the finished element. However, after many months of discussing the topic with her, Adora has come to learn that the scar is a reminder of the things she has overcome to get to where she is today. The final design that I created was the perfect combination of both of us, something that represents us both, the things we have been through and something that is unique.

Sparkles and Arrow Boy helped me to sneak my broken mask into Halfmoon on one of our many visits. I would have taken it myself but Adora might have gotten a little curious if she saw me walking with a rucksack or something. I don't usually carry stuff like that with me. Arrow Boy on the other hand always carries something with him when taking some books to and from his dad's library so he could easily get away with it and no one would bat an eye lid.

Luna took my design to one of Halfmoon's metal workers and had them create a mold that was specific to my design. She also got permission from the owner to use the foundry at the back of their shop to create the pin in a safe working environment. *Made life easier for us I guess.*

Adora love hearing about my daily adventures with my mom, even though she didn't know that some of the stories were made up as she was actually helping me to create my engagement gift. Luna and I each placed one half of my mask into the crucible, watching it melt, ready for it to be turned into something new. I think there were mixed emotions coming from melting it down. I made sure that Luna was okay with doing this before we started. Her words were simple…

"Melting this mask down resembles the end of one chapter and creating something new from it resembled the start of a new chapter. It will never really be forgotten for what it originally was but will be admired for what it is in it's new for."

I didn't really understand what she meant then but I do now.

Melog seemed highly fascinated by the melting process. Mind you, having never seen something like this before on their home planet I'm not really surprised. I did however have to stop them from trying to touch the hot liquid at one point, reminding them that even though they are from a different planet, getting burned will definitely hurt regardless of your species.

Once fully melted down, Luna helped me pour some of the liquid metal into the pin mold ready for it to set. There was quite a bit of the liquid metal left so we decide to create a second one should anything go wrong with the first one, before deciding to also create something special for the both of us. We decided to create something that serves a as simple reminder of all we have overcome to find each other once more.

Crafted carefully, Luna and I drew a small sketch of ourselves, very similar to the ones that Adora and I drew back when we were in the Horde. I'm happy to say that mine and Adora's masterful art skills came useful once again as we redrew them and now have a set in Halfmoon and Brightmoon. Luna said that I had always loved to draw with her and my mama when I was young magicat kitten so it seemed only right to create something similar. Luna even drew a small sketch of my mama so that she was also included. Luna had a tear in her eye when our designs was officially completed: sharpened and painted by the Magicat who let us use their workshop. It's surprising to think that something so simple can have such a deep, meaningful and impact. Once that was done, we went back to continuing with the design of my engagement gift to Adora.

Creating the pin was easy… sharpening, painting and adding little personal touches to it were more challenging.

The first time I tried to sharpen the pin it broke. The sharpening and smoothing equipment was almost impossible to use. The tools were either to big, to small or too brittle. Thank stars we made a second one as a spare but now I was incredibly nervous about damaging it as this was my last chance to get it right. I remember having a breakdown over it, worrying that I'd break it easily

having failed the first time. That’s when my mom stepped in to help. Delicately using one of her claws, Luna skimmed the edges of the pin, making the design features more defined before smoothing the shaped metal with a thin cloth. Apparently my mama once showed her that technique when she was creating a tiny sculpture. It’s not ideal but if it works it works. The cloth gave the pin a nice shine to it.

The next phase was to paint it. Finding the paint was difficult as I wanted the colours to be the exact same as the one on Adora’s sword and my mask. Not only that but the paint used has to be a specific type so that it will stay on the metal and not fade over time. Luna and I even looked outside of Halfmoon to find some but we struggled. Thankfully, there was a kind young woman at one of Brightmoon’s markets, funereally enough the same person who sold Adora her wing pin many years ago, that had a sliver and gold paint that could be used for the sword part of the pin.

We were on a roll, but hit a problem again when it came to trying to find the crimson red paint for my mask part of the pin. It wasn’t until a few days later that my mom asked if I could meet her in old Halfmoon. It wasn't until I arrived that we found the exact colour of red paint that I was looking for. Turns out that my mama had a secret workshop hidden within old Halfmoon’s castle. It was the only place Luna could think would still have some of the crimson red paint and thankfully we found some unopened. The tin might have been a few years old but the paint was still in good condition.

Surprisingly, whilst we were down there we also came across something incredible. It was a huge surprise to us both.

Luna found a metal box well sealed and hidden behind some old storage boxes full of old art work and inventions. When we opened it we found a series of art kits, paints, brushes, pencils, and canvases, all of which were unopened and untouched. In a folder, there lay a series of photographs and drawings that I have never seen before. Some have definitely been created by my mama and other's by me, or should I say a younger version of

me. *I can tell the difference, that's for sure.* On the top was a picture of the three of us: myself, my mom and my mama, as well as a folded note addressed to me under my old name. It read:

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To my precious kitten Cyra,

Your mom and I have noticed that you have taken quite an interest in art. You are a very talented Magicat at your age (3 years old). I know that you are much older than that now and I have no doubt that your artistic skills have progressed from some of the things you find in this box. Your mom doesn't know this but I have secretly been storing some of your art in here along with secret drawings and photos that she doesn't know that I have taken and created.

She never liked me taking pictures of her, she was always camera shy. However, we both know how beautiful she is so it was very hard for me to resist capturing moments like this, especially the ones where she held you tight in her arms. She'll probably kill me when she finds out about this but I don't care. I know she loves me really.

T he best way to capture a moment in time is to picture it and keep it in your heart. I wanted to give you something special to remind you to never lose your passion for doing something you love. Every great artist needs an art set so I have been buying you your own art materials for the day you take your passion further. The pictures and art in this box are there to remind you to never forget how much you love doing what makes you happy. You were always incredibly talented. I can't wait for the day you get to share you passion with your soulmate. I know they'll love you more than anything, just like I love you mom.

Happy 16th Birthday my little furball.

Mama loves you very much. xxx

P.S - If you found this before your 16th birthday, close the lid and act like you saw nothing. We'll keep it our little secret. :)

**

At lot of tears were shed that day but mainly happy ones. I wish I had got to spend more time with my mama before the Horde came and took me away from her. However, I am thankful everyday that she gave me the chance to live, the chance to re-connect with my mom and find my soulmate. I know for certain that even though Dawn is absent in person, she is still with me in spirit and held close within my heart.

Dawn's gift came in handy when painting and finishing the final touches to the pin. Once the paint had dried I was able to place a protective coating over it, which gave the pin a nice shining finish. Some might have said that it was complete after that moment but to me it still felt like something was, but I couldn't quite figure out what. After a few days of stressing over what it was, Melog piped up and made a brilliant suggestion…

"Why not add a piece of She-Ra's runestone to the swords hilt? That might be what's missing."

Melog was a genius as that was exactly what was missing. Painting the runestone in the centre didn't give the sword it's natural glow, it was missing an actual stone. One night, I carefully retrieved part of the runestone from the broken sword before taking it to Micah and Castaspella to ensure that the broken piece no longer had a connection to She-Ra, *mainly the old She-Ra*. Once that was sorted I brought the pieces to Luna who helped me to shape and size the stone to fit onto the pin. If Adora saw my

concentration face whilst I was adding the final touches she would have been laughing.

My engagement gift to Adora was finally finished. I held it high inspecting it. It was perfect.

Luna and Melog come up from behind me, getting a better look at my creation…

"It looks really nice Catra. The runestone was definitely the final touch that was needed. You can thank me for my suggestion later with a mini blueberry pie. You're mate is going to love it."

I giggle slightly, duly noting Melog's request. Luna smile and rest a hand on my shoulder…

"I agree with whatever Melog just said. It looks incredible Catra. Adora is going to love it. She is incredibly lucky to have you as her soulmate. I'm proud of you."

Luna gently hugs me around my shoulders behind as I try my best to hold back tears. The stress, the tears, the breakdowns have all been worth it. Now all that's left to do is plan how I'm going to propose to Adora and hope that she says yes.

--

"Oh come on Catra. You made me lose the bet to Spinny… AGAIN!"

"Well how was I meant to know you'd place a bet on something like that."

A week or two after creating Adora's engagement gift, I have been secretly going round to visit each of our friends asking if they would help me to surprise Adora. Luna and Micah both

agreed to help secretly plan an engagement party within the Whispering Woods, not to far from where I plan to propose. Perfuma and Scorpia have offered to help with the decorations, Mermista has promised to make sure that Seahawk doesn't set anything on fire and Sparkles and Arrow boy have agreed to make sure that Adora is up and ready for the day, even though Sparkles has said that I have to make it up to her for making her get up so early. Sparkles has never been the type for early mornings but it'll be worth it. The only people who I have yet to ask is Spinnerella and Netossa. I don't really want to ask them to do anything, I just want to ask if they'd attend the celebration after all is said and done. What I didn't know is that they were having a small bet between themselves on where I'd propose.

"You know a more simple bet would have been to have guessed what I was going to propose with."

"Oh we know but that could have been anything. Besides, where you were going to propose was more interesting, right Spinny?"

"Right Darling. You see we all know you and Adora have so much history that we knew when you're time came to propose you'd want it to happen somewhere special, somewhere that has meaning to you both. Netossa here though you'd go simple and propose at the Fright Zone like Adora did. I however, said that that would be too obvious and that you'd go somewhere different, maybe where your new chapter as girlfriends began. Guess I was right."

Spinneralla gives Netossa a teasing smile, much to Netossa's demise. It's obvious that it's difficult to stay mad at her though. I can tell from Netossa's growing smile.

Sensing my opportunity, I decide to tease Netossa for a little while...

"I think you need to work on you a-game Netossa. Your old age is catching up with you."

“I’m not that old. Spinny’s older than me…”

“Only by two years Darling and I've still won more bets that you.”

“Just you wait I’ll win the next one.”

It’s nice to see Netossa and Spinnerella like this. They’re so in love, so *mature*… I can’t wait to spend the rest of my life with Adora like this.

When the laughter dies down, Netossa is the one who speaks again…

“So puffball, what can we help you with?”

“Okay *grandma*…”

“I’m old enough to be your mother.”

The laughter starts again and this time it’s hard enough that I have to hold my stomach. Beside me Melog rolls their eyes, quietly reminding me that Adora is back at Halfmoon waiting for me.

Suppose I better get on with it then.

“Okay back to the serious business. I’m here to ask if you’d like to attend the secret engagement celebration that my mom and Micah are helping me arrange in the Whispering Wood for after I propose to Adora.”

“Didn't you already have one back in Halfmoon?” - Spinerella ask curiously.

“Sort of. It was more of a celebration of my return to Halfmoon. Only my mom and our friends knew of our engagement back then. We kept it quite. This time I want to be able to celebrate our engagement with everyone there, our friends and our family. I know it would mean a lot to both of us if you were there.”

Spinneralla and Netossa look at me with hearts in their eyes and a beaming smile on their face. Spinerella is the one who answers…

"Of course we'll be there Catra. We wouldn't miss it for the world. Do you want us to do anything or bring anything with us?"

Smiling brightly, I respond....

"Thanks for the offer but I think we'll be okay. Just bring yourselves… actually, now I think of it, can you possible keep an eye on Adora's flying talking horse. Knowing Swift Wind, he'll probably accidentally talk about my plan to propose and surprise her before I even get the chance to put my plan in motion. I haven't actually told him about it yet but I will be on the morning of the day."

At the side, I hear Netossa rumble...

"Ohhh you're getting up early to propose. You must really love this girl."

Netossa and Spinneralla snicker to themselves knowing full well that I am not a morning person. They also promise to keep an eye on Swift Wind. I know he'd try his best to keep it a secret but his *'sacred bond'* with Adora means that he might let word of the surprise slip, even if he doesn't use his words.

"Thank you. I look forward to seeing you both there."

With that Melog and I make our way back to Halfmoon. As I leave Spinneralla's and Netossa's garden I hear them mumbling…

"So Spinny, what's the next bet going to be?"

"How about where they'll get married?"

"You've got yourself a deal."

--

When I get back to Halfmoon later that day Adora is no where to be found. She's not in the gardens, nor the training simulation or in the kitchens. I briefly call Sparkles on our tech-pad to make sure that she hasn't gone back to Brightmoon. We're only due to head back there tomorrow so that I can put the final parts of my plan into action. When Sparkles confirms that Adora is not their either, I start to worry. When I enter Luna room I find that she and Dusk are not within the castle grounds either. Melog offers to stay in our room in case Adora comes back whilst I go out in search of her.

Why I thought of coming down here I have no idea but this is the only place I haven't looked. One of the villagers said that they saw Luna and Adora come this way but had no idea where they were heading so there's no harm in looking. When I get to the flower bed of white chrysanthemums I notice Luna walking my way…

"Catra you're back. How was your visit to see Netossa and Spinnerella. Did you get everything sorted that you needed to arrange?"

"Hey mom. Yeah everything is sorted. All that left to do know is… *you know*."

Luna hums knowing exactly what I mean. I grow more and more nervous by the day and I'm not sure why. I thought something like this would be easy, but I guess I was wrong. It's nerve wracking. I wonder if Adora ever felt like this when she was planning on proposing to me?

"Say have you seen Adora? I can't find her anywhere."

Luna smiles knowingly and answers… "Adora was with me a few minutes ago. She asked if she could go and speak with you mama."

"Hmm. Wonder why?"

"Well she said she wanted to ask her something, something that she asked me a while ago. If you want to know what that *something* was then maybe you should go and ask her. I will meet you both back at the castle when you return. I have a special feast planned before your return to Halfmoon tomorrow."

Luna smiles and continues to walk back toward the castle. When her shadow disappears I continue my journey towards Adora's location.

It's not long before I find Adora. She's exactly where Luna said that she would be. Dusk is roosting on one of the low tree branches across the river, keeping Adora company, listening to her ever word. Adora hasn't noticed me yet and I don't want to startle her. Carefully, I step of the stone and make my way across to her.

"Hey Adora."

Adora jumps slightly from her position on the bench but quickly smiles when she realises that the voice belongs to me. She blushes slightly...

"Hey Catra. I didn't expect you to be back so soon. How was your walk in the Whispering Woods?"

Oh right I almost forgot. I told Adora that I was going for a walk with Melog. She doesn't know where I really went. Shit I'm glad she reminded me before I let that slip up. I'll have to make Melog aware of my little white lie so they can play along. Not that it really matters as they can't communicate with Adora like I can

"All good. Melog loved chasing the little creatures around the bush. We even came across some weird looking lizard with wings and a horn on its head."

That is not a lie, that part is the truth. One our way to see Netossa and Spinerella we did see a lizard with wings but we didn't have time to stop to investigate.

Adora looks dumb-struck at my words and her jaw practically drops…

“What?” I ask curiously.

“This lizard with wings… did the wings happen to look like Swift Wind’s wings?”

“Now I come to think of it yeah, yeah it did.”

“Oh no.”

Adora’s head falls into her hands as she starts to laugh. For some reason I start to laugh with her. I imagine this is something she accidentally caused.

“What did you do this time dummy?”

“I may have accidentally zapped that lizard with She-Ra’s sword when I was first getting the hang of using She-Ra.”

“Hang on a minute is that how Swift Wind got his wings?”

Adora stays quite and answers by nodding her head. Now I’m laughing even harder than before. This is hilarious. *How come has she never told me this before?*

“Okay, okay so let me get this straight. The only reason you have a flying, talking horse and a rouge flying lizard is because you accidentally zapped them with She-Ra’s sword when you first found out you where She-Ra? Does that mean if you zapped me I’d also grow wings?”

It’s at this moment Adora lifts her head up once more, a shocked, puzzling expression on her face…

“You know I honestly haven't thought about that. I mean I imagine that’s possible but it only ever accidentally happened with animals.”

“Adora you’re such an idiot.”

“I know… but I’m your idiot.”

Adora moves to stand as she wraps her arms around me and pulls me into a kiss. She tries to place kisses all over my cheeks and I desperately try to push her away after the first few.

“Adora… stop it… that tickles.”

Adora laughs and releases her hold before gently resting her head against mine. We decide to sit down once more. My tail moves to lay across our laps and I begin to purr…

“So what made you want to come here?” - I ask curiously.

Adora hums and takes my hand in hers. Her eyes leave my gaze and look towards my mama’s memorial. She smiles as she speaks…

“I know I never got the chance to know your mama but I know from speaking with Luna how much you meant to her. Luna says that she always used to speak about how she hoped that one day you’d find your soulmate, someone who would love and cherish you for the rest of your life, just like she did for you mom. A while ago, I asked your mom permission for your hand in marriage.”

“Of course you did. Adora, you know you didn’t have to do that, right?”

“I know and Luna said the exact same thing but I know Bow has asked Micah permission for Glimmers hand…”

“Wait Bow is planning on proposing to Sparkles?”

“Yeah that what I was like too when I found out. Apparently he doesn’t plan on doing so yet but he wanted to ask in case he decides to propose soon. Anyway when I found out that that’s what people usually do I thought I best ask your mom too. She said nothing in the world would make her more happy than seeing

her daughter marry her soulmate. I know I have you mom's blessing but I also wanted to ask your mama too, even though I know she can't answer me in person."

As Adora speaks, Dusk flies down onto Adora's knee. She looks up to her as if she has been listening to her every word. Adora smiles and give her a few gentle strokes to the top of the owls head feathers. Adora then looks back to me, love seen clearly in her eyes.

"I promised both your mom and your mama that I will look after you, cherish you and love you for the rest of my life. I have always loved you Catra and I will never stop loving you. You are my world, my soulmate, my everything. I love you so much. I can't wait for the day I get to call you my wife."

Adora kisses me gently on the lips before moving back slightly. As Adora's goes to get up Dusk flies up to her shoulder and ruffles her feathers against her cheek before trying to nestle under her chin. Adora giggles and gives the owl a good few head scratches in return. Satisfied with the attention she has received, Dusk flies up high into the sky and into the fading sun.

Adora reaches out her hand to me to take… "You coming?"

I turn and smile at my mama's memorial one last time before I take Adora's hand. Adora helps me up and we make our way back to Halfmoon's castle. The feast was delicious and the night that Adora and I had will definitely not be forgotten. Let's just say that I'm just really glad that the walls within Halfmoon's castle are sound proof.

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****Earlier this Morning****

“Urghhh. I hope Adora realises how much I love her. I wouldn’t get up this early just for anyone.”

“I hope *you* release how much you owe me for getting me up this early. Seriously Horde scum, I don’t know how anyone back in the Horde coped with having to get up so early.”

“Technically we didn’t get up this early Sparkles. We’re up two and a half hours before we would be in the Horde. I've never woke up at first call anyway, Adora always had to drag me out of bed.”

It’s four o’clock in the morning. Sunrise will be at seven thirty and I want to make sure that all is set and in place before then. Adora is aware of where I want her to meet me and by when but she has no idea why.

Today is the day.

Today is the day that I am going to propose to Adora. After months of planning and preparing for this moment we’ll finally see what Adora has to say. I can only hope that all my hard work is for nothing and that she says yes.

“Where’s Melog?” - Bow asks as he rubs the sleep from his eyes.

“Melog is staying with Adora. They’re going to make sure she knows where to go when she wakes up. Also I don’t want her to be on her own when she wakes up and I’m not there. The last thing I want is her stressing.”

“But you have told her where to meet you right?” - Sparkles asks.

“Yeah I have. I’ve even left a note but we all know what she’s like.”

Sparkles and Arrow boy laugh tiredly when they realise that I am right. We all know what Adora is like so I was prepared to take all the measure necessary to reduce the chances of her stressing. We all head down to the kitchens to get something to eat. Micah is

already wide awake and waiting for us when we arrive. Wrong Hordak is already at work making us breakfast.

I wonder if he ever sleeps.

"Good morning brothers and sisters of Etheria. I hope you are hungry. I am preparing your favourite meals for this morning."

Micah chuckles to himself when he sees our tired faces. He takes a sip of his morning coffee...

"Good morning all. Glimmer I'm surprised you managed to get up so early."

"Believe me dad I almost didn't… and good morning wrong Hordak."

We all sit down for breakfast and tuck into the delicious meals Wrong Hordak has made us. Micah and Bow have pancakes, I have some toast and a few fish sticks, Sparkles has leftover cake. A while ago I would have questioned it but now I don't even bother. Any cake for breakfast is a good choice.

"I can't believe I'm going to say this has anyone seen…"

"DID SOMEONE SAY SWIFT WIND!"

Speak of the devil and he shall appear.

"Right on time too. I was beginning to wonder when you'd show up." - I say sarcastically as Sparkles rubs the side of her head as she tries to wake up.

"Well good morning to you too. Now why did you want me to be here so early and to *not* mention anything to Adora. Notice how I emphasized the *not* part."

Rubbing my head slightly, I answer them...

“Yeah Swift Wind I noticed. Wrong Hordak I want you to listen in as well.”

Wrong Hordak comes to the table to join us and gets comfortable. When I have everyone’s attention I speak once more…

“So everyone else here knows what I plan to do today. Please don’t be offended that I am only now just telling you two this but with your track history I didn’t want you spoiling the surprise.”

Wrong Hordak nods understandingly whereas Swift Wind goes to protest. However before he can open his mouth Sparkles interrupts him…

“You almost let it slip that Adora was going to propose to Catra.”

With that Swift Wind shuts his mouth and nods for me to continue…

“I’m going to be proposing to Adora at sun rise today. I wanted to invite you all to the secret party that Luna and Micah have been sorting in the Whispering Woods. You can *not* speak a word of this to Adora. Notice how I emphasized the *not* part… good. Understood?”

Swift Wind nods and trots on the spot showing his excitement, whereas Wrong Hordak nods and winks.

“Right with that said and done, I’m off to get dressed and I will see you all later. I just hope all goes well.”

Sensing my nervous, Swift Wind decides to take on the role of Melog and tries to calm my nerves...

“Catra, Adora loves you. Of course things are going to go well. She’s going to be so excited when she see what you have made for her.”

Arrow Boy decides to join in...

“Yeah remember Catra you’ve got this. Besides, it’s not likely that she’s going to say no, right Glimmer?”

“Bow’s right. Now go and get ready. Well see you later.”

With that I leave the others behind and silently get ready for the day. Once dressed I pick up the box that holds my little creation secret and head out into the Whispering Woods to meet my mom.

--

“Wow this looks incredible.”

“Thought you’d like it. Even Razz decided to get in on the action.”

“Wait Razz is here?”

“Well of course she is. You even went and invited her. She said she wouldn’t miss this for the world.”

Luna and the others have spent a lot of time this morning preparing this area of the Whispering Wood for the celebration. We decided to host the party near the cave/hideout that we used during the final year of the war. It’s a large, safe area that also provides us with shelter if the weather decides to be horrible to us. Life bursts in an ary of colours. All of our friends came to see how I was feeling this morning and to wish me luck, even though many said that I wouldn’t need it. A few more introductions were made. It was the first time Luna has meet Lonnie, Rogelio, Kyle and even Double Trouble. They have promised to be on their best behaviour today. Dusk even came down at one point to say good morning before flying over to Scorpia to help hang up some more banners. The only person I have yet to see is…

“Catra dearie there you are!”

Madam Razz comes running forward and pulls me to a tight hug.

“Hey Razz. Thanks for coming. It’s so nice to see you.”

“Ah don’t be silly Catra. Madam Razz wouldn’t miss yours and Adora’s wedding for the world.”

Confused slightly I look to Luna for help… *“She knows this isn’t the actual wedding right?”*

Luna shrugs her shoulders and we both decide just to let it pass. As we all know, Razz sometimes jumps between timelines and can easily get confused.

“Anyway you better get going dear. Your Adora is awaiting for you. I will see you later and just so you know, Madam Razz has made you a pie for later. Come along broom.”

Razz slowly walks further into the woods, humming an unsual tune as she goes. Luna and I can’t help but laugh. Razz never fails to make us smile. After a moment or two Luna walks towards me…

“Come on. I’ll walk you up there.”

Luna and I walk side by side as I get ready to take the next step in my adventure.

--

“I can see why you wanted to propose here. I imagine that the scenes below look beautiful when the sun rises.” Luna says as she smile looking out to the horizon.

“Yeah it really does.”

My words fail me as my voice slightly cracks. My mom notices the change in my voice and posture. Automatically, she seeks to comfort me…

"What's troubling you Catra? You know you can tell me anything. I'm here for you."

Slowly I decide to sit down on the grass below us. Luna follows me lead and sits beside me. She lets me rest my head against her shoulder and she begins to purr at a soothing pace. It helps me to relax my thoughts and speak my worries…

"What if she say's no? What do I do then? After everything we've been through together… I-I don't know what I'd do."

A few silent moments pass between us. Nothing is said. I'm not sure if that's a good thing or a bad thing. The only thing that reassures me is that my mom is not phased by my question. Her posture never changes, her fur never bristles and her purrs still beat to a soothing pace. Luna hums slightly and speaks…

"I imagine that everyone has these feelings before proposing to the person they love. I know your mama did. She told me after it all how nervous she was before she proposed to me. The truth is she already knew that my answer was going to be yes, it was always going to be yes, but she was still nervous because of the *'what if'* moment in the back of her mind..."

Luna takes a pause as I take my time to process her words, trying my best to understand what she means.

"My point is that I think we all know what Adora's answer will be. However, these feelings you are experiencing right now are normal. If you didn't have them then you should be asking yourself do you really want to go ahead with this? The nerves you feel right now Catra are telling you have much you love Adora, they're telling you that she is your soulmate and you are hers. Have faith in her and speak from the heart. Speak from the heart and you won't go wrong."

Luna pull’s me into a gentle hug from the side and kisses the top of my head. Our purrs becomes louder the more time we spend together. Eventually, Luna has to leave my side to join the others. Adora will be here soon… I hope all goes well.

--

****Now****

And that brings us to here, to this moment. Adora, the love of my life, my soulmate, my world, my everything, stands in front of me, supporting me with endless amounts of unconditional love. I have spent months planning and preparing for this moment and now it all comes down to one simple question…

“Adora… there’s something I need to ask you.”

Adora moves forward slightly and places a gentle kiss to my forehead. It's a simple, calming gesture that lets me know that everything is okay. Her hands form a gentle hold around mine and she starts to brush the top of her thumbs over them. My tail moves to gently stroke against her leg. When Adora leans back she smiles, silently letting me know that she is ready and listening.

Speak from the heart Catra. Speak from the heart and you won’t go wrong.

“Adora… I have loved you for a very, very long time, both platonically and romantically. The platonic love started when I was young. You found me, saved me gave me a name and became my best friend. I love being around you getting to spend time with you. As I got older the platonic love turned into romantic love. At first I was scared what this new feeling was but over time I grew to like it, this strange feeling that made me want to be around you more, enjoy every moment we spent together, to explore if we could be more than friends, to spend the rest of my life with you."

A single tear escapes Adora's eyes but she hold back her words so I can continue...

"Adora I was in love with you long before I even realised that this feeling I had for you was love. I love being in love with you. I was so afraid that you didn't feel the same way about me. I was scared that if I told you we'd lose what we had re-gained after everything we went through. It wasn't until our first kiss that I was no longer scared to be afraid of falling in love with you. That's when I knew for certain that I couldn't live without you, that I wanted to be with you forever."

Reaching in my pocket, I pull out the small blue box that hides my little secret. Adora looks to it confused at first, but then her facial expression exchanges when she realises what I'm about to do. Tears start to well up in her eyes as I speak again…

"Back when you proposed to me you said that our first kiss sealed it for you. You knew in that moment that I was yours and you were mine. Adora, I had know long before that moment that I wanted you in my life, but that moment also sealed the deal for me. I knew that there was no one else I wanted to spend the rest of my life with. I knew it that moment that I was going to spend the rest of my life loving you. I know you said that you didn't need anything from me as an engagement gift but to me it didn't feel right. I wanted others to know how much you mean to me. To show others that I am yours and you are mine. For the past few months I have been working in secret to create something unique, from something that I once owned, that resembles both you and me and the love we have for each other."

I open the box and take out the pin that I have created for Adora. I called it the 'Catradora pin' as it combines two things that once belonged to myself and Adora, so it's a mix of our names. The heart pin was also suggested so we might call it that too sometimes but we'll see.

Adora's tears start to fall from her eyes as I place the pin in her hand…

“You are my everything Adora. My soulmate, my universe, the love of my life. I’d be lost without you. We have shared many wonderful memories together, many beautiful moments together and shared many promises. I want to add to all of them. I want to create more moments, more memories and more promises together with you. You already have my answer but now I want to know yours. So Adora, I now to ask you something from the heart…”

Closing Adora’s hand over the pin, I smile at her brightly and get down on one knee. It’s a serious fight to keep my tears from falling but I just about manage it. Adora looks to me with love literally pouring out of her eyes as I speak from the heart.

“Adora, will you marry me?”

In an instance, Adora’s lips meet mine. The force is enough for us to lose our balance as we both fall onto the glassy floor beneath us. We laugh between a series of hot, passionate kisses, one which I know for a fact will be revisited later on tonight. Adora eventually rolls off the top of me and sits up, pulling me up with her. She struggles to speak through her tears…

“Yes, yes a million time yes.”

Adora asks me to place the pin on her jacket just above where her heart is located. Although it was originally designed to be a belt pin it also looks nice there. Gently I pull Adora into another passionate kiss as the dawn begins to break. The warmth that hits us is relaxing and warm, quite possibly the warmest sunrise of the season yet.

Adora wipes away her steadying tears and giggles before she speaks...

“I was honestly not expecting that.”

“Well what were you expecting dummy?”

“I don’t know but definitely not that.”

“Adora you are such an idiot.”

“I know… but I’m you’re idiot…*forever*.”

“You know I probably should have asked that instead.”

Adora pushes me to the ground again laughing, before kissing me once more. I would like to keep this going but I have one more surprise in store for her. Besides, we’ve got the rest of our lives to be like this together. At the bottom of the hill I can hear our friends and family cheering, all waiting for the official celebrations to begin.

When we stand their smiles and tears of happiness can been seen.

“So you ready for our engagement party.”

Adora looks to me surprised...

“You didn’t?”

“Oh I did. I invite all our friends and family to join us.”

Adora wipes a few fresh tears from her eyes before gently pecking me on the lips once more… “I’m so lucky to have you in my life. I love you so much Catra.”

“I love you too Adora.”

Adora and I walk down hand in hand towards our friends and family, officially ready to begin the celebration.

The party was amazing. Everyone welcomed us with open arms. Tears and smiles were seen all around, many stories were shared. Luna and I told Adora how I created my engagement gift for her and how our friends helped me to plan and pull of this whole event. It took a while to get Adora to calm down from crying many happy tears.

Everyone loved the fireworks display that occurred that night, which was a little surprise arranged for us by Luna and Micah. Luna made sure that Halfmoon's silent fireworks were used and Micah helped with the display. The finishing touch was the final firework, which projected the Heart of Etheria symbol high in the sky, follow by small sketches of all our friends and family surrounding it. It was beautiful and emotional.

This is what it feels like to be part of a family that loves and supports you. I finally have everything I ever wanted in life, everything I ever needed in life.

That night Adora and I went to bed dreaming of the day we'd officially become each other's wives. However, that day for now can wait because right now I am held tight in the arms of the woman I love more than anything in the world: the love of my life, my soulmate, my Adora. We'll be together forever.

Chapter End Notes

> Hope you enjoyed the second to last chapter of Finding Halfmoon. I hope you enjoyed reading this update and the little special parts I included in it. 🥰 - Only one more chapter to go. Can you believe it 😱.
>
> There were originally only meant to be fourteen chapters but then I was like, 'go on, do fifteen, make an epilogue for this fic.' Bonus points if you can guess what the BIG finale includes 😉. Many of our favourite character will return with quite a few surprises in the fics' final update on Friday (that's when Finding Halfmoon will officially be complete). Where has the time gone? There will also be the final extra chapter content released the same day. Until then, hope you enjoy. See you soon ☺️
>
> P.S - Thank you for your love and support throughout the story updates, especially with the longer chapters. I have loved hearing your thoughts each week. They mean the world to me. I hope you enjoy the final chapter (will be released

Friday) as much as I have enjoyed sharing this story with you. 🥰

Epilogue - Promises

Chapter Summary

> Two years have passed since Catra and Adora discovered Halfmoon.
>
> Today is an important day for Catra and Adora... it's their wedding day!
>
> Emotions run high, more surprises and happy memories are shared. The next part of their story is about to begin.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

****Two Years Later****

The warm sun beams through mine and Adora's bedroom balcony window at the break of dawn, illuminating our room in our newly built home. Being the Magicat that I am, I stretch far and wide to soak up as much of the suns morning warmth as possible. If it wasn't for a gentle blowing sensation against my ear I would have stayed in my current position. Instead, I roll onto my side, groaning in disapproval of being disturbed as I bury my head against Adora's bare chest.

Adora giggles softly. The vibrations of her laughter are felt through her chest. She starts to gently stroke thought my now fully grown mane, easing me to awake. When that doesn't work she resorts to gently stretching the lower corner of my ear, something she knows that I can't resist the feeling of.

Slowly but surely, I open a single eye and turn my head slightly upwards. I am greeted to Etheria's most beautiful sight.

“Good Morning sleepy head.” - Adora says in a sing song voice. Her smile alone lights up our room.

“Adora, you know I hate getting up so early.”

My voice is croaky, making it sound like I'm groaning. In an attempt to hide my eyes from the sun light, I nestle myself further against Adora's chest, forcing her to lie back down on our bed. Adora giggles as she starts to draw sooth circular patterns across my bare back as I slowly wake up. The soothing feeling results in my purring.

"I know you hate early mornings but today is a big day for us. I couldn’t get back to sleep once I woke up.”

Still in a semi-sleepy phase, I answer Adora using a sarcastic tone...

Catra uses her sarcastic tone to answer me...

“Really? I never would have guessed. I thought I would have tired you out after last night’s antics. Besides, you were the first one to fall asleep afterwards.”

Adora starts to laughs even harder and her cheeks start to burn bright red. I love making her laugh. Her voice makes me feel things. Last night was something to remember that’s for sure. We both have the marks to prove it.

It’s been so much easier to get some alone time now that we have our own place. After I officially proposed to Adora, which was about two years ago now, we started to get to work on finding some place to call our own. We decided to settle on a small location within the Whispering Woods, more or less in the middle between Halfmoon and Brightmoon. We’re not to far from where Netossa and Spinnerella live and we’re not too far from the local village Elberon should we need to get supplies.

Halfmoon and Brightmoon have been great homes to us these past few years but we always knew that we were never going to

make either our permanent home. Obviously still have our rooms in each kingdom and we're more than welcome to come and go as we please, but we wanted somewhere that we could call our own, some place we could grow old together and enjoy life to its fullest as just the two of us.

It took about a year's work to build our new home. We had all the support and help from our friends and family should we have asked for it. It was handy to know we had people to rely on when thing's got difficult. Ultimately, Adora and I made our new home fit to our needs and wants. A large garden with a specifically designed simulation ground like the one back at Halfmoon but on a smaller scale, a stable at the side for Swift Wind should he choose to visit although her prefers to stay in Brightmoon, your basic room aspects such as a kitchen, living room, dining room and a few bedrooms which all come with their own on-suites. I am happy to say that all rooms, particularly mine and Adora's room, are well sound proofed thanks to Entrapta's help. If we hadn't had that installed I think the whole of the Whispering Wood might have heard Adora last night.

The nice feature that Adora wanted to include was the waterfall that flows from a nearby stream just outside our house. Adora's reason for wanting a waterfall or river near our home is because the sound helps her to relax and if I'm being honest I have come to like it over the years too. At first I was scared of issues surrounding flooding but after extensive land development plans, we determined that that would be highly unlikely situation to occur due to it's location. However, to be on the safe side, we built our home on a sturdy platform just incase anything changed. You have to be prepared for everything, including the impossible.

After our home was built and decorated, we decided that we could move onto planning our wedding day. A lot of extensive planning, preparations, sleepless nights and silly little arguments have gone into planning our wedding day. It's safe to say that Adora's planning flow chart came out at one point, which I took the great liberty of shredding up after everything was settled and set in stone. Adora also joined in at one point. I think it was the

first time she was glad to see the back of them. Planning a wedding is stressful.

When times got difficult or stressful for us, we'd stop our plans and go and explore. We'd go for a walk, maybe go and see Razz, my mom or our friends, but most of all we enjoyed sitting at the top of Halfmoon's mountain watching the stars at night. After Luna showed me that place after I first transformed I knew I was one day going to take Adora there one day. It was a beautiful evening. It became our secret spot in Halfmoon, just like the watch tower back in the Fright Zone.

It took a while to get everything sorted but we got there in the end. Once a date was set, (*specifically set on the date the war ended and Adora and I confessed our love for one another)*, preparations where finalized, invitations were sent out and necessary alterations concluded, all we had to do was wait for our official wedding day to arrive… today is that day.

"How much longer can we have in bed before we have to get up?"

"About an hour and a half. Maybe two hours because Glimmer has offered to teleport me to Brightmoon and you to Halfmoon. We all know what Glimmer is like for being late… Why do you ask?"

Now fully awake from my sleepy state, I pounce onto of Adora, straddling her hips under my naked form. Adora was clearly not expecting it as her cheeks have flushed completely red and she appears to be lost for words. It's *'Adorable'*.

Prowling over her, I can feel the heat inside rising. Once were eye to eye, I gently press my body against her and lean to whisper in her ear…

"Because that's ample time to make love to my *fiancé* one last time. That's if you're up for it after last night *princess*?"

Adora nervously giggles and quickly finds my lips, kissing me passionately. I feel her legs squirming behind me, trying to find some form of friction to relieve a bit of pressure. She gently pulls

at my shoulders, bringing me closer to her. We only part to catch out breathes. *Stars she's knows how to turn me on.*

"I'm always ready to have fun with you. But remember not to leave any marks in visible places. The last thing I want is for me to have a huge hickey on my neck on our wedding pictures."

I laugh slightly at the thought of leaving a bright red mark on Adora's neck for everyone to see when she walks down the aisle. The idea intrigues me but I'm not that mean. Gently, I peck Adora's lips and look deep into her beautiful eyes, the eyes that I very first feel in love with.

"Don't worry. I won't. I promise. At least not today… I love you Adora."

Adora's voice catches slightly as she reaches up and pulls me into a soft kiss before saying… "I love you too."

We spend the next hour in a heated love making session. Heated passion leads to us getting tangled in the bed sheets and blissfully tangled between one another. The sounds that escape us could almost form of song of how much we love each other. It's another reminder of how grateful I am that our walls are sound proof.

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"So… what do you think?"

Turning to face Melog, Scorpia and Entrapta I notice that their faces light up in awe.

"Wow Wildcat you look amazing. You really look the part. Adora's going to love you in that suit."

"I agree with Scorpia. Not to mention the colour white, gold and blue really suite you."

Mreow – "You look stunning Catra. You're mate is going to fall head over heels for you. I mean I know Adora isn't wearing heels but you get what I mean."

Sparkles arrived a bit later than expected this morning, which was a good thing considering what Adora and I were doing. Sparkles teleported me over to Halfmoon shortly after arriving. My best friends were there waiting for me. I don't usually like teleporting, mainly because it makes me feel unwell, but for one day I can put up with it.

Adora is getting ready in Brightmoon where Arrow Boy and Sparkles will be with her.

Before coming up to mine and Adora's old room to get ready for the big day, I decided to go and see my mama, Dawn. We had a nice chat, I got some of my last minute worries off my chest. After that I came back to the castle, had breakfast with my mom and my friends who spent the night here in Halfmoon, and then went to get ready for the big day.

Smiling at my friends I turn back to inspect myself in the mirror.

My now fully grown mane is tried back nicely keeping my hair out of my eye. I feel more in control now it's at the length I feel most comfortable with.

The suit I'm wearing is tailor made for me by one of Halfmoon's finest designer. Kia has been in the clothing industry for many years and was easy to approach when wanting to have something specific designed. She listened to my ideas, presented me with her plans and made adjustments and alterations when needed or asked. The end design: the suit that I am wearing now is perfect. The suit and pants are a faded white colour, traditional to match Etheria's wedding styles. The seams of the blazer however have a gold colour to them. Why she added this I'm not sure.

It probably has something to do with what Sparkles suggested to her when I asked for her input. Either way it looks really nice.

My shirt underneath is a faded blue colour, something that contracts nicely with white of my blazer and the blue of Adora's mesmerizing eyes. My open bow tie is a faded gold colour so that it matches with the with the colour of the blazer seams.

Again this was another suggestion from Sparkles.

For the first time in forever, I am wearing a pair of shoes. I won't lie it feels slightly weird but not as uncomfortable as I expected. Luna took me to see a shoe maker after I raised concerns over being barefooted at our wedding. I know I went to the Princess Prom bare footed but that was different. I had a combat motive back then. Now I don't have a reason to fight or to run. I want to look and feel the part.

Smith was the name of the gentleman who designed my shoes. Just like Kia, he has been in the industry for many years, making shoes to fit the comfort of Magicats feet. It's fair to say he did an impressive job too, they're very comfortable. Her gave them a black, nicely polished finish, with golden seams and brogue stitching.

Inspecting myself in the mirror, I notice that there is a very important piece of my attire that's missing. I search the area frantically and then I hear Melog *mreows* beside me. Using their paw, they point to the small box on the desk side. Breathing a sigh of relief, I open the box and attach my wing pin badge to the left lapel of my jacket. Carefully, I position it just above where my heart is located, so that it resembles that Adora has my whole heart and unconditional love.

There. That's much better.

Knock, Knock, Knock

The knocking at the door catches my attention as a familiar sight walks through…

“Am I allowed in?” - Luna asks as she peeps her head around the door.

“Hey Mom. Of course you are. What are you asking for?”

Luna smiles and closed the door behind her. Dusk flies over from her shoulder and onto mine. She chirps happily and brushes a piece of hair out of my face to behind my ears. I giggle softly and give Dusk a little scratch on the top of her head before she flies down and sits on Melog’s shoulder.

Luna speaks with a bright smile on her face.

“Morning ladies. Loving the outfits. Take it you are all ready for today”

Scorpia is wearing a deep coloured red dress, similar in style to the one she wore at the Princess prom. It really suits her and I know for a fact that her dress will be contrasting well with whatever Perfume is wearing. Entrapta is wearing a purple coloured suit. I knew she was indecisive on what she would be wearing, whether it be *'a dress or a suit was down the data'* she said. I guess the suit won in the end. Either way, purple is definitely her colour.

“Thank you Luna. You’re looking very nice too.” - Scorpia says, smiling up at Luna.

“They’re right mom. You look incredible.”

Luna blushes slightly...

“Well thank you. Thought I’d change it up a little bit for a special occasion like today.”

Luna smiles as she does a little twirl. Similar to my choice, Luna decided to have a tailor made dress for mine and Adora’s wedding. The top part is fitted to hang off her right shoulder, a nicely designed band that wraps around her waist, which then allows the rest of her dress to fall nicely down her legs. There is a

slight opening in the lower half of the dress just slightly above her left knee. Unlike me, Luna had legging made in the same colour that wrap around her feet for support. After many years of not wearing shoes I can imagine that now matter how comfy tailor made shoes are it just wouldn't feel right. I'm surprised to see that she is wearing her hair down, letting it flow over the front of her exposed shoulder. To top it all off she is wearing her sun necklace that my mama gifted to her all those years ago.

When Luna looks to me it becomes clear that she is on the verge of tears. *Hopefully happy tears*. She does her best to hold them back but it's obvious that she is struggling.

"Do you mind giving us a minute?" - Luna asks politely as she looks to Scorpia and Entrapta

Scorpia smiles understandingly and she gets up to leave. She get's Entrapta to follow suite and I get Melog and Dusk to follow them both. When the door closes only me and my mom are left in the room. Luna comes forwards and gives me a tight hug. I hug her back with just as much loving force, doing my best to keep my own tears at bay. I hate it when people cry because I too start to cry. The only time I want to cry today is when I see the love of my life, *soon to be wife*, moments before I marry her.

That's right… Adora and I are breaking tradition. We're going to see each other before our wedding ceremony. Adora and I have never been one for tradition and we are not about to start now. I mean we are following some traditions like vows and rings but other than that were having our wedding our way.

After a moment or two, Luna releases me and moves to hold my hands in hers. She smiles at me brightly, trying her best to form words…

"Look at you. You look amazing. You really look good in a suit. Adora's really hit the jackpot."

"Mom." - I groan slightly embarrassed.It's sometimes difficult to hear these words coming from a loving parent. I'm still new to it all.

I'm not sure who's more lucky to me marry who: me marrying Adora or Adora marrying me.

Luna giggles slightly, wiping her happy tears away before she speaks again…

"It's true. You can't hide from the truth my kitten. I wish you're mama could see you now. She'd so proud of you Catra, just like I am. You've become this wonderful young Magicat who has exceed our hopes and dreams for you. You found your soulmate, your person. I couldn't be more happy for you if I tried."

As Luna's words hit my heart I have to take a few steady breathes to stop my tears from escaping… "Thanks mom. Please don't make me cry before I see Adora. I'm trying my best to hold back tears now."

Luna laughs slightly as she places a gentle hand to my cheek. As always, I lean against her touch, purring up a storm. Luna lightly brushes away a tear that threatens to fall from my eyes before she retakes my hand in hers.

"How are you feeling? Nervous? Excited?"

"A little bit of both I guess. I always hoped this day would come and now we're here it's a bit surreal... I'm getting married today. I'm getting married to Adora today! Is this really happening?"

My heart does at little happy dance when I mention Adora's name. I wonder how she is feel right now? Is she feeling as excited but just as nervous as I am?

Luna hums softly and answers my rhetorical question...

"Yes. It's really happening. It's all real."

A few seconds of content silence pass between us before Luna seems to remember something… “Oh before I forget. I brought you something.”

Luna walks away from me to retrieve a small, thin box that she obviously hid in here for this very moment. I wonder what’s inside?

“You know how you were looking for something to borrow to follow Etheria’s wedding tradition..?”

Luna smiles and removes the lid from the box. Inside is a perfectly preserve white chrysanthemum flower. It looks exactly like the one from my mom’s and mama’s wedding pictures. When I look into my mom's eyes my suspicious are confirmed.

“This is the flower that your mama wore on her suit at our wedding day. After our wedding she had a friend preserve it so that it could one day be used again if needed. I think she’d want you to have it.”

Gently, I go to take the flower out of its box but my hands retract. I don’t want to damage it.

As if being able to read my mind, Luna’s words put me at ease…

“It cannot be damaged because of how well preserved it is. You don't need to worry about that.”

Carefully, Luna takes the well preserved flower out of it's box and gets me to face the mirror. She initially blocks my view as she attaches it to my free lapel on the opposite side to where my wing pin badge is. Luna then moves to stand behind me and places a hand on my shoulder. She look at me in the mirror and smiles.

It looks perfect. It feels like my mama is with me. I miss her so much... “I wish she was here.”

Luna gently hugs me from behind and rests her head on my shoulder She does her best to smile as her eyes begin to water. A

low purr starts to emit from her chest and I do the same…

“I know. I wish she was here too. But I know that even though she can’t be here in person, she will always be with us in our hearts.”

That’s all it takes for me to have a little cry. I turn in my mom's hold and rest my head against her chest as she holds me close. Luna starts to rub gentle circle on my back, helping to keep my calm. Despite the tears I am still able to say what I want to say…

“I love you mom.”

I feel Luna’s voice hitch slightly, before she places a gentle kiss to the top of my head... “I love you too kitten.”

When are tears slow we remain holing each other for a few minutes. It’s calm, peaceful and comforting. We probably would have stayed like that for a while longer if there hadn’t been a quite knock at the door followed by Scorpia telling us that Sparkles was here to take us to the Whispering Woods, where our wedding was taking place. When Scorpia speaks, Sparkles waves around the corner. She’s wearing a very nice, pinkish-purple dress, that has a few light blue flowers, most likely an addition from Perfuma, flowing down the sleeve of where her dress hangs off her left shoulder.

Assessing myself one last time in the mirror, I straighten my jacket and head out to meet the others. I arrived at Halfmoon as someone’s fiancé. When I return I'll be someone’s wife.

Luna takes me hand just before we teleport… “Alright then. Let’s get you married.”

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“After so many years of teleporting you think I’d be used to it by now.”

“You seem to be getting better with it though compared how you used to be when I teleported you somewhere. Maybe your just one of those people who doesn’t go well with teleportation. It’s only like Mermista getting sea sick every now and then, which is ironic considering she is the princess of the seas.”

Sparkles snickers at her remark but she does show some sympathy in making sure that I am okay as the dizziness slowly starts to wear off. She teleported us to an area just outside of where mine and Adora’s wedding ceremony is going to be taking place. Entrapta and Scorpia went to take their seats at the top of the isle, whilst Melog and Luna have decided to stay near to where Sparkles dropped us off to speak with Micah for a little while. Now it’s just me and Sparkles as she walks me through the Whispering Woods towards where I'll find Adora.

“You know, the more I think about it, the more I like the fact that you and Adora have gone against tradition and have decided to see each other before the ceremony. It’s a very *you* thing to do. Do you mind if I ask why you suggested it?”

“Well you know me Sparkles. Adora and I are never one to follow tradition.” - I laugh nervously as I think over the true reason as to why I asked if we could do this…

“If I tell you, you have to promise not to tell Adora. She doesn’t know the true reason as to why I asked this of her, at least not yet anyway.”

Sparkles stops in her tracks for a moment, giving me a questioning look but then smiles and nods for me to continue…

“The reason why I ask to see Adora before we officially get married is because throughout my life, right before something changed, whether it be for better or worse, Adora was there. I always saw her or heard her voice before anything happened."

Sparkles tilts her head slightly in curiosity as she waits for me to continue...

"When I was found in the Horde's corridor, Adora was there. When I decided to stay with the Horde after she left for the Rebellion, the last thing I saw was Adora. When I sent you to her back when we were fighting the intergalactic Horde before *he* started to control my mind, the last voice I heard was Adora's. When Prime took my last life, my last sight and thought was Adora. When I opened my eyes again and I finally knew that I was safe, it was Adora who held me close and promised to bring me home. Little did Adora know back then that I was already home, she was my home, she always had been my home."

Looking up to the sky, I notice Dusk fly over us. She's probably doing a surveillance scan. It reminds me of the days back when Adora and I were up at our secret spot back in the Fright Zone. We'd often see the silhouette of an Etherian Moon Owl fly over us. It's was a memorable sight to see...

"The point is I have always seen Adora before something major happened in my life and yes I know I'll see her walking down the aisle, but I want to keep our little tradition of seeing each other before the next chapter of our lives begin, that next chapter becoming wives."

The thought of being able to have one final moment alone with Adora before our wedding makes my heart soar and my smile beam even brighter. I can't wait to see her. I know for a fact that she is going to look wonderful. It's going to be difficult not to cry when I see her.

Speaking of crying, I hear a hiccup sound coming from beside me. I turn to my side and notice that Sparkles tears have started to fall early. Time for a bit of teasing...

"Wow. You really are an ugly crier."

Sparkles can't help but laugh as she shoves me in the shoulder gently…

“Piss of Horde scum. You’ve been listening to Bow too much. He’s going to be crying more than me when you and Adora say your vows. We’ve already shared enough happy tears this morning when getting Adora ready for today. She looks amazing.”

“I have no doubt that she does.”

Sparkles walks me a few step further forward until she meets up with Arrow Bow. He's looking rather well dressed in his pale blue suit, with a pink flower attach to his lapel and signature heart symbol wore on his sleeve. I could have placed money that his suit shirt would have the design of a crop top. He can be so predictable.

“Morning Catra. You’re looking rather stunning.” - Bow says as he goes to loop his arm around *fiancé*, giving her a light kiss on the cheek. He has to bend down to the height difference… “Are you ready for the big day?”

“More than ready Arrow Boy. I take it this is where you both leave me?”

Sparkles is the one who answers… “Yep it is. Adora I believe is just a few more steps ahead. You’ll find her easy. When you’re ready just head back to where I teleported you before and we'll get you to hitched. Don’t be late.”

In the blink of an eye, Sparkles and Arrow Boy sparkle away and I’m left on my own, ready to continue my search for Adora, my very soon-to-be wife.

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The Whispering Woods breeze is gentle and calming. It feels as though the magic within the woods is guiding me towards the love of my life. It's not long before I find her, standing facing away from me, looking up at the Crystal castle. I know she sometimes comes here to talk to Mara, the She-Ra before her. I know that we may not have known Mara in person, she lived a thousand years before us, but Adora told me that she came to visit her not long before the Heart of Etheria, to remind her that she too is worthy of love.

Taking a few deep breathes I emerge from the bushes and walk towards the love of my life…

"Hey Adora."

As Adora turns to face me, she smiles and a few tears managed to escape from my eyes. Adora dress is a mix of white, gold and blue. Her dress is a glorious white in colour and fits perfectly to the contours of her body and waist. Her shoulders are almost completely exposed, only the gold lining of her straps drape over her collar bone and shoulders. The thick band that goes around her waist, almost as if splitting her dress in two is the same colour of blue as her eyes. My engagement gift to her is attached to the band on her left side, just above her hip. She is wearing flat golden shoes. As sensible choice if you ask me. Her gorgeous long blonde hair has been let down loose, draping over her right shoulder. I notice at the back of her hair, she has two tiny braids that meet in the middle, tiny white chrysanthemums have been carefully placed in the twists.

Completely lost for words and desperately trying to stop more tears from falling, I surge forwards at a fast pace, wrapping my arms around Adora and pull her into a passionate kiss. Adora's arms wrap around my shoulders loosely as she returns my kiss with just as much passion and enthusiasm. When we pull away, simply to catch our breathes, I notice that Adora has a few loose tears falling from her eyes. I gently brush them away with the stroke of my thumb as I desperately try my best to hold my own back. I just about manage it.

“Adora you look wonderful.”

Adora giggles slightly through her now steadying tears… “You really think so?”

“Are you kidding me? Have you not looked at yourself in the mirror this morning? Adora you are most beautiful sight I have ever seen. Quite possibly the most beautiful sight in the whole of Etheria. Maybe even the whole universe.”

“Oh stop it.”

“I’m serious.”

Adora starts to laugh which causes me to start laughing to. I can’t believe that this person, this amazing woman, my best friend, will soon be my wife. As Adora’s laughter dies down she starts to fiddle with the lapels of my jacket…

“You look rather wonderful too. You really do suite a suit. You look just as good as the time you wore that red one to the Princess Prom. Do you remember that night?”

“How could I forget it. That dress you wore made me *feel* things Adora. I couldn’t get that imagine of you out of my head for weeks.”

Adora giggle-snots as she relives that memory… “That suit of yours had the same effect on me. Not to mention when you dipped me, I knew what you were doing back then.”

Oh she has no idea what I plan to do at the end of the ceremony does she? I t will be quite the surprise for her. I wanted to pull her into a kiss so badly that night. Guess I'll have to make up for it today.

Smiling at the memory, I move slightly to rest my forehead against Adora’s. She hums softly when we make contact and we let the time pass us by for a few quite minutes…

“You nervous?” - Adora asks as she holds me close.

“A little bit. Although, I’m more excited about starting the next chapter of our lives together. What about you?”

“Same here. I think it would be wrong if we weren’t feeling a little bit nervous and excited at the same time. Catra, we’re about to get married. We’re about to become wives. Did you ever think we’d get to this moment.”

“Honestly… no, not really. But that's because I didn’t know about marriage until after the war ended.”

Adora laughs knowing exactly what I mean. Her answer would probably be the same as mine if it wasn't for the nerves. We only learned about families, relationships and marriage after the war ended. Horde education didn’t care to teach you that kind of stuff. We had to figure all that out on our own.

Instinct guides me closer to Adora as I finish my sentence...

“But after learning about all that of, I couldn’t wait to spend the rest of my life with you. I dreamed about this moment for a long time Adora. I dreamed about sharing the rest of my life with you. I can’t wait to call you my wife.”

Leaning in slowly, I gently kiss Adora on the lips once more. Compared our last kiss, this is soft, gentle and relaxed. We take our time. We have nowhere to be just yet. This will probably be the last kiss we share as fiancés as the next time I get to kiss her we’ll be wives. Adora hums slightly in disappointment as I remove my lips from hers. She goes to chase mine, causing me to laugh slightly at her little pout. Taking a few steps away form her, leaving her gentle hold, I smile softly before reaching my hand out towards her…

“You coming?”

Adora smiles brightly and it’s clear from the look in her memorizing blue eyes that she is once again trying her best to

hold back tears. I know those words mean many things to her, they hold a silent promise that all will be okay once she takes my hand in hers. Knowing this, Adora smiles and takes my hand, holding it tightly as we start to whisper silent promises to each other as we walk back towards the start of the next chapter of our lives together.

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When Adora and I arrive back to where the ceremony is taking place, Melog, Luna, Dusk, Swift Wind, Micah, Sparkles and Arrow Boy are all ready and waiting for us. Our ceremony is happening the exact location that Adora and I stood after the magic from the Heart of Etheria was released. Only Adora and I know what lies beneath our feet and what happen deep down underground.

We discussed where to have our ceremony for a long time but we eventually settled on this exact location for three reasons. One being because it's out in the open but only those who were there when the magic was released know where to find it, making it the perfect spot for a small wedding with our friends and family. Two being because it's almost in the same spot where Adora and I confessed our love for each other, only this time it's above ground and not underground within the tunnels, which was initially guarded by the First-Ones creature. Finally, three being because the scenery at this view is beautiful and will look incredible on our wedding pictures.

"Oh good you're here and in the nick of time. Glimmer was worry you were going to be late."

"Bow you're not supposed to tell them that!"

"Oh please they're not bothered. Besides knowing you, you'll be late to our own wedding anyway."

“Can’t be late to something that we haven’t even started planning yet.”

Sparkles and Arrow Boy start bickering back and forth with the pre-marriage banter. Bow only proposed a few month ago anyway so, speaking from experience, they’ve got a lot of planning ahead of them.

Swift Wind is the first of them all to greet us before asking Adora is she can help fix his bow-tie. Apparently it’s been wonky after he took a little excited flight and he can’t fix it himself because of… *well…* hooves. Once sorted, he gives Adora an over the shoulder hug and goes to join Scorpia and Entrapta at the top of the isle.

Dusk flies over to Adora for Luna’s shoulder shortly after and nuzzles up against Adora’s cheek. She chirps to me in greeting before flying away, being sure to brush my ear with her wing as she goes past, before sitting besides Scorpia on her custom made perch. She already have a fiddle with a loose strand of my mane this morning so I at least know my hair is looking okay now as she'd not fiddled with it again since.

Melog rolls their eyes and comes up to Adora's side, nudging themselves against her knee. Adora kneels down to them, straighten their small, light blue coloured dicky-bow tie...

“You look very handsome Melog. That bow suites you. Blue really is your colour.”

Mreow

They say thank you and compliment Adora on how beautiful she looks. Unlike Swift Wind, Melog stays besides me as they will be walking me down the aisle with Luna.

Luna is next to greet Adora, pulling her into a warm embrace… “You look stunning Adora, absolutely wonderful.”

“Thank you Luna. Oh did you remember to bring the thing?”

"Of course I did. Dusk helped me selected them. Glimmer has them ready for you."

"What thing?" - I ask, partially curious and confused.

Adora smiles with her devilish smirk… "You'll see."

Before I have time to question Adora further Micah interrupts…

"Well don't you two look smart. I'd love to give you more time together but it will soon be time for the ceremony to begin. I entrust that you have your vows prepared. Adora if you'd like to go and wait with Glimmer and Bow, they're escort you down the isle to Catra in a few moments time. Catra when you are ready, Luna and Melog will walk you to the top. Don't worry, Bow and I have the tissues ready for anyone who might need them."

All of us start to laugh at Micah's words. So far I have been able to keep my tears at bay but I feel that when I see Adora walking down the aisle some are going to fall.

Adora squeezes my hand one last time and we exchange whispered words of *'I love you'* to each other before we go our separate ways. Our eyes never leave each other until Adora disappears from my vision. When I turn back to face Luna and Melog they both have bright smiles on their faces.

Luna reaches for my hand as I take a soft hold of hers. She gives it a gentle squeeze… "You ready?"

I smile happily... "To marry the love of my life? I'm more than ready."

Luna offers me her right arms from me to link, whilst Melog stands on my right side. Together, we walk down the aisle.

Our friends and family smile and stand, watching me in awe as I reach the top. Everyone who is important to us is here. Members of the Rebellion, including honorary members such as Bow's dads, Castaspella and her wife General Juliette, Madam Razz, Double

Trouble, Huntara, Entrapta's robot Emily and Wrong Hordak. Some of the Magicats we have gotten to know over the past year have also come to join in with the celebration: general Jax is one of them. The Star siblings have also traveled far to be here today. Even our first family from back from when we were in the Horde are here to celebrate: Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio. It means a lot to have them here.

Mreow – "Are you still feeling nervous?"

I answer them without speaking words… *"Surprisingly, no. Not anymore."*

The reason why my nervousness has completely disappeared is because of the person, the love of my life, my soulmate, slowly walking down the aisle towards me, towards our new beginning. Music is softly playing as Sparkles and Arrow Boy walk Adora down the aisle. Some people whisper words of how wonderful she looks and other people are crying.

Bow and Scorpia are two of those people who are crying right now.

However, in spite of all this, I find it hard to focus on anything but Adora. I am completely memorised by how radiant, stunning and beautiful she looks as she walk towards me. It's only when she gets a little bit closer that I release what her and Luna's *'little secret'* was that they were discussing earlier. In Adora's hand, she holds a well-presented bouquet of pure white chrysanthemums. They look exactly like the ones that my mom had on her wedding day and they perfectly match the flower attached to my jacket lapel.

I turn to my mom, who smiles at me knowingly, before turning back to face Adora, smiling even brighter than before. I'm unable to hold back my tears when Adora arrives at the top of the aisle, so I let a few of them fall. Adora hands her bouquet over to Sparkles, before returning to face me, gentle brushing my tears away with the gentle touch of her hand. She then takes my hands

in her and we rest our foreheads together. The purr that emits from my chest is incredibly loud. I wouldn't be surprised if everyone can hear me but I don't care. I don't think I've ever felt this happy.

"Catra you know if you start crying then I'll start crying."

"I can't help it. You look incredibly beautiful Adora. I'm the luckiest person in the world."

"Well that's impossible because I'm the luckiest person in the world because I'm getting to marry you."

Adora and I giggle quietly as we take in the final few moments of peace to ourselves. My tail moves to gently brush over Adora's bare hand where her ring will eventually be place when we say our vows.

After a moment or two, and after hearing people whisper in awe, Micah clears his throat altering us that he is ready when we are. Luna, Melog, Sparkles and Arrow Boy all take their seats with the others. Adora and I separate slightly but are hands keep a firm hold on each other. Our eyes remain completely fixated on the other, looking at them with astonishing amounts of unconditional love and support. I get lost looking into Adora's eyes everytime. They've always been so memorizing, so beautiful. It's no wonder its one of her first features that I fell in love with.

"Welcome everyone. We gather here today to witness the long awaited union of these two lovely people: Catra and Adora. I would have stated their full names but after speaking to them both before the ceremony we decided against it."

Everyone laughs, including Adora and myself. It was something we had discuss but the more we thought about it we more we realised how stupid our childhood names really are. Blamed our middle name choices on lack of imagination. Besides, we're not actually sure how many people know our full names. We know the Rebellion members know. Mermista made quite the scene when

she found out our full names, it was like she had never laughed so hard before in her life. Anyway, it doesn't matter what our full names are. To many we are simply Catra and Adora.

Micah clears his throat once more and continues to speak…

"Love is one of the most powerful feelings that anyone can experience in their lives. It is also a joy to witness love flourishing and growing in all forms. I speak for many when I say that we have had the great honour of watching the love that these two here have for each other develop over the years. Some had the honour of witnessing their love blossom long before these two even knew what love was. Others witnessed it in times of great struggle and came together to help them power through in times of the others absence. Others have come to watch their love grow more recently, listening to the stories of their times past."

As Micah speaks, Adora and I briefly look towards our friends and family. First we look to our first family: Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio. Lonnie used to tease us all the time. Saying that we were blind to see what was right in front of us. Looking back now it makes complete sense.

Then Adora looks to Sparkles and Arrow Boy, where as I look to Scorpia and Entrapta. The Super Pal Trio was there for me in the most difficult of times. Despite everything, they were there for me and at the end of it all they forgave me, no questions asked.

I then look to Sparkles and Arrow Bow. They kept Adora safe when I couldn't keep my promise to her. They were there for her when she was at her lowest point, and witnessed her opening her heart to me, even thought Adora didn't know it back then.

When Micah mentions those who are only just witnessing our love for each other in recent times, I look towards my mom, Melog and Dusk. Melog got to witness the start out mine and Adora's relationship, even though they were unaware of the roots that forged my love for her. We only met Luna and Dusk just over two years ago. My mom has listened to all of our stories, both good

and bad, and helped us through some tough times with her help and guidance. Through it all she's seen how strong our love is for one another. How unique our love is for each other.

After a short pause Micah continues...

"I strongly believe that anyone who has witnessed the love that these two have for each other will tell you that there is something very special about them. It's not everyday you find yourself lucky enough to be marrying the person you grew up with, the person who you first fell in love with. When you find that special someone you hold onto them tight and you never let go. No matter how hard things get, not matter how hopeless things feel, you hold onto that person because they are the only thing in life that matters. They're the reason you keep going. They're the reason your love keeps burning brightly. That kind of love is what saves the universe."

Adora and I giggle to each other softly and rest our foreheads together once more whilst we are given the opportunity to do so. It's our way of showing each other how much we me to one another when words cannot be spoken. We know exactly what Micah means by his words, even though only Adora and I know what really happen that day.

Our friends and family look at us with heart eyes. I see Sparkles hand Arrow Boy a set of tissues from behind at one point and Micah having to clear his eyes as well...

"Now if I was to follow tradition I would be asking at this point in the ceremony *'if anyone objects to this marriage, speak now or forever hold your peace'*, but I won't be doing that as there is obviously no need for it. It is clear for all to see that the love Catra and Adora have for each other is the most beautiful, most powerful kind of love there is. As well as that I was *threatened* by the fact my own daughter would disown me if I said that..."

All of us burst out with laughter when Micah jokes about why he won't be following tradition. It's good to know that our friends

have our back. Although he does speak truth with the fact that the love that Adora and I have for each other, in it's own way, is unique, powerful and beautiful.

"Now is the time for the exchange of rings and vows. Adora, Catra, I believe you have prepared your own vows and that your friends have your rings at hand. Although, I should mention that your friends actually have your rings on a pillow as neither of your ring bearers have hands. Adora, would you like to go first?"

Adora smiles to herself and takes a few steady breathes. She gives my hand a firm yet gentle squeeze. I can sense that she's nervous. I start to purr softly one more and I start to rubs slow circles across the back of her hands. Instantly, this seems to relax her and she finds the courage to speak from the heart…

"Catra… I will admit that I am quite surprised that we have somehow manged to get to this point today. I often dreamed about getting to spend the rest of my life with you but for a long time it felt like it could be nothing more than a dream. Our paths seemed to have different journeys for us to take. A path that I feared would take me away from you, the person I loved most in my life."

In a way she's not wrong. Our destinies did mean that we had to spend some time away from each other but in true motion, that time a part only made us stronger, more determined to be together...

"However, despite everything, the hardships and the difficult times, we challenged our so called destinies and forged our own paths, a path that led us back to each other. I was scared to fall in love with you because I was scared of not being good enough for you. I was afraid that after everything we had been though, after how hard we had to fight to be together, that we wouldn't be able to rekindle our relationship."

The three simple words *'I love you'* can change everything in the matter of a single heartbeat. It can go one of two major ways. It

can be the start of something new or the end of a friendship. It's why I kept my true feelings hidden for so long. I didn't want to loose Adora again. Strangely, love is more powerful than people think. Eventually the true will come out and guide you home. It will make you admit your feelings for one another, especially in the scariest of times.

"Although, it soon became clear that my love for you wouldn't allow me to give up so easily. I had to tell you how I felt about you even if the worst should happen. I have never felt love so powerful, so strong, so wonderful for anyone but you Catra. You are the reason why love is so beautiful. When I found you in that box all those years ago something started to change within me. As we grew, new feelings started to emerge. I wanted to be around you all the time, I wanted to protect you, I wanted to love you for the rest of my life. Back then I didn't know what all of that meant but now I do. All I have to do is look at you and know that I am safe and I am loved. I found my soulmate."

A small tear escapes from one of my eyes but Adora is quick to catch it before it can fall. She then turns to Swift Wind, who carries my ring on a soft blue pillow. Adora and I purposefully made our own wedding rings simply because we could. They're gold in colour but have a small symbol etched in the centre: the Heart of Etheria symbol. Adora takes the ring from Swift Wind and opens my hand so she can hold it properly. As she speak, she slides the purposefully made ring onto my ring finger…

"You are my life, my world, my soulmate… *my Catra.* We made many promises over the years and now I want to add to them all. I promise to love you, cherish you and protect with all of my heart for the rest of eternity. You are my everything and I can't wait to spend the rest of my life with you. I love you more than words can say. When word fails, I'll remind us both our life long promise: *'You look out for me and I look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other.'"*

"You Promise?" - I ask, just like all those times before.

“I Promise. I love you Catra.”

The struggle to not pull Adora into a kiss there and then is real. I’m only just managing to hold back my tears.

That promise that I said has stuck with us our whole lives. Many believe that we had broken it on numerous occasions, and at one point so did we, but looking back I realise that we never really broke it. When we pushed the other away, we did it to protect the one we love.When I told Adora to stay away to protect herself, she ignored me and came to my rescue and went through all the hardships that came with it. When I ran because I didn’t want to see the one I love to sacrifice herself from some stupid destiny, my heart forced me to turn around and be with her, to tell her how much she meant to me because I worried that I’d never get the chance to tell her how much I loved her.

Through thick and thin we looked out for each other, loved each other, kept our promise to each other.

Micah turns to me, reminding me that it is now my turn to exchange vows and rings. Melog comes up behind me, ring at the ready on a red pillow for me to take when ready. I take a few deep breathes, clearing my mind and thinking of our happiest memories. Adora’s thumbs gently brush over the top of my hands. When I look to her eyes, she looks to me full of love. Her smile gives me all the courage I need to speak form the heart…

“Adora… how on earth am I meant to beat your vows?”

Everyone laughs, including Adora. I love making her laugh, making her smile. Stars she means everything to me…

“As you know I have never been the greatest when it comes to speaking from the heart as I never used to be the best at processing my emotion. However, loving you has made what was once difficult much easier, and I am no longer afraid to wear my heart on my sleeve and speak from the heart..."

Adora smile brightly, knowing exactly what I mean by this. In the past, I kept my emotions hidden, kept my true feeling locked away. Fear of what would happen if I spoke the truth were the cause of that. However, with Adora's support and love, I've learned to let go of fear and allow my true feelings to break free. I feel free... like I can be me. Adora made the process of accepting myself and loving myself for who I really am much easier. I find myself falling in love with her more and more each day.

"We've come so far from where our story began all those years ago. You gave me my name, became my best friend, showed me the good side of life but most importantly you showed me how to love. If it wasn't for you saving me that day I don't know where I'd be right now. We've been through a lot together. Some memories are good, others not so good, but no matter what we always came out stronger than before."

My hands start to tremble a little. Some memories still haunt us. After all these years you think we'd be over it but the truth is it's never been that simple. Many moments from our past will live with us forever, reminding us of the things we've been through, both good and bad. What matters now is how we choose to deal with them and how we choose to move on. We'll help each other through every sleepless night, through ever panicking moment, through every argument... no matter what we'll be there for each other, just like we always have been.

Adora gives my hands a gentle squeeze, helping me to relax once more. We're both desperately trying to hold back tears. Adora's beautiful smiles reflects my own and I continues with my vows...

"The love that I have for you, the love that still grows stronger each day because of you, is the reason I am standing her today. You are part of the reason why I am the person I am today. Adora, I loved you long before I even knew what love was. I was afraid to tell you all those years ago about how much I cared for you because I was scared that you wouldn't feel the same. Being able to love you freely and having you loving me back was nothing but a dream, but then my dream came true. I thank my

lucky stars that I now get to call my best friends, the love of my life, my soulmate... my now wife. I know I used to say that everything I did was *'not because I like you.'* What I was really saying was *'it's not because I like you… it's because I love you'*."

A small tear starts to leave Adora gorgeous blue eyes as her voice hitches slightly. My hand softly rest against her cheek and I use my thumb to gently brush it away. Adora's hand moves to hold mine against her cheek for a moment or two as she leans into my touch. Smiling brightly, I turn to Melog and take Adora's ring from them. Lifting Adora's hand, I gently slide the wedding ring onto her finger…

"Adora, you mean more to me than words can say. You are my home, my world, my soulmate… *my Adora*. As you said in your vows we have made many promises to each other over the years and I have no doubt that many more will be made in our future together. I promise to love you, care for you, and remind you everyday just how much you mean to me. I will never stop loving you Adora. *'You look out for me and I look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other.'"*

Adora says the part that almost finishes our promises… "You promise?"

"I promise. I love you Adora. I always have."

Still unable to officially kiss Adora yet, we settle for resting our heads together. In the corner of my eye I can see out friends and family smiling happily and sharing tears of joy. However, I can only focus on the most beautiful sight in the whole of Etheria who is standing incredibly close to me. The evening sun slowly closes in, shining beautifully over the scenery behind us and lightly up the Heart of Etheria symbol etched on our rings.

Eager to kiss her, I loudly say to the crowd whilst not taking my eyes of her for a second… "Can I kiss her yet?!"

Everybody laughs including Adora. I can tell she's just as eager as me. I can feel her trembling. I have no doubt about it that some Adora will be teasing me about this moment for the rest of my life.

Micah speaks the words that I have long await to hear since the moment Adora walked down the aisle…

"It is with deepest pride and great honour that I now pronounce Adora and Catra as wives. You may kiss the bride."

Before Micah can even finish his sentence, I skillfully yet carefully dip Adora into the same pose that we did so many years ago back at the Princess Prom. Adora was clearly not expecting it from how bright her cheeks begin to burn. I start to laugh at the adorable sight, but my giggles are quickly cut short when Adora pulls on my lapel jacket, closing the gap between us as kissing me passionately. At first I'm caught off guard but I easily relax into the kiss when Adora's hands come to rest around my shoulder. Our friends and family cheer as we share our first official kiss as wives.

Adora and I smile into our kiss, momentarily forgetting that there are people around us celebrating our union. When we part, Adora's smile is as radiant as ever, her eyes beautifully memorizing. She giggle-snorts when she seem how flushed my cheeks are from having been caught me off guard.

Laughing with her I quietly whisper… "You're such an idiot."

"I know, but I'm now officially your idiot *forever*." - Adora responds, showing me her wedding ring to emphasize her point.

I start to laugh even harder… "I wouldn't have it any other way. I love you."

"Awww. I love you too."

Adora passionately kisses me again as I gently lift us up and out of the dip. When we part our friends and family comes forward

and surround us. The first person I hug, *besides Adora obviously*, is my mom. She has tears her eyes and a beaming smile on her face. She whispers how happy she is for us both and how proud she is. Dusk and Melog are the next two friends I hug. From behind Scorpia pulls me into a bone crushing hug, lifting me high into the air as she tears of joy. Madam Razz, Sparkles, Arrow Boy, Netossa and Spinneralla are next to hug me.

Before we head to the Fright Zone for our wedding reception and meal, we all gather round and have a big family photo in front of the beautiful Etherian scenery behind us.

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As the night draws to a close, Adora and I decided to head up to our secret spot back at the place where our story began: the watch tower. We decided to have our celebrations back here in the Fright Zone, now perfectly renamed and refurbished 'Friend Zone', as we wanted to celebrate our marriage somewhere close to where our story began. We discussed it for a while, Brightmoon was even suggested due to it glorious ballroom. However, the more we thought about it the more we realised that our very first home was a perfect place to celebrate our marriage.

Many stories were told, tears of laughter and joy were shared. Sparkles was the one who managed to catch Adora’s bouquet of flowers when she threw them into the crowd. Sparkles joked with Arrow Boy that they better get a move on with making plans for their wedding. I wonder what Netossa and Spinneralla will make bets out of with their wedding.

Our first dance was perfect, definitely one to remember. Holding Adora close as we let the days events to wash over us was very emotional. It meant the world to us both having the people we care about the most join us, our family and our friends here with

us to celebrate. After all was said and done, Adora and I decided to come up to our secret spot to relax for a little while and simply enjoy some alone time.

“Beautiful sight isn’t it?” - Adora says as she look out towards the clear night sky, the stars and moons shining extra bright tonight.

“Yeah. It is.” - I say, looking towards Adora rather than the scenery before is.

When Adora notices that I’m referring to her rather than the midnight sky, she blushes deeply and giggles. I love seeing her smile, making her laugh, and making sure she knows how much I love her. I can’t believe that I get to spend the rest of my life with her.

Adora’s smile soon become that devilish smirk of hers. She hums, confirming that she is up to something. She takes a few steps back from the railing an reaches her hand out to me…

"May I have this dance?"

I end up laughing to myself as I gracefully take Adora's hand… “Why of course. Just try to not step on my toes this time.”

“I didn’t step on them during our first dance did I?”

“No you didn’t, I’ll give you that. But I recon you only managed to not step on my toes this time because of the amount of dance lesson we had before that.”

Adora and I both end up in a state of laughter remembering the many times we had accidentally stepped on each other’s toes both recently and during our dancing lessons back in our youth. The Horde made it a mandatory session to learn how to dance in case we ever had to attend a formal event a go undercover. Adora and I always partnered up together as we felt most comfortable with each other. Really I just loved to piss off a certain someone but getting to be close to Adora was a bonus. I was always the better dancer. I had better coordination and timing but I had to avoid

accidentally stepping on my tail. It took Adora a little bit of time to get this good at dancing.

Gently, I rest my head against Adora's shoulder, listening to her steady heart beat coming from her pulse point. I wrap her arms around her waist and hold her close. Adora places a soft kiss to the top of my mane before resting her head there, wrapping her arms around me in a warm embrace. We start to steadily sway backwards and forwards. I begin to hum a soft tune as we go. No word need to be said. All our words are spoken through our hearts and said through our kisses and soft touches. For now it's nice to simply hold each other like this and let time pass us by.

Adora's body starts to shiver slightly under my touch when a short gust of wind breezes past us…

"Are you cold?" - I ask as I start to remove my jacket. I don't give Adora the chance to answer before I'm securing it over her shoulder.

"Thank you." - Adora whisper as she softly kisses my cheek.

Once my jacket is secure on Adora's shoulders, we walk over to the area of the tower that has no safety rail. We sit with our legs dangling over the edge. Adora lovingly rests her head on my left shoulder and takes one of my hands in her. I place a soft kiss to the top of her forehead as my tail moves to wrap around her back. Content with the peaceful moment, I begin to purr.

"How you feeling?" - Adora asks.

"Amazing. Wonderful. Extravagant. I'm not sure one word does my feelings justice Adora. I've just married my soulmate. It doesn't get much better than that. How you feeling? You okay?"

Adora smiles and hums to herself as she listens to my words. She gives my hand a gentle squeeze before she responds…

"I'm more than okay. I've just married my best friend. The most beautiful, amazing, wonderful Magicat in the whole universe. I've

married my soulmate. There's too many words to describe how I feel... but maybe I can show you how I feel."

Adora's hand brushes against my cheek as she pulls me in for a soft, passionate kiss. Our kiss is soft, warm and caring. It's shouldn't feel any different to when we've kiss before but for some reason it does. It feels like the start of the next chapter in our lives, a new beginning.

When we part, *simply because we have to breathe*, a soft hum escapes Adora and I begin to purr even louder. We rest our foreheads together, something that happens almost instinctively. At that moment, Adora and I speak the words that have more meaning than they seem and words that I know we will be saying for the rest of our lives.

"I love you Adora."

"I love you too Catra."

We spend most of the night up at our secret little spot, enjoying each other company and letting the fact that we are no each other wives sink in. Tomorrow we will head back home and start this new chapter in our lives. What adventures and challenges lie ahead I do not know, but what I do know is that I'll be able to take them all head on with Adora by my side.

Over in the distance, the silhouette of an Etherian Moon Owl flies above us just like it did all those years ago when made many promises and shared many memories up here at our secret spot.

Chapter End Notes

> There you have it. Finding Halfmoon has officially concluded 😊.
>
> Where has the time gone? It only feels like yesterday I started sharing this story with you. The final extra content chapter has also been released. Go and check it out (link

here: https://archiveofourown.org/works/39964356). It's the epilogue from Adora's POV. Hope you enjoy.

Thank you all for liking, following and commenting on my fic throughout this incredible journey, especially on the longer chapters. Your kind words mean the world to me. I really hoped you enjoyed reading Finding Halfmoon. Thank you for being amazing readers. 🥰

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!